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CITY OF BERKELEY

BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL SPECIAL and REGULAR MEETINGS

May 19, 2026

WEBVTT

1
00:00:21.110 --> 00:00:21.980
Boardroom: Okay.

2
00:00:35.630 --> 00:00:48.669
Boardroom: Okay, hello everyone! Good afternoon. I'm calling to order a special meeting of the Berkeley City Council. Today is Tuesday, May 19th. It is 4.03 p.m. Clerk, could you please start us off with a roll?

3
00:00:48.910 --> 00:00:53.110
Boardroom: Okay, Councilmember Castarwani is currently absent.

4
00:00:53.570 --> 00:00:56.269
Boardroom: Councilmember Taplin is currently absent.

5
00:00:57.700 --> 00:01:00.180
Boardroom: Member Bartlett is currently absent.

6
00:01:01.160 --> 00:01:02.900
Boardroom: Vice Mayor Chevum?

7
00:01:03.000 --> 00:01:03.770
Boardroom: Peasant.

8
00:01:04.040 --> 00:01:11.989
Boardroom: Councilmember O'Keefe? I'm here. Blackaby? Here. Unapara? Here. Humber? Present. And Mayor Isi? Here.

9
00:01:12.130 --> 00:01:16.079
Boardroom: Okay, quorum is present. Alright, so for our action calendar for this.

10
00:01:16.170 --> 00:01:32.460
Boardroom: We really have one item on here, which is the presentation and discussion of the second community survey results and direction regarding

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potential ballot measures for the November 3rd, 2026 general municipal election, and I will pass it over to our city manager.

11
00:01:32.810 --> 00:01:45.899
Boardroom: Thank you, Mayor. Thank you for the opportunity to present today. We are excited, our esteemed panel of staff experts here, as well as our lake research partner firm that did the community survey.

12
00:01:46.000 --> 00:01:53.720
Boardroom: They are online. So we're excited to present the results of the community survey that was conducted for the $300 million

13
00:01:53.900 --> 00:02:01.519
Boardroom: geobond for infrastructure, and the half-cent sales and use tax measure. We have a lot of

14
00:02:01.720 --> 00:02:16.310
Boardroom: information to go through, both on the, results of the survey, as well as an update on our project revisions, that were largely driven by a lot of conversations with the community, conversations with council members, etc.

15
00:02:16.360 --> 00:02:30.600
Boardroom: A reminder that we're not here tonight asking you to vote on ballot measure language, we're not… we'll come back with that, but we're wanting the approval to move forward after you hear the presentation from staff and Lake Research Partners. So…

16
00:02:30.840 --> 00:02:36.009
Boardroom: With that, we're excited to walk through all this, and I will turn it over to Deputy City Manager White.

17
00:02:36.930 --> 00:02:49.859
Boardroom: Thank you, City Manager. Good evening, Mayor and City Council. David White, Deputy City Manager. Just to begin the presentation and explain a little bit about what we hope to accomplish this evening, just to amplify a little bit of what our

18
00:02:49.940 --> 00:03:05.930
Boardroom: City Manager shared. So, we'll start off with some background and context, just to set the stage, for why we're here tonight. Subsequent to that, we are going to bring forward Lake Research Partners to talk about the results of the second community survey that we administered in April.

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19
00:03:06.280 --> 00:03:14.109
Boardroom: Then we are going to talk more specifically about, the general obligation bond, that is being proposed and some of its impacts.

20
00:03:14.330 --> 00:03:27.640
Boardroom: And, importantly, we're going to talk about the project portfolio that we brought to you, actually, back in December of 2025. And I'll touch on, in a little bit, about all the work that's been done to help refine, that project portfolio.

21
00:03:27.750 --> 00:03:31.819
Boardroom: Sorry, can I just check, Mr. City Clerk, is our volume okay online?

22
00:03:36.680 --> 00:03:41.740
Boardroom: Sorry about the interruption, I just want to make sure folks at home can hear you okay.

23
00:03:54.520 --> 00:04:01.320
Boardroom: Okay, I have other sources telling me that the volume is okay, so… Let's see…

24
00:04:24.990 --> 00:04:25.890
Boardroom: I think we're good.

25
00:04:26.040 --> 00:04:26.940
Boardroom: Thank you.

26
00:04:28.250 --> 00:04:29.530
Boardroom: Great, thank you.

27
00:04:29.850 --> 00:04:43.650
Boardroom: And then, after we talk about the general obligation bond, we'll talk about the sales and use tax that is also proposed for the November 2026 ballot, and we'll conclude that discussion with next steps and the timeline moving forward.

28
00:04:45.500 --> 00:04:48.380
Boardroom: So, in front of you,

29
00:04:48.760 --> 00:04:50.429
Boardroom: Why's that up on the screen?

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30
00:04:51.960 --> 00:04:57.940
Boardroom: Sorry, Mark, I think that… that we need to close this settings, box.

31
00:05:05.390 --> 00:05:07.430
Boardroom: Sorry about that, again. No, it's okay.

32
00:05:15.100 --> 00:05:15.860
Boardroom: Exclosed.

33
00:05:16.900 --> 00:05:23.630
Boardroom: Mark, it's good. Mark, we're good. Alright, great. Sorry about that. Ready? We're good. No problem. We got this. No problem. No problem.

34
00:05:23.730 --> 00:05:29.740
Boardroom: So, what this slide just highlights are the recommended actions that are in front of you.

35
00:05:29.790 --> 00:05:44.580
Boardroom: This evening. We had previously received direction from Council to proceed with ballot language for a $300 million general obligation bond, and we're seeking Council's affirmation to continue, that hard work in partnership with our city attorney's office.

36
00:05:44.920 --> 00:06:01.340
Boardroom: Secondly, with the team in front of you, we hope to unpack and discuss more about the project list, the infrastructure projects that are part of this package, and talk about what the state of that project list is, where changes have occurred.

37
00:06:01.550 --> 00:06:05.879
Boardroom: And to provide some recommendations about those projects as well.

38
00:06:06.110 --> 00:06:17.799
Boardroom: And then lastly, similar to the general obligation bond, Council has given us direction to proceed with a half percent increase in the sales and use tax to address our structural deficit in our general fund.

39
00:06:17.800 --> 00:06:26.880

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Boardroom: And again, after we talk about how those proceeds could be used, seeking Council's, direction and affirmation to continue, with that work.

40
00:06:29.300 --> 00:06:34.949
Boardroom: So to talk a little bit more about, context before we transition over to the community survey.

41
00:06:35.030 --> 00:06:53.819
Boardroom: At a high level, the city's exploration of the 2026 ballot measures really reflect two significant and related realities that we're dealing with as a city. First and foremost, as all of us know, we have a significant unfunded infrastructure liability, anywhere from $1.5 billion to $2 billion.

42
00:06:53.870 --> 00:07:01.060
Boardroom: So, the General Obligation bond provides a tremendously wonderful vehicle for us to be able to generate the resources needed.

43
00:07:01.100 --> 00:07:14.919
Boardroom: To invest, in our infrastructure, to address issues of accessibility, resiliency, sustainability, and certainly to address issues of liability and reduce costs as we're able to advance those projects in the future.

44
00:07:15.340 --> 00:07:28.040
Boardroom: And then secondly, as I mentioned, because of our general fund structural deficit, the sales and use tax provides a tremendous opportunity for us to be able to generate the resources needed to help address our structural deficit.

45
00:07:28.320 --> 00:07:39.269
Boardroom: And this process has been multi-phased, and it has been incredibly data-informed, as we'll go through this evening. The work that we have accomplished has included council work sessions.

46
00:07:39.670 --> 00:07:44.780
Boardroom: follow-up and implementation of council referrals, infrastructure analysis.

47
00:07:45.110 --> 00:07:55.140
Boardroom: Implementing statistically valid voter surveys, community and commission engagement, which we'll talk more about, and certainly continued refinement of our project priorities.

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48
00:07:55.360 --> 00:08:10.500
Boardroom: So with that, I'm going to transition now to Lake Research Partners to talk about the results of the second community survey, and then certainly, Mayor, if it's at your pleasure, we can stop, respond to questions that pertain to the survey, and then move to the second part of the presentation.

49
00:08:16.260 --> 00:08:22.950
David Mermin: All right, so if you think that's my cue, and it's, it's David Mervin here at Lake Research Partners. Can you all hear me all right?

50
00:08:25.350 --> 00:08:26.699
Boardroom: Yes, we can hear you.

51
00:08:26.700 --> 00:08:45.450
David Mermin: Excellent. Good to be with the Council and staff, and appreciate the support from the City staff in building these… the survey and helping us achieve the results and the data we're about to show you. And as you know, we have been polling the City of Berkeley now for

52
00:08:45.690 --> 00:08:51.100
David Mermin: Many years, various community surveys on many topics, including various ballot measures.

53
00:08:51.250 --> 00:08:54.540
David Mermin: This is the second survey we've conducted this year.

54
00:08:54.720 --> 00:09:02.960
David Mermin: And, I'm going to be presenting the… both the overall findings and some analysis of those results.

55
00:09:03.110 --> 00:09:08.870
David Mermin: This is an overview, of course. There are, you know, a lot more data in the full report, which is available to everyone.

56
00:09:08.980 --> 00:09:14.519
David Mermin: And, happy to take questions at the end. So I'm going to put on the screen here the

57
00:09:16.360 --> 00:09:21.549
David Mermin: Presentation of the findings. Let's make sure that appears. Everyone see that all right?

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58
00:09:22.740 --> 00:09:23.680
Boardroom: Yes.

59
00:09:23.960 --> 00:09:24.840
David Mermin: Excellent.

60
00:09:25.240 --> 00:09:36.379
David Mermin: So, again, this is a survey of likely voters in the city of Berkeley. It's conducted from the voter file methodologies, combination of live phone interviews and text-to-online

61
00:09:36.530 --> 00:09:43.540
David Mermin: And it's representative of the electorate that we expect to turn out and vote in November of 2026 in the city.

62
00:09:43.850 --> 00:09:56.780
David Mermin: And I'll show you the demographics in a second. Just get to… here we are. This was conducted in the week of April 21st, 2026.

63
00:09:56.880 --> 00:10:06.949
David Mermin: Data are stratified and weighted to be representative of the electorate in Berkeley. Margin of error for the full sample is plus or minus 4.4%.

64
00:10:08.620 --> 00:10:13.389
David Mermin: These are the demographics, more details on all of these available in the full report.

65
00:10:13.500 --> 00:10:20.609
David Mermin: But it is, probably representative across the city of the, again, the likely voters we expect to turn out in November.

66
00:10:21.280 --> 00:10:22.589
David Mermin: So,

67
00:10:22.800 --> 00:10:40.610
David Mermin: As a general set of takeaways, we would say our main focus here, after having tested a range of projects and options and priorities with voters in the earlier survey that was conducted in February, this is a follow-up where we were bearing down on specific language for the

68

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00:10:40.610 --> 00:10:45.939
David Mermin: General obligation bond and the sales tax, measure for the city budget.

69
00:10:46.280 --> 00:11:02.539
David Mermin: And also testing these measures in the context of other measures that we expect to appear on the November ballot, particularly those having to do with revenue, because we know that that has an impact on how people vote and when they have multiple revenue measures to consider.

70
00:11:03.260 --> 00:11:11.449
David Mermin: What we generally found is that both the general geo bond and the sales tax fallout measures have slightly lower support.

71
00:11:12.080 --> 00:11:21.460
David Mermin: They were essentially identical to the… with very slight adjustments to the versions of the measures we tested in February, and they both have

72
00:11:21.650 --> 00:11:27.910
David Mermin: Majority support, and they are both slightly above the threshold they would need to pass.

73
00:11:28.010 --> 00:11:32.450
David Mermin: But they did both go down slightly from where they were in the February poll.

74
00:11:32.720 --> 00:11:47.260
David Mermin: And that is possibly just a reflection of evolution over time, but also very likely affected by the crowded environment on the ballot, which we tested. And we'll show you the other measures that we tested along with these two.

75
00:11:47.700 --> 00:11:57.859
David Mermin: That probably brings down a little bit the level of support when voters have so many revenue measures to consider. Nonetheless, nearly 7 in 10

76
00:11:58.190 --> 00:12:11.790
David Mermin: Berkeley voters are inclined to vote yes on the GEO bond on the initial ballot, 69%. If that were right on target, that would be just above the two-thirds vote needed to pass for that type of bond.

77

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00:12:12.070 --> 00:12:20.049
David Mermin: And then the sales tax measure also starts lower than it did in February, but it is at above a majority at 52%.

78
00:12:20.440 --> 00:12:33.290
David Mermin: Again, it's just a couple of points over the threshold, the simple majority threshold to pass that type of a revenue measure. So they were both, at the moment, in a position to pass, but obviously pretty close to the line in terms of being

79
00:12:33.810 --> 00:12:35.600
David Mermin: Exceeding the threshold.

80
00:12:35.690 --> 00:12:54.130
David Mermin: When we test additional positive and negative information, as you know, we like to do these stress tests where we get positive and negative messages in equal… equal time for both sides to simulate the sort of campaign and additional information that voters would get between now and when they would vote.

81
00:12:54.480 --> 00:13:00.990
David Mermin: And when we do that, the geo bond, the support declines slightly.

82
00:13:01.260 --> 00:13:14.010
David Mermin: Which means it just falls just below the threshold for 67, but it is still very close to that two-thirds threshold. Interestingly, the sales tax measure of the support increases after people hear the arguments back and forth.

83
00:13:14.560 --> 00:13:30.610
David Mermin: And so our general conclusion is that both of these measures are in a position to pass, assuming there is a solid campaign, that there is communication done to voters in support of each. It does appear, you know, based on past results, based on

84
00:13:30.720 --> 00:13:36.260
David Mermin: how close these are to the thresholds. It does appear that these would be in a position to pass, but it would require

85
00:13:36.690 --> 00:13:41.860
David Mermin: Some information, some campaign, in favor to maintain that support.

86

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00:13:42.450 --> 00:14:00.670
David Mermin: We also tested several other local and regional revenue measures, really for context. We also found most of those also have strong support, but the inclusion of so many such measures on the 26th ballot probably increases the tax sensitivity, which may be dampening a little bit the support for these two.

87
00:14:01.010 --> 00:14:04.149
David Mermin: So we'll start with the numbers on the… on the bond.

88
00:14:04.520 --> 00:14:09.860
David Mermin: And just to remind everyone, this is how we described it. We try to keep these descriptions simple, but also

89
00:14:10.130 --> 00:14:15.199
David Mermin: Very similar to what people would read on the ballot, when they were voting.

90
00:14:15.470 --> 00:14:28.770
David Mermin: Mentioning a $300 million general obligation bond, the improvements that it would fund, and noting the costs for property owners, 22, estimated $22.14 per $100,000 of property value.

91
00:14:29.350 --> 00:14:33.890
David Mermin: And so that's the measure that people were voting on.

92
00:14:34.930 --> 00:14:50.290
David Mermin: A very similar version of that, which we tested in February. We've got 71% yes, 12% no. That margin has decreased a bit, but it is still, very healthy, 69% inclined to vote yes.

93
00:14:50.800 --> 00:15:06.770
David Mermin: 16% inclined to vote no on that measure, and 15% undecided. So even if, assuming those numbers are directly on target, even if all of the undecided voters broke toward a no vote, that would still pass.

94
00:15:06.970 --> 00:15:18.260
David Mermin: by a couple of points. It is typical for undecideds to break more toward a no than a yes, but you would also expect to pick up potentially some of those undecideds, so it's still, we would say, in a position to pass.

95
00:15:19.330 --> 00:15:26.880

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David Mermin: We also noted here, and so you see that threshold, the two-thirds threshold that we're exceeding slightly in the graph.

96
00:15:27.440 --> 00:15:34.060
David Mermin: And then on the right is some of the demographics broken down, just for analysis, and noting where the shift has been.

97
00:15:34.070 --> 00:15:50.340
David Mermin: compared to February, our overall margin, which was plus 59 points, is now plus 52 points. The shift in that margin, and when you… when you measure a shift in margin, it's slightly exaggerated. It's only a couple of points on the yes vote, but it looks a little bigger on the margin.

98
00:15:50.340 --> 00:16:05.320
David Mermin: We see that older voters and white voters slipping down a bit more in terms of their support, although, again, every group of voters across the city, demographically, is in favor, and in most cases, large majority is in favor of the GO bond.

99
00:16:06.630 --> 00:16:23.309
David Mermin: We then tested these arguments, pro and con, favor and against, equal time on both sides, which may or may not reflect the actual environment, but wanted to do this to see how strongly that yes vote would hold up as a result of that back and forth.

100
00:16:23.330 --> 00:16:27.090
David Mermin: And the answer is, pretty well. It does decline by a few points.

101
00:16:27.150 --> 00:16:37.320
David Mermin: And in this, re-ballot, after people hear that additional information, the yes vote declines just slightly down to 64%. The no goes up a bit to 20%.

102
00:16:37.340 --> 00:16:52.659
David Mermin: And you still have 15% undecided. Even if this were the, end case of, after the back and forth of the campaign, that would still be a pretty plausible position for the measure to pass. It would need a few more points from the undecideds.

103
00:16:52.740 --> 00:17:06.760
David Mermin: to get over the two-thirds threshold, but that would be a typical shift that you might see, as we've seen in other revenue measures

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in Berkeley. But nonetheless, it's pretty close to the threshold, and obviously within the margin of error in terms of whether it would pass.

104
00:17:07.079 --> 00:17:16.700
David Mermin: And again, notably, we're comparing this now to the informed ballot from the earlier poll in February. We again see older voters

105
00:17:16.920 --> 00:17:32.209
David Mermin: older men, non-college voters, and voters in West and Central Berkeley moving down a little more from where they were, compared to February. Nevertheless, this is still pretty close to the threshold of passage with that $300 million general obligation bond.

106
00:17:32.720 --> 00:17:40.710
David Mermin: We also wanted to just note where the undecided voters were and the persuadable voters for those who would be involved in potentially

107
00:17:41.240 --> 00:17:45.240
David Mermin: Communicating, the undecided voters,

108
00:17:45.660 --> 00:17:53.709
David Mermin: African American voters in Berkeley, those who are registered independents, renters, particularly women who are renters.

109
00:17:54.240 --> 00:17:56.590
David Mermin: A little more likely to be undecided.

110
00:17:56.960 --> 00:18:11.229
David Mermin: the persuadable voters, those who are both undecided and move in the direction of voting for the bond, also more women, white women, independent voters, and older Black voters, all in that group of being a little bit more persuadable.

111
00:18:13.810 --> 00:18:20.259
David Mermin: So that's the overview, and again, there's more data behind that, but just that's the overview of the findings on the GEO bond.

112
00:18:20.490 --> 00:18:22.750
David Mermin: And then we turn to the sales tax.

113
00:18:23.100 --> 00:18:30.349

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David Mermin: Measure, which, also we were retesting to see if the specific version that would go on the ballot would be successful.

114
00:18:30.610 --> 00:18:50.019
David Mermin: This is the description we gave, increasing the sales tax in the City of Berkeley to help address the city's budget deficit of approximately $30 million. Shovel measure levying a 0.5% sales tax, increasing the total sales tax rate to 10.75, the amount it would generate, and the things that would be funded, should it be adopted.

115
00:18:50.910 --> 00:18:54.989
David Mermin: This measure did decline somewhat from where it was in February.

116
00:18:55.200 --> 00:19:09.959
David Mermin: We had measured this at about a 60% yes initially. The current initial ballot on this late April survey is 52% yes to 32% no. That's still a measure plus… with rounding, plus 19 points.

117
00:19:10.060 --> 00:19:15.919
David Mermin: And it is still just above the threshold of 50% that a sales tax measure would need.

118
00:19:16.050 --> 00:19:27.820
David Mermin: So you would conclude again that this is a measure that is in a good position to pass, but it is close, and it would require some campaign and information, probably, to ensure that it would.

119
00:19:28.330 --> 00:19:45.669
David Mermin: And the, the declines we see in this case, more among young… older women, white voters, younger men, and Central Berkeley voters, as well as homeowners, a little bit, softer than they were in their support, but everyone is still net in favor

120
00:19:45.920 --> 00:19:51.189
David Mermin: Of this measure, and in most cases, over 50% in support of the measure.

121
00:19:52.110 --> 00:19:54.259
David Mermin: Again, we stress tested.

122
00:19:54.750 --> 00:20:04.980
David Mermin: Supporters and opponents arguing back and forth about whether it's a good idea to pass the sales tax, the things that we need

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to fund, versus the opponents saying that it costs too much, we can't afford it.

123
00:20:06.760 --> 00:20:09.849
David Mermin: And then re-ballot. Interestingly, here.

124
00:20:10.010 --> 00:20:20.150
David Mermin: Unlike on the GEO bond measure, the support actually goes up somewhat, perhaps because voters understand better the budget need as a result of those arguments.

125
00:20:20.250 --> 00:20:33.520
David Mermin: But instead of… so from a 52% yes on our initial ballot here in April, we go up to 56% yes, up 4 points. The no holds steady at about 30%. The margin is now plus 27 points.

126
00:20:33.700 --> 00:20:44.009
David Mermin: And again, looking at the net, it is pretty close to where it was in February. It's actually gone up a little bit among voters of color and renters.

127
00:20:44.010 --> 00:20:58.380
David Mermin: But it has gone down a bit among white voters, non-college voters, and voters in Central Berkeley, when we look at where the shifts are. But again, the overall finding here is that this still has majority support, that majority increases a bit after the

128
00:20:58.390 --> 00:20:59.800
David Mermin: head-to-head arguments.

129
00:20:59.930 --> 00:21:04.659
David Mermin: And it still has a… looks like it's in a position where it would… would pass.

130
00:21:06.590 --> 00:21:13.969
David Mermin: This, again, is just a breakdown of the undecided and persuadable voters for those who might be interested in communicating.

131
00:21:14.250 --> 00:21:28.559
David Mermin: We have a lot of undecided voters in the Berkeley Hills, particularly women in the Hills on the sales tax measure. Again, the independent voters. Interestingly, voters with a graduate degree, the most highly educated voters, are usually less undecided on this measure, or more so.

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132
00:21:29.630 --> 00:21:34.919
David Mermin: College-educated women, and again, renters showing up in the undecided voters, disproportionately.

133
00:21:36.450 --> 00:21:55.459
David Mermin: And then we also wanted to share data we learned about the ballot order, as well as the other potential measures that could be out there on the local and regional ballot. This is an experiment we did just between these two measures, where we rotated which one people heard first.

134
00:21:55.540 --> 00:22:07.570
David Mermin: And we wanted to see if it made a difference as to the overall support. So this is looking… all of the numbers you're seeing here are just for the, general obligation bond.

135
00:22:07.740 --> 00:22:19.949
David Mermin: And whether you hear it first or second, it actually does, slightly better if you hear it second after the sales tax, which is not necessarily what we would expect.

136
00:22:19.990 --> 00:22:32.469
David Mermin: But in both cases, it's very close to the threshold of two-thirds, but it's slightly higher after they hear the sales tax. And then once they have the back-and-forth arguments, it's essentially no difference what order they hear it in. It's a 64%.

137
00:22:32.470 --> 00:22:41.789
David Mermin: So our general conclusion here is it doesn't matter much which one of these two measures goes first. You're going to be in a very similar range in terms of the level of support.

138
00:22:42.030 --> 00:22:49.279
David Mermin: And then the sales tax measure also does a little bit better when you hear it second, rather than first.

139
00:22:49.680 --> 00:22:56.530
David Mermin: And that evens out somewhat, even on the informed ballot, it's still true.

140
00:22:56.810 --> 00:23:08.520

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David Mermin: I'm sorry, I'm stating that wrong. In this case, they hear it that they do slightly, yeah, slightly better when the sales tax is heard second. That would be on the left, 53 versus 50.

141
00:23:08.860 --> 00:23:24.530
David Mermin: And, still true even after the informed ballot, that if you've heard the sales tax second, it does slightly better. So, putting all those together, it's a close call, it's not a huge effect, but it is plausible that the sales tax does slightly better when it's heard second.

142
00:23:24.720 --> 00:23:30.930
David Mermin: Compared to the GeoBomb, it looks like the, you know, all things being equal, the best order, but it doesn't matter much.

143
00:23:32.130 --> 00:23:44.899
David Mermin: The thing that does matter a little more than that, in terms of the order, is the fact that these other revenue measures from other jurisdictions, or just from other sources, are on the Berkeley ballot in 2026.

144
00:23:45.190 --> 00:23:55.329
David Mermin: And just noting that we, in this case, we put all of these before the two measures we're most interested in, because we wanted to see the impact that they had on that.

145
00:23:55.800 --> 00:24:05.429
David Mermin: And the one that is very popular here in Berkeley, and this is a good sign, although obviously the rest of the region gets to vote on this as well.

146
00:24:05.460 --> 00:24:16.849
David Mermin: But the regional transit measure as of today would get 79% of the vote… voting yes. In the City of Berkeley, only 9% would vote no. There's a very pro-transit

147
00:24:16.970 --> 00:24:21.380
David Mermin: Constituency here in the city, only 12% undecided.

148
00:24:22.620 --> 00:24:31.250
David Mermin: So that is a very supportive vote for the transit measure, but again, the main reason we had it in this poll was to see what impact it had on our… on the city measures.

149
00:24:31.580 --> 00:24:38.930

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David Mermin: We also tested the Alameda County Living Wage Measure, which is not, strictly speaking, a revenue measure, but does involve money.

150
00:24:39.320 --> 00:24:51.970
David Mermin: And it does appear to have very strong support in the City of Berkeley as well. They are, I believe, gathering signatures and have not, fully qualified, but assuming this is going forward and is on the ballot.

151
00:24:52.100 --> 00:24:57.610
David Mermin: Has strong support in the City of Berkeley, 78% yes to 14% no.

152
00:24:58.760 --> 00:25:16.629
David Mermin: the arts tax measure, which is also going to be in the ballot in the city, assuming that is on, we would see 67% right at two-thirds of Berkeley voters saying they would vote yes for the arts funding. It's very popular among younger women and among renters.

153
00:25:16.880 --> 00:25:28.710
David Mermin: there is some correlation. The people who tend to vote no on the… our two core measures that we were measuring, that we showed you earlier, the GO bond and the sales tax, also tended to vote no here, and vice versa.

154
00:25:29.140 --> 00:25:36.899
David Mermin: But it is, overall getting about two-thirds support, and again, it's just a question of the impact of having the multiple

155
00:25:37.390 --> 00:25:38.670
David Mermin: revenue measures.

156
00:25:39.010 --> 00:25:51.819
David Mermin: And then an additional sales tax measure, which is the… specific to sugar-sweetened sodas, of course, which Berkeley's had now for many years, but this is an increase in that soda tax measure… soda tax

157
00:25:53.520 --> 00:25:59.239
David Mermin: To increase the impact of the programs that are funded by it. 69% say they would vote yes.

158
00:25:59.480 --> 00:26:01.659

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David Mermin: For the soda tax increase.

159
00:26:02.340 --> 00:26:11.789
David Mermin: And 45% strong support. Only 23% would vote no. This is also in a pretty strong position in terms of the support citywide.

160
00:26:11.880 --> 00:26:22.390
David Mermin: And again, it's correlated that voters who vote yes on the GEO bond and the fraud or sales tax are also more likely to vote yes on this soda tax measure.

161
00:26:22.810 --> 00:26:24.829
David Mermin: And then finally, the public bank.

162
00:26:25.100 --> 00:26:30.889
David Mermin: Which also, involves, revenue from a parcel tax.

163
00:26:30.990 --> 00:26:49.030
David Mermin: Would voters support this? This is the softest in terms of the level of support that we… of the measures we tested. It is still a majority in favor of establishing a public bank, funded through a parcel tax, but 58% would vote yes. That's lower than some of the other measures, and 24% would vote no.

164
00:26:49.530 --> 00:26:54.149
David Mermin: Still a positive margin, and again, renters and younger women being the most supportive.

165
00:26:55.040 --> 00:27:03.539
David Mermin: So all of that is to say that we have several measures, all of which are pretty popular on the ballot, but cumulatively, it does appear to have brought down the

166
00:27:03.750 --> 00:27:13.859
David Mermin: by a few points, the total level of support. Nonetheless, our general conclusion would be, that we have, approximately two-thirds or slightly more.

167
00:27:14.270 --> 00:27:19.169
David Mermin: Support for the general obligation bond, making it a pretty good position to pass.

168
00:27:19.330 --> 00:27:25.660

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David Mermin: And slightly, a narrow majority, voting yes on the sales tax measure.

169
00:27:26.260 --> 00:27:35.350
David Mermin: But with a wide margin over the no vote, again, suggesting he's still in a pretty good position to pass in November, and that's, those are the conclusions we bring to the Council.

170
00:27:38.220 --> 00:27:44.850
Boardroom: Thank you so much, I appreciate that. Do folks have any questions about these results?

171
00:27:45.880 --> 00:27:49.340
Boardroom: Sorry. Yes. Councilmember Blackaby?

172
00:27:50.920 --> 00:27:52.410
Boardroom: Thanks, Madam Mayor.

173
00:27:53.030 --> 00:28:08.119
Boardroom: Hey, David. Quick question on undecideds versus persuadables, just to reflect, refresh my recollection. So the undecideds are truly the folks who said, I don't know how I'm gonna vote. Persuadables is undecideds plus the lean yes and lean no, is that the right way to think about it?

174
00:28:08.120 --> 00:28:16.810
David Mermin: Well, the persuadables… good question, and I went over it very quickly, but the persuadables would be the undecideds, plus the people who shift

175
00:28:17.050 --> 00:28:20.760
David Mermin: Hard a yes, because even though the overall shift was

176
00:28:21.370 --> 00:28:24.210
David Mermin: Almost even, or some very slightly negative.

177
00:28:24.480 --> 00:28:43.540
David Mermin: there were people going in both directions, right? So, we're interested in for, again, not necessarily for the official communications, but for anyone who's, potentially supporting the measure, communicating with voters, noting who the persuadable voters are, which would include the undecideds, as well as the people who move

178

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00:28:43.690 --> 00:28:44.869
David Mermin: Toward a guess.

179
00:28:45.510 --> 00:28:55.010
David Mermin: So that… that's the difference between those. There's a lot of overlap, and the general conclusion about who those undecided persuadables are is listed in those tables.

180
00:28:55.010 --> 00:28:59.360
Boardroom: Right, so it's undecided plus those who shifted yes after messaging, is that right?

181
00:28:59.360 --> 00:29:01.120
David Mermin: That's correct. That is correct.

182
00:29:01.120 --> 00:29:13.679
Boardroom: And then, in a typical revenue measure in Berkeley, you're mentioning, kind of, the history. If we're at, sort of, somewhere right around 60… if we're right around the two-thirds…

183
00:29:13.840 --> 00:29:20.460
Boardroom: Now, how those undecideds typically breaks.

184
00:29:20.460 --> 00:29:25.939
David Mermin: Yeah, it depends what year you look at, right, and also what's it. So, in other places.

185
00:29:26.060 --> 00:29:28.720
David Mermin: First of all, I would say, you know, our general

186
00:29:29.370 --> 00:29:39.189
David Mermin: Rule of thumb that we, provide to those who are testing revenue measures is that most of your undecideds will break… they will be more likely to break toward a no than a yes.

187
00:29:39.780 --> 00:29:48.310
David Mermin: Because if they're undecided, they're already having some doubts, and then that just, you know, it's easy for doubts to accumulate, and people don't know as a default.

188
00:29:48.500 --> 00:30:06.990
David Mermin: Having said that, the city has a history of passing revenue measures, sometimes by quite wide margins, and often in our own polling,

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which we've been done since 2012 in the city, those yes margins have exceeded what we measured on the polling that we did for around this time in the spring.

189
00:30:07.240 --> 00:30:16.849
David Mermin: Of the election year. So, I would conclude that in Berkeley, usually we see a little bit higher yes vote than we measured in the poll 6 months earlier.

190
00:30:16.920 --> 00:30:27.750
David Mermin: But that's a reflection of actual events, there being communication and campaigns and so forth. And it is also true that, for instance, in 2022,

191
00:30:28.690 --> 00:30:35.600
David Mermin: There were a couple… there was a measure on the ballot that fell… essentially landed almost exactly where the yes vote was measured.

192
00:30:35.750 --> 00:30:55.700
David Mermin: In the spring, which was, in fact, slight, you know, just a very, very narrowly short of the threshold needed. So, I don't want to say we know that it will exceed, it doesn't always, but it often exceeds by a few points, on the final ballot, on the actual ballot in November. It won't be measured in the poll.

193
00:30:55.870 --> 00:31:04.369
Boardroom: And that's why it's good you're starting at the two-thirds, because you don't need a majority of the undecideds. You need some of the undecideds to give you the cushion, but…

194
00:31:04.370 --> 00:31:04.690
David Mermin: Trippie.

195
00:31:04.690 --> 00:31:05.010
Boardroom: starting.

196
00:31:05.010 --> 00:31:14.569
David Mermin: Yeah. You don't need most of them, you just need a handful, really, essentially, to break your way, break toward a yes, as a result of the campaign or information that they get.

197
00:31:14.780 --> 00:31:15.660
Boardroom: Thank you.

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198
00:31:17.050 --> 00:31:19.340
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Councilmember Taplin?

199
00:31:19.540 --> 00:31:25.699
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor, and good afternoon. Could we just see the arguments for and against the jail bond?

200
00:31:25.710 --> 00:31:34.400
David Mermin: Booker up in one, and you know, actually, Nothing scream… And… hang on.

201
00:31:35.890 --> 00:31:37.820
David Mermin: I'm sorry, for the geobond, right?

202
00:31:37.820 --> 00:31:38.490
Boardroom: Correct.

203
00:31:39.420 --> 00:31:40.550
David Mermin: I met…

204
00:31:43.880 --> 00:31:44.830
David Mermin: There it is.

205
00:31:58.980 --> 00:32:00.119
Boardroom: Okay, very helpful.

206
00:32:00.410 --> 00:32:01.340
Boardroom: Thank you.

207
00:32:02.140 --> 00:32:02.850
David Mermin: No?

208
00:32:07.430 --> 00:32:09.889
Boardroom: Okay, Vice Mayor Tregup.

209
00:32:11.380 --> 00:32:13.180
Boardroom: Thank you,

210
00:32:13.630 --> 00:32:22.859

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Boardroom: Three questions. First, just a clarification, when you mentioned Central Berkeley, is that Central and South?

211
00:32:23.710 --> 00:32:26.539
David Mermin: Yeah, so the definitions of the,

212
00:32:28.260 --> 00:32:30.880
David Mermin: Sorry, one second, but I will pull up my…

213
00:32:31.730 --> 00:32:45.560
David Mermin: So yes, it said… it is… we did… we create 3 regions. It's… the sample's not big enough to be able to break out every district on its own, right? They are… it's not a reliable end size in each individual district.

214
00:32:45.560 --> 00:32:53.530
David Mermin: So the definitions of these three regions are what we call the hills, is Council Districts 5, 6, and 8.

215
00:32:54.310 --> 00:33:01.239
David Mermin: what we call Central slash South, which is combined, is Districts 3, 4, and 7.

216
00:33:02.340 --> 00:33:05.329
David Mermin: and west is Districts 1 and 2.

217
00:33:06.470 --> 00:33:07.430
Boardroom: Thank you.

218
00:33:08.040 --> 00:33:21.270
Boardroom: You… spoke about, I mean, the, the recommendation… well, the overarching conclusion is that

219
00:33:21.560 --> 00:33:29.660
Boardroom: Based on Pauling, both measures are… there… there is a… a…

220
00:33:30.610 --> 00:33:33.800
Boardroom: Greater than 50-50 chance that they would

221
00:33:33.980 --> 00:33:48.409
Boardroom: pass, provided, that there is a robust campaign. What can you say, about the intensity, or how might this be impacted?

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222
00:33:48.640 --> 00:33:52.809
Boardroom: By the intensity of the opposition campaign.

223
00:33:53.450 --> 00:33:58.220
Boardroom: For example, if there is an organized, opposition campaign.

224
00:33:58.810 --> 00:34:08.500
David Mermin: Certainly. I would say if there is no opposition campaign, these are a very strong position to pass. It would be unlikely for the no vote to increase enough.

225
00:34:09.030 --> 00:34:17.810
David Mermin: To defeat these measures if there was no actual campaign on the no side, and that has been the case. You know, once… some… occasionally that has been true. There's been very little

226
00:34:18.080 --> 00:34:31.110
David Mermin: opposition campaign. There is an opposition campaign, that's what we simulated, right, with that informed ballot, was a pro, a yes campaign, and also a no campaign, communicating equally.

227
00:34:34.250 --> 00:34:35.370
Boardroom: Oh, -oh.

228
00:34:40.580 --> 00:34:44.889
David Mermin: with voters, so I think we would say as, you know, what we show them as the…

229
00:34:45.060 --> 00:34:46.859
David Mermin: Sorry, could you listen?

230
00:34:47.489 --> 00:34:48.569
David Mermin: Can y'all hear me?

231
00:34:48.889 --> 00:34:50.320
David Mermin: Can y'all hear me, Arian?

232
00:34:50.320 --> 00:34:52.119
Boardroom: You're here now, but you cut out for.

233

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00:34:52.120 --> 00:34:55.290
David Mermin: Okay, there was a tech glitch there, apologies, that's probably on my end.

234
00:34:55.520 --> 00:35:00.599
David Mermin: I am traveling, this week, which is why I couldn't be here in person, but

235
00:35:00.730 --> 00:35:03.399
David Mermin: the, so…

236
00:35:03.470 --> 00:35:21.829
David Mermin: We… if there was no… if there was not any opposition campaign, I would say these are in a quite strong position to pass. If there is an opposition campaign, and it is equal to… roughly equal to the, yeah, the positive campaign in favor of the measures, that's what we simulated in the survey with that head-to-head argument.

237
00:35:21.890 --> 00:35:25.430
David Mermin: And that would suggest that in that situation.

238
00:35:25.800 --> 00:35:30.049
David Mermin: It would be close, but, you know, more likely to pass than not.

239
00:35:30.280 --> 00:35:44.330
David Mermin: And of course, if you had a massive opposition campaign, and some big funder came in to, you know, constantly hammer at these things and tell voters it's a terrible idea, and that would be, you know, voters hear more no than yes.

240
00:35:45.500 --> 00:35:51.070
David Mermin: This would be… these would be in some danger, they would be less likely to pass in that situation.

241
00:35:52.710 --> 00:35:55.169
Boardroom: Yeah, thank you,

242
00:35:56.580 --> 00:36:08.889
Boardroom: And obviously, when, in particular, the gold bond, when it's so close to the line, I think this is, probably going to be of importance.

243

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00:36:09.090 --> 00:36:15.250
Boardroom: My last question is around, you know, any…

244
00:36:15.410 --> 00:36:20.089
Boardroom: Any high-level thoughts you could share with us around

245
00:36:20.340 --> 00:36:31.790
Boardroom: best practices for the packaging of these two, ballot measures, if we were to include both of them on the ballot,

246
00:36:32.030 --> 00:36:35.690
Boardroom: it's… You know,

247
00:36:36.210 --> 00:36:46.970
Boardroom: the, the no argument, like when, you had the battery of, negative information, out there,

248
00:36:47.680 --> 00:36:58.420
Boardroom: understandably revolves around, you know, the message, we've been taxed enough. And there are different, Well…

249
00:36:59.600 --> 00:37:03.849
Boardroom: if you put the language back up, you know, I think it talks about

250
00:37:04.130 --> 00:37:09.279
Boardroom: Affordable housing, it talks about other, areas of investment.

251
00:37:09.520 --> 00:37:14.060
Boardroom: I'm wondering if, you have any thoughts around

252
00:37:14.200 --> 00:37:19.649
Boardroom: How we can explain, this is why,

253
00:37:19.870 --> 00:37:36.860
Boardroom: The two measures are needed, but, just as importantly, this is why they're structured differently, because they, are funding different things that could not necessarily be funded,

254
00:37:37.080 --> 00:37:40.719
Boardroom: Through, A different revenue stream.

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255
00:37:42.060 --> 00:37:59.690
David Mermin: It's a complicated question. Let me preface it by saying that, obviously, with the, you know, publicly funded research that we're doing here, we are not directly advising any campaign on either the yes or no side, right? We're just telling you the information based on the, what we learned from the voters.

256
00:37:59.830 --> 00:38:11.539
David Mermin: I would say, though, that, we… one thing we know, which we know from previous experience, as well as the earlier testing about the contents of the

257
00:38:11.850 --> 00:38:14.329
David Mermin: Fond and sales tax measure is that

258
00:38:14.470 --> 00:38:24.510
David Mermin: we deliberately highlighted here in this description some of the things that we knew voters cared most about in the City of Berkeley, and that that is certainly important.

259
00:38:24.730 --> 00:38:32.529
David Mermin: If, for any effort to pass these measures, to highlight the actual impacts that they would have positively on

260
00:38:32.640 --> 00:38:39.049
David Mermin: The priorities that voters have, and those include ensuring safety, first and foremost, and quality of life.

261
00:38:39.360 --> 00:38:57.889
David Mermin: The importance of repairing, things that are… that need fixing, such as streets and parks, improving and increasing affordable housing. So those things are specified in part because we know that voters care a lot about them, and we have research data to… to support that.

262
00:38:59.550 --> 00:39:11.839
David Mermin: I hesitate to go too much further in terms of offering any strategic advice other than to say it's, you know, those in support of the measure would certainly need to talk about the importance of those, funding those

263
00:39:11.970 --> 00:39:14.339
David Mermin: Specific outcomes.

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264
00:39:14.500 --> 00:39:18.469
David Mermin: The improvements that are needed, and creating a sense of,

265
00:39:18.770 --> 00:39:25.200
David Mermin: Urgency, recognizing the, you know, the structural deficits, the infrastructure,

266
00:39:25.560 --> 00:39:31.169
David Mermin: Deficit that is long-standing, and the importance of funding to… to catch up with those.

267
00:39:31.960 --> 00:39:32.939
Boardroom: Thank you so much.

268
00:39:35.830 --> 00:39:37.379
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember O'Keefe?

269
00:39:40.520 --> 00:39:42.190
Boardroom: Thank you.

270
00:39:43.010 --> 00:39:54.429
Boardroom: I'll start by saying I, I'm kind of… I'm only gonna ask about the sales tax measure. It's kind of the only thing I have eyes for right now. I'm pretty concerned… there's a question coming, I promise.

271
00:39:54.460 --> 00:40:09.720
Boardroom: I'm concerned about these numbers. I hear your, confidence, you know, it's… I hear you say things like it's very well positioned to pass, and I appreciate your arguments about the, undecided voters and the dynamics of how things can change, but a lot of these numbers for the sales tax are

272
00:40:10.030 --> 00:40:14.550
Boardroom: Disturbingly close to the 50% threshold, considering the margin of error is 4%.

273
00:40:14.980 --> 00:40:22.240
Boardroom: So, given that is my concern, I'm… I'm really curious about…

274
00:40:23.480 --> 00:40:27.260
Boardroom: About this result, that hearing it

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275
00:40:27.450 --> 00:40:32.900
Boardroom: Second, after the geobond actually seemed to increase

276
00:40:33.530 --> 00:40:40.929
Boardroom: Am I reading that correct? It seems to increase the support if they hear the GOP first, and then… and then about the sales tax. Is that right?

277
00:40:41.350 --> 00:40:45.529
David Mermin: Yes, and you are not the only person who was somewhat surprised by that result.

278
00:40:45.530 --> 00:40:59.279
Boardroom: Yeah, because I'm really concerned about it, you know, maybe in a vacuum it would pass, but the, presence of other, other items. So, I'm wondering… yeah, thank you for confirming that that is indeed surprising. Can… do you have any theories, or is that, is that…

279
00:40:59.710 --> 00:41:01.630
Boardroom: A more common result than…

280
00:41:02.890 --> 00:41:12.269
David Mermin: The only, my hypothesis, and there's no way to test this in the, Retrospectively, is that

281
00:41:15.120 --> 00:41:32.920
David Mermin: a general sales tax, people think of it as going to just sort of general operations, right? And it's like, sure, maybe you need it, maybe you don't. And that the cumulative effect of the description of the urgent funding priorities for the city that were contained in both measures.

282
00:41:32.990 --> 00:41:40.869
David Mermin: And the specific, improvements that would result in terms of, you know, Public safety, quality of life.

283
00:41:41.320 --> 00:41:44.299
David Mermin: Fixing things that are broken.

284
00:41:44.430 --> 00:41:49.319
David Mermin: May have created, just a slightly greater sense of,

285

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00:41:49.470 --> 00:41:56.079
David Mermin: A belief that, yes, we need to fund things in the city, and yes, we have some deficits we need to address in terms of those

286
00:41:57.310 --> 00:42:00.119
David Mermin: facilities and services, right? So…

287
00:42:00.490 --> 00:42:11.530
David Mermin: That would be my guess as to why it would be slightly higher as a result of having heard both, and but I would say that generally just reassuring that it doesn't matter much what order you put the two in.

288
00:42:11.840 --> 00:42:31.340
David Mermin: But all things being equal, you would go ahead and put the bond first, and then the sales, given these findings. And I would… and then I would also point to the broader conclusion that there are a lot of revenue measures here, and it does appear that the cumulative weight of those is pulling these down a little bit from… from where they were a couple of months ago.

289
00:42:31.990 --> 00:42:43.559
Boardroom: Yeah, thank you, actually. Thank you for that last comment, because that was my second question, is… it wasn't clear to me, and I'm sorry if you did make this clear, but I missed it if you did. Did you… you didn't do a similar test

290
00:42:44.200 --> 00:42:49.809
Boardroom: it looks like you did poll about all the other measures, but…

291
00:42:49.810 --> 00:43:02.130
David Mermin: And we did all of those before… Sorry, just to clarify what I think, where I think you're getting at, which is that we did test all of the other local and regional measures before these two.

292
00:43:03.240 --> 00:43:14.700
David Mermin: Deliberately, because we wanted to make sure we understood the reality of voters seeing all these measures on the ballot, and the only way to do that in a poll, which is sequential rather than a ballot where you're looking at it all at once.

293
00:43:14.820 --> 00:43:16.030
David Mermin: is to…

294

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00:43:16.610 --> 00:43:34.410
David Mermin: to ask all the other ones first, and then this… and then the two that we were most focused on. So, this is the… it's a tougher test, but it is a more realistic test for those two measures to… for voters… for us to know that voters are going to see, you know, these seven or eight different kinds of local

295
00:43:34.930 --> 00:43:49.150
David Mermin: Revenue and or, you know, money-related measures. And, you know, looks like their support is still pretty solid for both of these, but it is a little bit lower than what we were measuring a couple months ago.

296
00:43:49.410 --> 00:44:01.019
Boardroom: Okay, oh, that's helpful, thank you for clarifying. So just to be sure I understood you correctly, all of these numbers for both the GO and the sales tax were all measured after asking about the other measures.

297
00:44:01.090 --> 00:44:09.289
David Mermin: That's right, and you'll see that it's quite… it's laid out in sequence in the top line results, which is another document submitted as part of the report.

298
00:44:09.460 --> 00:44:10.730
Boardroom: Thank you so much.

299
00:44:12.110 --> 00:44:18.570
Boardroom: I would like to move on, because I know we have quite a bit of presentation time left, so I'm going to pass it back to our city staff.

300
00:44:21.830 --> 00:44:24.329
Boardroom: Sounds good. Can everyone hear me okay?

301
00:44:24.820 --> 00:44:25.520
Boardroom: Great.

302
00:44:25.910 --> 00:44:44.409
Boardroom: So, good afternoon, Honorable Mayor, City Council, and Community. Before trans… oh, my name's Carrie, I'm an Assistant to the City Manager, and before transitioning into the revised project portfolio, we want to briefly frame the broader infrastructure context and intended impact of the proposed geo-bond.

303

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00:44:44.430 --> 00:44:51.759
Boardroom: So, as this slide shows here, existing annual funding addresses only a small portion of Berkeley's infrastructure needs.

304
00:44:51.810 --> 00:45:05.050
Boardroom: Many funding sources for the city are restricted, one-time, or competitive when considering grants. And ultimately, this deferred maintenance continues to increase long-term repair costs and operational risk.

305
00:45:05.280 --> 00:45:06.919
Boardroom: At the same time.

306
00:45:07.170 --> 00:45:13.939
Boardroom: kind of going to the green part in the middle, Berkeley does have a strong track record of leveraging prior infrastructure investments.

307
00:45:14.080 --> 00:45:33.720
Boardroom: For example, Measure T1 passed by voters in 2016, leveraged approximately $100 million in bond funding into roughly $183 million in total investment through grants and external funding. T1 is winding down, as less than 5 of the 75 projects have yet to start construction.

308
00:45:33.720 --> 00:45:45.900
Boardroom: And this bond measure has been responsible for improvements across Berkeley, including the Adult Mental Health Clinic, North Berkeley Senior Center, Live Oak Community Center, the award-winning Willard Clubhouse.

309
00:45:45.900 --> 00:45:59.870
Boardroom: Berkeley Corp yard, Aquatic Park Tie Tubes, improvements to the Berkeley Rose Garden, a variety of streets, including portions of Adeline and University Avenue along the waterfront, as well as a variety of green infrastructure projects.

310
00:46:00.040 --> 00:46:19.489
Boardroom: Some of the projects under construction right now include improvements to two fire stations, MLK YAP, D&E docks, as well as the Santa Fe right-of-way conversion to a park. So these bonds are… these bond funds are totally committed and will be fully spent in the next 18 to 24 months.

311
00:46:19.570 --> 00:46:34.209

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Boardroom: So the proposed geo-bond structure would support the next phase of strategic infrastructure investment focused on public safety, accessibility, resilience, community-serving facilities, and long-term stewardship of critical public assets.

312
00:46:37.240 --> 00:46:40.070
Boardroom: Just give me one second… there we go.

313
00:46:41.170 --> 00:46:55.000
Boardroom: This slide may look familiar. It shows the estimated taxpayer impact of a proposed $300 million general obligation bond, assuming that $100 million is issued every 5 years beginning in 2027.

314
00:46:55.000 --> 00:47:05.339
Boardroom: So this slide provides two views. First, a historical look at tax rates associated with previously approved GO bonds, that's sort of the gray-shaded portion you see there.

315
00:47:05.440 --> 00:47:16.850
Boardroom: And then second, a forward-looking estimate of the proposed $300 million GO bond when combined with existing bond authorizations. That's sort of the dark blue shading that you see.

316
00:47:16.850 --> 00:47:32.989
Boardroom: So, under this scenario, the combined average tax rate from 2027 to 2067 is estimated at .0441%, or in layman's terms, $44 per $100,000 of assessed value.

317
00:47:32.990 --> 00:47:51.850
Boardroom: So for the median assessed home value in Berkeley, this equals approximately $242 per year. So importantly, the projected combined average tax rate remains below historical averages for existing authorizations and below rates seen in the late 1990s and early 2000s.

318
00:47:51.850 --> 00:47:58.490
Boardroom: So, in short, the proposed bond remains within Berkeley's historical range of geo-bond tax rates.

319
00:47:59.710 --> 00:48:11.679
Boardroom: We're gonna bring back a couple of slides you may have seen. So this one may look familiar to many, but we wanted to note that the proposed geo-bond framework still organizes projects into three primary categories or themes.

320

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00:48:11.750 --> 00:48:14.209
Boardroom: Community facilities and quality of life.

321
00:48:14.260 --> 00:48:29.019
Boardroom: public safety, and critical infrastructure and accessibility. This structure was intended to make the project portfolio easier to understand from a public-facing perspective, while still reflecting the complexity of Berkeley's infrastructure needs.

322
00:48:29.040 --> 00:48:40.969
Boardroom: Staff have also developed and applied a more formalized evaluation methodology to improve transparency regarding how projects were assessed and prioritized, and I'll get into that in the next couple of slides.

323
00:48:41.670 --> 00:49:00.590
Boardroom: We also wanted to bring back this slide and note, for those just being informed about this process, following the December 2025 Council work session, staff launched a community engagement process from January of this year through March. This engagement helped inform the draft project portfolio and broader infrastructure priorities.

324
00:49:00.590 --> 00:49:08.300
Boardroom: It included meetings with city commissions, community focus groups, joint district meetings, and a city webpage and email for public feedback.

325
00:49:08.460 --> 00:49:26.919
Boardroom: During these meetings, staff shared the project portfolio and asked for input on which projects felt most urgent, what needs or communities may be missing, where investment could improve access and equity, and which investments would provide the greatest long-term benefit for Berkeley.

326
00:49:26.930 --> 00:49:35.730
Boardroom: In conjunction with Council Direction, as well as the community survey, this feedback helps staff refine and prioritize the portfolio.

327
00:49:36.870 --> 00:49:56.770
Boardroom: So one of the major goals in refining the project portfolio was improving transparency around how projects were evaluated and prioritized. So to support that effort, staff developed a six-factor evaluation framework designed to assess both public benefit and implementation feasibility. I think this is attachment 2 in your packet.

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328
00:49:56.990 --> 00:50:12.400
Boardroom: Projects were evaluated across 6 categories seen on the slide here. Health, life, and safety, infrastructure condition, accessibility and resilience, community use and equity, green resiliency and sustainability, deliverability and readiness.

329
00:50:12.420 --> 00:50:27.670
Boardroom: and external funding potential. I do want to note, that we did incorporate criteria from the Park, Recreation, and Waterfront Commission's information report, where they evaluated projects. This helped improve our definitions and framing in our methodology, and just wanted to note that.

330
00:50:27.960 --> 00:50:37.270
Boardroom: So, looking at this slide, the highest weighted categories ranging from health, life, and safety through green resiliency and sustainability, those were weighted at 20%,

331
00:50:37.500 --> 00:50:43.019
Boardroom: And deliverability and funding, external funding leverage were weighted at 10% each.

332
00:50:43.050 --> 00:50:49.499
Boardroom: Projects then received low, medium, and high rankings within each category, which translated into weighted scores.

333
00:50:49.500 --> 00:51:04.270
Boardroom: Contributing to an overall score out of 100. So, generally, as noted on this slide here, projects scoring 75 and above were considered higher priority, 50 to 74 medium priority, and anything below 50 lower priority.

334
00:51:04.390 --> 00:51:24.239
Boardroom: So importantly, this framework was intended as a decision support tool, not purely a mechanical ranking system. So staff also considered council direction, geographic distribution, sequencing, community feedback, updated cost estimates, and overall portfolio balance when refining the proposed project list.

335
00:51:24.240 --> 00:51:33.119
Boardroom: So ultimately, this evaluation and methodology is intended to help staff understand priority phasing should the general obligation bond pass.

336

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00:51:34.090 --> 00:51:38.910
Boardroom: This slide summarizes the current working financial framework associated with the bond.

337
00:51:39.140 --> 00:51:55.119
Boardroom: The framework currently assumes $300 million in total bond sales, approximately $13 million in assumed bond interest earnings on the conservative end, and a total projected program capacity of approximately $313 million.

338
00:51:55.190 --> 00:52:04.929
Boardroom: The project portfolio itself currently totals approximately $272.5 million across the three infrastructure categories.

339
00:52:05.240 --> 00:52:30.020
Boardroom: And… The most important part, the framework also includes approximately $40.5 million in staffing and implementation-related resources. So this is an important component of the framework, because the BOM program of this scale requires significant delivery infrastructure over many years, so this could include project management, compliance, any required costs related to auditing and reporting.

340
00:52:30.220 --> 00:52:32.810
Boardroom: And general program administration needs.

341
00:52:32.910 --> 00:52:51.450
Boardroom: So these implementation resources are intended to support a responsible project delivery, not necessarily ongoing operational staffing. And with that said, I'll turn it over to our Parks, Recreation, and Waterfront Director, Scott Ferris, who will talk more about the community, facilities, and quality of life project portfolio.

342
00:52:53.360 --> 00:52:54.100
Boardroom: That's fair.

343
00:52:57.250 --> 00:53:00.730
Boardroom: Thanks, Kerry. Mayor and Council,

344
00:53:01.900 --> 00:53:08.419
Boardroom: So she's already introduced me. I'll introduce my staff that are here to support and provide detailed answers to questions if you have them.

345
00:53:09.260 --> 00:53:17.470

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Boardroom: they're sitting behind me, Evelyn Chan, supervising civil engineer, and Taylor Lancelot, who is acting

346
00:53:17.990 --> 00:53:22.509
Boardroom: Acting in Nelson's Place, Nelson Lamb is also a supervising civil engineer.

347
00:53:22.710 --> 00:53:30.430
Boardroom: Okay, so I'm gonna take you through 20 proposed PRW projects, Parks, Recreation, and Waterfront projects.

348
00:53:30.890 --> 00:53:36.420
Boardroom: And talk about them just briefly, each project, and a little bit of history.

349
00:53:37.690 --> 00:53:40.839
Boardroom: So, first on the list here is Francis Albury Community Center.

350
00:53:41.420 --> 00:53:46.090
Boardroom: This project was… is… first of all, Francis Albert is the only…

351
00:53:46.950 --> 00:53:53.969
Boardroom: and a senior center that is not seismically safe at this point. So, T1 has taken care of

352
00:53:54.240 --> 00:54:00.580
Boardroom: All the other facilities, and we've got, one under construction and another one to be under construction soon.

353
00:54:00.790 --> 00:54:08.720
Boardroom: But Francis Albright, was, got conceptual money to design the community center in T1 Phase 1.

354
00:54:09.110 --> 00:54:19.560
Boardroom: And we had an amazing two-year process, which we designed a community center there, and we'd like to go ahead and build that community center, and that is essentially replacing

355
00:54:19.720 --> 00:54:23.760
Boardroom: That's a teardown and replacement like Willard was.

356

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00:54:23.910 --> 00:54:36.899
Boardroom: So it's a full replacement, a brand new facility. It is a very small facility, given the amount of people it serves, and a much larger facility in the same kind of envelope is going to serve the community much, much better.

357
00:54:37.720 --> 00:54:49.220
Boardroom: Next I'm gonna talk about the Harrison turf, field conversion. So this converts, Harrison Park soccer fields, there are two soccer fields there, from, from grass to artificial turf.

358
00:54:50.380 --> 00:55:03.320
Boardroom: This is really important to all the sports field users, because it'll produce about 120% more play time. That field is closed 6 months a year, largely because of the wear and tear.

359
00:55:03.450 --> 00:55:07.100
Boardroom: And… Sometimes more than that.

360
00:55:08.460 --> 00:55:25.450
Boardroom: the sub-base of that field needs total renovation and needs to be repaired, and so it really limits the amount of use and how long we can keep that grass green. So while we replace it with turf, it's really gonna improve the amount of time that the youth can play on the fields.

361
00:55:26.050 --> 00:55:28.869
Boardroom: We've got several restrooms here.

362
00:55:29.010 --> 00:55:33.549
Boardroom: We're gonna talk about… a couple of them are on the T1 list, Harrison Park.

363
00:55:33.750 --> 00:55:41.439
Boardroom: was originally on the T1 list, and then got pulled off at the end because we need to consolidate dollars, along with the, the restroom

364
00:55:42.040 --> 00:55:47.100
Boardroom: Near the park at the waterfront. So, in this case,

365
00:55:47.300 --> 00:55:50.550
Boardroom: This would fund the construction of those two restrooms.

366
00:55:50.940 --> 00:55:54.939

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Boardroom: And so at Harrison and the Berkeley waterfront.

367
00:55:55.170 --> 00:56:04.670
Boardroom: We're adding two new restrooms to this list, Cedar Rose and Cordnisus, and we've gotten a lot of feedback about these two parks and upgrading the restrooms.

368
00:56:04.860 --> 00:56:10.429
Boardroom: From, essentially, what we call our block restrooms with just a toilet, to something that's more user-friendly.

369
00:56:11.360 --> 00:56:22.940
Boardroom: The last project on the list here is the King Pool and Locker Room, and I'll talk more about this project at the end on our fourth slide, where we talk about, how our projects have changed. Next slide, Carrie.

370
00:56:24.510 --> 00:56:25.740
Boardroom: So,

371
00:56:26.700 --> 00:56:40.159
Boardroom: The next 6 projects are… kind of… the next 7 projects are kind of a combination of place structures and open spaces and greenies, and so this list actually changed dramatically throughout the public process.

372
00:56:40.310 --> 00:56:42.430
Boardroom: In the city manager's eyes.

373
00:56:42.540 --> 00:56:54.169
Boardroom: Cedar Rose, for us, is kind of a no-brainer. It's fully designed and ready to bid out. In fact, we have bid out the, 5-12 place structure now.

374
00:56:54.400 --> 00:57:01.199
Boardroom: And the 2-5 place structure is designed and ready to go. We just need the allocation to construct it.

375
00:57:01.700 --> 00:57:08.700
Boardroom: Same… something very similar, Glendale Aloma. We've gone through a two-year process there, where we've designed… done a conceptual design.

376
00:57:08.850 --> 00:57:16.030

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Boardroom: And we're not that far from being able to construct that site. Got a lot of good input over the last year and a half.

377
00:57:16.210 --> 00:57:19.430
Boardroom: And, we've got a final conceptual design there.

378
00:57:20.810 --> 00:57:23.760
Boardroom: We've added a couple projects here,

379
00:57:23.850 --> 00:57:43.070
Boardroom: During T1 Phase 2, when we did a lot of public process, a couple of the projects that came up in District 8 were Monkey Island Park and the Garber Path right-of-way, which includes, a walkway, kind of a street, and a bunch of landscaping. And they didn't get funded in T1, Phase 2,

380
00:57:43.610 --> 00:57:58.710
Boardroom: But we didn't have a whole lot of projects in District 8, so we kind of went back and took another look at that, and heard some feedback from the community, and added those two projects. And while they're right together, so we would include them probably in one project.

381
00:57:58.790 --> 00:58:04.729
Boardroom: And we would improve, potentially improve the, the…

382
00:58:04.900 --> 00:58:09.650
Boardroom: elements of Monkey Island, and just a total redo at Garber Path.

383
00:58:11.230 --> 00:58:17.860
Boardroom: A couple of projects down below, the Adeline Corridor space. This is, refers to…

384
00:58:18.500 --> 00:58:20.460
Boardroom: We have an add-on corridor plan.

385
00:58:20.690 --> 00:58:25.039
Boardroom: Public Works is in the process of designing

386
00:58:25.360 --> 00:58:30.519
Boardroom: that street plan from Ashby all the way to the Oakland border.

387

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00:58:30.910 --> 00:58:36.259
Boardroom: So, and we're also… we've got… we've got, 30% design funding on that.

388
00:58:36.440 --> 00:58:41.279
Boardroom: We're applying for 100% divines funding. That design funding doesn't include the open space.

389
00:58:41.530 --> 00:58:49.710
Boardroom: And there's gonna be transportation dollars to fund that project as we move forward, but funding the park or the open space, we're not gonna have…

390
00:58:54.440 --> 00:58:55.250
Boardroom: Am I good?

391
00:58:55.390 --> 00:59:01.979
Boardroom: We have actually, about $850,000, which will be a HUD grant,

392
00:59:02.380 --> 00:59:21.410
Boardroom: to do some design there, but we're gonna need money to construct that as the Adeline plan goes on, and so that's what these dollars are for. We're, you know, we're talking about a 12 to 15 year spend here, so we're anticipating in the next few years, we'll be ready to construct those open spaces in the Adeline Corridor.

393
00:59:22.140 --> 00:59:41.870
Boardroom: Another project, a couple other projects were added, was the Dwight Talgraph open space, which is, what people refer to as the Adeline Triangle. As the Telegraph Avenue Plan is executed, it's gonna create an additional open space at the Adeline… Adeline Triangle, and so this project, we would construct it with, $3.5 million.

394
00:59:42.340 --> 00:59:52.819
Boardroom: Native plant median conversions, we've heard for years about the importance of converting some of our bigger, larger medians in Sacramento and University to native plant gardens.

395
00:59:53.340 --> 01:00:02.609
Boardroom: And, we heard a lot of feedback in the public process, and so this money allows us to do 3 or 4 blocks on Sacramento and University.

396
01:00:02.930 --> 01:00:03.810
Boardroom: Next slide.

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397
01:00:05.270 --> 01:00:09.770
Boardroom: The last 5 projects are all waterfront projects.

398
01:00:10.520 --> 01:00:24.800
Boardroom: And the three of these projects are very grant eligible, and so we're only asking for a portion of the projects that we… and we anticipate getting grants to fund the remaining portion.

399
01:00:25.410 --> 01:00:30.919
Boardroom: The, perimeter pathway, the Sea Level Rise Bay Trail project.

400
01:00:31.240 --> 01:00:43.350
Boardroom: And, the south… I'm sorry, and the seawall drives of Bay Trail Improvements are all projects that we know we're going to be able to secure grants for. Not 100% positive, but given,

401
01:00:43.650 --> 01:00:51.189
Boardroom: Our ability to secure grants, we're pretty positive that those will… that we're just… these are just leverage money in order to complete the project.

402
01:00:51.820 --> 01:01:06.299
Boardroom: The last two projects, the South Cove Seawall project, if you haven't been down to the South Cove Seawall, you know it's failing, and once that seawall fails, everything that happens there will cease to happen.

403
01:01:06.460 --> 01:01:20.350
Boardroom: So, all the, all the, everybody who launches from that South Cove, Cal Adventures, Cal Sailing, won't be able to use that, and won't be able to use that area, and so this totally replaces the seawall.

404
01:01:21.000 --> 01:01:27.140
Boardroom: And the other functional project here is the timber pile replacement. We did some of this in T1 Phase…

405
01:01:27.750 --> 01:01:41.749
Boardroom: 1, or T1 Phase 2, and, we are permit ready. Our permit doesn't expire for another 3 to 4 years, so as soon as this… if this one measure would pass in November, we could execute the,

406
01:01:42.090 --> 01:01:46.580

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Boardroom: The additional $3 million of a power replacement immediately.

407
01:01:47.530 --> 01:01:54.250
Boardroom: Okay, next slide. Okay, so what's changed here? And, I'll kind of skip the top

408
01:01:54.480 --> 01:02:01.659
Boardroom: area of what's… what will be kept in and what's advanced, but what's been scaled down a little bit? I… I talked earlier about King Pool.

409
01:02:01.890 --> 01:02:08.700
Boardroom: And how that shifted a little bit. Originally, we proposed, it was in the proposal, it was $25 million to replace the pool.

410
01:02:10.020 --> 01:02:19.789
Boardroom: We got a lot of feedback about that. Pro and con, not the right location, we should deal with West Campus, or put the pool at St. Francis Albreyer.

411
01:02:20.020 --> 01:02:23.020
Boardroom: And so, ultimately, as we went through.

412
01:02:23.510 --> 01:02:36.569
Boardroom: knowing we needed to scale back on some of our projects, essentially that original list probably had, I think, close to $430,000… $430 million worth of projects needing to scale back,

413
01:02:37.120 --> 01:02:44.300
Boardroom: to meet our $300 million. That was one of the projects that came off the list, and we had a variety of, of,

414
01:02:44.740 --> 01:03:00.269
Boardroom: a variety of pros and cons, and people who supported and people who didn't support it. So, we scaled it back to $5 million and did a renovation of the existing… existing two pools there. And one of the things that's happening at King, as opposed to West Campus.

415
01:03:00.360 --> 01:03:16.310
Boardroom: King is kind of up in the hills, there's a lot of movement in that ground. The concrete was poured in the middle 60s, and so it's starting to move, and so we're having constant breaks in our pipes that are associated with that concrete. We have one now.

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416
01:03:16.420 --> 01:03:33.539
Boardroom: Where we're losing water, and I'm funding it in fiscal 27, but this has been constant over the last 5 years. The concrete is just… is just getting old, and it's moving, the ground is moving, and so we're having problems there. That whole thing needs to be replaced.

417
01:03:34.380 --> 01:03:39.539
Boardroom: Things that were removed or deferred, we had proposed,

418
01:03:39.710 --> 01:03:53.329
Boardroom: about, I think, anywhere between, $2 to $4 million worth of dog parks, live oak park improvements that included the basketball courts and the open grass area there. San Pambo Park irrigation.

419
01:03:54.050 --> 01:03:59.170
Boardroom: And we also proposed a project for University Avenue Sea Level Rise and Bike Park.

420
01:03:59.480 --> 01:04:08.110
Boardroom: And then we had kind of a portion of Aquatic Park Dreamland. We know that Dreamland area project's gonna cost us about $8 million.

421
01:04:08.280 --> 01:04:14.989
Boardroom: And we think we have a funding source for about 3 quarters of it. So all those got removed.

422
01:04:15.470 --> 01:04:16.820
Boardroom: Ultimately.

423
01:04:17.430 --> 01:04:30.159
Boardroom: There are grant sources out there that can fund some of that, and parks tax, and so that was one of the reasons why, for the removals, if you have detailed questions, I can ask, tell you about each project, and then I've talked about the ones we've added.

424
01:04:31.940 --> 01:04:34.879
Boardroom: Carrie, am I gonna pass it to the Chief here?

425
01:04:42.740 --> 01:04:44.719
Boardroom: Alright, good evening.

426
01:04:45.160 --> 01:04:56.390

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Boardroom: I'm going to talk about the fire and public safety projects. So there's four main drivers to the urgent need to renovate the city's public safety infrastructure. Tonight, I'm going to provide a high-level overview.

427
01:04:56.750 --> 01:04:59.090
Boardroom: Of why it's important that this work begin now.

428
01:04:59.500 --> 01:05:02.009
Boardroom: First, the stations are simply too old.

429
01:05:02.400 --> 01:05:09.669
Boardroom: The City's 2023 Fire Facilities Master Plan found that nearly every facility needs major renovation or replacement.

430
01:05:10.160 --> 01:05:15.819
Boardroom: Most of Berkeley's fire stations were built in the 50s and 60s, and no longer support current staffing.

431
01:05:16.350 --> 01:05:20.719
Boardroom: Employee health and safety standards, or long-term operational demands?

432
01:05:21.250 --> 01:05:26.239
Boardroom: Acting now prevents an emergency situation for future councils and staff.

433
01:05:26.960 --> 01:05:31.050
Boardroom: Second, emergency calls and responsibilities have grown dramatically.

434
01:05:31.930 --> 01:05:36.819
Boardroom: Emergency responses have increased 60%, 65% in the last 30 years.

435
01:05:37.070 --> 01:05:43.600
Boardroom: And today's fire service responds to fire more than fires. In fact, it's almost a misnomer that we're called a fire department.

436
01:05:44.650 --> 01:05:49.559
Boardroom: To meet that expanded mission, the fire department houses far more people in each facility.

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437
01:05:50.520 --> 01:05:55.419
Boardroom: Larger apparatus, and carries more equipment than these mid-century stations were built to support.

438
01:05:56.130 --> 01:05:58.340
Boardroom: Third, the complexity.

439
01:05:58.450 --> 01:06:01.870
Boardroom: Of each project, and the impact to employee health and safety.

440
01:06:02.410 --> 01:06:09.620
Boardroom: Fire stations have to remain operational following a large seismic event, which means that they have to meet California's Essential Services Act.

441
01:06:10.020 --> 01:06:17.929
Boardroom: That, in turn means that they're some of the most expensive infrastructure to renovate and replace that any city operates.

442
01:06:18.420 --> 01:06:20.870
Boardroom: So, it's slow going, and it's really expensive.

443
01:06:21.480 --> 01:06:25.520
Boardroom: We also know that emergency responders faced increased risk of cancer.

444
01:06:25.670 --> 01:06:38.769
Boardroom: from carcinogen exposure. A lot of this happens in the living quarters, because older fire stations aren't built with separated facilities where the contaminated, gear and apparatus are off-gassing carcinogens throughout the day.

445
01:06:39.580 --> 01:06:51.360
Boardroom: So, these new stations will be built with those, those segregated areas that will improve employee health long-term and reduce the number of cancer diagnoses that we have each year.

446
01:06:52.070 --> 01:06:56.150
Boardroom: And finally, all of the public safety projects included within this framework

447
01:06:56.500 --> 01:07:02.240

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Boardroom: Incorporate resilience and sustainability components, primarily solar and battery backup.

448
01:07:02.540 --> 01:07:11.860
Boardroom: So this not only will take the facilities to energy neutral, but will prepare the city for a transition to the fleet… a fleet of electric fire engines in the next 10 to 15 years.

449
01:07:12.270 --> 01:07:22.089
Boardroom: So the bottom line for us is these upgrades are not expansions. They're critical reinvestments in aging infrastructure to ensure reliable emergency response for the next 75 years.

450
01:07:22.410 --> 01:07:29.980
Boardroom: Starting now allows the city to phase the work responsibly over the coming decades instead of deferring these complex and necessary projects.

451
01:07:30.260 --> 01:07:34.200
Boardroom: to the community, and the councils of the future. Thank you.

452
01:07:39.600 --> 01:07:51.180
Boardroom: Good afternoon, Mayor, Councilmembers, Wahita Mary, Interim Director of Public Works. This slide begins with one of the city's most visible and liability-sensitive infrastructure needs, accessibility.

453
01:07:51.810 --> 01:07:56.560
Boardroom: The 50-50 sidewalk program, at approximately $14.6 million.

454
01:07:56.680 --> 01:08:02.880
Boardroom: Helps accelerate sidewalk replacements citywide, and address a long wait list of unsafe and un…

455
01:08:03.140 --> 01:08:16.790
Boardroom: even conditions. In parallel, the $4.5 million ADA barrier removal allocation focuses on improving access within city-owned facilities and paths of travel for individuals with disability.

456
01:08:17.080 --> 01:08:24.080
Boardroom: The category also preserves funding for essential service facilities, including animal service upgrades.

457
01:08:24.450 --> 01:08:31.259

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Boardroom: the Berkeley Mental Health Annex Renovation, South Berkeley Senior Center, Mechanical System Improvements, HVAC,

458
01:08:31.580 --> 01:08:41.560
Boardroom: and the remaining funding needed to complete the African American Holistic Resource Center, that was a commitment that the city made. Overall, these investments prioritize accessibility.

459
01:08:41.840 --> 01:08:47.489
Boardroom: public safety, Essential services, and long-term facility reliability.

460
01:08:47.740 --> 01:08:53.730
Boardroom: While helping ensure that limited capital dollars are directed towards the city's highest impact needs.

461
01:08:55.859 --> 01:09:02.589
Boardroom: This slide continues the critical infrastructure and accessibility category, with a focus on civic buildings.

462
01:09:02.880 --> 01:09:10.550
Boardroom: Public safety facilities, and… historic civic assets. These are not just building improvements.

463
01:09:10.760 --> 01:09:19.399
Boardroom: They support daily city operations, public access, emergency response, and long-term facility reliability.

464
01:09:19.560 --> 01:09:30.479
Boardroom: Key investments include the 1947 Center Street Elevator Replacement Project, which addresses safety, reliability, and ADA access.

465
01:09:30.950 --> 01:09:44.020
Boardroom: Moving on to the 2180 Milvia Modernization Project, which addresses aging building systems. Again, improving accessibility, hazardous material.

466
01:09:44.240 --> 01:09:55.760
Boardroom: And so forth. And moving on to 2100 MLK Public Safety Building, which is a major investment in our 24-hour emergency operations hub, including the 911 Dispatch Center.

467
01:09:55.930 --> 01:10:08.940

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Boardroom: The slide also includes grand match funding for the Model Charic Building and the Veterans Memorial Building, helping the City position these historic civic assets for future restoration and community use.

468
01:10:09.240 --> 01:10:18.920
Boardroom: Overall, with this approximate $75 million investment, this category reflects a practical balance between essential facility modernization

469
01:10:19.070 --> 01:10:26.179
Boardroom: Accessibility, public safety operations, and responsible stewardship of important civic assets.

470
01:10:29.710 --> 01:10:37.819
Boardroom: This slide summarizes how staff refined the critical infrastructure and accessibility category to make the portfolio more focused and easy to deliver.

471
01:10:38.120 --> 01:10:45.209
Boardroom: Most of the core projects were preserved because they addressed well-documented needs related to accessibility.

472
01:10:45.590 --> 01:10:52.439
Boardroom: Life safety, seismic resilience, essential services, and public safety operations.

473
01:10:52.960 --> 01:11:02.240
Boardroom: A few changes that were made to somewhat improve the alignment and reduce duplication are Old City Hall and the Veterans Memorial Building.

474
01:11:02.480 --> 01:11:10.549
Boardroom: They were scaled to the minimum funding needed for grand match opportunities, rather than the full funding restoration through the bond.

475
01:11:10.570 --> 01:11:25.690
Boardroom: For the seismic, upgrades that's necessary. The 911 Dispatch Center was folded into the broader public safety building project, which better reflects the shared facility, systems, and emergency operation needs at the 2100 MLK building.

476
01:11:26.450 --> 01:11:33.080

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Boardroom: The West Berkeley Family Wellness Center was removed because it has recently been worked on, it's been improved.

477
01:11:33.390 --> 01:11:43.890
Boardroom: And as a lower near-term priority for us. The African American Holistic Resources Center was added to close a known funding commitment that the city has made to fulfill that project.

478
01:11:44.100 --> 01:11:55.160
Boardroom: Overall, these changes preserve the city's highest priority civic accessibility and public safety investments while keeping the portfolio focused, strategic, and defensible.

479
01:11:55.460 --> 01:11:58.420
Boardroom: With that said, I'll hand it over back to our Deputy City Manager.

480
01:12:00.950 --> 01:12:17.100
Boardroom: Hello again. So, in addition to looking at the general obligation bond to support infrastructure needs, as we mentioned, we also explored the feasibility of an increase in the sales and use tax measure of 0.5% from 10.25 to 10.75%.

481
01:12:17.570 --> 01:12:28.609
Boardroom: And what we know in working with our outside consultant is that could generate anywhere from $9 to $10 million in general fund resources that we have proposed to help offset our general fund structural deficit.

482
01:12:28.810 --> 01:12:37.299
Boardroom: And what this slide really helps to emphasize is how we have proposed those resources be deployed. So they're, proposed to be used across three departments.

483
01:12:37.320 --> 01:12:51.039
Boardroom: Parks, Recreation, and Waterfront, the Police Department, and Fire Department. And working from the bottom to the top, for the Fire Department, these resources would be, proposed to be used to maintain, Fire Station 4 and keeping that open.

484
01:12:51.330 --> 01:13:05.270
Boardroom: For the police department, it would be proposed to be used for 15 police officers and 6 dispatchers in total. That would be, useful to help keep the department operating in a manner that they can proactively address public safety needs.

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485
01:13:05.350 --> 01:13:21.810
Boardroom: And then lastly, for our Parks, Recreation, and Waterfront department, these resources would be deployed to help support critical staffing to ensure that after-school programs, camps, community centers, pools, and other very important programs for our youth can continue to operate as they currently do.

486
01:13:23.950 --> 01:13:37.760
Boardroom: So where are we and what's on the horizon? So, as mentioned before, we are bringing… we brought forward to this evening the results of the second survey, the results of the refined infrastructure project list.

487
01:13:37.880 --> 01:13:55.600
Boardroom: And in terms of going forward, after this evening, we look forward from direction to Council to move ahead, with developing ballot language for both the GEO bond and the sales and use tax measure. If we receive that direction, our intention is to be back in front of you on June 16th with the proposed ballot language.

488
01:13:55.840 --> 01:14:04.119
Boardroom: And that will give Council plenty of time, if necessary, to make any additional adjustments, because we have to have that to the county on August 7th.

489
01:14:04.220 --> 01:14:10.129
Boardroom: And we would like to, obviously, if necessary, have that done by the last council meeting on July 28th.

490
01:14:10.850 --> 01:14:25.430
Boardroom: So just to, come back to what we're looking for this evening from the City Council, the three actions that we reviewed at the beginning of this meeting. First is to affirm direction to continue to move ahead, with the general obligation bond ballot language.

491
01:14:25.660 --> 01:14:32.410
Boardroom: Second is to give us feedback on the project lists that have been presented by, our three directors.

492
01:14:32.600 --> 01:14:40.450
Boardroom: And then lastly, to affirm direction to continue to move ahead with the sales and use tax and drop ballot language for that as well.

493

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01:14:40.840 --> 01:14:57.389
Boardroom: Mayor, we'll turn it back over to you to facilitate. Thank you. Thank you very much, Deputy City Manager, and also team. I really appreciate the presentation, and what I'd like to do is start with questions from my Council colleagues on the Part 2 of this presentation.

494
01:14:57.480 --> 01:15:07.060
Boardroom: And then we will take public comment, and then we'll come back for deliberations, discussions. Are there any questions from my Council colleagues?

495
01:15:08.270 --> 01:15:19.799
Boardroom: Yes, Councilmember Kesarwani. Thank you very much, Madam Mayor. Thank you, to our three department folks for your presentations. I did want to ask you, Chief Farris.

496
01:15:19.810 --> 01:15:29.500
Boardroom: the… the situation with Kingpool, I didn't quite follow. I mean, I understand it's old, so are you prop… and I… and the presentation said that… so you're just proposing…

497
01:15:29.880 --> 01:15:33.960
Boardroom: Actually, can you just clarify what exactly you're proposing for Kingpool?

498
01:15:34.900 --> 01:15:44.050
Boardroom: Essentially, we're redoing, the, the infrastructure associated with the two pools there, and… and the pump room.

499
01:15:44.640 --> 01:15:47.800
Boardroom: So, the concrete, the piping.

500
01:15:48.090 --> 01:15:57.580
Boardroom: the pumps and the filters. Okay, because I think, because I thought you were suggesting another pool somewhere, but that's not part of this.

501
01:15:57.680 --> 01:16:04.720
Boardroom: Because I feel like… I don't know if I made it up, but, like, Fran… you were saying something about a pool of Francis Albire?

502
01:16:05.420 --> 01:16:11.120
Boardroom: So, there was some feedback as a part of, the conceptual plan for

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503
01:16:12.500 --> 01:16:23.710
Boardroom: the community center in San Pavo Park, Francis Albright, there was a discussion around a pool. In fact, it was included in the original conceptual plan. And so, as we brought this to the public,

504
01:16:23.780 --> 01:16:39.419
Boardroom: there was some concern that we were spending money at King and not building a new pool there. And just to remind you, we… a few years ago in 2020, we signed a new agreement with the school district that gives us a…

505
01:16:39.470 --> 01:16:44.700
Boardroom: a 30-year, lease at Kingpool, but only a 10-year

506
01:16:44.820 --> 01:16:48.099
Boardroom: at two fives lease at West Campus Pool.

507
01:16:48.530 --> 01:16:51.809
Boardroom: And the thought at that time was.

508
01:16:51.920 --> 01:16:59.149
Boardroom: as we were going through that process, that either the school district might use West Campus for some other,

509
01:16:59.260 --> 01:17:07.880
Boardroom: some other thing, or that we wouldn't need it, because we potentially would build a pool at… in San Pablo Park?

510
01:17:08.090 --> 01:17:09.380
Boardroom: And so…

511
01:17:09.490 --> 01:17:22.829
Boardroom: as we started to take it through public process, we got a lot of that feedback. Hey, you know, why rebuild a brand new pool of king? Should be more equitable, should do something in Francis Albire?

512
01:17:23.040 --> 01:17:26.460
Boardroom: And ultimately, When, as we kind of…

513
01:17:26.560 --> 01:17:31.069

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Boardroom: went through priorities and heard feedback. There were some… a lot of people in favor of King.

514
01:17:31.070 --> 01:17:51.539
Boardroom: A lot of people in favor of San Pablo Park for a pool, and a lot of people that just thought we should just renovate the existing King Pool. And so that's where we landed, for a variety of reasons. I didn't quite follow this full story arc. Sorry, I wasn't there. So, okay. So, and actually, this raises another question for me. So we're leasing Kingpool from the school district?

515
01:17:52.160 --> 01:18:00.319
Boardroom: On both King and West Campus. Okay, but, but we are paying for these infrastructure improvements.

516
01:18:00.460 --> 01:18:01.250
Boardroom: Correct.

517
01:18:03.400 --> 01:18:11.540
Boardroom: Okay, that's part of our lease agreement, is that right? It's a no-cost lease agreement, so we're not paying for the…

518
01:18:11.750 --> 01:18:15.629
Boardroom: You know, we take care of the facility and operate, and…

519
01:18:15.780 --> 01:18:23.410
Boardroom: you know, it's a part of agreement that includes, King Park, Thousand Oaks Park,

520
01:18:23.930 --> 01:18:26.459
Boardroom: And, both pools.

521
01:18:26.720 --> 01:18:37.300
Boardroom: Okay. And the MLK Yacht facility, next to Grove Park, that community center. This is also part of that lease. Okay. Okay, that's all I have, thank you.

522
01:18:40.360 --> 01:18:42.150
Boardroom: Thank you. Councilmember O'Keefe.

523
01:18:43.630 --> 01:18:50.170
Boardroom: Thank you. My first question was about the Kingpool, so I think you answered most of it. I just want to clarify.

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524
01:18:50.260 --> 01:18:51.840
Boardroom: Are there…

525
01:18:51.910 --> 01:19:08.630
Boardroom: Under the current version of the proposal, are there any improvements to be made to the locker room, or the outside of the pool, or is it just… you're limiting it only to the repair of the concrete and the pump? Yeah, it's limited just to the pool envelope, not to the locker room. Okay, so no safety improvements or anything like that?

526
01:19:08.690 --> 01:19:22.540
Boardroom: Not… not within the current budget, no. Okay. Proposed budget. Thank you for clarifying that. Yep. I also, I was disappointed to see the removal of the Live Oak basketball courts from the list, and I was wondering if you could speak more to that, was that…

527
01:19:22.740 --> 01:19:24.649
Boardroom: The result of community feedback?

528
01:19:25.160 --> 01:19:26.919
Boardroom: Why was that decision made?

529
01:19:27.400 --> 01:19:30.609
Boardroom: There actually wasn't much, and

530
01:19:31.040 --> 01:19:35.300
Boardroom: And the community feedback that we got was, that…

531
01:19:36.230 --> 01:19:45.929
Boardroom: we… if this is a… this… although we thought was an important project, even from people in that district, but we would prefer that you spend your money elsewhere.

532
01:19:46.940 --> 01:19:59.660
Boardroom: As you know, that, you know, there's an open grass area that's not really… it's, you know, it's not… it's not no irrigation in it, and the basketball courts, we get all kinds of complaints about the basketball courts and volleyball courts, because they slant.

533
01:19:59.790 --> 01:20:09.009
Boardroom: Down, and so this, this proposal would have leveled it, created, kind of a smaller, under-eight soccer field there.

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534
01:20:09.600 --> 01:20:12.099
Boardroom: But there wasn't a whole lot of community support for it.

535
01:20:12.450 --> 01:20:21.970
Boardroom: And as we needed to whittle down, our projects to get into the $300 million, that was one that we didn't, that fell off the list.

536
01:20:22.210 --> 01:20:23.030
Boardroom: Okay.

537
01:20:23.140 --> 01:20:23.960
Boardroom: Thank you.

538
01:20:26.110 --> 01:20:28.590
Boardroom: Thank you very much, Vice Mayor Traja.

539
01:20:29.870 --> 01:20:44.470
Boardroom: Thank you. No, we have, discussed the, reductions to, improvements to, to historic buildings in, downtown Berkeley, but…

540
01:20:44.610 --> 01:20:51.320
Boardroom: For the benefit of the public, could you speak, a little bit more to,

541
01:20:51.490 --> 01:21:02.510
Boardroom: How the propo- the new proposal would work with respect to the grant match, and, Perceived,

542
01:21:02.890 --> 01:21:06.199
Boardroom: Probability of still receiving the grant.

543
01:21:07.890 --> 01:21:09.380
Boardroom: Wahid, I'll let you take that one.

544
01:21:13.160 --> 01:21:14.230
Boardroom: Soap?

545
01:21:14.520 --> 01:21:18.819
Boardroom: Based on our data, The full amount for

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546
01:21:19.440 --> 01:21:24.909
Boardroom: The seismic upgrades at the old City Hall would be approximately $14 million.

547
01:21:25.130 --> 01:21:36.069
Boardroom: and at the Veterans Building, it's about $6.7 million, and that's just seismic upgrades. There is a FEMA grant that we are aiming for, and strategically.

548
01:21:36.810 --> 01:21:41.879
Boardroom: We're aiming to… The goal is to match city

549
01:21:42.710 --> 01:21:46.169
Boardroom: funds to be able to leverage the FEMA grant that's coming up.

550
01:21:47.350 --> 01:21:52.619
Boardroom: Use the resources and the funding for other, more system safety

551
01:21:52.930 --> 01:21:58.250
Boardroom: public safety facilities, as funding is very limited, so that was the strategy there.

552
01:22:05.380 --> 01:22:19.530
Boardroom: Yeah. And then… Two more questions, I think. So, on the… Sorry, three more questions.

553
01:22:19.680 --> 01:22:31.069
Boardroom: I think this one is for Carrie, on the project evaluation methodology, under green resiliency and sustainability,

554
01:22:31.520 --> 01:22:44.909
Boardroom: did that factor in the recommendation from the Environmental and Climate Commission to make, buildings, zero net energy slash electric?

555
01:22:45.290 --> 01:22:48.309
Boardroom: Yeah, so I… can you hear me okay? Okay.

556
01:22:48.310 --> 01:23:06.739
Boardroom: So for the methodology, so we looked at the Parks, Recreation, and Waterfront Commission report, and then also the Environmental

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Commission report as well. So, what you'll notice in the methodology for green resiliency and sustainability, that's something with, in addition to accessibility.

557
01:23:06.740 --> 01:23:13.159
Boardroom: That's something that we made an effort to try and incorporate in many of the projects where feasible.

558
01:23:13.160 --> 01:23:27.540
Boardroom: For green resiliency and sustainability, that's where we have very specific criteria for what it captures and what it doesn't capture. One thing that I want to note is, you know, we had some notes in here around important guardrails, so just because…

559
01:23:27.540 --> 01:23:34.109
Boardroom: sustainability features are woven into many projects. That doesn't necessarily mean we have to score them highly, but

560
01:23:34.110 --> 01:23:54.000
Boardroom: Is it something like with the fire facilities, ensuring that we have solar, backup generators, is that right? All electric, you know, that's where it would receive a high score. Or for the, native plant median conversions, that's where it would receive a high score. Whereas things that are more traditional,

561
01:23:54.000 --> 01:24:01.570
Boardroom: sort of, HVAC improvements, and things of that nature, that's where clearly it wouldn't receive a high score. I hope I answered your question.

562
01:24:01.570 --> 01:24:10.049
Boardroom: Oh, yeah, I, I, enough that, yeah, I, I think I have a better understanding.

563
01:24:11.270 --> 01:24:22.129
Boardroom: On the Harrison Field Torf conversion, I know this, astrotorf has come up at public meetings,

564
01:24:22.330 --> 01:24:37.380
Boardroom: and I understand that what you're proposing is, perhaps a different kind of astrotorf that is more, environmentally friendly. Could you speak to that, and maybe just,

565
01:24:37.500 --> 01:24:47.360

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Boardroom: A suggestion to be, very specific about how the, you know, the word astrotorf is used, given its connotation.

566
01:24:48.390 --> 01:24:53.549
Boardroom: Yeah, so, AstroTurf kind of refers to a different product.

567
01:24:53.680 --> 01:25:00.489
Boardroom: That is… essentially all polycarbons and rubber.

568
01:25:01.210 --> 01:25:13.099
Boardroom: the product that we would be putting in at Harrison is very similar to the product we would be putting, except an upgraded version at Tom Bates that we have now, which is,

569
01:25:13.630 --> 01:25:18.370
Boardroom: it was… it's a… it's a plastic stem.

570
01:25:19.160 --> 01:25:25.310
Boardroom: with a cork base. Initially, you know, what we installed at Tom Bates.

571
01:25:25.460 --> 01:25:34.620
Boardroom: Was very traditional, where you see everywhere is that kind of plastic stem with the black cork, black, rubber petals.

572
01:25:34.740 --> 01:25:40.509
Boardroom: And in 2018, we switched to a different,

573
01:25:40.860 --> 01:25:50.870
Boardroom: Subservice, we added a concussion subsurface, and we added a different, plastic stem, and a cork base.

574
01:25:51.050 --> 01:25:54.090
Boardroom: And so, there are a variety of, of…

575
01:25:54.200 --> 01:25:58.860
Boardroom: Trends out there now amongst a lot of these, turf…

576
01:26:00.600 --> 01:26:06.829
Boardroom: turf soccer fields, that we would evaluate. Some of them are moving towards,

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577
01:26:06.940 --> 01:26:20.189
Boardroom: you know, walnut-based turf, walnut-based infield. It doesn't float like the, like the cork does, so if you, if you go out there on rainy days, you'll see our, some of our cork floating away.

578
01:26:20.390 --> 01:26:22.150
Boardroom: And,

579
01:26:22.280 --> 01:26:29.539
Boardroom: And the walnuts don't float like that, but there's, you know, in the industry now, there's some… there's some problems with

580
01:26:29.820 --> 01:26:38.869
Boardroom: you know, with youth and adults with nut allergies. And so, we would do the research that we needed to do to have the most, up-to-date

581
01:26:39.050 --> 01:26:43.229
Boardroom: Product that would be the most environmentally friendly product.

582
01:26:43.350 --> 01:26:45.089
Boardroom: That we would install in Berkeley.

583
01:26:46.490 --> 01:26:56.729
Boardroom: Great, thank you. And my last question, and this might be for, perhaps David, and…

584
01:26:58.460 --> 01:27:11.470
Boardroom: Questions have… I would say the combined, levy of approximately $44 per $100,000 of assessed value,

585
01:27:12.590 --> 01:27:22.150
Boardroom: over 41 years. Could you speak to approximately what that might mean to the median homeowner?

586
01:27:23.770 --> 01:27:28.039
Boardroom: So, the median assessed value that we,

587
01:27:28.380 --> 01:27:34.089
Boardroom: observed when we brought for the December report was $550,000.

588

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01:27:34.560 --> 01:27:41.080
Boardroom: So, applying that and $44 would be $242 a year.

589
01:27:41.500 --> 01:27:42.340
Boardroom: Thank you.

590
01:27:45.150 --> 01:27:56.909
Boardroom: Yes. And Councilmember Blackaby? Great, thanks, Madam Mayor. Just to pick up on that point, because I actually had a question about that also, on that chart, about the overall, the bond analysis and the indebtedness.

591
01:27:56.910 --> 01:28:11.479
Boardroom: And I appreciate the look at it just by bond. What might be helpful moving forward before we kind of do the final implementation, I think most residents don't think of just the city bond part of this separate. They think about the total tax bill. They think about all the parcel taxes.

592
01:28:11.530 --> 01:28:18.800
Boardroom: the stuff that comes from the school district, the things that come from the county. So I think the right context for this is not just

593
01:28:18.840 --> 01:28:32.709
Boardroom: the city's bond indebtedness, and what this is costing the residents from just that portion, but the overall tax bill? I know that's hard, and we've talked about that in the past, but… Yeah, so, in December, we did a fiscal year 26 model

594
01:28:32.820 --> 01:28:46.970
Boardroom: of the property tax bill, and I think for Berkeley, it's about $10,924 for our $550,000 median home at 1,900 square feet. In looking, this is a $100 million bond every 5 years.

595
01:28:46.980 --> 01:29:00.649
Boardroom: Based on analysis, if we did $100 million in 2027, that would add an additional $16 per $100,000, so you could add that to the $10,900 to get the total tax bill, based on fiscal year 26.

596
01:29:00.650 --> 01:29:11.420
Boardroom: Looking at fiscal year 27 is obviously unknown to us. There are a number of parcel taxes on the ballot, so we could model something out, depending upon which ones you think may pass.

597

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01:29:11.420 --> 01:29:28.810
Boardroom: But looking at fiscal year 26, that would be the impact. Right. So I guess, yeah, so you're saying, again, and the $242 is in the context of the median bill, which is already, would you say, the median total? The median assessed value was $550,000, and that's over the course of… that's the average over 40 years. Right. And just when we look at…

598
01:29:29.200 --> 01:29:36.329
Boardroom: the immediate $100 million is obviously a lot less. Got it. But that portion of the overall tax bill is also

599
01:29:36.370 --> 01:29:56.030
Boardroom: again, thinking of it in those terms, for the median average person, their average annual property tax bill with all of the other bells and whistles comes out to something like… It was, $10,924, the total tax bill fiscal year 26th. So you're talking about $242 on top of $10,000… again, which puts that in perspective, you know, again.

600
01:29:56.030 --> 01:29:57.860
Boardroom: No one wants to pay more taxes.

601
01:29:57.890 --> 01:29:58.690
Boardroom: But…

602
01:29:59.040 --> 01:30:08.339
Boardroom: they're already… there's already a $10,000 nut between the property tax and everything else that we're talking about. So this is a… incrementally, it's not… it's… it's… it's something, but it's not…

603
01:30:08.600 --> 01:30:15.050
Boardroom: the biggest driver, that number? Yes, but to be really clear.

604
01:30:15.510 --> 01:30:27.609
Boardroom: because we'd only do $100 million in 2027, we'd actually only add $16 per $100,000, we wouldn't add the $242. Okay, that makes sense, thank you.

605
01:30:27.670 --> 01:30:46.620
Boardroom: Question for the city manager, I know we've talked about it in the past, but just to confirm, if we do embark on this infrastructure measure and it passes, and we then have, sort of, these projects on our plate, knowing that we've got a super talented management team, but they're also managing a lot of day-to-day work.

606

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01:30:46.620 --> 01:31:00.009
Boardroom: how do you foresee… how do we staff this, execute this, make sure that we do all the oversight, and all of the work on these infrastructure projects at the level of quality we expect? How would you staff it and organize it? Yeah, it's a good question.

607
01:31:00.270 --> 01:31:12.390
Boardroom: As the staff mentioned, we did build into this, into the measure costs to add staffing. Obviously, we'd have to have more staff to… to run a $300 million bond project over these years, and so,

608
01:31:12.650 --> 01:31:29.619
Boardroom: We, you know, we haven't come up with exactly what the staffing model would look like, but we've built in the additional costs to add staff to run the measure, whether that is done sort of like T1, where part of it was done in parks and part of it was done in public works, or whether we created a separate standalone

609
01:31:29.620 --> 01:31:45.249
Boardroom: capital projects division to run it all. We haven't just made that decision yet, but, you know, those are the things we're talking about. Okay. And there are other cities we can also borrow from in terms of best practices and look at? There are, and we have, also, for previous ones. Great, thank you.

610
01:31:45.250 --> 01:31:51.580
Boardroom: When do we need to finalize the list of projects? Does that have to happen before we go to the ballot, or,

611
01:31:52.350 --> 01:31:55.399
Boardroom: This list that we're kind of negotiating between and what's on and what's off.

612
01:31:56.230 --> 01:32:01.670
Boardroom: Yeah, we wanna… we wanna finalize a list before we go to the ballot, but I also want to be clear that we…

613
01:32:01.780 --> 01:32:16.199
Boardroom: We're not saying that this is… that there can be no flexibility on this list for moving spending around, because we know that there will be, you know, things will happen. We'll get grants that, like, fully fund a project, and we'll want to move that money into another project, and so…

614
01:32:16.340 --> 01:32:27.150

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Boardroom: Just to be clear that, yes, we would like to finalize the project before we… before we… at the time when we get the ballot measure, when you adopt the language for the measure, but also we… we will…

615
01:32:27.780 --> 01:32:38.519
Boardroom: We will have flexibility built in so that we can move things around. Okay, thanks. Question for, Chief Sprague on the Fire Training Center. That replacement project, is that…

616
01:32:38.690 --> 01:32:54.189
Boardroom: Do you have a location? Is that envisioned to be at the Gilman Street location or somewhere else? We don't have a location nailed down, that's one potential location, but the city would have to, acquire the property and make sure we can fit everything there. Okay. First. Okay, got it. And then,

617
01:32:54.190 --> 01:33:01.759
Boardroom: he… we talked a little bit about the, investment in 2100MLK, the Public Safety Building.

618
01:33:01.760 --> 01:33:20.239
Boardroom: Obviously, so FIRE has shifted a lot of their operations out to the new location. So that work at the Public Safety Building is mostly 911 dispatch and police, is that right? Confirmed, it is. Okay, okay. And what are we, what are we doing with the rest of the space, by the way, in that building, with BFD moving up?

619
01:33:20.550 --> 01:33:25.770
Boardroom: Bro, police is expanding into it, is the short answer to that. Okay, great.

620
01:33:26.060 --> 01:33:41.529
Boardroom: Councilmember, also just to clarify, the dispatch center does still serve, fire and EMS? It's joint, right, it's joint, yeah, thank you. Okay. I think… oh, last thing, specifically on the projects, we… you mentioned that we'd reduced the…

621
01:33:41.690 --> 01:33:58.129
Boardroom: allocation for the Civic Center restoration, basically enough to secure grant matches. My only question is whether or not, if that's… there's sort of a too hot, too cold, just right. I would be supportive of something that's a little bit more than that. It feels like…

622
01:33:58.280 --> 01:33:59.530
Boardroom: You know, we're kind of…

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623
01:33:59.650 --> 01:34:15.519
Boardroom: bringing it way back to a very small amount that's… we still have a lot of runway to go to actually get those projects done. So, I know we've listened to a lot of the community feedback, and so I want to honor and respect that, and as you guys have thought about this process, but…

624
01:34:15.620 --> 01:34:34.010
Boardroom: I at least would be curious about moving that back a little bit higher. Maybe it's not at the full level that it was before, but I just don't wanna… I just don't wanna drag that out and then have a super long runway. Like, if we're gonna do it, I would like to, you know, make a solid step forward towards it. So that would… that's my own personal feedback. I don't know what other people think.

625
01:34:34.100 --> 01:34:35.769
Boardroom: Thank you. That's it.

626
01:34:37.500 --> 01:34:53.509
Boardroom: Thank you very much. I have a few questions as well. In the last conversation that we had about the sales tax and infrastructure bond, we talked about, allocating funding for auditing. Could you speak to if we've made any changes around that?

627
01:34:55.190 --> 01:35:03.969
Boardroom: That's where the $40.5 million, that's baked into that cost. And could you speak to… a little more to what that…

628
01:35:04.110 --> 01:35:06.489
Boardroom: Exactly would be used for.

629
01:35:07.350 --> 01:35:17.740
Boardroom: So, it would probably be very similar to T1, so we audit, self-audit, we actually outside audit T1 every two years, so I think we're in the middle of our fourth audit.

630
01:35:17.830 --> 01:35:28.749
Boardroom: Right now, and so it would be very similar, and the audit is to make sure that the funds are being spent as, per the measure, and per the, the language in the measure.

631
01:35:28.890 --> 01:35:34.780

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Boardroom: And it's pretty comprehensive, and so it happens every two years. We probably do something similar for this bond measure.

632
01:35:35.640 --> 01:35:44.180
Boardroom: Thank you, and I just want to understand, because I think for Measure FF, we had our city auditor do that auditing. Is there a reason we chose to do external audits for that?

633
01:35:48.370 --> 01:36:01.780
Boardroom: I can only venture to bet that's because that's… it was a citizen initiative. From a city practice perspective, we typically do audit our tax measures, and I think what we've… what we're proposing is fairly standard for, how we proceed.

634
01:36:02.030 --> 01:36:04.359
Boardroom: Thank you, I just want to make sure we…

635
01:36:04.670 --> 01:36:20.519
Boardroom: Have a clear understanding of that, since, of course, accountability is very important to us. We want to make sure folks know that we have these measures in place, when we're asking them to support them. And what happens if we don't secure grant funding for the projects that we hope to?

636
01:36:22.020 --> 01:36:29.220
Boardroom: I know that was touched on a little bit, but there are a number of projects that we talked about getting grant funds for.

637
01:36:32.680 --> 01:36:36.690
Boardroom: So, obviously, grant funding is never 100%.

638
01:36:38.110 --> 01:36:43.939
Boardroom: What you see in these proposals are really…

639
01:36:44.190 --> 01:36:47.919
Boardroom: The… and the only spot… the only spots that we… that we…

640
01:36:48.130 --> 01:36:52.910
Boardroom: Kind of mentioned that there was a potential use of those leverage, are ones where we were

641
01:36:53.190 --> 01:36:59.410

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Boardroom: pretty confident that we could secure funding for. There's probably another half-dozen projects on this list.

642
01:37:00.680 --> 01:37:18.709
Boardroom: That we think are possible for grant funding sources, that we didn't do that with, so we will either be able to leverage that funds to add more to the project, and more folk… more scope to. But we only really included the ones we were pretty confident on.

643
01:37:18.960 --> 01:37:26.339
Boardroom: And the grants that we know that are out there, have talked to funders about, and either have applied for.

644
01:37:26.600 --> 01:37:28.860
Boardroom: Or, received similar grants before.

645
01:37:29.980 --> 01:37:51.690
Boardroom: Yeah, I just want to make sure we're clear with the public that if we don't receive that funding, we probably won't be able to do those projects. One thing I'll say, you know, our city manager had alluded to the fact that we're, wanting to build in flexibility, and I think where the, scoring methodology comes into play for the items that were scored very high for leveraging external funding.

646
01:37:51.690 --> 01:37:57.649
Boardroom: That could potentially help just the phasing of it, just because the bond is issued at $100 million every…

647
01:37:57.650 --> 01:38:09.910
Boardroom: 5 years. So I think that's something in terms of strategy, thinking about, phasing out certain… er, not phasing out, but how we phase in certain projects related to grant timelines as well.

648
01:38:11.080 --> 01:38:19.829
Boardroom: That makes sense, thank you. And then, one more thing I wanted to make sure I understood, can you speak a little bit to…

649
01:38:20.380 --> 01:38:26.519
Boardroom: how we've prepared for increases in costs, both to labor, materials, I think…

650
01:38:26.830 --> 01:38:33.309
Boardroom: I'm a little cautious of that, knowing that, these costs can go up really drastically.

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651
01:38:34.400 --> 01:38:38.319
Boardroom: Right? This is something we didn't push it a little closer… didn't do in T1.

652
01:38:38.460 --> 01:38:47.920
Boardroom: But it's something we've done with these projects. So, we've added, additional funding, knowing that

653
01:38:48.030 --> 01:39:01.749
Boardroom: you know, depending on how these bonds are sold, whether it's in two or three phases, we've added, the appropriate amount of money to some of these projects that we know are gonna be, later. They're gonna happen later in the bond measure.

654
01:39:02.050 --> 01:39:10.849
Boardroom: And we didn't do that in T1. It was one of the reasons why we, along with increases from COVID and all the related,

655
01:39:11.270 --> 01:39:19.130
Boardroom: concrete and metal increases that we saw during that time, that we had to restructure, restructure the projects

656
01:39:19.260 --> 01:39:23.549
Boardroom: I think over the life of T1, we restructured maybe 5 or 6 times.

657
01:39:23.810 --> 01:39:33.390
Boardroom: which included Council approval on that. We would go to our Public Works and Parks Recreation and Waterfront Commission, then bring those changes to Council.

658
01:39:34.400 --> 01:39:43.020
Boardroom: Thank you so much, I appreciate it. I'd like to move us over to public comment. If there is any public comment on this item…

659
01:39:43.230 --> 01:39:59.670
Boardroom: which its official title is, Presentation and Discussion of Second Community Survey Results and Direction Regarding Potential Ballot Measures for the November 3rd, 2026 General Municipal Election Item. Please raise your hand if you're online, or come up to the front if you've… if you'd like to make a comment.

660

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01:39:59.820 --> 01:40:01.070
Boardroom: In person.

661
01:40:14.040 --> 01:40:33.809
Boardroom: Hi, I'm Judy Zyka, I'm one of the co-presidents of the Berkeley Historical Society and Museum, and I'm particularly interested in the Veterans Building and the Old City Hall. There seems to be this misconception that these are vacant buildings. In fact, in the…

662
01:40:34.510 --> 01:40:43.290
Boardroom: Is Part D of the, Civic Center Improvements, the, the, the survey results?

663
01:40:44.340 --> 01:40:50.239
Boardroom: There's a statement that says, these are closed buildings that are not currently serving the public.

664
01:40:50.510 --> 01:41:06.279
Boardroom: And I think that that perception is really misleading because, in fact, both of these buildings are used every day, and the Berkeley Historical Society has been there since 1992. That's 34 years.

665
01:41:06.710 --> 01:41:17.839
Boardroom: These buildings are seismically unsound. We have… we host events, we host exhibits, we host…

666
01:41:18.360 --> 01:41:25.590
Boardroom: Thank you. Thank you very much. In any case, I think that that's important to keep in mind here. Thank you. Thank you.

667
01:41:31.700 --> 01:41:45.720
Boardroom: Good afternoon. Thank you, to the Commission and the… or the Council and the staff. My name's Allison Labonte, I'm a resident in District 2, and I especially appreciate hearing how the focus groups and, meetings with the commissions

668
01:41:45.720 --> 01:42:08.229
Boardroom: has, been incorporated in some of the changes recommended here by staff. There was just, two things, in conversations that I continue to have with the community, to… that I wanted to point out. One, I'm uncertain about how we can say that the bathrooms are user-friendly. One thing that's going around on the West, Berkeley WhatsApp chat is, like, these are…

669

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01:42:08.230 --> 01:42:32.389
Boardroom: requiring a phone to scan a QR code, some of the smart bathrooms, and I'm not sure that that's really that, easy, user-friendly, especially for elderly. And, the other thing is, in a February 2026 document with the costs of projects, the King Pool, with a locker room, decking, piping, roof.

670
01:42:32.650 --> 01:42:39.310
Boardroom: was 5 million, so if there's no locker room, why is it still listed 5 million recommendations? Thank you. Thanks.

671
01:42:39.420 --> 01:42:40.620
Boardroom: Thanks, Allison.

672
01:42:41.090 --> 01:42:55.950
Boardroom: Just to address… just some… I know you already answered this, but just some changes were made because of the increase in costs along the way, and some staffing as well, so that might address some of that, but go ahead. Hi, John Kaner, Downtown Berkeley Association Community for Cultural Civic Center.

673
01:42:56.070 --> 01:43:02.130
Boardroom: So, we appreciate the challenge that you're all facing, in that,

674
01:43:02.280 --> 01:43:18.759
Boardroom: John, can you talk in the mic? Oh, I'm sorry. How do we get funding for the Civic Center? It didn't poll as well as other items. I think the idea of having a match for the FEMA grant is a good idea. I think, was it about $5 million, the match?

675
01:43:18.950 --> 01:43:34.390
Boardroom: For both buildings. The question I have is, if we don't get the FEMA grant, God knows, with this administration, could we repurpose that? When I talked to Liam Garland a couple years ago, a prior head of public works, he said we needed about

676
01:43:34.390 --> 01:43:40.529
Boardroom: $2 million to make us shovel-ready for, with CEQA and NEQA.

677
01:43:40.530 --> 01:43:56.219
Boardroom: So, what my request is that that $5 million, we wish it was more, but that there's some flexibility in that, and how it's, the ballot measure is written, and how that money can be deployed to get ready for shovel-ready… Thanks, John. …when the economy turns around. Thank you.

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678
01:43:56.660 --> 01:44:00.759
Boardroom: Anyone else in person? Okay, go for it.

679
01:44:07.030 --> 01:44:16.209
Boardroom: what is born in Berkeley bursts out and buzzes around the world. Right now, we have a great historic, museum.

680
01:44:17.040 --> 01:44:19.499
Boardroom: And we do great things, but…

681
01:44:20.060 --> 01:44:25.630
Boardroom: We need… we are underrepresented, and we are an underfunded gem.

682
01:44:26.430 --> 01:44:32.340
Boardroom: And what I'm asking is, I respectfully ask the City Council to approve this bond.

683
01:44:32.500 --> 01:44:45.910
Boardroom: reconsider the puny allocation given to Old City Hall, and dedicate enough financial resources for our mission at the Historical Society to build a great museum, and I ask your help to make that happen. Thank you.

684
01:44:46.570 --> 01:44:47.760
Boardroom: Thank you.

685
01:44:51.080 --> 01:45:06.080
Boardroom: That was Karen Chapman from the, Berkeley Historical Society and Museum. I'm Anne Harlow from the same institution. But I want to mention that it's not just our museum that is occupying space in one of those two buildings. There's also the Dorothy Day House.

686
01:45:06.270 --> 01:45:17.309
Boardroom: which is visited by many people every day, and, you know, it could collapse in an earthquake, and who's gonna be responsible? City of Berkeley for not taking care of a building it owns.

687
01:45:17.410 --> 01:45:29.299
Boardroom: And then there's options. Recovery Services also is very active in the, Model Sherrick building. Berkeley Community Media is active in the, Old City Hall, which…

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688
01:45:29.470 --> 01:45:33.649
Boardroom: You do need to always, I think, say Old City Hall, not just Maudel Sherrick Building.

689
01:45:33.810 --> 01:45:36.490
Boardroom: For the… for the public.

690
01:45:36.850 --> 01:45:40.049
Boardroom: I'm glad that the numbers got revised about the seismic work.

691
01:45:40.340 --> 01:45:49.599
Boardroom: But, it didn't sound to me like you were budgeting an adequate match for the total amount for the Veterans Building, grant, if we get that.

692
01:45:49.740 --> 01:45:50.550
Boardroom: Thank you.

693
01:45:50.990 --> 01:45:52.210
Boardroom: Thank you.

694
01:45:52.710 --> 01:45:54.480
Boardroom: Anyone else in person?

695
01:45:54.760 --> 01:45:55.930
Boardroom: Folks online?

696
01:45:57.900 --> 01:46:00.299
Boardroom: Yes, there's currently 10 hands raised.

697
01:46:00.580 --> 01:46:03.570
Boardroom: First is Aaron Dean.

698
01:46:05.830 --> 01:46:07.340
Erin Diehm: Good evening, can you hear me?

699
01:46:08.080 --> 01:46:08.810
Boardroom: Yes.

700

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01:46:08.990 --> 01:46:26.129
Erin Diehm: Thank you for taking my comment. This is Erin Deem. I want to speak in support of projects number 30 and 31, the Maldah Share Rec and Veterans Memorial Building. I strongly support the work and vision for these important community spaces, and I really want to highlight projects number 22 and 23.

701
01:46:26.130 --> 01:46:41.019
Erin Diehm: And this is transforming the mediums from weedy lots that can be a visibility risk and require ongoing mowing to beautiful, climate-resilient, green, low-water, low-maintenance California native plantings.

702
01:46:41.020 --> 01:46:52.409
Erin Diehm: I'm sure it would garner a lot of strong community support. I'm actually in the parks one to two days a week, helping maintain the native plant gardens there that I helped spearhead on the commission, and I can honestly…

703
01:46:52.410 --> 01:47:08.660
Erin Diehm: Every time I'm in the park, one, two, three, four, five people stop, and they say they love the native plants. They even know the names, they surprise me. Hummingbird sage, or the CNosis. People know it's a movement, and so supporting this would be a wonderful idea and a great addition to our city.

704
01:47:08.660 --> 01:47:09.130
Boardroom: Fair enough.

705
01:47:09.130 --> 01:47:09.870
Erin Diehm: Thank you.

706
01:47:12.510 --> 01:47:14.449
Boardroom: Next is Mary Carlton.

707
01:47:22.090 --> 01:47:24.320
Mary Carleton: Sorry for the time to…

708
01:47:24.490 --> 01:47:42.539
Mary Carleton: Thank you very much. I'm sorry I was not able to attend in person, and I really appreciate your work. Regarding line 22 and 23, I'd like to suggest adding the words as needed after soil replacement and new irrigation.

709
01:47:42.680 --> 01:48:02.000

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Mary Carleton: Because there are, you know, in my personal experience, and experience of other native gardeners, while water is vital for getting the plants started, it's remarkably little water, and can go from daily down to weekly quite quickly, and, to monthly.

710
01:48:02.000 --> 01:48:05.449
Mary Carleton: And certainly far less if the planting is done

711
01:48:05.450 --> 01:48:09.370
Mary Carleton: When the rains are starting.

712
01:48:09.700 --> 01:48:13.549
Mary Carleton: 20-gallon water carts with bicycle wheels.

713
01:48:13.670 --> 01:48:27.529
Mary Carleton: And a spigot on the median would allow volunteers to provide sufficient watering very easily, so the cost and the then plastic and the ground irrigation could be

714
01:48:28.190 --> 01:48:28.820
Mary Carleton: Yes.

715
01:48:28.820 --> 01:48:32.029
Boardroom: Thank you, I'm sorry your time is up. Thank you for your comment.

716
01:48:32.460 --> 01:48:35.079
Boardroom: Next is Ted Steen.

717
01:48:41.710 --> 01:48:42.940
Ted Steen - Eastshore Alliance FC: Hi, everyone!

718
01:48:43.140 --> 01:48:50.580
Ted Steen - Eastshore Alliance FC: Thank you, council members. My name is Ted Steen, and I represent East Shore Alliance FC, where we serve over a thousand children right here in the East Bay.

719
01:48:50.580 --> 01:49:10.079
Ted Steen - Eastshore Alliance FC: I'm here tonight to talk about supporting two things. One, it's vital to include the turfing of Gabe Catofo fields at Harrison Park and the bathroom improvements in this bond measure. The city's own assessment calls these failing fields, which our kids play on every week. That's a health and safety issue, and our

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community deserves better. We have a petition with over… with hundreds of signatures on it.

720
01:49:10.080 --> 01:49:32.320
Ted Steen - Eastshore Alliance FC: Second, taking a look at the proposed 40-60% increase in youth sports, especially with the expansion of Harrison Park when it comes to turfing. That kind of jump puts soccer out of reach for a lot of families. Before I step down, I have to recognize two Berkeley staff members, Cesar, who does a great job keeping up the grass fields, and Twin, who's always out here on the field and in the parking lot, making sure that our kids are safe and supported.

721
01:49:32.320 --> 01:49:33.620
Ted Steen - Eastshore Alliance FC: Thank you all so much.

722
01:49:34.710 --> 01:49:35.690
Boardroom: Thank you!

723
01:49:36.710 --> 01:49:40.190
Boardroom: Okay… Next is Lisa Bullwinkle.

724
01:49:44.080 --> 01:49:58.500
Lisa Bullwinkel: Hi, good evening, everyone. I'm Lisa Bullwinkle, I'm on the Art Commission, but I'm speaking as a resident tonight. First of all, I'd like to see us fix existing things that we have, instead of coming up with a whole bunch of new projects.

725
01:49:58.510 --> 01:50:18.410
Lisa Bullwinkel: But I'd also want to talk about Old City Hall and the Veterans Building. I understand the match for Old City Hall. If it's a 50-50 match, it kind of works, but the amount for the Veterans Building is nowhere near what we would need in order to provide an art center for our community, and

726
01:50:18.410 --> 01:50:32.679
Lisa Bullwinkel: The idea of fixing these two buildings, besides that they're beautiful, is to also activate our Civic Center and keep it safe and a wonderful place for everyone to come and enjoy. And that only happens if we have a lot of foot traffic.

727
01:50:32.740 --> 01:50:48.050
Lisa Bullwinkel: By fixing these two buildings, we will have the facilities to encourage people to come downtown, enjoy the park, enjoy the Berkeley Museum, and take some art classes. So, I hope we can find some more money for the Veterans Building.

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728
01:50:48.050 --> 01:50:48.620
Boardroom: Bye.

729
01:50:49.880 --> 01:50:54.820
Boardroom: Next is Bay Area Adult Soccer League.

730
01:50:58.260 --> 01:51:08.350
Bay Area Adult Soccer League: Hi everyone, my name is Irene, I'm the owner of the Bay Area Adult Soccer League, and we have actually been playing at Tom Bates Sports Complex for about 13 years.

731
01:51:08.360 --> 01:51:20.219
Bay Area Adult Soccer League: We serve primarily the Berkeley community, the adult soccer community, so I'm here to make a big, big push for the artificial turf conversion for the Gabe, Gabe Cotalfo Harrison Park.

732
01:51:20.550 --> 01:51:32.799
Bay Area Adult Soccer League: Field project. We have been waiting for this for a really long time. The fields are totally congested. I can tell you, pre-COVID, we had maybe 12 sports groups vying for those slots at Tom Bates.

733
01:51:33.290 --> 01:51:42.009
Bay Area Adult Soccer League: pre-COVID, and then post-COVID now, we have quadrupled the amount of groups, so it's completely congested, and it would eliminate a lot of pressure on the Tom Bates

734
01:51:42.010 --> 01:52:00.720
Bay Area Adult Soccer League: competition for us to be able to have that artificial turf, which, as Scott Ferriss was saying, we could… it's not being used right now because it's grass and it needs to be maintained, like, 6 months out of the year, which is a whole lot of time, and this is really a quality of life issue, it's a public health issue, it's a mental health issue for our adults.

735
01:52:00.720 --> 01:52:01.479
Boardroom: Thank you so much.

736
01:52:01.480 --> 01:52:02.130
Bay Area Adult Soccer League: much.

737
01:52:04.230 --> 01:52:06.910

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Boardroom: Next is, Taj.

738
01:52:10.880 --> 01:52:21.799
Taj H-B: Yes, I'm sorry, I'm under the weather, so unfortunately I can't be there in person tonight. But I wanted to address… I'd like to urge the Council tonight to take a step back and look at this.

739
01:52:21.920 --> 01:52:36.369
Taj H-B: issue microscopically. So Honorable Mayor and Councilmembers, my name is Tasha Baptiste. I do serve as a Commissioner on the Disaster Infare Safety Commission and on the Community Health Commission, but I'm speaking tonight in my individual capacity as a Berkeley resident.

740
01:52:36.650 --> 01:52:40.510
Taj H-B: And the views below are not my own and do not represent a position of either Commission.

741
01:52:40.730 --> 01:52:55.070
Taj H-B: I urge the Council to reject the staff recommendation in Item 1 as currently framed, and to direct staff to return with ballot language for a general obligate… a go-bond infrastructure resilience bond in a range that's higher than the currently proposed $300 million, because

742
01:52:55.280 --> 01:53:06.939
Taj H-B: The city's own report contains the answer. The staff confirms that Berkeley's identified infrastructure needs exceed $1.5 billion. The proposed bond would address less than 20% of that backlog.

743
01:53:07.050 --> 01:53:13.459
Taj H-B: We are being asked to commit to 30 years of debt service for a program that, by the city's own admission, cannot solve the problem it was created to solve.

744
01:53:13.460 --> 01:53:14.960
Boardroom: Thanks, Taj. That is not…

745
01:53:14.960 --> 01:53:15.450
Taj H-B: Thank you.

746
01:53:17.570 --> 01:53:19.919
Boardroom: Next is Gene Hammond.

747
01:53:23.000 --> 01:53:47.060

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Jeanne Hammond: Hi, I am Jeannie Hammond. I live on Sacramento Street, and I'm speaking for myself and on behalf of my dad, who lives next door, and we're here to support line items 22 and 23 for the general bond measure, greening the medians, you know, converting medians to native plant gardens supports biodiversity, native pollinators, which you know are in severe decline globally.

748
01:53:47.130 --> 01:54:03.539
Jeanne Hammond: One way we can help is to provide more habitat in our cities, and this is a really beautiful and creative way to use underutilized land to create very visible pollinator habitat, and also replace areas that are currently requiring mowing.

749
01:54:03.540 --> 01:54:07.910
Jeanne Hammond: And that provide no habitat value, so I hope you include those projects.

750
01:54:07.910 --> 01:54:08.939
Jeanne Hammond: In the bond measure.

751
01:54:09.820 --> 01:54:10.889
Boardroom: Thank you!

752
01:54:13.320 --> 01:54:15.310
Boardroom: Next is Amy.

753
01:54:18.330 --> 01:54:26.489
Amy: Hello, thank you. First of all, thank you for, all the work that's gone into this process. It's obviously, takes a lot of time and effort.

754
01:54:26.620 --> 01:54:44.930
Amy: My name's Amy Woodward, I'm a resident in District 3. I'm also here to support line items 22 and 23, the native plant gardens and medians on Sacramento and University. I happen to be in a part of Berkeley that has a lot of oak trees, and the backyards of a good quarter block.

755
01:54:45.050 --> 01:54:51.179
Amy: And the number of birds and other native, animals that come through here is really quite astounding.

756
01:54:51.290 --> 01:54:56.970
Amy: Going and providing more habitat for native plants and animals,

757

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01:54:57.180 --> 01:55:11.129
Amy: both helps the local environment and creates a lot of enjoyment for countless Berkeley residents. Also reduces water needs and, is just the right, thing for this particular climate because, well, they're natives.

758
01:55:11.430 --> 01:55:20.669
Amy: I also wanted to just quickly speak out for Francis Elbuyer Community Center as well. It's long past time that, San Jose Park had… or San Pablo Park had.

759
01:55:20.670 --> 01:55:21.150
Boardroom: Thank you, Amy.

760
01:55:21.150 --> 01:55:22.650
Amy: proper facility, so thank you.

761
01:55:22.650 --> 01:55:23.520
Boardroom: Thank you.

762
01:55:24.330 --> 01:55:26.859
Boardroom: Next is David Flores.

763
01:55:29.140 --> 01:55:31.020
David Flores: Hey, Councilor, can y'all hear me?

764
01:55:31.410 --> 01:55:32.619
Boardroom: Yes? Yes.

765
01:55:32.620 --> 01:55:49.060
David Flores: Alright, cool, thank you. I'm sorry I couldn't be there in person, I'm on baby care, but, David Flores, I'm with Berkeley Community Media, but I'm here speaking as a resident of District 2, and I just want to put my full endorsement behind the, investment in the Civic Center,

766
01:55:49.060 --> 01:55:55.879
David Flores: I think it is a beautiful vision to have a place where the community can come in and be together, and not only that, but just

767
01:55:55.880 --> 01:56:06.980
David Flores: preserving these beautiful, historic buildings that are there, because, they're just a thing to behold from the outside, but also they're beautiful on the inside. So, thank y'all, and keep up the good work!

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768
01:56:07.690 --> 01:56:08.780
Boardroom: Thanks, David.

769
01:56:10.600 --> 01:56:13.070
Boardroom: Next is Lonnie Hancock.

770
01:56:13.460 --> 01:56:15.400
Boardroom: Former mayor and state senator.

771
01:56:24.220 --> 01:56:38.440
Loni Hancock's iPad (2): Hi. Sorry, I hope I'm unmuted. Just to add to what people have said, this is a great opportunity for a legacy for the generations that come after us, to save.

772
01:56:38.630 --> 01:56:41.640
Loni Hancock's iPad (2): Our old buildings, to put them to reuse.

773
01:56:41.920 --> 01:56:48.750
Loni Hancock's iPad (2): I was mayor over 30 years ago when we set up the Historical Society in

774
01:56:49.000 --> 01:57:03.030
Loni Hancock's iPad (2): the Veterans Building. They have grown to an extraordinary institution, all on volunteer organization and work. They have incredible archives, would be a great addition

775
01:57:03.150 --> 01:57:10.519
Loni Hancock's iPad (2): to the art district that's adjacent, and to life in the Civic Center for our city.

776
01:57:10.630 --> 01:57:15.940
Loni Hancock's iPad (2): Just to point out again, during the Great Depression.

777
01:57:16.540 --> 01:57:23.000
Loni Hancock's iPad (2): Some pioneering people set up the East Bay Regional Park District. Aren't we glad they did it?

778
01:57:23.250 --> 01:57:26.020
Loni Hancock's iPad (2): This is about the soul of Berkeley.

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779
01:57:26.610 --> 01:57:29.570
Loni Hancock's iPad (2): People need a sense of place in this time.

780
01:57:30.140 --> 01:57:32.690
Loni Hancock's iPad (2): Thank you so much for all your work.

781
01:57:33.560 --> 01:57:35.049
Boardroom: Thank you very much.

782
01:57:35.850 --> 01:57:40.449
Boardroom: Last speaker, the username's just iPhone.

783
01:57:41.130 --> 01:57:43.869
Boardroom: You should be able to unmute.

784
01:57:59.080 --> 01:58:04.539
Boardroom: iPhone, you have your hand raised, you should be able to unmute.

785
01:58:07.920 --> 01:58:08.900
Boardroom: There you go.

786
01:58:10.060 --> 01:58:12.850
iPhone (2): Hi, thank you so much for letting me…

787
01:58:12.970 --> 01:58:17.880
iPhone (2): giving me the opportunity. My name is Harry Doherty. I am actually the commissioner.

788
01:58:18.040 --> 01:58:20.650
iPhone (2): for the Bay Area Adult Soccer League.

789
01:58:21.210 --> 01:58:26.460
iPhone (2): I am speaking to support Ted, as well as my boss, Irene.

790
01:58:26.640 --> 01:58:34.920
iPhone (2): You know, in regard to expansion of the soccer field, and, converting those grass fields to,

791
01:58:35.260 --> 01:58:48.310

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iPhone (2): to tough fields as well. It's a very healthy thing to do for both the adult and youth community in our society. And, in the interest of time, I would like to say very quickly.

792
01:58:48.500 --> 01:58:51.199
iPhone (2): a shout-out to Bran and his…

793
01:58:51.580 --> 01:59:02.559
iPhone (2): Group, you know, for being able to coordinate the field allocation process, and particularly also to twin a young man that keeps the fields together.

794
01:59:03.100 --> 01:59:06.180
iPhone (2): order in the parking area. Since he's been around.

795
01:59:06.510 --> 01:59:16.270
iPhone (2): We have had very few break-ins in the parking area, particularly at Tom Bates. It keeps those fields tidy. She actually looks at it as if it's no private.

796
01:59:16.270 --> 01:59:20.439
Boardroom: Thank you so much, I'm sorry, your minute is up, but thank you so much for your comment.

797
01:59:21.910 --> 01:59:24.570
Boardroom: Okay, that, that's all the…

798
01:59:24.620 --> 01:59:44.550
Boardroom: speakers. Okay, thank you very much. I know we just had a lot of people walk in. For those of you who have just walked in, I know it's 6 o'clock, but we're still finishing our special meeting, which happened before. So, it's gonna be a little while, because we haven't actually done deliberations yet, so, if you have something that's a little bit later, if you want to take a stretch, feel free.

799
01:59:44.550 --> 01:59:49.269
Boardroom: And then also, can someone open the doors, maybe? Because I think that will help with the cross breeze.

800
01:59:49.350 --> 01:59:52.060
Boardroom: Thank you. It's quite hot in here.

801
01:59:52.260 --> 01:59:55.919

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Boardroom: Alright, so, moving on to Council…

802
01:59:56.170 --> 02:00:14.720
Boardroom: Comments, I'm gonna start over with Councilmember Taplin. Thank you very much, and thanks to staff and to all the speakers this evening. I'd first like to move that the Council affirm the direction to prepare bound language for a $300 million general obligation bond and a .5% increase in the city's sale and use tax. Second.

803
02:00:14.860 --> 02:00:21.110
Boardroom: Thank you very much. And I'm supporting these amounts because one thing that I learned from Measure L was that

804
02:00:21.280 --> 02:00:37.349
Boardroom: after doing engagement and increasing the amount twice after that engagement had a huge detrimental effect on public trust and made it impossible to message against on the trail. So, that's why I'm supporting what we've done tonight. Thank you.

805
02:00:37.770 --> 02:00:40.889
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Moving on to Vice Mayor Trey Gubb.

806
02:00:42.440 --> 02:00:56.089
Boardroom: Thank you so much. I also support this direction, and I would like to thank staff for their immense amount of work to help, get,

807
02:00:56.410 --> 02:01:03.459
Boardroom: both proposed measures to this point today, and I also wish to thank members of the public.

808
02:01:03.560 --> 02:01:06.939
Boardroom: Who have been,

809
02:01:08.040 --> 02:01:27.210
Boardroom: just, incredibly generous of their, time, coming to the meetings and providing their input. And I think this list has evolved, very much, in accordance to the feedback that we've heard. So my…

810
02:01:27.210 --> 02:01:43.019
Boardroom: My only comment, around asking staff to look at a further adjustment. It is, going to echo, Councilmember Blackaby's comments somewhat on,

811

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02:01:43.270 --> 02:01:46.929
Boardroom: Investing in, or at least,

812
02:01:47.250 --> 02:02:10.179
Boardroom: trying to prevent the demolition, the potential demolition by neglect of two historic buildings, in the downtown. The Medell Shirec, City Hall building, and the Veterans Memorial Building. I completely agree with the comments that, even in the state that they're in today, they're still, teeming

813
02:02:10.180 --> 02:02:14.690
Boardroom: with public life. I was just there, actually, for,

814
02:02:14.700 --> 02:02:33.810
Boardroom: a, memorial service on Sunday, and, you know, I've been to the Berkeley Historical Society offices. Imagine what it could be if it was, seismically safe, and all the spaces could be open for use.

815
02:02:35.820 --> 02:02:48.410
Boardroom: I was just looking, and I understand that this is a balancing act, there's only so much that can be squeezed into $300 million, but I went through and

816
02:02:48.410 --> 02:03:00.919
Boardroom: I'm just noting that, the adjustment to the Medell-Shireck building, restoration, from, the February slash March numbers constitutes.

817
02:03:01.090 --> 02:03:10.490
Boardroom: a 1.86-fold reduction, and to the Veterans Memorial Building, constitutes a 7.7-fold reduction.

818
02:03:10.600 --> 02:03:15.290
Boardroom: If there was a way, because…

819
02:03:15.430 --> 02:03:27.450
Boardroom: as much as I would love to see FEMA, provide matching grants under this Trump administration, I am just not confident in anything, and,

820
02:03:27.450 --> 02:03:36.300
Boardroom: I… I want to urge staff to look at if we might be able to move the line up a little bit for both of these buildings. Thank you.

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821
02:03:37.350 --> 02:03:47.870
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Councilmember Humbert? Yes, thank you, Madam Mayor. And in the interest of brevity, I had a whole list of thank yous to individuals, but I would just want to, you know.

822
02:03:48.200 --> 02:04:00.380
Boardroom: one ball of wax, thank you for everyone who worked on this. Compiling this list of projects and estimating costs was a huge lift when something I know

823
02:04:00.650 --> 02:04:08.170
Boardroom: stood on the shoulders of past work and past bond efforts, so I want to express my deep gratitude for everyone who has brought us to this place.

824
02:04:08.350 --> 02:04:20.089
Boardroom: I want to thank our consultant who performed the polling, who's done really good work for us this time, and in the past. I think the project list is in very good shape, so I don't have

825
02:04:20.270 --> 02:04:34.849
Boardroom: other than one substantive comment about that at this time, I'm really happy about fully… the proposal to fully fund the 50-50 sidewalk program. I think it's critical in terms of public safety. It was one of the first

826
02:04:34.940 --> 02:04:45.030
Boardroom: referrals that I, that I brought when I joined council was to fully fund it, got lost in the budget process, and I'm glad it's reappearing here.

827
02:04:45.310 --> 02:04:49.979
Boardroom: I do understand that people may feel a little uncertain.

828
02:04:50.270 --> 02:04:59.240
Boardroom: Given that we've seen some, decreases, in the second set of polling, but I think we're still at a decent level.

829
02:04:59.470 --> 02:05:13.510
Boardroom: So all told, I feel we're ready to move forward with both the sales tax measure and the general obligation bond as proposed. Thanks again, and I'm gonna support the pending motion. Thank you very much. Councilmember Kesarwani?

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830
02:05:13.560 --> 02:05:31.490
Boardroom: Thank you very much, Madam Mayor. Thank you again, Director Farris, Acting Director Amiri, and Chief Sprague, for the information you provided. Thank you, Mr. White. Thank you, Carrie. Ms. Arredondo, am I pronouncing your last name correctly? Okay, I just want to make sure I, I do that. So,

831
02:05:31.490 --> 02:05:54.190
Boardroom: And I, like Councilmember Hubbard, I want to thank everyone for all the work. There was a lot of community input that went into the project list that we have before us today, so I want to express gratitude for those meetings that occurred, and the public… members of the public that provided input. I did want to just highlight, some particular projects that were…

832
02:05:54.190 --> 02:06:04.450
Boardroom: really important to me as, the… one of the two representatives of West Berkeley. So, one, the Francis Albire Community Center, I think that's very important.

833
02:06:04.450 --> 02:06:12.509
Boardroom: For that, center to be seismically retrofitted and to be a modern facility for West Berkeley and San Pablo Park.

834
02:06:12.510 --> 02:06:23.069
Boardroom: I also want to note, all of the restroom improvements happen to be in District 1. I'm calling it the North Waterfront Park now, at the marina.

835
02:06:23.070 --> 02:06:35.300
Boardroom: That's really a citywide amenity, and we hear all the time that people are appreciating the throne bathroom that is there, but, you know, our goal is to have a permanent bathroom there, so I'm really pleased to see that.

836
02:06:35.320 --> 02:06:41.049
Boardroom: Of course, really pleased to see all of the important marina infrastructure improvements that are here, the…

837
02:06:41.220 --> 02:06:48.029
Boardroom: The seawall, you know, there's a climate resilience element to this that I think is very important.

838
02:06:48.080 --> 02:07:02.370

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Boardroom: And, I must do a nod to the, the soccer players, the advocates for the soccer players. Harrison Field is also in District 1, and, I would love to see that get upgraded with the artificial turf.

839
02:07:02.490 --> 02:07:21.030
Boardroom: Also, the West Berkeley Family Wellness Center is in District 1 as well, and that is in need of improvement. We've been able to address the North Berkeley Senior Center, the South Berkeley Senior Center, this is another center that we have that, we would like to improve. And then, like Councilmember Humbert, the 50-50 sidewalk

840
02:07:21.030 --> 02:07:25.450
Boardroom: program is very important. We have so many bumpy sidewalks that are…

841
02:07:25.450 --> 02:07:31.720
Boardroom: A hazard for… for people of all ages and abilities, and they're, you know, as the…

842
02:07:31.810 --> 02:07:46.739
Boardroom: birthplace of the disability rights movement, we really need to make sure all of our sidewalks are accessible, for… for people who may use, mobility assistance devices. I, I also, you know, we had those three fire,

843
02:07:47.050 --> 02:07:49.560
Boardroom: infrastructure improvements, I, I do…

844
02:07:49.790 --> 02:08:07.239
Boardroom: And I'm not trying to single out Station 4, I know a lot has been said about Station 4. I know we're going to talk about it a lot at the budget. Just because it was a very significant dollar amount, Chief, it would be helpful to get a breakdown. I don't know if you can speak to it now. I know you said… you talked about, you know, the carcinogenic apparatus.

845
02:08:07.390 --> 02:08:11.970
Boardroom: And maybe that's a conversation we can continue to have.

846
02:08:11.970 --> 02:08:28.220
Boardroom: I'd just like to understand better, you know, how we arrive at the $54 million. Yeah, you bet. We have, detailed analysis in the Fire Facilities Master Plan that was conducted by, fire station architects, and then priced out by contractors, and then escalated to 2020… 2030, I believe.

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847
02:08:28.470 --> 02:08:48.619
Boardroom: Oh, I'm sorry, it escalated. And then the cost was escalated from $2023 to $2030. Okay, so I can go back to that document and understand better the breakdown. I'll send you the relevant section so you don't have to dig. Okay, thank you, because that sounds like a long document. So it'd be helpful to have that, and so for the public, too, if we get questions, I'd like to have that information.

848
02:08:48.620 --> 02:08:52.570
Boardroom: So, and I did want to just speak briefly

849
02:08:52.570 --> 02:08:58.660
Boardroom: to the concern, I think, you know, maybe some of my colleagues are feeling, I know members of the public may be feeling.

850
02:08:58.660 --> 02:09:16.740
Boardroom: the number of revenue measures that voters are potentially going to see on the ballot. I do just want to state that, it's actually very inspiring that we have citizens gathering signatures to put measures on the ballot for various causes that they believe are important. So that…

851
02:09:16.820 --> 02:09:33.010
Boardroom: effort is not under the Council's control, right? So, there's the arts tax, the public bank, the public transit measure, you know, these are other entities, other people who are doing that. But of course, we do have to think about how that may impact

852
02:09:33.030 --> 02:09:42.719
Boardroom: what we are trying to do. I think, ultimately, given where the polling results were, This time, that…

853
02:09:42.770 --> 02:09:59.929
Boardroom: you know, I think we should still proceed. I didn't see any reason not to proceed with our plans, but to go into it with the awareness that there is gonna be fatigue, I think this is a tough economy for people, so there needs to be a positive message around

854
02:10:00.000 --> 02:10:05.170
Boardroom: both measures, and I think there's a lot of really important, critical projects

855
02:10:05.560 --> 02:10:22.129

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Boardroom: to emphasize for the infrastructure bond, I think some of this, you know, the costs will escalate. You know, the chief just spoke about escalating 2023 costs to 2026, so the longer we wait, the larger the bill is going to be, and so…

856
02:10:22.130 --> 02:10:31.529
Boardroom: And that's true for most of our infrastructure, so I think we need to emphasize those points. Okay. Oh, okay, I just almost done. I did want to just address, you know, that…

857
02:10:31.530 --> 02:10:43.739
Boardroom: the costs… and I wanna… I think Councilmember Tregoop asked about the costs. I just want to note the bond measure is $22.14 per $100,000 of home value.

858
02:10:43.900 --> 02:10:58.070
Boardroom: You know, and I know those new homeowners that, you know, we're trying to create new home ownership opportunities for you. If you bought a home this year for $1.5 million, if you do that math, $22.14 by 15,

859
02:10:58.210 --> 02:11:03.069
Boardroom: 1,500 thousands, that's $332.10 per year.

860
02:11:03.220 --> 02:11:16.570
Boardroom: And people who bought earlier, who bought at a lower price, are going to be less than that. So we are aware of that number, and I, you know, I want the public to be aware of that number. It's not nothing, but relative to…

861
02:11:16.910 --> 02:11:28.600
Boardroom: the entire tax bill, you know, we have to think about it that way, and some of the bonds that are going to be expiring, I think you talked about. So, and then finally, on the sales tax measure.

862
02:11:28.990 --> 02:11:41.359
Boardroom: I did want to say, I know we're not finalizing the ballot language tonight, but I think that final language should reflect our budget plan. And I think maybe we're gonna…

863
02:11:41.360 --> 02:11:49.819
Boardroom: finalize the language in June, so maybe we'll have a better exact sense of our budget, because we've been talking about restoring public safety positions

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864
02:11:49.820 --> 02:11:57.980
Boardroom: critical programs operated by the Recreation and Parks Department. So I, I think those are the programs that we should highlight, and…

865
02:11:57.980 --> 02:12:11.880
Boardroom: and not talk about other things that are not in our plan, because, you know, I want the public to know what the plan is, how those funds would be used. So that's all. Thank you so much for indulging me, and ready and very eager to support the motion.

866
02:12:12.170 --> 02:12:20.360
Boardroom: Thank you, and yeah, again, apologies for folks who have just walked in. We're still finishing our special meeting from before, so we will go over to Councilmember Lunapara.

867
02:12:20.670 --> 02:12:30.940
Boardroom: Thank you. I just have some, some brief comments. I really want to thank everyone who has put in the time and effort into this. I support…

868
02:12:31.300 --> 02:12:40.019
Boardroom: both as written, I support the amount that has been allocated. I really appreciate the addition of the, Dwight Triangle Project.

869
02:12:40.140 --> 02:12:53.379
Boardroom: in this, it is… that's very exciting, has been in the works for a long time. And, you know, with the goal of a car-free telegraph in the future, it'll be a perfect end node to it. So, thank you very much.

870
02:12:53.900 --> 02:12:55.360
Boardroom: Yeah, that's it. Thank you.

871
02:12:55.470 --> 02:12:57.170
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember Bartlett.

872
02:12:57.840 --> 02:13:04.270
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor. I, too, want to thank you all for your work. This is quite an expansive list.

873
02:13:04.430 --> 02:13:17.959
Boardroom: Very complicated, and, put together in two different buckets of finance that are each, also somewhat complex, and according to the

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poll, and I know Mr. Berman's work is fantastic, according to the poll, it looks somewhat promising.

874
02:13:17.960 --> 02:13:32.200
Boardroom: And so we will cross our fingers and support this going forward. And I do support the motion, thank you. A couple things I want to call out I'm really excited about, and a couple of notes. The, the airline open space, very exciting.

875
02:13:32.200 --> 02:13:46.139
Boardroom: This, of course, is, part of the reparative framework we've undertaken the last number of years regarding these public finance tools and the districts. You know, when the undergrounded BART, just so people don't know this, when they undergrounded BART,

876
02:13:46.140 --> 02:14:05.340
Boardroom: They were, they were supposed to make a park to go all the way across the city. Instead, they made, they made a Loney Park in North Berkeley, but they made asphalt, in South Berkeley. So, this is a great effort to, to restore that and give us a beautiful park greenway. I'm excited about that. The, the Senior Center, wonderful.

877
02:14:05.350 --> 02:14:22.720
Boardroom: the HVAC, upgrade. I'm wondering, if there's a possibility of shoehorning a bit more, work into that project, as it was rehabilitated under T1, as was North Berkeley Senior Center, but North Berkeley Senior Center happened to get a really beautiful.

878
02:14:23.210 --> 02:14:34.410
Boardroom: cosmetic upgrade, and whereas South Berkeley… we did not in South Berkeley. So it'd be great if we could maybe shoo in a little bit more in there to give it a similar, similar look.

879
02:14:35.490 --> 02:14:49.739
Boardroom: like a guy at North Berkeley. That'd be wonderful. And of course, very happy for the saga of the African American Holistic Resource Center to be coming, to a funding close, and I'm really excited about this. Very supportive. And this will be it. Thanks so much.

880
02:14:50.130 --> 02:14:58.429
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Councilmember Blackaby. Thanks, Madam Mayor. Everyone has said so many things, I'll be extremely brief. Again, thanks to city staff.

881
02:14:58.480 --> 02:15:23.440

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Boardroom: For their heavy lifting and all the community engagement that's gone into this process. Thanks also to David Mermond for his, research support to help inform some of these decisions. Just three kind of sets of projects I wanted to call out. One, again, I agree with Councilmember Trey Gube that, to the extent we can find a way to augment some of the funding, the Civic Center safety improvements around Old City Hall and the Veterans Building, I would love to figure out a way

882
02:15:23.440 --> 02:15:27.039
Boardroom: to do that within the overall portfolio.

883
02:15:27.040 --> 02:15:38.820
Boardroom: Second, as the dad of two young soccer players, I'm really glad to see the upgrades at Harrison Field. And Scott, I'll say the other thing about the, the cork is that it really gets in your shoes, and so…

884
02:15:38.820 --> 02:15:48.080
Boardroom: I don't know if there's a better material, if the walnut's better, but it's really painful. But anyway, upgrading Harrison's field so it's more, accessible more of the year is fantastic.

885
02:15:48.080 --> 02:16:00.919
Boardroom: And third, certainly from a District 6 perspective, the 50-50 sidewalk program, extremely important. We have so many, deteriorating, if not non-existent, sidewalks in the hills.

886
02:16:00.920 --> 02:16:16.559
Boardroom: The more we can do around safety and infrastructure for folks who are walking, biking, not on the sidewalk, but next to the sidewalk, and, just using the street infrastructure up there, is really important, so I appreciate seeing that.

887
02:16:16.590 --> 02:16:35.080
Boardroom: The last overall comment, I think in this whole process, we've been, and I, again, appreciate the transparency, through all of this and public engagement, and I think it's really incumbent on all of us as a council and as a city team to demonstrate continued transparency and accountability.

888
02:16:35.080 --> 02:16:48.209
Boardroom: Both in order to get these revenue measures passed, and then to ensure their successful delivery. I think that's something we've all heard time and again, that, again, ensuring we have trust, of the public.

889
02:16:48.209 --> 02:16:58.550

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Boardroom: that they have confidence in these plans and in what we're delivering is really, really important to me. I authored an item earlier this year with supportive colleagues to, again, set

890
02:16:58.670 --> 02:17:14.620
Boardroom: clear goals and metrics around the goals that we're trying to implement as a city. So again, heading into fall, I think the more we can do heading into November and then beyond to show that kind of discipline, setting really clear goals, measuring those goals.

891
02:17:14.620 --> 02:17:27.940
Boardroom: And being accountable, to what we said we're gonna do, and then delivering it. Again, it's good for showing voters that they can trust us with their hard-earned dollars, and then it's really important to actually delivering the work.

892
02:17:27.940 --> 02:17:35.649
Boardroom: So, I thank staff for this, and I also support the motion, and look forward to these moving forward. Thank you. Thank you very much. Councilmember O'Keefe?

893
02:17:37.430 --> 02:17:40.019
Boardroom: I think I'm last, oh, the mayor's last.

894
02:17:40.299 --> 02:17:44.749
Boardroom: Thank you very much. You know, I was,

895
02:17:45.549 --> 02:17:53.729
Boardroom: I want to say something, I, you know, I second almost everything that was said, I think everything that was said, especially thanking all of the work that went into this.

896
02:17:54.110 --> 02:18:01.960
Boardroom: I do have kind of a… just something I want to name, which is that we're talking about two different revenue measures here, and

897
02:18:02.290 --> 02:18:15.379
Boardroom: you know, I'm happy to support the motion, I think we should move forward with both of them, but the, the sales tax measure for me, like, if I had to choose between them, the sales tax measure would be the one I would choose. I feel like if we didn't pass it, the results

898
02:18:15.459 --> 02:18:24.079

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Boardroom: would be catastrophic to what we have now, whereas the bond is a lot of really important stuff that would be really wonderful to have, but I…

899
02:18:24.450 --> 02:18:31.830
Boardroom: if I felt like the two were sort of in contention with each other, I think I might have a little more reluctance to support this.

900
02:18:31.830 --> 02:18:39.399
Boardroom: However, I'm saying that because I want to say that I'm really heartened by the results of the survey and, you know, learning that

901
02:18:39.400 --> 02:18:55.640
Boardroom: the numbers that we saw were actually, in the context of all the other measures, and even when the two… these two measures specifically were side-by-side, it actually arguably helped, rather than, didn't make a difference. That makes me feel a lot better about supporting both, which feels a little scary and risky to me.

902
02:18:55.660 --> 02:18:58.290
Boardroom: But, I think, I think it's okay.

903
02:18:58.500 --> 02:18:59.739
Boardroom: Let's go for it.

904
02:19:00.420 --> 02:19:02.199
Boardroom: That's it. Thanks so much.

905
02:19:04.120 --> 02:19:28.349
Boardroom: Thank you very much. I want to start by just thanking all of you for the presentation this evening. There's so many city staff out here, so I also just want to thank all of you, because I know so much of your work and your feedback and your number crunching and your experiences, go into these presentations and also all the work that was done in the community outreach, so thank you all very much.

906
02:19:28.959 --> 02:19:31.200
Boardroom: I also wanna…

907
02:19:31.490 --> 02:19:45.060
Boardroom: thank, the Realize 2050 Task Force that was meeting in this last year to work on updating Vision 2050 and, working also with Councilmember Taplin and Trey Gubb and myself.

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908
02:19:45.059 --> 02:20:03.819
Boardroom: To make sure that we were really focused on bringing this bond measure forward in the first place. I think that's incredibly essential. Both are really… I'm glad you highlighted that, Councilmember O'Keefe, because it is important to acknowledge that there are two different things that we're talking about here, and I also see the real serious opportunity for success

909
02:20:03.820 --> 02:20:27.490
Boardroom: with both of them moving forward together, and so that is very exciting to me. I want to acknowledge some of the comments that were made, specifically from the folks who were talking about the Veterans Building and Old City Hall, to just say, yes, of course we know those buildings are being used, and, I'm very aware of the programs that are going on there and how important they are in our community.

910
02:20:27.490 --> 02:20:37.070
Boardroom: both, the history, but also, of course, Berkeley Community Media, which is responsible for streaming our meetings that we have here. That is their home, and, Dorothy Dayhouse.

911
02:20:37.280 --> 02:20:44.270
Boardroom: options, etc. And, I want to say that…

912
02:20:44.510 --> 02:21:00.369
Boardroom: Yeah, I mean, I was very excited for the results of the first poll, so I do have to say I was a bit disappointed to see the numbers going down there, but that hasn't, that hasn't made me feel that it's not possible. And so, you know, I will be working hard to make sure that these

913
02:21:00.370 --> 02:21:04.679
Boardroom: passed to help continue the support that we need for our city.

914
02:21:04.970 --> 02:21:09.970
Boardroom: I want to also mention, second what…

915
02:21:10.140 --> 02:21:20.560
Boardroom: Councilmember Blackaby was saying about accountability and oversight, that is incredibly important. Many of you know that my background is with the League of Women Voters, and a lot of my work has been around,

916
02:21:20.730 --> 02:21:29.689

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Boardroom: You know, making sure that we are transparent and accountable, that we have transparent and accountable government, and so as mayor, that's also very important to me.

917
02:21:29.690 --> 02:21:51.969
Boardroom: I want to mention also that the tax burden that folks were talking about, it's folks like me that are lucky enough to have a newer home that are gonna pay a lot more of this tax burden, and, and I am still very supportive of it because I know how much benefit that brings to people around the city. It's incredibly challenging for those of you who were not involved

918
02:21:51.970 --> 02:22:01.750
Boardroom: To take a look at all these districts across the city, looking at equity and safety and climate change, to think about all these different projects, just

919
02:22:01.750 --> 02:22:05.160
Boardroom: I know that there was so much work that went into it, so I just want to make sure you've…

920
02:22:05.160 --> 02:22:25.010
Boardroom: you know that I really see that work and how hard and challenging it was. I had an intern or staff or both at all of the community meetings, and I know that you all continued to improve that process and make sure you were getting really strong community engagement, so thank you very much again to the staff. I am supportive of both items, and I'd like to…

921
02:22:25.010 --> 02:22:27.359
Boardroom: Move us forward for the vote.

922
02:22:27.760 --> 02:22:30.440
Boardroom: So, can we take the roll on that, please?

923
02:22:30.930 --> 02:22:38.180
Boardroom: Okay. To, approve the staff recommendation to prepare the ballot language for the $300 million

924
02:22:38.180 --> 02:22:51.509
Boardroom: general obligation bond, and also the ballot language for the .5% increase in the sales and use tax for the November 3rd, 2026 ballot.

925
02:22:52.070 --> 02:23:04.210

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Boardroom: On the motion, Councilmember Kesarwani? Yes. Taplin? Yes. Bartlett? Yes. Trega? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby? Yes. Kunapara? Yes.

926
02:23:04.280 --> 02:23:13.819
Boardroom: Humber? Yes. And Mayor Ishii? Yes. Okay, motion carries. Very good. So I would like to see if there's a motion to adjourn. So moved.

927
02:23:14.310 --> 02:23:17.530
Boardroom: Second. Okay, is there any opposition to adjournments?

928
02:23:17.750 --> 02:23:35.349
Boardroom: Okay, we are adjourned by unanimous consent. Don't leave yet. What I'd like to do, because there are… I think there are many people here that are here for our, our ceremonial matters, and so if it's okay with you all, I'd like to move forward and do our ceremonial items, so that way some folks can leave if they don't want to stay.

929
02:23:35.390 --> 02:23:49.069
Boardroom: So, yay! So in that case, I'm going to call to order the Berkeley City Council meeting. Today is Tuesday, May 19th, 2026. It is 6.26 PM, and if we could please take the roll, Clerk.

930
02:23:49.590 --> 02:23:52.220
Boardroom: Yes, calling the rule.

931
02:23:52.860 --> 02:24:00.850
Boardroom: For the 6 p.m. regular meeting, Councilmember Kesarwani, here. Kaplan, Presence.

932
02:24:01.090 --> 02:24:06.219
Boardroom: Kaplan is present. Bartlett? Here. Trega? Present. O'Keefe? I'm here.

933
02:24:06.320 --> 02:24:12.760
Boardroom: Blackaby? Still here. Luna Parra? Here. I'm here. And Mayor Ishii.

934
02:24:13.080 --> 02:24:19.040
Boardroom: Here. Okay. Okay, we're having too much fun, you guys, calm down. Alright, so…

935
02:24:19.190 --> 02:24:26.589

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Boardroom: Alright, so let's move on to our ceremonial matters. We have a very exciting one. It is Public Works Week.

936
02:24:27.050 --> 02:24:29.800
Boardroom: Woo! Yay! Give it up for Public Works!

937
02:24:31.590 --> 02:24:40.780
Boardroom: We lo- Don't leave, Wahid, we're still here. Okay. Alright. I… Have a proclamation!

938
02:24:41.830 --> 02:24:45.840
Boardroom: Well, first of all, actually, Public Works folks, do you want to come up here?

939
02:24:46.110 --> 02:24:49.770
Boardroom: Yeah, come hang… come up here! We want to celebrate you.

940
02:24:50.290 --> 02:24:51.570
Boardroom: Yay!

941
02:24:56.450 --> 02:25:00.359
Boardroom: Oh, my thing came out.

942
02:25:03.390 --> 02:25:05.239
Boardroom: Come on up, yeah.

943
02:25:05.450 --> 02:25:09.970
Boardroom: You can come stand by the podium, or… there's more room over here.

944
02:25:16.780 --> 02:25:19.389
Boardroom: There you go.

945
02:25:26.170 --> 02:25:34.829
Boardroom: Alright, very nice. As you shuffle up, I'm gonna read the City of Berkeley Proclamation. Celebrating National Public Works Week 2026.

946
02:25:34.870 --> 02:25:47.839
Boardroom: Whereas this year marks the 66th annual National Public Works Week, sponsored by the American Public Works Association, whereas public works professionals provide a vital role in creating sustainable and resilient communities.

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947
02:25:47.840 --> 02:26:07.230
Boardroom: through a focus on infrastructure, facilities, and services which maintain public health, high quality of life, and the well-being of the people of the City of Berkeley, and whereas the City of Berkeley Public Works Department serves over 120,000 Berkeley residents by providing integral services to 214 miles of streets.

948
02:26:07.230 --> 02:26:14.539
Boardroom: 400 miles of sanitary sewers, 78 miles of store water piping, yes, okay, yes.

949
02:26:16.060 --> 02:26:31.930
Boardroom: 30 green infrastructure installation, 8,000 plus street lights, 3,750 parking meters, 54 public buildings and waste recycling and composting. I think we need to give it up for that section first. Okay, yeah.

950
02:26:37.950 --> 02:27:02.940
Boardroom: And whereas recently the department oversaw the implementation of red curb painting to 1,700 intersections, a monumental stride for Berkeley as one of the first cities to comply with the new state law that prohibits parking directly next to intersections, and whereas the City of Berkeley Public Works Department's contributions are instrumental to everyday services, thus civic leaders and community members of all ages in the city are

951
02:27:02.940 --> 02:27:09.720
Boardroom: encouraged to maintain an ongoing interest in all public works services provided. Now.

952
02:27:09.720 --> 02:27:22.390
Boardroom: Therefore, be it resolved that I, Adina Ishii, Mayor of the City of Berkeley, do hereby proclaim the week of May 17th to May 23rd, 2026, to be National Public Works Week in the City of Berkeley.

953
02:27:22.400 --> 02:27:23.700
Boardroom: I…

954
02:27:30.360 --> 02:27:40.880
Boardroom: I urge all to recognize Public Works' substantial contributions to protecting community health, safety, and advancing the quality of life for everyone. Thank you all so much for your work.

955

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02:27:56.430 --> 02:28:04.469
Boardroom: Do you want to say anything? I'll just keep it brief. As you guys know, this year's theme is very appropriate.

956
02:28:05.000 --> 02:28:09.829
Boardroom: It's rooted in service and powered by community, and that says a lot.

957
02:28:10.330 --> 02:28:16.490
Boardroom: I just want to take a quick moment to recognize the dedicated professionals here tonight representing Public Works.

958
02:28:16.880 --> 02:28:18.800
Boardroom: These are the people in the field.

959
02:28:19.090 --> 02:28:27.489
Boardroom: And in the office who keep Berkeley running, often behind the scenes, but always with a deep commitment to serving this community. So, thank you for what you do.

960
02:28:27.650 --> 02:28:30.549
Boardroom: You are appreciated, and it's all about love.

961
02:28:41.210 --> 02:28:50.320
Boardroom: Absolutely. Okay, let's see. Maybe my staff can stand on this side. Sydney, you want to pop over?

962
02:28:50.610 --> 02:28:53.280
Boardroom: You want to pop over to this side and take it this way?

963
02:28:53.520 --> 02:29:13.410
Boardroom: Over here, Sydney, there's a… We're gonna need a white lens. Where's the white lens from? Oh, that works. Oh, yeah. Here! There we go. Can you, can you see everyone?

964
02:29:16.170 --> 02:29:20.379
Boardroom: Turns out we have a chomp style.

965
02:29:20.480 --> 02:29:22.050
Boardroom: 1, 2…

966
02:29:31.710 --> 02:29:35.610

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Boardroom: Thank you, Mayor.

967
02:29:59.130 --> 02:30:09.559
Boardroom: Okay. Thank you so much, everyone. Thank you again to Public Works for being here, and for all of the work that you do in our city.

968
02:30:09.690 --> 02:30:21.990
Boardroom: Okay, so our second ceremonial matter for this evening is, the Willard Park Clubhouse and Restroom Replacement Project CPRS Facility Design Ward of Excellence.

969
02:30:22.200 --> 02:30:23.890
Boardroom: Yay!

970
02:30:25.960 --> 02:30:30.109
Boardroom: Is… is anyone here… is staff here also from… It's love here.

971
02:30:30.660 --> 02:30:34.269
Boardroom: Oh, you're right here. Okay.

972
02:30:34.400 --> 02:30:41.789
Boardroom: Alright, did you want to stand or be up here? Yeah, would like that.

973
02:30:43.060 --> 02:30:44.610
Boardroom: Yay! Okay.

974
02:30:45.110 --> 02:30:47.500
Boardroom: Very good.

975
02:30:48.080 --> 02:30:50.320
Boardroom: Can you… designer.

976
02:30:50.590 --> 02:31:08.879
Boardroom: Wonderful! Okay, so, tonight, we are proud to recognize the City of Berkeley staff who brought the Willard Park Clubhouse… oh, sorry, staff and also designers, who brought the Willard Park Clubhouse and Restroom Replacement Project to life. This Measure T… this Measure T1 project is receiving the California

977
02:31:08.880 --> 02:31:26.640

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Boardroom: Parks and Recreation Society's Facility Design Award of Excellence for cities with a population between 50,000 and 125,000 people. This award recognizes exceptional projects throughout California that exemplify innovation, impact, and leadership in the field of parks and recreation.

978
02:31:26.880 --> 02:31:37.380
Boardroom: The Willard Park Clubhouse and Restroom Replacement Project is being honored for transforming an overcrowded, outdated facility into a safe, inclusive, and climate-resilient community hub.

979
02:31:37.980 --> 02:31:57.510
Boardroom: Guided by years of public input and collaboration, the project expanded health, childcare and recreational opportunities, creating new reservable community spaces, improved park usability and safety, and delivered a LEED Gold Net Zero Neighborhood Resiliency center. Yay! To,

980
02:31:58.130 --> 02:32:08.449
Boardroom: To formally present the award, I'd like to invite Leah Martinez, representative from the California Park and Recreation Society, to the podium to share a few remarks and present the Award of Excellence to the City of Berkeley.

981
02:32:08.660 --> 02:32:26.310
Boardroom: Thank you. Good evening, Honorable Mayor Ishii and Berkeley City Council members. My name is Leah Martinez, I'm a Recreation Supervisor with Hayward Area Recreation and Park District, but this evening, I am here as the Secretary-Treasurer of the California Park and Recreation Society State Board of Directors, as well as the Awards of Excellence program.

982
02:32:26.310 --> 02:32:34.069
Boardroom: The California Park and Recreation Society Annual Awards Program celebrates outstanding examples of quality facility and park design.

983
02:32:34.070 --> 02:32:50.450
Boardroom: Programming accomplishments, effective communications, community leadership, and professional successes that take place daily in our profession. Through our five award categories, we highlight the people, places, spaces, programs, and stories that make communities like the City of Berkeley special.

984
02:32:50.780 --> 02:33:03.280
Boardroom: As one of five awardees in the mixed-Use Facility Community Center category, the City of Berkeley's Willard Park Clubhouse and

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Restroom Replacement Project stood out from a total of 186 award applicants.

985
02:33:03.500 --> 02:33:28.230
Boardroom: This project transformed an outdated 565-square-foot building into a vibrant, inclusive, and climate-smart hub for South Berkeley. Programmatically, the after-school enrollment programming jumped 100%, from 45 to 80 participants, and no longer spilled into the park with the added space. This facility books up to 8 months in advance and includes warm, well-ventilated rooms, gender-neutral restrooms, and flexible spaces for quiet or active

986
02:33:28.230 --> 02:33:44.879
Boardroom: active play, while staff can provide hot meals, diverse programming, and conduct confidential staff operations as needed. Park visitor loves the centrally located public restroom with 88 accessible stalls and baby changing stations, dramatically improving usability for caregivers.

987
02:33:44.880 --> 02:33:49.489
Boardroom: Guided by input from at least 200 community members over a 3-year process.

988
02:33:49.830 --> 02:34:09.220
Boardroom: that was challenged by COVID, the LEED Gold Net Zero Solar-Powered Clubhouse also serves as a neighborhood resiliency hub during climate and emergency events. Congratulations, City of Berkeley, on your award-winning Willard Park Clubhouse and Restroom Replacement Project on winning the 2025 Mixed-Use Facility Community Center Award of Excellence.

989
02:34:15.400 --> 02:34:17.740
Boardroom: Oh, it's so beautiful! Yes.

990
02:34:18.110 --> 02:34:19.640
Boardroom: That's really nice.

991
02:34:22.000 --> 02:34:23.049
Boardroom: Let me take a photo today.

992
02:34:24.610 --> 02:34:26.010
Boardroom: Oh, do…

993
02:34:36.660 --> 02:34:37.329
Boardroom: That's okay.

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994
02:34:37.810 --> 02:34:43.649
Boardroom: We can point them.

995
02:34:49.950 --> 02:34:51.189
Boardroom: Thank you!

996
02:35:04.860 --> 02:35:07.849
Boardroom: Sorry, did folk… did Steph, did you all want to say anything?

997
02:35:15.980 --> 02:35:17.070
Boardroom: Not sure if I can.

998
02:35:18.720 --> 02:35:19.789
Boardroom: Here we go, Al.

999
02:35:20.320 --> 02:35:27.869
Boardroom: Other than, I just want to thank the perseverance of my staff, and, Councilmember…

1000
02:35:28.060 --> 02:35:32.589
Boardroom: Humbert, but also Councilmember Drosti. So,

1001
02:35:34.720 --> 02:35:43.659
Boardroom: A lot of public feedback on this project. It took a long time to come to fruition, and big thanks to the designer, ELS,

1002
02:35:43.930 --> 02:35:50.319
Boardroom: many changes as we move forward, and this is, I think, the most awarded

1003
02:35:50.540 --> 02:35:59.940
Boardroom: project in the state of California, not only this year, but for the City of Berkeley in a long, long time. Not only has been awarded the CPRS,

1004
02:35:59.980 --> 02:36:12.049
Boardroom: State Ward, CPRS District Wards. We are also the American Public Works Association Northern California Project for the Year, and we're in the running for the APWA.

1005

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02:36:12.950 --> 02:36:15.769
Boardroom: National Project of the Year.

1006
02:36:15.920 --> 02:36:20.140
Boardroom: And, we've just found out this afternoon that,

1007
02:36:20.440 --> 02:36:28.360
Boardroom: ASCME has awarded it a technology award to the… to two other… to the… two other technology awards to that project, so…

1008
02:36:28.510 --> 02:36:37.339
Boardroom: It's won 5 awards at this point, and is still eligible for a couple more, so it's a pretty amazing project. That's so amazing. Thank you, Scott. Thank you.

1009
02:36:37.480 --> 02:36:51.709
Boardroom: Thank you to the designers, the city staff, everyone, and I also have a note here that says, this project would not have been possible without the 2016 Measure T1 Bond Measure. So… That is so true. Thank you very much to T1.

1010
02:36:52.480 --> 02:37:11.219
Boardroom: And perfectly timed, since we were just talking about our new measure that we were just, we were just discussing in our special meeting. So, thank you very much. Those are our two ceremonial items for this evening, so now we will take a 15-minute break between, this section, so that,

1011
02:37:11.640 --> 02:37:14.600
Boardroom: And we will be back in 15 minutes. Thank you.

1012
02:37:20.320 --> 02:37:27.080
Boardroom: Hello, everyone. Good evening! We're gonna start back up again. Thank you so much for your patience.

1013
02:37:27.540 --> 02:37:35.360
Boardroom: For those of you who came in a little later, we were finishing our special meeting, so we were wrapping that up.

1014
02:37:35.510 --> 02:37:41.240
Boardroom: We started the regular meeting, and we did two ceremonial items, and now we're moving on to city manager comments.

1015

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02:37:42.750 --> 02:37:47.619
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor. Just one brief comment, which is that, the…

1016
02:37:47.840 --> 02:38:06.020
Boardroom: bicycle plan, as you'll notice, is removed from this agenda. The reason for that is because we had to go through a SQL process, so we'll be doing that over the next couple weeks, with a plan to bring it back on June 9th, hopefully. So June 9th is our target date for that, I just wanted to say that. Thank you.

1017
02:38:06.060 --> 02:38:08.920
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Okay, folks, please…

1018
02:38:09.710 --> 02:38:15.660
Boardroom: Please take your conversations outside. If you're having a side conversation, please take it outside.

1019
02:38:16.150 --> 02:38:19.440
Boardroom: People in the first few rows, I can still hear you.

1020
02:38:19.780 --> 02:38:24.920
Boardroom: Thank you. Alright, so we are now moving on to public comment on non-agenda matters.

1021
02:38:27.600 --> 02:38:31.700
Boardroom: Okay, so we will, choose, 5 cards.

1022
02:38:31.870 --> 02:38:48.669
Boardroom: For in-person speakers, and then we'll go to the first 5 hands raised on the Zoom. And again, this is for comments, oh, each speaker will only have 1 minute to speak, and this is for comments that are not… for items that are not on the agenda.

1023
02:38:51.820 --> 02:39:04.660
Boardroom: So we have Steven, Albert, Abby Vieira, We have Celeste Marks, And Rohan Prasad…

1024
02:39:04.870 --> 02:39:08.890
Boardroom: And that's it. We just have, 4 cards for in-person speakers.

1025
02:39:09.270 --> 02:39:12.549
Boardroom: Steven Alpert, Abby Vieira.

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1026
02:39:12.840 --> 02:39:20.700
Boardroom: Rohan Prasad, and Celeste Marks. So you can come up in any order, and you'll have one minute.

1027
02:39:21.210 --> 02:39:24.170
Boardroom: So I have 2 minutes? Okay, yes, 2 minutes.

1028
02:39:25.140 --> 02:39:30.790
Boardroom: Thank you. We cannot accept any new cards at this…

1029
02:39:31.950 --> 02:39:42.060
Boardroom: I am Dr. Steven Alpert. Berkeley residents have reason to be profoundly disappointed and disillusioned by the actions of this Council, its committees, and its commissions.

1030
02:39:42.300 --> 02:39:47.510
Boardroom: Council members proclaim they're pro-housing. It demonstrates clear, pro-developer bias.

1031
02:39:47.890 --> 02:39:50.499
Boardroom: Local business owners were not consulted.

1032
02:39:50.610 --> 02:39:57.550
Boardroom: about the plans to upzone North Shattuck, Solano, or College Avenues. In fact, the council members met with developers

1033
02:39:57.780 --> 02:40:07.960
Boardroom: First, During a special meeting on February 24, this Council overturned Berkeley's labor standards passed in 2023,

1034
02:40:08.180 --> 02:40:16.400
Boardroom: Which required developers of large projects to provide contractors with fair pay, health insurance, and funds for apprenticeship training.

1035
02:40:16.740 --> 02:40:25.419
Boardroom: During a Planning Commission meeting last September, over 40 individuals expressed concerns about the proposed upzoning building heights, that they were excessive.

1036
02:40:25.740 --> 02:40:31.349

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Boardroom: Every council… every commission member then stated the higher heights were not a problem.

1037
02:40:31.730 --> 02:40:36.320
Boardroom: Foremost, this council needs to stop pushing the utterly false

1038
02:40:37.160 --> 02:40:44.599
Boardroom: narrative that building market-rate housing will readily produce affordable units. Real-world data directly contradict this.

1039
02:40:44.860 --> 02:40:54.120
Boardroom: As presented last week, a recent study by Buchholz demonstrated that even under overly optimistic… don't smile. Even under overly optimistic conditions.

1040
02:40:54.170 --> 02:41:05.800
Boardroom: In our area, it takes over 20 years for newly built market rate housing to eventually filter down and become affordable, whereas with historical data, it takes over 100 years.

1041
02:41:06.250 --> 02:41:09.230
Boardroom: Evidently, these findings were very conf… con…

1042
02:41:09.390 --> 02:41:25.469
Boardroom: troublesome to Councilmember Humbert, who deceptively tried to… Just a reminder not to refer to individual council members, just refer to us as a body, please. This is of use to the community, when people try to just represent information that's false.

1043
02:41:26.130 --> 02:41:35.240
Boardroom: Okay, these findings were troublesome to Councilmember Humbert, who tried to discredit black holes, as shown in this composite screenshot of MarkHumboldtz.com.

1044
02:41:35.410 --> 02:41:53.300
Boardroom: Please note the highlighted… Sir, thank you for your comment. A reminder that when you come and speak to us as a whole, that you refer to us as a whole body. Please, thank you. Again, when people lie to the community… Thank you, your time is up. Thank you very much. You need to listen to the rules that we have in this chamber. Thank you.

1045
02:41:55.960 --> 02:42:07.849

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This information provided by Zoom. The City of Berkeley cannot certify the following text since we did not create it.

Boardroom: Hey, how's it going? Good evening, good evening, everyone. My name's Rohan, I like to talk about artificial intelligence. Experts say that we are heading towards mass unemployment.

1046
02:42:07.990 --> 02:42:10.809
Boardroom: The empowerment of dictators and oligarchs.

1047
02:42:10.930 --> 02:42:16.969
Boardroom: And potentially the annihilation of the human race because of developments across the bay.

1048
02:42:17.610 --> 02:42:29.379
Boardroom: Our government has done nothing about this. Governor Newsom has struck down AI legislation, the state legislature has been lobbied by, corporations like OpenAI.

1049
02:42:29.410 --> 02:42:39.710
Boardroom: I'd like to call on Governor Newsom to hold a citizen's assembly about AI policy, and govern AI like an existential threat, just like we've done for nuclear weapons.

1050
02:42:39.920 --> 02:42:43.590
Boardroom: Berkeley, I urge you to pass a resolution,

1051
02:42:43.760 --> 02:42:50.390
Boardroom: calling on Governor Newsom to do these actions and be a leader in free speech and democracy like you have before. Thank you.

1052
02:42:51.180 --> 02:42:52.210
Boardroom: Thank you.

1053
02:42:55.300 --> 02:43:01.210
Boardroom: Okay, folks, please… please keep your side conversations outside. Thank you.

1054
02:43:01.510 --> 02:43:16.309
Boardroom: Good evening, my name is Abby Vieira, and on March 16, I had the great pride and great pleasure of joining City of Berkeley with the Berkeley Rent Board. I was so proud to take on the job because the City of Berkeley has always demonstrated the values that I truly believe in.

1055
02:43:16.310 --> 02:43:29.930

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Boardroom: City of Berkeley has always led by example, and after 18 years of working with marginally housed communities, I was so proud to advocate for one of the most comprehensive rent stabilization ordinances in the country.

1056
02:43:29.930 --> 02:43:37.549
Boardroom: One that has led by example. Two and a half, three weeks into starting that new job, I received an impact notice that I was going to be laid off.

1057
02:43:37.620 --> 02:43:48.589
Boardroom: Just left a job with stable hours, just, moved my family, who was all here, they're now looking for pizza elsewhere, just moved them to Berkeley Care,

1058
02:43:48.590 --> 02:44:06.980
Boardroom: And here I am facing layoff. I'm here to advocate that due to, that nobody walk out the door right now in this job market. I think with all of the intelligence that we have, creativity, innovation, with the values we say that we believe in, nobody should be walking out the door in this job market. Thank you so much.

1059
02:44:12.060 --> 02:44:18.180
Boardroom: Okay, so we'll go to online, or, again, this is comments that…

1060
02:44:18.320 --> 02:44:22.139
Boardroom: For items that are not on the agenda, we have one minute.

1061
02:44:22.290 --> 02:44:26.790
Boardroom: First is a phone number ending in 211.

1062
02:44:28.900 --> 02:44:29.870
Boardroom: Good evening.

1063
02:44:33.090 --> 02:44:39.390
1510****211: Hi, this is Ed. First of all, Alex, beautiful to hear Lonnie Hancock's voice. She was a great mayor.

1064
02:44:39.700 --> 02:44:42.230
1510****211: Maybe we should just have women mayors, you know?

1065
02:44:42.760 --> 02:44:54.169

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1510****211: She was great. She was a great mayor, and I'm very happy to hear. Okay, my assistant, Citroy, handy some paper, will file a formal complaint with the State of California General Attorney.

1066
02:44:54.370 --> 02:44:56.330
1510****211: City of Berkeley? Totally.

1067
02:44:56.580 --> 02:45:01.559
1510****211: Totally, totally betrayed us and tens of thousands of our customers.

1068
02:45:01.780 --> 02:45:09.850
1510****211: So, read that carefully, and also request a meeting with the mayor whenever you have time. The other part of it is…

1069
02:45:10.070 --> 02:45:18.840
1510****211: Our business contributed more than a million dollars to Berkeley, City of Berkeley Tax Treasury. Our… hired thousands of employees.

1070
02:45:19.040 --> 02:45:25.989
1510****211: Our business hire more women than men in our big red time than all of our competitors.

1071
02:45:26.100 --> 02:45:32.120
1510****211: We don't need help, we need action. Non-action ever again, and the rest of them was criminal.

1072
02:45:32.270 --> 02:45:38.149
1510****211: We need action. We need to also be able, not only our business suffering, but also change the staff.

1073
02:45:39.630 --> 02:45:42.859
Boardroom: Next is Cheryl Davil, a former council member.

1074
02:45:46.130 --> 02:46:01.970
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: So, now you're taking 15 minutes after 45 minutes. That's kind of pathetic and sad. You're really wasting people's time having them come to the meeting, and then starting the meeting and taking a 15-minute break after a short period of time.

1075
02:46:02.120 --> 02:46:18.319

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Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: And side conversations of the council should also be outside. Actually, you shouldn't even be talking or on your cell phones, which you all do 20… all the time during these meetings, which is also pathetic.

1076
02:46:18.510 --> 02:46:34.499
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: And since you've gotten the raise that I initiated by my legislation, you've lowered the amount of time that people are allowed to speak in a meeting. You limited the time for the flock cameras to 2 hours for

1077
02:46:34.500 --> 02:46:49.010
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: public comment in the room and an hour online. That's unfair, and everything should be fair, which I know you're not. Free Palestine, free us all, free us from the fascism of this Berkeley City Council, and their.

1078
02:46:49.010 --> 02:46:51.559
Boardroom: Thank you, thanks for your comments.

1079
02:46:51.910 --> 02:46:56.100
Boardroom: Next is a phone number ending in 000.

1080
02:47:06.230 --> 02:47:13.049
1510****000: We left copies of our complaint on the table in the front of the council meeting. Please, audience.

1081
02:47:13.050 --> 02:47:13.810
TELEPHONE_USER: Copy of this.

1082
02:47:13.810 --> 02:47:17.880
Boardroom: Sorry, I think you've already spoken during a public call. Next is Dela Luna.

1083
02:47:21.270 --> 02:47:30.400
Della Luna (she/her) Huichun: Yes, thank you. I want to talk today about Zoran Mamdani, a mayor who's only been in office for 4 months, and has already

1084
02:47:30.660 --> 02:47:45.160
Della Luna (she/her) Huichun: Closed a $12 billion deficit without, cutting benefits from the people nor the workers, $8 billion in aid from the state, an additional $2 billion in pension restructuring.

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1085
02:47:45.310 --> 02:47:50.780
Della Luna (she/her) Huichun: And he has invested in childcare for the people, the housing.

1086
02:47:51.140 --> 02:47:57.579
Della Luna (she/her) Huichun: and city infrastructure. So, I wanted to highlight this as in only 4 months.

1087
02:47:58.000 --> 02:48:02.259
Della Luna (she/her) Huichun: And I think that Zoran Mamdani is showing what is possible.

1088
02:48:02.340 --> 02:48:21.320
Della Luna (she/her) Huichun: that good governance is possible, and that it is possible to care for your constituents and make the city actually work for people, and I think you all have someone to look up to in that regards, but you cannot tell us that it's not possible. So I do expect you all to move in that direction, because it's possible.

1089
02:48:21.490 --> 02:48:22.370
Della Luna (she/her) Huichun: Thank you.

1090
02:48:23.950 --> 02:48:25.500
Boardroom: Thank you.

1091
02:48:26.010 --> 02:48:29.980
Boardroom: Next is, kieran Slaughter?

1092
02:48:34.610 --> 02:48:49.519
Kieron Slaughter: Yeah, good afternoon, good evening. Kieran Slaughter here. Good to be able to make it as part of the public speaker. Just wanted to give a quick announcement about the 21st Annual Tommy Smith Youth Track Meet, presented by the 100 Black Men of the Bay Area, celebrating two decades of promoting athletic.

1093
02:48:49.520 --> 02:48:53.559
Boardroom: Karen, I'm sorry, but I think that's actually on our consent calendar.

1094
02:48:53.560 --> 02:48:54.400
Kieron Slaughter: Oh, it is?

1095

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02:48:54.400 --> 02:48:55.360
Boardroom: Yeah.

1096
02:48:55.360 --> 02:49:06.290
Kieron Slaughter: Oh, man, okay. Well, let me just speak on how proud I am of the Willard Park renovation project, as someone who actually played in that park and worked

1097
02:49:06.330 --> 02:49:17.790
Kieron Slaughter: at Willard Park as my first city job, I just wanted to say how beautiful that center came out, and how proud all the staff should be, and former Councilwoman, Lori Drossi should be. I didn't know that there weren't any…

1098
02:49:17.950 --> 02:49:32.320
Kieron Slaughter: opportunities to speak on the ceremonial albums, but I saw that, and I just want to give you all kudos. It's an amazing project. It just really brings to life the rest of Willie Park, and also kudos to all the hard-working Public Works staff during Public Works Week, whenever I see them.

1099
02:49:32.530 --> 02:49:41.560
Kieron Slaughter: servicing the trash cans and recycling, they're always smiling, and they're always waving back at me in the morning. So, I'll hold the rest of my comments to the other item.

1100
02:49:42.340 --> 02:49:44.240
Boardroom: Thanks, Karen. Good pivot.

1101
02:49:46.440 --> 02:49:51.250
Boardroom: Last speaker is, Denise Jones.

1102
02:49:55.300 --> 02:50:01.350
Denise Jones: Alright, good evening. Good evening to the Mayor. This is Denise Jones again.

1103
02:50:01.350 --> 02:50:17.950
Denise Jones: I'm the director at the Berkeley Drop-In Center, and again, I am reaching out for whatever monetary support we can get. The Berkeley Drop-In Center was impacted by Proposition Number 1 and the BHSA funding changes.

1104
02:50:17.950 --> 02:50:23.620
Denise Jones: And effective July 1st of 2026, there will be no funding.

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1105
02:50:23.620 --> 02:50:39.750
Denise Jones: We are an entity that helps, our community with food, clothing, mailboxes, locker services, and despite the major cuts that are coming, I am currently running the drop-in center with 3 staff.

1106
02:50:39.750 --> 02:50:46.369
Denise Jones: And who will be gone by June the 30th, but we still have over 300 clients.

1107
02:50:46.370 --> 02:50:55.370
Denise Jones: That will be without food, effective June 31st. I'm reaching out for $500K for the next 2 years. Thank you.

1108
02:50:56.410 --> 02:50:57.500
Boardroom: Thank you.

1109
02:50:59.410 --> 02:51:10.199
Boardroom: Yeah, that's it. That's it for non-agenda public comment. Okay, very good. Thank you so much. Thank you, everyone, for your public comment. And we will now move on to the consent calendar.

1110
02:51:11.420 --> 02:51:14.550
Boardroom: Councilmembers, do you have any comments on the consent calendar?

1111
02:51:16.250 --> 02:51:24.910
Boardroom: I will start with Councilmember Taplin. Thank you, Madam Mayor, and good evening, everybody. On items 16-17, these are my offices.

1112
02:51:25.480 --> 02:51:39.940
Boardroom: resolutions relinquishing funds for the Berkeley Humane's 12th Annual Pines for Paws Fundraiser and the 100 Black Men in the Bay Area's Tommy Smith Youth Track Meet. I want to thank my co-sponsors and my colleagues for their support this evening, and I encourage all to attend. Thank you.

1113
02:51:40.560 --> 02:51:43.720
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Councilmember… oh, Vice Mayor Treyka?

1114
02:51:46.170 --> 02:52:02.520

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Boardroom: Thank you so much. I, wanted to comment on a few items on this agenda. First of all, items 6 and 7, both are joined HomeKey Plus applications, and…

1115
02:52:02.550 --> 02:52:12.499
Boardroom: I'm very excited to see both of these move forward tonight. I would like to thank, staff who made this possible.

1116
02:52:12.860 --> 02:52:15.169
Boardroom: It, you know,

1117
02:52:15.620 --> 02:52:29.010
Boardroom: I, I had the deep, honor, thank you so much to the mayor for, sending me to the, a press conference, today, where it was announced that,

1118
02:52:29.010 --> 02:52:36.440
Boardroom: Countywide, there is another, major reduction over, 10%, for.

1119
02:52:36.440 --> 02:52:53.800
Boardroom: the unhoused population and the unsheltered unhoused population, and, projects like these are integral, as we, do everything possible, towards a Bay Area that we can all call home.

1120
02:52:53.800 --> 02:52:57.589
Boardroom: Including in Berkeley.

1121
02:52:57.790 --> 02:53:20.050
Boardroom: Item 14, recommendation to add 3 ceremonial street name signs in honor of Daniel Ellsberg on Kittredge. This is in my district, and I am, very grateful to the, Transportation and Infrastructure Commission for, taking this on and making this recommendation, and it would… and…

1122
02:53:20.050 --> 02:53:33.030
Boardroom: All who, all the community, members who, first reached out to us, to do that, and, very excited that this is moving forward tonight. Thank you.

1123
02:53:34.790 --> 02:53:47.340
Boardroom: Items, item 15, I would like to… this is a referral to incorporate food insecurity as a funded category in future community agency grant funding cycles.

1124

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02:53:47.340 --> 02:53:55.769
Boardroom: I would like to thank Councilmember Kesarwani for her work, and wanted to see if it would be possible to be added as a co-sponsor.

1125
02:53:56.460 --> 02:53:59.710
Boardroom: Yes, Councilmember Trigger, we'd be delighted to have you.

1126
02:53:59.850 --> 02:54:01.199
Boardroom: Thank you so much.

1127
02:54:01.630 --> 02:54:17.460
Boardroom: Items 16 through 18, I, want to thank the authors of those items, and, will contribute $100 out of my G13 account to each of those items.

1128
02:54:17.520 --> 02:54:27.320
Boardroom: And item 19, which is, the Berkeley Rotary Endowment Education and Community Welfare support,

1129
02:54:27.420 --> 02:54:37.910
Boardroom: This is going to, help the Berkeley Rotary Endowment to raise funds for the Rotter Care Health Clinic four-year collegiate Scholarship Program.

1130
02:54:37.910 --> 02:54:52.299
Boardroom: supportive housing and hygiene kit programs. In previous years, these funds were raised, together with and through the Taste of Downtown Berkeley event. This year,

1131
02:54:52.310 --> 02:55:12.229
Boardroom: There was a decision made, by the Rotary to move it towards a biannual event, so there will be a bigger and better event in 2027. But the need for this funding still continues, and so, I would like to thank the Rotary, and I believe Tina is on the Zoom, tonight.

1132
02:55:12.230 --> 02:55:24.879
Boardroom: Who can say a little more, but, thank you for continuing to move this really important effort, and would welcome, any, D13 allocations from my colleagues.

1133
02:55:24.880 --> 02:55:25.870
Boardroom: Thank you so much.

1134

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02:55:26.040 --> 02:55:29.270
Boardroom: Thank you very much. I'm moving on to Councilmember O'Keefe.

1135
02:55:32.170 --> 02:55:40.570
Boardroom: Thank you, Mayor. I first want to comment about item, 14, I think?

1136
02:55:42.100 --> 02:55:43.360
Boardroom: Yes,

1137
02:55:43.570 --> 02:56:02.010
Boardroom: just want to say Daniel Ellsberg is a personal hero of mine, and I actually, even though I teach computer science, it seems unrelated, I actually find a way to work him into my curriculum every year, because the students do not know who he is, and so, I just wanted to say I'm really, happy to… to be supporting Adam 14, and thank you so much for bringing it.

1138
02:56:02.260 --> 02:56:15.290
Boardroom: And then, the… for the D13 items, I will contribute to all of them, except the one I'm already on, so that means $250. I would love to contribute to the Pints for Paws, item 16.

1139
02:56:15.350 --> 02:56:29.359
Boardroom: To the, track meet. I recently became a track mom, so especially excited about that. I have $250, and, the flea market, absolutely would love to contribute to that, and I'm already listed as a co-sponsor for

1140
02:56:29.430 --> 02:56:36.380
Boardroom: Item 19, so thank you so much, Councilmember Trey Group, for… Vice Mayor Trey Group, for, allowing me to do that. Thank you.

1141
02:56:36.500 --> 02:56:55.719
Boardroom: Thank you. Councilmember Humbert? Yes, thank you, Madam Mayor, and I first have a question about item 13, which is the Disaster and Fire Safety Commission recommendation about the bike plan. I'm wondering if that could be continued to the meeting where we take up the bike plan. I guess that's in June.

1142
02:56:57.030 --> 02:57:06.300
Boardroom: You certainly could. I mean, I think the point of that item was to ask that staff do certain things in the bike plan, and we have considered and done most of those things.

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1143
02:57:06.300 --> 02:57:24.370
Boardroom: So, I think it's… it could come tonight as, like, a precursor to that item and say, hey, these are things we want to make sure you included in the plan, or it could come on the night of the plan, either way. We just… I decided to leave it there since it was… it was before the plan, and at least not after. Okay, yeah, it sounds like there's no need to… to move it, at least to me.

1144
02:57:24.370 --> 02:57:26.800
Boardroom: Number 14,

1145
02:57:26.800 --> 02:57:32.770
Boardroom: Daniel Ellsberg is also one of my personal heroes. I read a lot of his writings before I turned 20.

1146
02:57:32.880 --> 02:57:52.419
Boardroom: My wife was at a writer's retreat in Point Reyes Station, and the writers are supposed to sign their names in the closet. I walked in the closet where she was gonna sign, and there was his name, and it was really… it was a moving experience for me. So, thank you for… for doing this.

1147
02:57:54.830 --> 02:58:06.190
Boardroom: Number 15, I appreciate, which is the, referral to incorporate food insecurity as a funded category in future community agency grant funding cycles.

1148
02:58:06.190 --> 02:58:14.909
Boardroom: I appreciate, Councilmember Kesarwani adding me as a co-sponsor on this important item. Food insecurity is a fundamental problem.

1149
02:58:14.910 --> 02:58:32.639
Boardroom: It's gotten worse after prices have risen with the pandemic incense. The organizations in Berkeley that address this are doing essential, but often behind-the-scenes work, and they must be empowered to participate in our community agency grant funding process. That was an oversight, and I'm glad it's being corrected. Thank you.

1150
02:58:32.750 --> 02:58:35.360
Boardroom: Councilmember Cassarwani,

1151
02:58:35.420 --> 02:58:48.610

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Boardroom: As to item number 16, Pints for Paws, I'm a co-sponsor. Thank you, Councilmember Taplin. Such a wonderful organization, Berkeley Humane, and I'd like to contribute $250.

1152
02:58:48.610 --> 02:58:58.520
Boardroom: For my discretionary account, on 16, 17, 18, and 19 would like to contribute $100 each.

1153
02:58:58.600 --> 02:59:03.219
Boardroom: from our discretionary, D8 account. Thank you.

1154
02:59:04.650 --> 02:59:06.870
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Councilmember Blackbee?

1155
02:59:06.970 --> 02:59:25.169
Boardroom: Thanks, Mayor Ishii. Just a couple of comments. Again, I also wanted to appreciate, Councilmember Castorwani and team for item 15, referral to incorporate food insecurity as a funded category in future community grant funding cycles, incredibly important, and I'm proud to support that effort.

1156
02:59:25.170 --> 02:59:38.919
Boardroom: On item 16, would like to relinquish $250. I was proud to co-sponsor item 17, 100 Black Men of the Bay Area's Tommy Smith Youth Track Meet. I wanted to relinquish $500 for that.

1157
02:59:38.930 --> 02:59:48.389
Boardroom: And then item 18 and 19, the Berkeley Flea Market and the Berkeley Rotary Endowment Education Support, also $250 for each of those.

1158
02:59:48.600 --> 02:59:52.770
Boardroom: And then I had a couple of questions I wanted to ask on,

1159
02:59:53.180 --> 03:00:00.699
Boardroom: information item, number 30 and 31, I think Mr. Oyankani is on the… on the line.

1160
03:00:02.610 --> 03:00:16.940
Boardroom: I really appreciate getting these quarterly reports on the performance of our, investment portfolio that leads in very directly to the conversation we're gonna have about the budget later tonight. I'm gonna share my screen really quick, just to highlight one piece.

1161

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03:00:17.170 --> 03:00:23.930
Boardroom: And then ask Henry a quick question, because if there's any policy adjustments that we should consider,

1162
03:00:24.240 --> 03:00:34.039
Boardroom: Just to note, again, there's huge clarity and transparency in terms of the returns we're getting on the investment portfolio. We have about $600, $700 million of assets.

1163
03:00:34.170 --> 03:00:40.530
Boardroom: Previous councils I know have put very particular constraints on what the finance team

1164
03:00:40.530 --> 03:00:43.570
Boardroom: Can do, with this pooled money.

1165
03:00:43.570 --> 03:01:00.779
Boardroom: I also know there's, you know, kind of the vagaries of the market and the length of time of various, of, various instruments that we have and when they come to maturity. And Henry and I have already had a back and forth on this in email. So I think my question for, the finance team and for Henry is.

1166
03:01:00.780 --> 03:01:14.849
Boardroom: Is there more that we can do on the policy side, to relax any of the constraints that are inhibiting returns? I'll just observe that, you know, even if we got a half a point better and matched

1167
03:01:14.970 --> 03:01:23.759
Boardroom: Burbank, or a point better, and match San Francisco or San Jose, that's worth, you know, several million dollars to the top line on the revenue side.

1168
03:01:23.760 --> 03:01:38.279
Boardroom: So anyway, so, question just to Henry is, are there things that we could be doing from a policy side, adjustments we could make that would give you more of the flexibility to aid on bumping that rate up? So that's question number one, and question number two is.

1169
03:01:38.300 --> 03:01:46.439
Boardroom: what the assumption is in next year's budget for return, and what we're assuming in terms of revenue from the portfolio. Thank you.

1170
03:01:47.030 --> 03:01:54.799

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Henry Oyekanmi: Yeah, thank you, thank you, for the question. I just want to give you a little bit of context for this. If you look at the reports that we had about

1171
03:01:55.150 --> 03:02:03.180
Henry Oyekanmi: about a year and a half ago, we were… we were very close to the top at that time. There's a cycle. We buy,

1172
03:02:03.350 --> 03:02:11.240
Henry Oyekanmi: investments for 3, 4, 5 years, and we locked them in. So when you lock them in, if you look at the reports that we have.

1173
03:02:11.240 --> 03:02:26.110
Henry Oyekanmi: Because we locked them in at that rate, when it was, like, 0.5 or 0.75, like, just 75 basis points. But now, if you look at the same report, I think there's an Exhibit E1 or something in there, it tells you.

1174
03:02:26.510 --> 03:02:37.300
Henry Oyekanmi: 10 of all the investments that we locked in at 0.1 to 0.75% are all going to be mature… maturing this year, within the next 6 months.

1175
03:02:37.430 --> 03:03:00.010
Henry Oyekanmi: And the market is at about 3.5 to 4.2. So we are going to buy those investments after they mature, and we are going to be at the top of it by the time, maybe next or two years, we're going to be, like, probably at the high top of that ladder. So it's always cyclical because of the investment timing and when we lock them in. So that's number one.

1176
03:03:00.140 --> 03:03:06.499
Henry Oyekanmi: And then, from a bigger picture, yes, we are trying to see if there's anything we can do. I know

1177
03:03:06.500 --> 03:03:12.910
Henry Oyekanmi: The markets are very volatile now, so this is probably not the time to be changing stuff, so we're looking at it in terms of standardized.

1178
03:03:12.910 --> 03:03:29.470
Henry Oyekanmi: And so, if you look at the revenue projection that we did for next year, we are taking into this account that, yeah, we're going to have more revenues for next year than we had this year. And that's one of the reasons why, if you look at the investments, the earnings that we are assuming we are going to get, it's probably going to be about

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1179
03:03:29.530 --> 03:03:37.720
Henry Oyekanmi: 10 to 11 million, even though we have less money to invest, because we are running… we have a budget deficit, so we don't have enough cash.

1180
03:03:37.720 --> 03:03:49.869
Henry Oyekanmi: But even with that, we're still going to have more revenues, and our rates are going to go up, because we're going to be able to lock in these higher rates once these 10 or 11… I think we have about 14

1181
03:03:49.870 --> 03:04:02.690
Henry Oyekanmi: maturities that are coming within the next 6 months. And once those maturities are coming in, we are going to be buying at a higher rate of about 3% to 4% to 5%. So, we are going to be at the top of that cycle again.

1182
03:04:02.690 --> 03:04:12.859
Henry Oyekanmi: While everybody else goes down, and then once we start maturing again, then everybody will come up again, so that it's always been a cycle in terms of, luck.

1183
03:04:12.860 --> 03:04:15.050
Henry Oyekanmi: The way we lock those investments.

1184
03:04:15.470 --> 03:04:16.000
Boardroom: Thanks.

1185
03:04:16.000 --> 03:04:30.130
Henry Oyekanmi: And at the same time, we're looking at… we are going to cancel to do… to see whether we should change our investment report. Me and you have been having this conversation, so we've been talking about what can we do on the margins, what are the things that we can do that can help us.

1186
03:04:30.130 --> 03:04:47.240
Henry Oyekanmi: unlock some of the things that we had. Like, you were right, we couldn't do so many things we couldn't do. So we are trying to see whether there's anything we can… that Council can help us and give us the permission to do a little bit of a… broaden our investments to see whether we can make, even if it's just a million dollars more.

1187
03:04:47.330 --> 03:04:51.740

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Henry Oyekanmi: That makes sense, but everybody's looking for revenues, and that will help with our budget deficit.

1188
03:04:51.740 --> 03:05:06.939
Boardroom: Thank you. Thanks, Henry. And just, folks, just a reminder, consent calendar, you know, we shouldn't really be having much discussion or inquiry at this time, so I want to ask if, in the future, you want to have a conversation about this, that we take it off the consent calendar. Okay. I'll just…

1189
03:05:06.940 --> 03:05:13.690
Boardroom: close by saying, you know, thanks for this. A million dollars here, a million dollars there. It's real money, as we've heard in the past.

1190
03:05:13.790 --> 03:05:30.789
Boardroom: And so, again, I appreciate the effort, here, and, and know you are doing everything you can to maximize, the return here. We've rightfully so been focused on the cost side of the equation on the budget, because that's the part that's in our most direct control.

1191
03:05:30.790 --> 03:05:46.040
Boardroom: But this does feel like a lever where, hey, if we can figure out a few other things to do here, and I… Paul, you know, we've all been talking about this, so this is not, you know, so I appreciate the conversation, the ongoing work here, and anything we can do to support you, please let us know. Thank you.

1192
03:05:47.410 --> 03:05:49.219
Boardroom: Thank you. Councilmember Lunapara.

1193
03:05:50.890 --> 03:06:02.700
Boardroom: Thank you. I'd like to donate $200, to items 16, 17, 18, and 19 from my discretionary funds. And I also briefly want to speak

1194
03:06:02.850 --> 03:06:09.990
Boardroom: on item 6, the, home key application for supportive housing in People's Park, I…

1195
03:06:10.510 --> 03:06:29.210
Boardroom: did not support the development of People's Park, and I mourn the People's Park that was there, and now our job is to make sure that there are as many units and permanent supportive housing units as possible at that site, to support our unhoused neighbors. And so I support this strongly. Thanks.

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1196
03:06:29.750 --> 03:06:31.779
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember Kasarwani.

1197
03:06:33.570 --> 03:06:44.150
Boardroom: Thank you very much, Madam Mayor. So, I, too, wanted to, just note and thank our staff for, I believe it's items 6 and 7, for the supportive housing at Peoples Park.

1198
03:06:44.160 --> 03:07:02.879
Boardroom: 110 units for low-income and previously unhoused individuals, and for North Berkeley BART, that is in my district, I'm very proud to see our application, with the developer Insight Housing for 85 studio and one-bedroom units serving homeless individuals and veterans.

1199
03:07:02.880 --> 03:07:11.729
Boardroom: These two projects are just a tremendous demonstration of our city's commitment to housing people at all income levels.

1200
03:07:11.730 --> 03:07:20.559
Boardroom: And I really hope that these two applications are successful, because when we do these affordable housing projects, we have to have what's called a funding stack, so it's the…

1201
03:07:20.650 --> 03:07:38.440
Boardroom: local affordable housing bond monies, it's the state funding, we're trying to get some here, it's the low-income housing tax credits, and all of that comes together, to help us create these new units for people. So thank you for that, and then I also wanted to thank everyone for their

1202
03:07:38.440 --> 03:07:47.669
Boardroom: kind comments about the item related to incorporating food insecurity as a funded category in our community agency RFP.

1203
03:07:47.670 --> 03:08:02.859
Boardroom: process, I want to add the mayor as my final co-sponsor. I want to thank the co-sponsors and everyone supporting that. And I also wanted to note that we… the reason why we're simply asking for the category in the community agency RFP process is because

1204
03:08:02.950 --> 03:08:17.969

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Boardroom: We were really lucky, and we were able to repurpose federal funds through home ARP, American Rescue Plan dollars, to the tune of $377,000 over two fiscal years. So that RFP is out.

1205
03:08:18.080 --> 03:08:28.079
Boardroom: And, you know, we encourage our providers of food assistance to respond to that RFP. I think maybe it's still open for that purpose.

1206
03:08:28.290 --> 03:08:43.739
Boardroom: So, so that's that. And then I did want to just make the donations. I'm just, pleasantly surprised by all the opportunities to show my appreciation. So $100 to the Berkeley Humane's 12th Annual Pints for Paws fundraiser.

1207
03:08:43.750 --> 03:08:49.050
Boardroom: $100 to the Black Men of the Bay Area's Tommy Smith Youth Track Meet.

1208
03:08:49.190 --> 03:09:00.190
Boardroom: $100 to the Berkeley Flea Market Art Walk event, and finally, $100 to the Berkeley Rotary Endowment Education and Community Welfare Support,

1209
03:09:00.480 --> 03:09:04.030
Boardroom: So, so thank you all for bringing those forward, and that's all.

1210
03:09:04.380 --> 03:09:06.440
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Councilmember Bartlett.

1211
03:09:06.530 --> 03:09:14.079
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor. And, thank you, Councillorwani, for bringing forward item 15, this food measure.

1212
03:09:14.100 --> 03:09:26.279
Boardroom: You know, during the pandemic, we saw the food shocks, the first, supply chain shocks really hit us, and scarcity came into our, you know, consciousness.

1213
03:09:26.280 --> 03:09:42.009
Boardroom: We responded and created this, this food, resilience measure called FARM a while ago. And, so, you know, the war in Iran, we know, as offset, is taking fertilizer offline, so crops are not being planted right now over in different parts of the world.

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1214
03:09:42.010 --> 03:09:54.559
Boardroom: Including America, and also the fuel prices going up tremendously will also raise the price of food. So I think number 15, this food resilience will be front and center, in our conversations next year.

1215
03:09:54.600 --> 03:10:04.570
Boardroom: Sadly. And I wanted to co-sponsor it, but of course you left me out. Again, guess what guests are wanting. After all of our years of doing it together, Cam, you always leave me off the good ones.

1216
03:10:04.820 --> 03:10:06.220
Boardroom: Okay,

1217
03:10:06.300 --> 03:10:16.759
Boardroom: Whatever. Still a fan, though, I'm still a fan. You know, so, Pints for Paws want to give, $250 to the Pines for Paws celebration. Beautiful.

1218
03:10:16.760 --> 03:10:27.690
Boardroom: event every year, I love it. Very, very thankful to Councilmember Taplin for the Tommy Smith, 100 Black Men track meet. I'd like to donate $250 out as well.

1219
03:10:27.690 --> 03:10:36.839
Boardroom: And number 18, the, the flea market, one art, art walk, this is, this is, came out of our office. And so, this came from…

1220
03:10:36.910 --> 03:10:46.749
Boardroom: You know, a couple of years, more than a few years, right, Paul? I see you. Of diligent effort to take this community treasure

1221
03:10:46.750 --> 03:10:54.710
Boardroom: And give it, you know, give it the tools to reinvigorate, to evolve, to grow, to expand its mission, because its mission was set

1222
03:10:54.710 --> 03:11:09.389
Boardroom: when BART displaced many black businesses in that little area there to give some sort of economic conduit for people. And so, this is a chance to kind of reinvigorate, get it going again, as I said, so thank you again for all those who contribute.

1223

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03:11:09.540 --> 03:11:16.630
Boardroom: And the Rotary Club, a great organization, donated $150 to that. Thank you, Councilman… Mr. Vice Mayor.

1224
03:11:16.790 --> 03:11:17.489
Boardroom: Thank you.

1225
03:11:18.310 --> 03:11:25.690
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember Taplin. Thank you. On item 18, I would like to be recorded as contributing $500. Thank you very much.

1226
03:11:26.310 --> 03:11:39.969
Boardroom: Thank you very much. I also want to add my thanks and enthusiasm for items 6 and 7 for the two home key projects. Just another example of the City of Berkeley continuing to apply for funding to support affordable housing and also access grants

1227
03:11:39.970 --> 03:11:57.680
Boardroom: At the state level, but also, you know, we're doing it state, federal, county level, so I really want to thank staff for all of their work there. That's for the People's Park Project and also, North Berkeley BART. Thank you for Councilmember Kessimwani for adding me to the food insecurity item. Grateful to be a part of that.

1228
03:11:57.680 --> 03:12:07.459
Boardroom: As it's an issue that's very near and dear to my heart. And then for items 16, 17, and 18, that's Pines for Paws, 100 Black Men Track Me, and the Berkeley Flea Market Art Walk.

1229
03:12:07.460 --> 03:12:24.759
Boardroom: I'd like to donate $250 to each of those items. Thank you very much. Can we move on to public comment, please? If you have public comment on any consent calendar or information items only, please comment up or raise your hand online. Kieran, now's your time.

1230
03:12:34.300 --> 03:12:48.119
Boardroom: Good evening, Madam Mayor, City Council, City Manager, and City Staff. My name is Pam Gray, and I'm the Chair of the Board of Directors for the Berkeley Food Network, and we are Berkeley's largest food assistance nonprofit.

1231
03:12:48.440 --> 03:13:06.740
Boardroom: First, I want to say thank you to Councilmember Kesarwani, and also, Councilmember Humbert for authoring and co-sponsoring, this item, number 15 on the consent calendar, as well as the Mayor, and also

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Councilmember Triggroup, and in spirit, Councilmember Bartlett for also co-sponsoring.

1232
03:13:06.880 --> 03:13:22.269
Boardroom: I really want to say thank you, to the mayor and to all Council. You have all, I know, been down to the Berkeley Food Network to see our operation, and you know exactly what it is that we're doing and the importance of the work in town. And I just want to say thank you so much for that support.

1233
03:13:22.710 --> 03:13:33.990
Boardroom: So, really, on behalf of all of the community members in Berkeley who received this critical food assistance, I just want to say thank you for all of your strong and ongoing support for our work. Thanks.

1234
03:13:34.260 --> 03:13:35.390
Boardroom: Thank you.

1235
03:13:42.390 --> 03:14:00.479
Boardroom: Good evening, Honorable Mayor, City Council, City Manager, my name's Andrew Crispin, I'm the Executive Director at Berkeley Food Network. On behalf of Berkeley Food Network, I want to acknowledge Council Members Kesarwani, Trey Goop, Humbert, and the Mayor for supporting item 15 to make food security an addressable and fundable item in an ongoing funding cycle.

1236
03:14:00.540 --> 03:14:10.720
Boardroom: Earlier this week, I was in Sacramento meeting with staff from food banks and policy and advocacy organizations from across California to help prepare for the impacts of H.R. 1.

1237
03:14:11.000 --> 03:14:29.000
Boardroom: It doesn't look good. April 1st, we had 5… over 5,000 Alameda County residents kicked off CalFresh. Starting June 1st, and every subsequent month on the 1st, an additional 55,000 Californians will be kicked off CalFresh. And the governors may revise funding for food banks cut in half.

1238
03:14:29.300 --> 03:14:37.079
Boardroom: We're approaching a food security cliff at the same time as economic pressures forcing more families to choose between rent and food.

1239
03:14:37.540 --> 03:14:46.870

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Boardroom: Here in Berkeley, we are continuing to focus on building resiliency here, especially as we celebrate our 10th year of service, and we're gratefully looking forward to partnering with the city. Thank you.

1240
03:14:52.920 --> 03:15:03.690
Boardroom: Good evening, Council. My name is Joe Lisner. I've been, in Food Not Bombs feeding people on the streets for 26 years, so I know how important

1241
03:15:03.970 --> 03:15:06.259
Boardroom: Housing is for the homeless.

1242
03:15:06.450 --> 03:15:19.550
Boardroom: I also am, for some reason, indelibly a supporter of People's Park, especially as our Constitution is being subverted as we breathe. If only they could

1243
03:15:20.000 --> 03:15:24.410
Boardroom: both, you know, come to fruition. So what I want to tell you is.

1244
03:15:25.110 --> 03:15:37.289
Boardroom: University of California threw RCD under the bus. Very, flippant, you know, legal brief that totally submerged them. So what you gotta look out for is, what's the total price?

1245
03:15:37.380 --> 03:15:52.460
Boardroom: They are applying for, project-based, vouchers, which means they're gonna look for federal money, which means they have to comply with the National Historic Preservation Act. There's nothing in Item 6 about who's gonna pay for that.

1246
03:15:52.650 --> 03:15:59.719
Boardroom: Or, how it's gonna be bought about. Thank you. Thank you.

1247
03:16:03.060 --> 03:16:18.270
Boardroom: Hi, I'm Patricia Ellsberg, married to Dan for 53 loving years, and I deeply want to thank you on his behalf and our whole family. It means so much, and he dedicated his life to peace.

1248
03:16:18.290 --> 03:16:35.999
Boardroom: And he loved being in this… living in this area. He drove a little sports car, and I can just see him going around the street, so

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looking at his name. Thank you so very much. He's my personal hero, too. Thank you.

1249
03:16:40.720 --> 03:16:54.560
Boardroom: Hi, my name is Phyllis Olin, and I live in District 6 in Berkeley, where I've been for many years. It… it has been my honor to shepherd, this,

1250
03:16:54.560 --> 03:17:12.979
Boardroom: getting the street signs named after Ellsberg. The process has been about 2 years now. So, I am so grateful that this is finally happening, and I really appreciate the comments from several council members supporting this.

1251
03:17:13.020 --> 03:17:22.119
Boardroom: I want to note also that the signs are going to be on one side, Milvia, this is on Kittredge.

1252
03:17:22.120 --> 03:17:38.030
Boardroom: which borders Berkeley High, and on the other side, Fulton, which borders the university. So hopefully more and more young people will become aware of Daniel Ellsberg and what he has contributed to us. Thank you. Thank you.

1253
03:17:42.980 --> 03:17:49.209
Boardroom: Hi, my name is Jackie Cabasso. I'm the Executive Director of Western States Legal Foundation in Oakland.

1254
03:17:49.360 --> 03:17:55.419
Boardroom: A nuclear disarmament advocacy organization founded in 1982, and it's been my…

1255
03:17:55.990 --> 03:18:09.089
Boardroom: pleasure, and sometimes a little bit for frustration working with Phyllis and our team over the last couple of years to make this street renaming a reality, but we're really, really very pleased

1256
03:18:09.250 --> 03:18:22.679
Boardroom: But it's happening, and I want to say something about why it's so important in this world today. Dan Ellsberg was also a personal hero of mine, but also a friend of mine, and a colleague.

1257
03:18:22.810 --> 03:18:33.940

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Boardroom: And what he stood for, truth-telling, whistleblowing, peace, anti-war, nuclear disarmament, and social justice.

1258
03:18:34.630 --> 03:18:40.030
Boardroom: And he was a giant. And young people need to know about people like Dan.

1259
03:18:40.160 --> 03:18:46.080
Boardroom: And look… and for him to become their heroes as well. Thank you. Thank you.

1260
03:18:52.480 --> 03:18:59.130
Boardroom: Hello, my name is John Burroughs. I live in the Greater East Bay, but I was a graduate student at

1261
03:18:59.340 --> 03:19:05.289
Boardroom: Berkeley, I too, like Jackie, knew Dan Ellsberg fairly well.

1262
03:19:06.160 --> 03:19:17.780
Boardroom: He's pretty well known for being a critic of the Vietnam War and releasing the Pentagon Papers. What needs to be known more

1263
03:19:18.000 --> 03:19:23.449
Boardroom: Is that he was a critic of nuclearism.

1264
03:19:23.920 --> 03:19:35.210
Boardroom: and an activist against reliance on nuclear weapons. He wrote a book, which I recommend, it's called The Doomsday Machine.

1265
03:19:35.840 --> 03:19:39.200
Boardroom: One of the memories of my life is…

1266
03:19:39.580 --> 03:19:51.920
Boardroom: being involved in a protest at the Nevada test site in the 1980s with Dan. So, it's really terrific that the streets are going to be named in his honor. Thank you.

1267
03:19:52.620 --> 03:19:53.710
Boardroom: Thank you.

1268
03:19:59.140 --> 03:20:02.079
Boardroom: Good evening, my name's Judith Ehrlich.

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1269
03:20:02.300 --> 03:20:15.359
Boardroom: I'm a filmmaker, and I've made 3 films about Daniel Ellsberg. One is The Most Dangerous Man in America, Daniel Ellsberg in the Pentagon Papers, which was nominated for the Oscar and Emmy and won the Peabody Award.

1270
03:20:15.360 --> 03:20:27.490
Boardroom: And brought some more attention to Dan. And then, The Boys Who Said No, which was, about draft resistors during the Vietnam War, focused on Joan Baez, but Dan was a major character in that.

1271
03:20:27.490 --> 03:20:42.519
Boardroom: And now, a new film that we're just gonna release online, June 4th. It's gonna be free and, available. It's a half-hour film about nuclear war and Dan speaking about nuclear war. So we're really, glad that we…

1272
03:20:42.520 --> 03:20:48.409
Boardroom: We can put it out at no cost, and a lot of groups are embedding it on their websites as well, so…

1273
03:20:48.410 --> 03:20:59.850
Boardroom: Hope you all get to see it. Thank you, and I really… it's gonna be wonderful to have… I live a block from Kittredge, and I get to see it every day. Thank you. Thank you.

1274
03:21:04.790 --> 03:21:16.029
Boardroom: Good evening, council members and Madam Mayor. My name is Claire Greensfelder, and I'm a 45-year, or longer, I can't remember anymore, resident of Berkeley and homeowner in District 6.

1275
03:21:16.130 --> 03:21:21.459
Boardroom: I'm also the Executive Director of the California Institute for Community Art and Nature that produces the annual

1276
03:21:21.460 --> 03:21:41.050
Boardroom: California Native Ways Festival, Nolani Park, and the Berkeley Bird Festival downtown. But I'm here tonight because Daniel Ellsberg was also a personal friend and colleague of mine. And I've been, I knew him, I met Dan first at Patricia Both at an event in Berkeley about 1980, when I was working on the Nuclear Weapons Freeze campaign, that

1277
03:21:41.050 --> 03:21:44.290

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Boardroom: actually won in California, and made a difference globally.

1278
03:21:44.290 --> 03:21:57.039
Boardroom: Although I've worked many years on other issues, climate change, indigenous rights, and others, like our West Berkeley Shell Mound, I am helping with the promotion. I was one of the producers of The Most Dangerous Man, and I'm also helping with the promotion of this film.

1279
03:21:57.040 --> 03:22:13.579
Boardroom: June 4th, we'll have our online launch, and when the street is dedicated, we're very much hoping to have a big event in downtown Berkeley to show all three of Judy's films, and we hope you all will join us. So I brought you on an invitation. Yeah, feel free to pass it to the clerk, and we can pass around. Thank you.

1280
03:22:17.910 --> 03:22:20.300
Boardroom: Hi, Kelly Hammergren.

1281
03:22:20.400 --> 03:22:29.369
Boardroom: I'm gonna talk about something that no one else has mentioned, and probably most of you don't care about a lot, but it's the record retention schedule.

1282
03:22:29.510 --> 03:22:45.809
Boardroom: And, of course, I would really like everything saved forever, but I understand we can't do that because of space and expense, but I really wish that that was laid out for us, what that… what the problems were.

1283
03:22:46.140 --> 03:22:57.439
Boardroom: And I just think, in terms of the boards and commissions, I know sometimes people feel that they don't contribute much, but going to those meetings, I see they contribute a lot.

1284
03:22:57.830 --> 03:23:12.980
Boardroom: And then the minutes really don't give us a good documentation of what actually happened in that meeting. With the action minutes, so much is lost, and sometimes it'll just say discussion held.

1285
03:23:13.200 --> 03:23:14.810
Boardroom: Well, what was that?

1286
03:23:15.050 --> 03:23:25.070

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Boardroom: And only 90 days to retain records, recordings of the meetings is way too short. Thanks, Kelly. Appreciate it.

1287
03:23:28.780 --> 03:23:29.470
Boardroom: Okay.

1288
03:23:33.470 --> 03:23:50.159
Boardroom: Carol Morasovic. First, as former chair of the Homeless Commission, we did recommend maximizing the number of units in the supportive housing in People's Park. I believe we said 125 or 150. So we're pleased to see this moving forward. I also want to address,

1289
03:23:50.160 --> 03:23:57.009
Boardroom: the record's retention. And first, legally, I understand that

1290
03:23:57.010 --> 03:24:06.000
Boardroom: The city attorney has advised that the correct records will be, will be retained. However, it could be that…

1291
03:24:06.530 --> 03:24:18.499
Boardroom: someone is unknown at the time the issue, and something… a legal issue could emerge later, and then you won't have the records. I'm also, concerned

1292
03:24:18.500 --> 03:24:39.079
Boardroom: from the purpose of historical value, it's really important to have records to be able to go back and research and find information on issues, sometimes individuals. And… and I'm… I hope that this is scrutinized carefully. Thanks, Carol. Thank you.

1293
03:24:39.080 --> 03:24:42.090
Boardroom: Bless you.

1294
03:24:43.350 --> 03:24:44.190
Boardroom: Thank you.

1295
03:24:45.350 --> 03:24:55.070
Boardroom: Good evening, Council. I'm… my name's Andrew Pritchard, I'm with Berkeley Copwatch, and I'd like to address pepper spray reporting. In 1997, when Copwatch

1296
03:24:55.190 --> 03:24:58.809

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Boardroom: launched our campaign to ban pepper spray. We felt that it was…

1297
03:24:58.910 --> 03:25:05.160
Boardroom: potentially lethal. There were many deaths that had been attributed to its use, and we were very against it.

1298
03:25:05.570 --> 03:25:14.140
Boardroom: The pepper spray reporting requirement that was in that 1997 legislation was there because our fear was that the police would use it

1299
03:25:14.460 --> 03:25:21.160
Boardroom: Against mentally ill people. Against people who are marginalized. Against people who can never, in this day and age.

1300
03:25:21.340 --> 03:25:23.259
Boardroom: Be able to bring a complaint.

1301
03:25:23.570 --> 03:25:25.349
Boardroom: To the Police Accountability Board.

1302
03:25:26.180 --> 03:25:36.019
Boardroom: That people who are falling on our sidewalks, people who are disoriented, people for whatever reasons don't do what the police say when the police say to do it.

1303
03:25:36.550 --> 03:25:38.569
Boardroom: They're the ones who are going to be suffering.

1304
03:25:39.150 --> 03:25:46.499
Boardroom: And the fact that that reporting requirement was meant to have a unique Was it justified?

1305
03:25:46.770 --> 03:25:51.910
Boardroom: Because those folks will never Ever be able to complain.

1306
03:25:52.410 --> 03:25:54.499
Boardroom: We just… suck it up.

1307
03:25:55.270 --> 03:26:02.549
Boardroom: I'm gonna tell you also that now that the mobile crisis team is gone, we have no non-police alternative.

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1308
03:26:02.770 --> 03:26:07.960
Boardroom: So you're gonna have untrained people with, with, with compliance in a can.

1309
03:26:08.430 --> 03:26:10.780
Boardroom: And that's how we're going to govern.

1310
03:26:11.130 --> 03:26:18.069
Boardroom: And when the police chief tells us, well, just look at the dashboard. Look, those statistics don't tell any story.

1311
03:26:18.710 --> 03:26:38.509
Boardroom: Somebody's gotta get their head in there and look at how the police are using it. And we all know damn Skippy well, too, that if the police are allowed to use pepper spray for crowd control to go after that one person, and all the rest is just collateral damage, and I say that to you as somebody who was a victim of police collateral damage and their use of tear gas.

1312
03:26:38.840 --> 03:26:41.689
Boardroom: So I don't take this lightly, and I also say this.

1313
03:26:42.660 --> 03:26:45.260
Boardroom: Poor people deserve parks, too.

1314
03:26:45.580 --> 03:26:50.789
Boardroom: And I don't know how you're gonna spend $3 million on a triangle and Dwight and Telegraph. Thanks, Andrea.

1315
03:26:57.660 --> 03:27:00.560
Boardroom: Hello, good evening, Honorable Mary Ishi.

1316
03:27:00.810 --> 03:27:15.970
Boardroom: wonderful council members, and City Manager. My name is Dr. Monique Allen. I am here representing Community Services United, who operates as the Berkeley Flea Market, which is under brand new leadership, stewarded by all female energy.

1317
03:27:16.060 --> 03:27:29.760
Boardroom: and remains committed to providing family-centered cultural activities, seasonal celebrations, music, art, and workforce opportunities through the flea market. Also, I would really like to…

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1318
03:27:30.360 --> 03:27:42.120
Boardroom: establish the fact that we appreciate this investment from each of you, as it affirms Berkeley's continued commitment to community unity, cultural preservation, and inclusive public engagement.

1319
03:27:42.610 --> 03:27:44.729
Boardroom: Thank you. Thank you.

1320
03:27:47.580 --> 03:27:49.069
Boardroom: I'm looking for candidates.

1321
03:27:50.200 --> 03:27:53.089
Boardroom: One minute. Anyone else?

1322
03:27:53.740 --> 03:27:55.549
Boardroom: Two minutes. Anyone else?

1323
03:27:56.880 --> 03:27:58.260
Boardroom: 3 minutes, I knew.

1324
03:27:58.540 --> 03:28:00.859
Boardroom: Alright, thank you, that's all I need. I appreciate you all.

1325
03:28:04.290 --> 03:28:06.319
Boardroom: So that's total 4 minutes.

1326
03:28:10.520 --> 03:28:13.890
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor, Council Members, and staff.

1327
03:28:14.400 --> 03:28:27.380
Boardroom: Residents of Berkeley, my friends, my neighbors. My name is Aiden Hill. I'm a candidate for Berkeley City Council District Number 7, a Southside resident, and a long-term renter here.

1328
03:28:27.490 --> 03:28:30.089
Boardroom: I'm asking you, please.

1329
03:28:30.240 --> 03:28:36.789
Boardroom: Pull Consent Calendar Item 6 on People's Park, and refer it back to the Housing Advisory Commission.

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1330
03:28:37.400 --> 03:28:42.389
Boardroom: Now, to be clear, Berkeley needs housing. Berkeley needs supportive housing.

1331
03:28:42.600 --> 03:28:45.660
Boardroom: But this item involves People's Park.

1332
03:28:45.770 --> 03:28:58.569
Boardroom: Public land, publicly accessible land, south side density, and a $14,359,593 spending in public housing funding.

1333
03:28:59.530 --> 03:29:09.989
Boardroom: It also comes while Berkeley faces a structural deficit of nearly $30 million, a total amount nearly half the deficit should not move forward quietly on consent.

1334
03:29:10.510 --> 03:29:15.290
Boardroom: This item has not earned community consent.

1335
03:29:16.790 --> 03:29:30.919
Boardroom: Residents found out after the Housing Advisory Commission had already acted. We wrote letters, we showed up, we asked for the item to return for public input. We were told only a commission member could place it back on the agenda. None did.

1336
03:29:31.240 --> 03:29:39.219
Boardroom: Southside has 12,195 residents, and a density of more than 63,000 people per square mile.

1337
03:29:39.420 --> 03:29:46.489
Boardroom: It is already carrying UC growth, housing pressure, service strain, and a severe shortage of public open space.

1338
03:29:46.940 --> 03:29:49.919
Boardroom: This is not opposition to housing.

1339
03:29:50.520 --> 03:30:04.509
Boardroom: It is opposition to making Southside absorb another major decision after the destruction of our urban ecology, our urban forest, the 2.8 acres of land that we had for climate change.

1340

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03:30:06.270 --> 03:30:17.209
Boardroom: Students need housing. Unhoused people need housing. Long-term residents need better housing, including myself. And, Southside needs stability.

1341
03:30:17.480 --> 03:30:29.020
Boardroom: But Southside isn't empty. Southside isn't here for corporate, aka UC Berkeley, aka a multi-billion dollar corporation that sells nuclear weapons.

1342
03:30:30.210 --> 03:30:36.230
Boardroom: You have a responsibility to your community, not to corporations.

1343
03:30:38.810 --> 03:30:40.829
Boardroom: And so, if you go forward.

1344
03:30:41.100 --> 03:30:57.169
Boardroom: with this item, if you pretend the community, the ones that were tear gassed, the ones that were arrested, the ones that were thrown onto the ground and their children had to watch them because they wanted to protect a public park, they wanted to protect a place where they had swing sets.

1345
03:30:57.830 --> 03:31:00.849
Boardroom: Where children blew bubbles in the wind.

1346
03:31:01.080 --> 03:31:03.580
Boardroom: Where we saw dragonflies.

1347
03:31:04.580 --> 03:31:14.700
Boardroom: We look outside at Strawberry Creek. You're welcome to protect that. We see San Pablo Park, Ohlone Park. You all have those parks.

1348
03:31:14.810 --> 03:31:22.229
Boardroom: But 12,000 people in this district can't have one open space that doesn't belong to UC Berkeley?

1349
03:31:22.460 --> 03:31:26.690
Boardroom: That doesn't belong to people…

1350
03:31:30.750 --> 03:31:34.980
Boardroom: If I know what I know, you will vote in favor of this tonight.

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1351
03:31:35.220 --> 03:31:47.890
Boardroom: But I want you to know that we did not give the okay. We did not agree to $14 million of our public's money being used to destroy this urban space.

1352
03:31:48.280 --> 03:31:53.600
Boardroom: We believe in the future of our children, and that means they need trees to breathe.

1353
03:31:53.710 --> 03:31:55.759
Boardroom: That means they need community.

1354
03:31:56.510 --> 03:31:58.899
Boardroom: That means they need People's Park.

1355
03:31:59.160 --> 03:32:10.200
Boardroom: So I ask you, give us a fair hearing, a fair process, bring it back to the Housing Advisory Commission. We deserve that much. Thank you.

1356
03:32:11.280 --> 03:32:12.550
Boardroom: Thank you.

1357
03:32:13.580 --> 03:32:18.109
Boardroom: Any other public comment on consent or information items only?

1358
03:32:22.160 --> 03:32:24.689
Boardroom: You have com- 5 hands raised online.

1359
03:32:25.570 --> 03:32:27.829
Boardroom: First speaker is Ruben Lozardo.

1360
03:32:31.860 --> 03:32:37.099
Ruben Lizardo: I just wanna… thank and follow on Kieran Slaughter's.

1361
03:32:37.320 --> 03:32:43.020
Ruben Lizardo: Expression of gratefulness to Mr. Terry Taplin.

1362
03:32:43.130 --> 03:32:48.810
Ruben Lizardo: his co-sponsors, the mayor, and the council, for your support of the Tommy Smith

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1363
03:32:49.290 --> 03:32:52.269
Ruben Lizardo: You tracked me, we're really grateful.

1364
03:32:52.590 --> 03:32:59.240
Ruben Lizardo: want to also, I think there are other folks from the 100 Black Men in Cal Athletics waiting to…

1365
03:32:59.410 --> 03:33:05.950
Ruben Lizardo: Also, thank you, but I also want to let you know that if you can make it to the track meet this Saturday.

1366
03:33:06.220 --> 03:33:15.620
Ruben Lizardo: at 8, you can participate in the Parade of Champions, or if you can make it at any other time, just let us know so we can introduce you to folks.

1367
03:33:15.820 --> 03:33:18.840
Ruben Lizardo: Also want to thank the Mayor and the council and the staff.

1368
03:33:19.140 --> 03:33:26.580
Ruben Lizardo: for their leadership in helping get behind the SAHA 110 units of affordable housing.

1369
03:33:26.900 --> 03:33:31.269
Ruben Lizardo: at People's Park, really grateful for that leadership, and…

1370
03:33:31.790 --> 03:33:35.630
Ruben Lizardo: the historic investment of affordable housing in the South Side.

1371
03:33:35.630 --> 03:33:36.440
Boardroom: Thank you.

1372
03:33:37.760 --> 03:33:40.909
Boardroom: Next is Cheryl Davil, a former council member.

1373
03:33:43.530 --> 03:33:51.750
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: For Juan, the records retention… is problematic.

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1374
03:33:52.100 --> 03:34:01.050
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: Specifically for legislation of previous council members, when you converted your website, you did not

1375
03:34:01.180 --> 03:34:05.489
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: All the links to legislation that were…

1376
03:34:05.590 --> 03:34:10.930
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: previously working are no longer working. So I hope you,

1377
03:34:12.500 --> 03:34:19.519
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: Seems like you should have rectified that when you did it, but, you know, you didn't, so I hope all the legislation is available.

1378
03:34:19.910 --> 03:34:23.190
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: I agree with Aiden's remarks.

1379
03:34:23.450 --> 03:34:26.589
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: As well as Andrea Pritchard.

1380
03:34:26.980 --> 03:34:43.260
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: Pepper spray should not be on the freaking consent calendar. It's… it's… it's terrible that… it's… I wish someone would have the courage to pull that SHIT off the consent calendar. It should not be on there.

1381
03:34:43.530 --> 03:34:49.000
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: People probably don't even know this is at the meeting tonight, or else that room would be…

1382
03:34:50.130 --> 03:34:52.390
Boardroom: Next is Karen Slaughter.

1383
03:34:56.600 --> 03:35:03.240

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Kieron Slaughter: Yeah, good evening, Honorable Mayor and City Council. I just want to, once again, thank you for supporting item 17, Tommy Smith Youth Track Meet.

1384
03:35:03.390 --> 03:35:16.460
Kieron Slaughter: I'm joining you, you know, from home, but I'm also a proud member of the 100 Black Men, as well as a proud member of two student-athletes at Berkeley High. And so, we're really excited to bring this signature event back home to Berkeley and Edwards Stadium.

1385
03:35:16.490 --> 03:35:35.109
Kieron Slaughter: Events like this create tremendous social and economic value for our community by bringing families, athletes, and visitors to the city, while supporting local businesses and showcasing Berkeley as a destination for youth sports. I also want to just highlight the work of the 100 Black Men of the Bay Area and the committee.

1386
03:35:35.290 --> 03:35:46.239
Kieron Slaughter: the Hunter Black Men Youth Track Meet, and just want to, once again, invite folks out there, and thanks again for the partnership with UC Berkeley and the City of Berkeley, and the sponsors of this ad.

1387
03:35:46.550 --> 03:35:47.300
Kieron Slaughter: Thank you.

1388
03:35:47.530 --> 03:35:48.870
Boardroom: Thanks, Karen.

1389
03:35:49.370 --> 03:35:52.220
Boardroom: We miss you. City of Berkeley.

1390
03:35:53.450 --> 03:35:57.750
Boardroom: Next is, caller phone number ends in 211.

1391
03:36:03.600 --> 03:36:09.220
1510****211: Daniel Erzberg was a great man. He also was a friend. I talked with him, he was just unique.

1392
03:36:09.350 --> 03:36:11.620
1510****211: Was a beautiful man, too. Very good looking.

1393
03:36:11.950 --> 03:36:24.929

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1510****211: And he actually… we need him today more than ever, because the big plan, they brought that monsterity in the White House to start World War III. Doomsday Clock, right now, his closest effort in midnight.

1394
03:36:25.170 --> 03:36:28.070
1510****211: We are in horrible, horrible shape.

1395
03:36:28.220 --> 03:36:32.180
1510****211: Meanwhile, this living piece, while we'll have life in…

1396
03:36:32.360 --> 03:36:41.570
1510****211: In the world, Berkeley and everywhere. So, let's work together. Mayor, give me a call. Have a beautiful and good night. Greatest city in the world. Thank you.

1397
03:36:42.210 --> 03:36:42.790
TELEPHONE_USER: Mike.

1398
03:36:43.010 --> 03:36:47.069
Boardroom: Thank you. Next is Tina Echeveri.

1399
03:36:50.710 --> 03:37:02.770
Tina Etcheverry: Okay, I'm unmuted. Well, first of all, thank you very much for putting this on your agenda tonight. I am Tina Echeveri. I'm the treasurer of Berkeley Rotary Endowment.

1400
03:37:02.830 --> 03:37:12.239
Tina Etcheverry: And we have organized, as a major fundraiser every year, the Taste of Downtown Berkeley, where we try to showcase the restaurants along Shattuck Avenue.

1401
03:37:12.320 --> 03:37:25.769
Tina Etcheverry: However, we've moved it to a biennial event, so the next one is in 2027. However, we still have major, financial projects going, service needs.

1402
03:37:25.800 --> 03:37:42.360
Tina Etcheverry: We have 14 scholarships that we give to Berkeley High students, and these are 4-year college scholarships. So there's… it's a major, need financially to support these, students from Berkeley High School.

1403
03:37:42.360 --> 03:37:53.450

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Tina Etcheverry: We give them to students that are low-income in their family, and usually first to college. And not only is it a scholarship, but we mentor them for the full four years.

1404
03:37:53.450 --> 03:37:53.780
Boardroom: Thank you.

1405
03:37:53.780 --> 03:37:56.160
Tina Etcheverry: We also have the Roticare Free Clinic.

1406
03:37:56.160 --> 03:37:58.530
Boardroom: Gina, thank you so much. I'm sorry your time's up.

1407
03:37:59.440 --> 03:38:02.279
Boardroom: Next is Demarcus Williams.

1408
03:38:06.050 --> 03:38:10.430
DMarcus Williams: Hello, everyone. My name is Demarcus Williams, and I

1409
03:38:10.910 --> 03:38:29.680
DMarcus Williams: run the risk of sounding redundant, but I'm actually the chair of the Tommy Smith Youth Track Meet, and it's just wonderful to be in your presence. On this evening, I just really want to thank everyone for their participation, all the council members who are donating. There's been a lot of talk about food.

1410
03:38:29.680 --> 03:38:45.529
DMarcus Williams: Right? And one element that is pretty unique to this track meet is we actually feed all of the athletes. So there's gonna be over 4,000 meals given out for free to these young athletes. This is a community event, it's not your traditional track meet.

1411
03:38:45.590 --> 03:39:02.220
DMarcus Williams: Tommy Smith, who has dedicated his life to being a humanitarian, will actually be present, so I really want to stress the opportunity for you to come out to that meet and join he and the rest of the 100 Black men in that epic, ceremonial parade.

1412
03:39:02.220 --> 03:39:12.159
DMarcus Williams: And really see where your funds and your efforts are gonna be able to make an impact over on so many people. We have nearly 50 teams and over 1,000 athletes coming out to compete.

1413

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03:39:12.160 --> 03:39:16.190
Boardroom: Thank you so much. Thanks, everyone, for your public comments.

1414
03:39:16.380 --> 03:39:24.489
Boardroom: I think that's our final one. Alright, is there a motion to approve the con… to approve the consent calendar? So moved. Second.

1415
03:39:24.600 --> 03:39:28.090
Boardroom: Alright, is there any opposition to approving the consent calendar?

1416
03:39:29.020 --> 03:39:34.349
Boardroom: Okay, we will approve that by unanimous consent. Our consent calendar is approved. Thank you all.

1417
03:39:37.870 --> 03:39:46.559
Boardroom: Okay… Sorry? Oh, yes, here. Alright, there it is. A ceremonial bang of the…

1418
03:39:47.500 --> 03:39:56.139
Boardroom: Of the gavel. Okay, so, we are now moving on to our action calendar. We have a number of public hearings this evening.

1419
03:39:56.140 --> 03:40:15.350
Boardroom: And I'm gonna start us off with number 20 to reestablishment of the Downtown Berkeley Property-Based Business Improvement District. Now, this is kind of an unusual item in the way in which we have to go about it, but I will, explain to you all the, sort of.

1420
03:40:15.350 --> 03:40:16.390
Boardroom: process.

1421
03:40:16.560 --> 03:40:35.349
Boardroom: And, I will start it off, we're gonna start it off with Eleanor. Do you… actually, I'm gonna pass it over to you, and then I can talk more about the process after. Sure. Thanks. Can you guys hear me okay? Yes. Good evening, Mayor and Council. I'm Eleanor Hollander, I'm the Manager of the Office of Economic Development here at the City of Berkeley, and tonight I have the pleasure of…

1422
03:40:35.350 --> 03:40:42.160
Boardroom: Introducing an item we've actually talked about two other times before. This is our third, meeting regarding the renewal of the downtown.

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1423
03:40:42.410 --> 03:40:51.799
Boardroom: property-based business improvement district. As many of you know, the downtown Pivot is, managed by the DBA, the Downtown Berkeley Association.

1424
03:40:51.800 --> 03:41:02.570
Boardroom: And it provides cleaning and hospitality and marketing services for Berkeley's downtown commercial district. The downtown bid was first established in 2011 for a 5-year term, and renewed in 2016 for a 10-year term.

1425
03:41:02.570 --> 03:41:07.660
Boardroom: And the item before us tonight proposes to renew the district for another 10-year period through 2036.

1426
03:41:07.830 --> 03:41:21.089
Boardroom: The authorizing legislation, for renewing a property-based business improvement district in California requires, Council to conduct a public hearing, and upon conclusion, if no majority protest exists after the tabulation of the assessment ballots.

1427
03:41:21.160 --> 03:41:37.950
Boardroom: Then you have the privilege of, considering the resolution to reestablish the downtown, PBID, and if the district is adopted, we'll also consider a contract with the DBA for 10 years to administer the management district plan of the… how many acronyms can I say? Of the PBID?

1428
03:41:37.950 --> 03:41:48.090
Boardroom: I just wanted to say one thing. Speaking of the DBA and the Downtown Berkeley Association, I wanted to extend a special thank you to John Kainer, the DBA's CEO, for his dedicated service and partnership.

1429
03:41:48.090 --> 03:41:50.590
Boardroom: Of this district since 2011.

1430
03:41:50.760 --> 03:41:51.680
Boardroom: Thank you.

1431
03:41:55.560 --> 03:42:00.550
Boardroom: Did I miss anything, Mr. Clark, in the process that I should make sure I mention?

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1432
03:42:02.680 --> 03:42:15.799
Boardroom: We're gonna go look at the ballots, but I'll turn it back to you, Mayor. That concludes my remarks. Yes, thank you very much. So, we've already opened the public hearing, we're gonna take Council questions now on this item, then we'll take public comment, then…

1433
03:42:15.800 --> 03:42:30.630
Boardroom: Council will vote to close the public hearing. The ballots will be counted in the gym, which is over by the parking lot. The public may view the process, and after the tabulation ends, the City of Clerk prepares and signs the certification.

1434
03:42:30.630 --> 03:42:47.069
Boardroom: And we will reconvene the item to accept the certified results and consider the rest of the item, which includes adopting two resolutions, one approving the down… potentially, I guess it depends on what happens with the ballots, but potentially approving the downtown property-based bid for the next 10 years.

1435
03:42:47.090 --> 03:42:50.520
Boardroom: And approving the contract with the DBA to implement the bid.

1436
03:42:50.680 --> 03:43:04.739
Boardroom: And so, what is gonna happen is they will go and count, but we will move on to the next item, so just so folks understand, we're doing a little bit of crossover tonight. Okay, so with that, are there any council questions?

1437
03:43:07.920 --> 03:43:16.899
Boardroom: Okay, is there any public comment on this item? We are on item number 20, which is reestablishment of the Downtown Berkeley Property-Based Business Improvement District.

1438
03:43:18.610 --> 03:43:21.040
Boardroom: Yes, if you have public comment, come on up.

1439
03:43:32.960 --> 03:43:34.919
Boardroom: My name is Tim Southwick.

1440
03:43:36.530 --> 03:43:42.899
Boardroom: We've been a, landowner and business operator on Shattuck Avenue for over 50 years.

1441

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03:43:43.780 --> 03:43:47.250
Boardroom: And, 10 years ago, we signed up for this project.

1442
03:43:48.190 --> 03:43:53.310
Boardroom: And, we have about $140,000 invested.

1443
03:43:54.110 --> 03:43:55.519
Boardroom: in this project.

1444
03:43:55.750 --> 03:44:04.280
Boardroom: And one main reason we like… we like what they do. They're trying very hard. We like them. We like the… like what… everything they're doing. But…

1445
03:44:04.580 --> 03:44:07.130
Boardroom: We signed up for it for graffiti.

1446
03:44:07.900 --> 03:44:15.190
Boardroom: And the… BART… our main issue is the BART station, the BART tunnels that go into the BART station.

1447
03:44:15.300 --> 03:44:16.480
Boardroom: They're filthy.

1448
03:44:16.660 --> 03:44:18.430
Boardroom: The graffiti's crazy.

1449
03:44:19.680 --> 03:44:21.820
Boardroom: They're… they're not cleaning it up.

1450
03:44:22.000 --> 03:44:23.570
Boardroom: So I have an idea.

1451
03:44:23.940 --> 03:44:36.140
Boardroom: I'll opt out of the next 10 years. Actually, I don't like 10 years, 5 years. I'll opt out of it. And our company will take it upon themselves to get rid of that graffiti. It's awful. It's an expensive project.

1452
03:44:36.410 --> 03:44:41.390
Boardroom: They say Bark's gonna come by and do it. Yeah, 10 years, they didn't come by and do it.

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1453
03:44:41.800 --> 03:44:53.330
Boardroom: So, the Downtown Association, they had a chance to do it. They didn't do it. I drive by every day and I see this. I can't stand it. I'm gonna invest the money. Our money.

1454
03:44:53.610 --> 03:45:06.140
Boardroom: to clean up the tunnels that go down. Just figure people that come from out of town, that walk up those stairs to go to the University of California, and all they see is this damn graffiti. You can't believe it.

1455
03:45:06.630 --> 03:45:24.669
Boardroom: And I'm gonna clean it up, but I need your permission. I need your permission to opt out, because I think this mission… this, ballot is gonna pass, which is fine. I don't have any problem with that. But I want to opt out, because this… cleaning up this graffiti is gonna be a big project.

1456
03:45:25.320 --> 03:45:29.520
Boardroom: And so I hope the Council will allow me to do it.

1457
03:45:30.110 --> 03:45:34.660
Boardroom: And you'll see a clean BART station that you don't have to worry about.

1458
03:45:35.040 --> 03:45:37.530
Boardroom: Thank you. Thanks for your comment.

1459
03:45:41.960 --> 03:45:55.850
Boardroom: Hello all, my name's Tom Parrish. I am the Vice Chair of the board of the Downtown Berkeley Association, and I just wanted to speak to the value of the Downtown PBID and the Downtown Berkeley Association for

1460
03:45:55.850 --> 03:46:06.149
Boardroom: what it does to keep downtown clean and safe. And as the manager of four properties for Berkeley Repertory theater downtown, I can attest to the value of those services. Thank you.

1461
03:46:06.520 --> 03:46:08.549
Boardroom: Thanks, Tom. Thanks for coming.

1462
03:46:09.300 --> 03:46:11.610

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Boardroom: Any other public comment? Oh, yes.

1463
03:46:14.500 --> 03:46:15.280
Boardroom: Indeed.

1464
03:46:15.650 --> 03:46:21.809
Boardroom: Good evening, council members. I'm Tim Southwick, Jr. You've spoken to my… heard my father this evening.

1465
03:46:22.240 --> 03:46:30.269
Boardroom: And I just want to tell you that I applaud what John Kaner and the Downtown Association has done since 2011.

1466
03:46:30.570 --> 03:46:34.890
Boardroom: However, as my father said, We're in support of the measure.

1467
03:46:35.200 --> 03:46:36.890
Boardroom: The term is too long.

1468
03:46:37.190 --> 03:46:39.080
Boardroom: 10 years is too long.

1469
03:46:39.350 --> 03:46:43.530
Boardroom: I'm in favor of Reducing the term to 5 years.

1470
03:46:43.930 --> 03:46:56.050
Boardroom: As we're committed to clean up all of the graffiti and everything that the Downtown Association does, but I implore you to look very carefully at the term of the PBID. Thank you very much.

1471
03:46:56.390 --> 03:46:57.570
Boardroom: Thank you.

1472
03:46:59.190 --> 03:47:02.000
Boardroom: Any other public comment, online?

1473
03:47:02.280 --> 03:47:09.350
Boardroom: Looks like we have two hands raised. First is… Phone number ending in 211.

1474
03:47:15.790 --> 03:47:20.909

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1510****211: Hi, I had a very good discussion within Orlando a few years ago.

1475
03:47:21.030 --> 03:47:24.349
1510****211: You know what the subject of the discussion was? She left. She really left.

1476
03:47:24.550 --> 03:47:28.099
1510****211: where my hair was at. But we need… what we need to do

1477
03:47:28.200 --> 03:47:38.460
1510****211: Why in the hell do we have all of this empty, vacant, retail spaces all over Telegraph, Chadac, San Pablo, University Avenue, when this could be thriving businesses?

1478
03:47:38.900 --> 03:47:48.539
1510****211: Why don't the city do what they did years ago, but find its landlords? What in the hell are they doing using our own land, our own city?

1479
03:47:48.920 --> 03:47:50.909
1510****211: Drive business out of town.

1480
03:47:51.450 --> 03:47:57.080
1510****211: Please consider that very carefully. Again, Eleanor, hi. Perhaps we could meet sometime soon.

1481
03:47:57.190 --> 03:48:02.529
1510****211: You can be a very good person, to have a talk with. Thank you, have a good night.

1482
03:48:03.900 --> 03:48:04.830
Boardroom: Thank you.

1483
03:48:05.310 --> 03:48:10.289
Boardroom: Next is, Cheryl Davila, a former council member.

1484
03:48:15.000 --> 03:48:19.879
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: Excuse me, this is a no-bid contract.

1485
03:48:20.600 --> 03:48:36.139

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Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: It should not be for 10 years. I see 33,558,899 million… million dollars for this con… 10-year contract.

1486
03:48:37.040 --> 03:48:47.250
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: That is so ridiculous. I'm sure you could do better when you're facing a $30 million deficit.

1487
03:48:47.680 --> 03:49:01.100
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: Come on, now, this is ridiculous. And I don't even know if they'd do that great of a job. And if they did, they… if they're gonna… you're gonna pay them that much, they should be doing the whole city, not just the downtown.

1488
03:49:01.700 --> 03:49:08.869
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: Because that's a lot of money, and it's a lot of money that really is not justifiable at this day and time.

1489
03:49:09.350 --> 03:49:17.769
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: just like all the other actions that you do are not justifiable at this day and time. You haven't done anything about the arms embargo.

1490
03:49:17.880 --> 03:49:26.579
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: You haven't said no to fascism, racism, Zionism, And the genocide continues.

1491
03:49:26.750 --> 03:49:39.289
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: But you guys aren't remorseful, but hopefully you won't be here for that long, because it is an election year, and please do vote, everyone. Vote Pamela Price for DA,

1492
03:49:39.470 --> 03:49:46.970
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: Butch Ware for governor. His name wasn't on it because it was an orchestrated attack to keep his name off.

1493
03:49:47.310 --> 03:49:50.870
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: So, right wherein on the ballot?

1494
03:49:51.840 --> 03:49:54.280

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Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: And stop talking.

1495
03:49:54.640 --> 03:50:00.030
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: While I'm talking, pay… at least try to pretend like you're paying attention.

1496
03:50:01.630 --> 03:50:03.330
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: That's really sad.

1497
03:50:03.630 --> 03:50:18.250
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: how you guys play games, and you know what? I noticed that also, people have told me that when I speak, you don't have me on camera when I'm in the room at the podium. What kind of shenanigans is that? Everybody should be treated equally.

1498
03:50:18.250 --> 03:50:18.570
Boardroom: Thanks.

1499
03:50:18.570 --> 03:50:19.270
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: Under…

1500
03:50:20.390 --> 03:50:21.970
Boardroom: Thanks for your comments.

1501
03:50:22.980 --> 03:50:24.579
Boardroom: Any other public comments?

1502
03:50:24.760 --> 03:50:39.790
Boardroom: That's it. Okay, very good. Thank you all so much. So, can we have a motion to close the public hearing? Wait, I'm sorry, give me one second. Yeah, I was gonna say, we did council questions, but…

1503
03:50:39.900 --> 03:50:43.269
Boardroom: What's not on my list is comments.

1504
03:50:46.950 --> 03:50:52.200
Boardroom: on the bid itself, so… I think we should take comments, and then we'll close.

1505
03:50:52.470 --> 03:50:58.220

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Boardroom: Or we could close and then take comments, doesn't really matter. Let's close… is there a motion to close? Second.

1506
03:50:59.730 --> 03:51:04.360
Boardroom: Can we take… is there any opposition to closing the public hearing?

1507
03:51:04.930 --> 03:51:07.700
Boardroom: Okay, we will close the public hearing then.

1508
03:51:07.850 --> 03:51:14.599
Boardroom: That was for you. Okay, go ahead, do you want to speak? Yeah, thank you so much, and, thanks, Director Hollander and everyone.

1509
03:51:14.680 --> 03:51:29.389
Boardroom: I just want to say, you know, this isn't my district, but I have had the pleasure and honor of getting to know the folks in the DBA and work with them, and, you know, some of us have partnered on things over the years, and John, I want to thank you so much.

1510
03:51:29.490 --> 03:51:36.010
Boardroom: And I want to say thank you to Matt Jervis and everybody, Hurdy, the ambassadors, Tom from the rep.

1511
03:51:36.130 --> 03:51:42.669
Boardroom: And, I mean, y'all are more than welcome to do the whole city. If you could find a way to do that, well, we'd be happy to have you.

1512
03:51:42.840 --> 03:51:54.099
Boardroom: But I want to just thank you all for what you do for the downtown, and for your advocacy for all of our commercial districts, and just, I, you know, it's your vote, and it's your… just for the record.

1513
03:51:55.180 --> 03:52:08.489
Boardroom: we're not spending any money, this is their money that they're spending. So, thank you for doing that as well. And whatever you all decide, I just hope we can continue working together. Thank you. Thank you. Yeah, Councilmember… or Vice Mayor Trey Gubb.

1514
03:52:09.220 --> 03:52:18.470
Boardroom: Thank you so much. First of all, to the gentleman who spoke about concerns with graffiti at the BART station,

1515

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03:52:18.490 --> 03:52:34.609
Boardroom: My Chief of Staff is here. We're happy to connect you with the BART director and our point… staff point of contact there. I want to, just echo, Councilmember Kaplan's comments,

1516
03:52:36.010 --> 03:52:37.880
Boardroom: one, in…

1517
03:52:38.270 --> 03:52:51.740
Boardroom: In the 23 months that I have been in office as the downtown representative, one of my most joyful and proudest, parts of the job

1518
03:52:51.920 --> 03:53:08.399
Boardroom: was spending a lot of time at, with John and his entire team, whether it's at Downtown Berkeley Association monthly meetings, our one-on-ones, and just in general,

1519
03:53:08.840 --> 03:53:15.640
Boardroom: I… the downtown Berkeley community is so fortunate,

1520
03:53:15.640 --> 03:53:34.770
Boardroom: to have, you at the helm, John, as well as, all the members of the DBA team, some of whom are here, tonight, and, just very excited to hopefully be able to move this forward for 10 more years.

1521
03:53:36.240 --> 03:53:38.979
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Any other comments from Councilmembers?

1522
03:53:39.690 --> 03:54:03.139
Boardroom: I just want to add my thanks. John is just an incredible advocate for the downtown. He's been an amazing partner on so many different projects, and my office has been really focused on supporting our business districts, and just generally our local businesses, and John's advocacy in making sure we have vibrant storefronts, supported businesses, clean streets.

1523
03:54:03.150 --> 03:54:13.139
Boardroom: And also serving our unhoused population is just really… it's admirable. So, John, just please know that, I really see all the work that you do, and just, just…

1524
03:54:13.140 --> 03:54:30.849
Boardroom: totally, based on my own experiences, I… I was recently… I had guests visiting, and they… they saw a glass bottle that had broken, and a

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traffic light, and literally, we walked around the block, came back, and the glass had been picked up, and I just think that that really just, illustrates so beautifully how much work that…

1525
03:54:30.850 --> 03:54:38.390
Boardroom: people are doing to keep our streets clean, so thank you so much to your ambassadors and all the work that's going into the work that you're doing.

1526
03:54:38.430 --> 03:54:56.959
Boardroom: We want to continue to make sure that our downtown businesses and all of our business districts are being supported. So, thank you all very much. Okay, so, we've already closed the public hearing, the ballots are going to be counted in the gym, and then we will return back to this item. So, in the meantime, thank you very much, Eleanor.

1527
03:54:57.020 --> 03:55:02.260
Boardroom: And in the meantime, we will move on to item 21.

1528
03:55:03.380 --> 03:55:19.989
Boardroom: Which is the proposed FY2027, FY2028 biennial budget, and proposed biennial budget public hearing number one. I sort of want to give us 5 minutes, just so you can have staff come in and get settled, and we can take a quick stretch break. So we will be back in 5.

1529
03:55:28.890 --> 03:55:32.919
Boardroom: Okay, thank you everyone so much for your patience.

1530
03:55:32.920 --> 03:55:52.680
Boardroom: We are going to open the public hearing for item number 21, which is the proposed FY2027 and FY2028 biennial budget and proposed biennial budget public hearing number 1. I will pass it over to our city manager and ask that everyone quiet down, please. Thank you. Sorry.

1531
03:55:53.120 --> 03:55:54.190
Boardroom: Thank you, Mayor.

1532
03:55:56.010 --> 03:56:09.410
Boardroom: As you all know, we have a significant structural budget deficit. We've talked about it quite a number of times with the Budget and Finance Committee. We've talked about it with all of the city staff a number of times.

1533
03:56:09.690 --> 03:56:12.679

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Boardroom: You've seen the reports that are in front of you tonight.

1534
03:56:12.810 --> 03:56:15.999
Boardroom: So tonight we will go through…

1535
03:56:16.440 --> 03:56:19.940
Boardroom: Both the budget balancing plan, which focuses

1536
03:56:20.140 --> 03:56:25.509
Boardroom: Mostly on the general fund part of the budget, but we will also cover the full budget.

1537
03:56:25.920 --> 03:56:29.899
Boardroom: All funds, and all positions, and so…

1538
03:56:30.060 --> 03:56:42.900
Boardroom: It's a fairly long presentation, we'll try to not belabor it too much, but we do want to, we do want to do it justice and, speak about it in a fair, fairly high level of detail.

1539
03:56:43.360 --> 03:56:56.630
Boardroom: we're… this is our first budget hearing with you. Our goal is that we would bring this back June 23rd for adoption, and there would be iterative steps between now and then with the Budget and Finance Committee and coming back here as well.

1540
03:56:56.880 --> 03:57:12.330
Boardroom: And so, presenting the budget tonight will be Budget Manager Marikar Dupaya and our Deputy City Manager, David White. We also have all of our department heads either here in the room or online if there's more detailed questions about those budgets.

1541
03:57:12.420 --> 03:57:16.940
Boardroom: So, with that, I will pass it over to Marikhar to start us off.

1542
03:57:17.920 --> 03:57:20.429
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor and Council Members.

1543
03:57:21.810 --> 03:57:29.500
Boardroom: Thank you. So tonight, we are going to propose, present the proposed fiscal year 27 and 28.

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1544
03:57:29.630 --> 03:57:32.400
Boardroom: Biannual budget to the full council.

1545
03:57:33.950 --> 03:57:42.150
Boardroom: First, we're gonna give you the big picture situational overview, then we're gonna go and move on to the summary of our general fund.

1546
03:57:43.490 --> 03:57:44.570
Boardroom: Thank you.

1547
03:57:45.520 --> 03:57:51.610
Boardroom: After that, we'll move on to all funds, which is our overall budget for the city for the next 2 years.

1548
03:57:51.730 --> 03:57:58.550
Boardroom: We're gonna talk about our proposed, 27-28 staffing, next steps, and of course, discussion.

1549
03:58:06.930 --> 03:58:09.650
Boardroom: Fiscal context, impacts, and unknowns.

1550
03:58:09.780 --> 03:58:22.579
Boardroom: We've mentioned this several times, but it's worth repeating that we are experiencing a structural deficit, not only in the general fund, but also in other funds, and some examples of that are parking, marina.

1551
03:58:23.040 --> 03:58:23.880
Boardroom: Oops.

1552
03:58:24.070 --> 03:58:25.870
Boardroom: and our CIP.

1553
03:58:26.620 --> 03:58:32.719
Boardroom: There's rising costs in personnel, pension, healthcare, and liability insurance, and that's nothing new.

1554
03:58:32.930 --> 03:58:39.510
Boardroom: There's labor negotiations that are unknowns. Inflation, which is coming back with a vengeance.

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1555
03:58:39.750 --> 03:58:42.510
Boardroom: Reliance on one-time sources.

1556
03:58:42.950 --> 03:58:47.570
Boardroom: We're also waiting still on our year-end results for fiscal year 26.

1557
03:58:47.720 --> 03:59:00.079
Boardroom: We have deferred maintenance and significant unfunded infrastructure needs, which we just talked about in our special meeting. Increased service demands and community expectations.

1558
03:59:00.560 --> 03:59:14.160
Boardroom: and the November 2026 ballot measures. I want to pause a little bit here and talk about not just the two local ones that we discussed earlier today at the special meeting, which is the gold bond for infrastructure, as well as the,

1559
03:59:14.380 --> 03:59:23.200
Boardroom: Use tax and sales tax. But there's also a state ballot that has garnered enough signatures?

1560
03:59:23.550 --> 03:59:31.190
Boardroom: And we'll be on the ballot this November, and it's called the, local taxpayer protection.

1561
03:59:31.530 --> 03:59:34.890
Boardroom: And that has 3 components. First one is…

1562
03:59:35.270 --> 03:59:42.910
Boardroom: It's now going to require two-thirds supermajority vote to pass any citizen initiative tax measures.

1563
03:59:43.710 --> 03:59:49.440
Boardroom: There's also going to be… A really strict restriction on property transfer taxes.

1564
03:59:49.880 --> 03:59:52.480
Boardroom: And it cannot go above state-level rates?

1565
03:59:52.810 --> 03:59:55.369
Boardroom: And lastly, the third component is…

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1566
03:59:56.110 --> 04:00:02.420
Boardroom: It will repeal any property taxes that were passed Two years prior.

1567
04:00:05.470 --> 04:00:10.069
Boardroom: And last, but certainly not least on this list is our state.

1568
04:00:10.190 --> 04:00:17.829
Boardroom: And federal revenue limitations, as well as our chaotic economic and political uncertainty.

1569
04:00:24.490 --> 04:00:31.909
Boardroom: So, I've heard this asked before, have we faced deficits before, and how did we avoid large-scale reductions?

1570
04:00:32.180 --> 04:00:37.290
Boardroom: This slide's specifically to address that, and the short answer is yes, we have.

1571
04:00:37.700 --> 04:00:43.110
Boardroom: So from fiscal year 17 through 2026, we took about a 10-year look back.

1572
04:00:43.400 --> 04:00:49.099
Boardroom: And city costs grew faster than revenues, so average growth of the last 10 years.

1573
04:00:49.220 --> 04:00:55.590
Boardroom: 8%, growth in expenses, and 6.5% growth

1574
04:00:55.890 --> 04:01:11.450
Boardroom: In revenue, and that's actually skewing the average a little bit, because in fiscal year 2022, we had that one large anomaly of our, property transfer taxes reaching $40 million, so that was, like, a 24% increase in our general fund revenue.

1575
04:01:12.750 --> 04:01:24.729
Boardroom: COVID-19 shifted our economic landscape for the city and for the whole world, actually. The city balanced our budgets by using temporary, one-time measures.

1576

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04:01:25.120 --> 04:01:32.019
Boardroom: This is not an exhaustive list, but some examples of those balancing measures were using, ARPA funds.

1577
04:01:33.370 --> 04:01:44.280
Boardroom: the property transfer taxes that I just spoke of, Hiring freezes, project deferrals, Use the fund balances, reserves.

1578
04:01:44.440 --> 04:01:47.269
Boardroom: And transfer in from other funds.

1579
04:01:47.840 --> 04:01:53.760
Boardroom: Now, these approaches never address the underlying structural deficit of the general fund.

1580
04:01:54.380 --> 04:02:01.909
Boardroom: And although budgets were, on paper, technically balanced, Expenses continued to outpace revenues.

1581
04:02:07.020 --> 04:02:13.440
Boardroom: This slide goes into more details of the type of balancing measures that we did for those 10 years.

1582
04:02:13.720 --> 04:02:32.169
Boardroom: So for 2018-19, we had a deficit of about $10 million, and that was resolved by resetting property transfer tax baseline. Originally, at that time, it was, $12.5 million. It got reset to $10 million so that we could have $2.5 million more for operating.

1583
04:02:32.560 --> 04:02:38.360
Boardroom: Transfers from other funds, increased, transfers to other funds decreased.

1584
04:02:38.850 --> 04:02:43.139
Boardroom: In 2021, $40 million was the estimated deficit.

1585
04:02:43.370 --> 04:02:47.920
Boardroom: And that was addressed through, hiring freezes, no capital investments.

1586
04:02:48.390 --> 04:02:52.849
Boardroom: And the use of our, reserves, $11 million.

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1587
04:02:53.390 --> 04:03:01.360
Boardroom: In 2022, $27 million, and that was when we utilized $23 million of that, of the ARPA funds.

1588
04:03:01.890 --> 04:03:06.890
Boardroom: Deferment of large capital projects, equipment purchases, and new projects.

1589
04:03:08.070 --> 04:03:14.090
Boardroom: In 2023, $22 million, we used fund balance and salary savings from vacancies.

1590
04:03:14.710 --> 04:03:19.560
Boardroom: 2024, $12 million, the same balancing measures.

1591
04:03:19.790 --> 04:03:27.279
Boardroom: 2025, $17 million. We used the same balancing measures, but we also added the use of the Section 115 trust.

1592
04:03:27.460 --> 04:03:33.149
Boardroom: And taking a workers' comp holiday, meaning that the general fund did not contribute into the workers' comp fund.

1593
04:03:33.780 --> 04:03:47.570
Boardroom: Fiscal year 2026, the most recent one that we addressed, $29 million. There was an increase in the general fund revenue projection. There was a use of the Section 115 trust again, a workers' comp fund.

1594
04:03:47.790 --> 04:03:55.030
Boardroom: IT cost allocation, small sites reallocation, and the freezing of 45 vacant positions.

1595
04:03:55.300 --> 04:03:59.399
Boardroom: Which will… Come into the conversation later on.

1596
04:04:04.270 --> 04:04:10.340
Boardroom: For the 27 and 28 budget development process, we knew that we were going to have a structural deficit.

1597
04:04:10.660 --> 04:04:16.849
Boardroom: However, we wanted to approach developing the general fund baseline a little bit differently than in the past.

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1598
04:04:17.120 --> 04:04:25.259
Boardroom: So what we've done, instead of just copying prior, base… prior adopted budgets, we actually looked at actual expenditures.

1599
04:04:25.390 --> 04:04:42.260
Boardroom: look back about 4 years, and asked the departments not just to look at the 4 years' actuals, but look ahead to see what their actual needs are. And that's how we developed the baseline budget. Hopefully, this will eliminate inefficiencies and replace outdated budgets.

1600
04:04:42.360 --> 04:04:48.570
Boardroom: And this was, based on data-driven spending patterns and the real costs of services.

1601
04:04:49.630 --> 04:04:55.949
Boardroom: The updated general fund baseline for overtime, hourly, and non-personnel expenses reflects this approach.

1602
04:04:56.750 --> 04:05:00.960
Boardroom: For the baseline, our personnel assumptions includes the following.

1603
04:05:01.270 --> 04:05:08.579
Boardroom: There's a cost of living increase for miscellaneous employees, but for fiscal year 2027 only.

1604
04:05:08.780 --> 04:05:11.260
Boardroom: Because it reflects current MOU.

1605
04:05:12.290 --> 04:05:15.909
Boardroom: There is no COLA in fiscal year 2028 at all.

1606
04:05:16.070 --> 04:05:19.909
Boardroom: This is subject to change depending on labor negotiations.

1607
04:05:20.490 --> 04:05:24.890
Boardroom: Their step and pay ban increases for all eligible employees.

1608
04:05:25.450 --> 04:05:31.060
Boardroom: All ad pays associated with employees and specific classifications are there.

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1609
04:05:31.180 --> 04:05:32.730
Boardroom: in the projection.

1610
04:05:33.120 --> 04:05:37.830
Boardroom: Increases to all benefits, and the majority of that is from health and pension costs.

1611
04:05:38.250 --> 04:05:43.309
Boardroom: A good example is our health costs increased 10% from 26.

1612
04:05:43.440 --> 04:05:46.390
Boardroom: And 12% from 27th to 28.

1613
04:05:47.310 --> 04:05:50.109
Boardroom: Vacant positions are budgeted at Step 1.

1614
04:05:50.510 --> 04:05:57.200
Boardroom: And the frozen positions, as part of the 2026 mid-annual budget update,

1615
04:05:57.730 --> 04:06:02.779
Boardroom: are not budgeted also in 27 and 28, and that's a total of 45 FTEs.

1616
04:06:06.460 --> 04:06:14.949
Boardroom: The budget process continues. So after we developed the baseline, we knew that we had a deficit, and we had a more revised deficit.

1617
04:06:15.240 --> 04:06:23.709
Boardroom: So, our budget balancing framework Was there was a citywide effort for a 10% to 12.5% general fund reduction.

1618
04:06:24.060 --> 04:06:28.749
Boardroom: And other funds that also had structural deficits.

1619
04:06:28.980 --> 04:06:35.050
Boardroom: We're asked to also come up with reduction plans, and there were also revenue-generating ideas.

1620

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04:06:36.330 --> 04:06:53.229
Boardroom: So the general fund deficit ranged from $31.3 million in fiscal year 2027 to $29.5 million in fiscal year 28, and this is after the revenue and expenditure adjustments have been made. And there's a separate slide to go into that in more detail.

1621
04:06:53.490 --> 04:06:58.719
Boardroom: This includes strategic cost shifts, non-departmental, and other budget refinements.

1622
04:06:59.020 --> 04:07:03.650
Boardroom: Required debt service support, and parking fund stabilization.

1623
04:07:04.560 --> 04:07:17.990
Boardroom: Use of one-time resources. Before I go into this, I want to, explain where we're getting this one-time resource from. $4.17 million of that is coming from, what we call operating reserves.

1624
04:07:18.100 --> 04:07:31.539
Boardroom: But it's actually, came from the AA01 excess equity calculation, and it's just a fiscal year 2025 unassigned fund balance. We had the foresight to put that aside, because we knew we had to balance this deficit.

1625
04:07:32.210 --> 04:07:36.590
Boardroom: About $7.8 million of that came from the dissolution of

1626
04:07:37.860 --> 04:07:46.710
Boardroom: Excuse me, really development, about $7.8 million, and that was, came from, the finance director's, projection.

1627
04:07:46.990 --> 04:07:49.269
Boardroom: For fiscal year 2026.

1628
04:07:49.990 --> 04:07:59.560
Boardroom: And that is being utilized, for the following. $2.1 million in one-time funds used to smooth out the deficit, because we have two very different.

1629
04:07:59.560 --> 04:08:11.429
Boardroom: deficit amounts to solve for in 27 and 28. $9.4 million of that is used to sustain services for public safety and youth and adult programs in fiscal year

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1630
04:08:11.790 --> 04:08:14.480
Boardroom: 2027 until the outcome of the,

1631
04:08:14.620 --> 04:08:19.110
Boardroom: potential sales and use tax measure in 20… November 2026.

1632
04:08:19.290 --> 04:08:24.459
Boardroom: And about half a million dollars is allocated to employees impacted by the budget balancing plan.

1633
04:08:25.260 --> 04:08:28.189
Boardroom: The 2027 revenue projection,

1634
04:08:28.700 --> 04:08:37.239
Boardroom: It's also reflected, the sales and use tax measure. Additional budget reductions will be needed if it does not pass.

1635
04:08:38.140 --> 04:08:49.519
Boardroom: So, building the baseline, balancing the budget, now we're on to the proposed budget, and that's what we're gonna talk about, tonight. And there'll be several other discussions after this.

1636
04:08:52.850 --> 04:08:56.219
Boardroom: General Fund Budget Balancing Phase, this is what…

1637
04:08:56.720 --> 04:09:09.520
Boardroom: happened, really briefly. I'll just go over 2027, because 28 is very similar. So, the initial estimate of general fund deficit in 27 was about $32.3 million.

1638
04:09:09.940 --> 04:09:27.560
Boardroom: The additional income from the revenue projection that came from the finance department on February 2026, we netted about $5.1 million. So the revised deficit after the revenue projection, our deficit came down to about $27.14 million.

1639
04:09:27.930 --> 04:09:37.749
Boardroom: We adjusted it to rev… We adjusted… there were some adjustments made, and so we looked at to see what are some of the things, organizationally that we needed to address.

1640
04:09:38.010 --> 04:09:51.409

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Boardroom: And one of that was that we have a debt service payment for 1947 Center Street that, if we don't pay, could impact our ability to borrow in future years. And 1947 Center Street is one of those funds that are stressed.

1641
04:09:51.810 --> 04:10:04.869
Boardroom: So, we allocated $1.6 million towards that of the general fund. There's also the parking fund stabilization, about $1.05 million. Those are also two funds that are stressed.

1642
04:10:05.420 --> 04:10:10.420
Boardroom: Other adjustments to non-departmental that happens to any regular budget cycle?

1643
04:10:11.440 --> 04:10:20.289
Boardroom: And with all of those adjustments, the total deficit, before using one-time resources went up to $31.35 million in 2027.

1644
04:10:21.780 --> 04:10:32.659
Boardroom: And the use of one-time resources of $2.1 million, and that is to smooth out the two years. It's hard to, balance a budget when they're very different.

1645
04:10:32.710 --> 04:10:48.050
Boardroom: In two years, so we wanted to just kind of come up with very similar plans for both. So, using the one-time resource, the general fund deficit after revenue and expenditure adjustment came down to $29.3 in 27 and 29.5 in 28.

1646
04:10:53.190 --> 04:10:57.840
Boardroom: So, given all of this, what has… what have we been focusing on?

1647
04:10:58.150 --> 04:11:03.640
Boardroom: To come up with this, balancing plan and this proposed budget.

1648
04:11:03.780 --> 04:11:09.379
Boardroom: So the goal has always been, it's a recurring, sustainable, structurally balanced budget.

1649
04:11:09.800 --> 04:11:15.769
Boardroom: Prioritize core services. Reduce reliance on one-time, short-term budget balancing measures.

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1650
04:11:16.140 --> 04:11:19.449
Boardroom: Match one-time resources to one-time needs.

1651
04:11:21.310 --> 04:11:24.850
Boardroom: Take proactive steps on the factors we can control.

1652
04:11:25.420 --> 04:11:28.449
Boardroom: Ensure long-term fiscal stability.

1653
04:11:29.190 --> 04:11:33.740
Boardroom: Pursue revenue enhancements and alternative funding sources whenever feasible.

1654
04:11:34.140 --> 04:11:37.319
Boardroom: And live within our values, and live within our means.

1655
04:11:46.320 --> 04:11:48.600
Boardroom: Program, service, and staffing impacts.

1656
04:11:49.090 --> 04:11:53.969
Boardroom: So, despite nearly $30 million in general fund reductions each year.

1657
04:11:54.100 --> 04:12:03.319
Boardroom: With reductions in several special funds, the city relied on its values and prioritized Minimizing impacts to the following.

1658
04:12:03.520 --> 04:12:09.720
Boardroom: Core and essential services, including safety net services, Community well-being.

1659
04:12:10.380 --> 04:12:13.830
Boardroom: Service continuity, and workforce stability.

1660
04:12:14.630 --> 04:12:20.499
Boardroom: And at the same time, the city also focused on strengthening the city's long-term fiscal foundation.

1661
04:12:21.420 --> 04:12:24.390
Boardroom: Achieving Structurally Balanced Budget.

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1662
04:12:24.930 --> 04:12:29.810
Boardroom: While the impacts of the balancing plan and this proposed budget are significant.

1663
04:12:30.270 --> 04:12:34.889
Boardroom: The city conducted due diligence to mitigate effects wherever possible.

1664
04:12:37.220 --> 04:12:50.659
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor and Council, and I won't… I'm gonna, take a little bit of time to talk about, the impacts of our budget balancing plan, and so we'll go through this in some, detail, but not too much detail.

1665
04:12:50.840 --> 04:12:56.189
Boardroom: But before I do that, I just want to talk a little bit about, the work around,

1666
04:12:56.580 --> 04:13:04.969
Boardroom: Addressing homelessness in our community and what we've done with this budget to help, do our best to continue to fund this work and prioritize this work.

1667
04:13:05.210 --> 04:13:14.389
Boardroom: So, what I want to comment on in the context of this budget is that resources are allocated for a very broad and comprehensive approach to addressing homelessness.

1668
04:13:14.460 --> 04:13:30.740
Boardroom: So this includes continuing to support outreach, shelters, our public works teams that's out in the field addressing community impacts, all the work that is so very important, to moving the needle on homelessness. We continue to do our best to support and fund.

1669
04:13:31.900 --> 04:13:42.559
Boardroom: When we came to you last fall, we brought forward a presentation, under the leadership of Peter Perdue to talk about, our comprehensive approach to addressing homelessness.

1670
04:13:42.700 --> 04:13:57.189
Boardroom: And in that presentation, one of the things that we talked about was the fiscal cliff that we were confronting in being able to support our motel programs, a very vital component to providing shelter to help people bridge into permanent supportive housing.

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1671
04:13:57.500 --> 04:14:08.310
Boardroom: And we had, brought forward and admitted that we understood that we had two motels of the three that we were supporting, that we're gonna run out of funding in fiscal year 2027.

1672
04:14:08.450 --> 04:14:16.930
Boardroom: And the two that we were specifically worried about were the Beyond Horizon program down on San Pablo, and the Campus Motel on University Avenue.

1673
04:14:17.260 --> 04:14:26.859
Boardroom: And one of the things that I think we can see as a bright spot in this budget is that we're able to preserve funding for one of those two motels, and that's the Beyond Horizon Motel.

1674
04:14:27.380 --> 04:14:36.309
Boardroom: However, because of our deficit, there are reductions that are proposed in our work to address homelessness, and so I just want to talk about those for a moment.

1675
04:14:36.920 --> 04:14:47.049
Boardroom: So, we do propose eliminating the city share, for the outreach worker, that is, supported and led by the Downtown Business Association.

1676
04:14:47.410 --> 04:15:06.309
Boardroom: The Seasonal Winter Shelter Program, is a resource we also proposed, not moving forward with in the coming fiscal years. This is a program, that has moved around over time. In the past most recent history, it was a program that was operated out of Old City Hall, Model Chirac.

1677
04:15:06.540 --> 04:15:19.890
Boardroom: In this past fiscal year, or past calendar year, it was moved to a location in Emeryville. And that was done so because Old City Hall is not habitable and appropriate, for individuals to sleep in and live in.

1678
04:15:20.290 --> 04:15:30.919
Boardroom: Unfortunately, the Emerville location is no longer available to us, and so, we do not have another location for this program, and so we are proposing to eliminate the funding for this program.

1679
04:15:31.070 --> 04:15:38.260

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Boardroom: However, we do have continued support for the inclement weather shelter program, and that will continue to operate under the purview of our budget.

1680
04:15:38.930 --> 04:15:45.339
Boardroom: The social service specialist position that was, funding was provided for in the last fiscal year budget.

1681
04:15:45.630 --> 04:15:51.100
Boardroom: That position is vacant. Unfortunately, we are proposing to eliminate that position as well.

1682
04:15:51.650 --> 04:15:59.930
Boardroom: Also, we're proposing to, reduce funding for the Back Stair Center, that's a program down on 2nd Street, by about $200,000.

1683
04:15:59.990 --> 04:16:18.290
Boardroom: We think that reduction in funding matches a right-sizing of the program. They went through some extensive renovations over the past year, and unfortunately have had to reduce capacity, and so we think that this reduction in funding, does match more with what their capacity, currently is projected to be.

1684
04:16:18.920 --> 04:16:24.690
Boardroom: In addition to that, in order to keep programs funded, we are proposing some strategic reallocations of funding.

1685
04:16:24.920 --> 04:16:38.140
Boardroom: For the Boss Step Up Housing Program on University Avenue, we're proposing to reallocate funding out of the General Fund into another general fund revenue stream that is, accounted for as a separate fund, and that's Measure U1.

1686
04:16:38.500 --> 04:16:48.320
Boardroom: And also, we are proposing to reallocate a portion of the funding for the Backstair program into a state revenue source, permanent local housing program, PLHA.

1687
04:16:50.250 --> 04:17:01.599
Boardroom: I do want to comment a little bit on Measure U1 and how we're proposing to allocate resources under Measure U1, and this chart summarizes a line item budget, for that program.

1688
04:17:01.770 --> 04:17:19.490

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Boardroom: So, just to remind everyone, the revenue stream that we get from that last year was budgeted about $6.5 million. Those revenues have been re-evaluated, under the leadership of our finance director, and we now anticipate about $6.6 million in annual revenue stream under Measure U1.

1689
04:17:19.960 --> 04:17:35.689
Boardroom: You can see the personnel breakdown on this slide. In addition to that, from a programmatic perspective, there are annual allocations attributed to the Housing Trust Fund. We have a very robust affordable housing project portfolio, about 1,500 units in the pipeline.

1690
04:17:35.770 --> 04:17:53.280
Boardroom: There are many different, revenue streams that support that, robust pipeline. However, we understand that, you know, cost of construction, cost of labor go up, and so this allocation is important to make sure that there are resources to help support the affordable housing pipeline that this Council has committed to.

1691
04:17:53.960 --> 04:18:07.649
Boardroom: There are resource allocations for two projects here as well. These were actually resources that were allocated in last year's budget, but were not spent, so we're merely proposing to carry those forward, both for 1740 San Pablo and Ephesians Court.

1692
04:18:07.990 --> 04:18:13.380
Boardroom: And then you can see some of the other categories here as well. I already mentioned Boss Step Up Housing.

1693
04:18:13.510 --> 04:18:22.850
Boardroom: There's capacity building for emerging developers, and our Health, Housing, and Community Services Department issued an RFP for this program in this past fiscal year.

1694
04:18:23.410 --> 04:18:36.380
Boardroom: We continue to have resources allocated to Eviction Defense Center and East Bay Community Law Center, all about, you know, doing all the work that possibly can be done to assist people from becoming homeless.

1695
04:18:37.080 --> 04:18:45.770
Boardroom: We also propose, the third motel that I did not talk about before was the Capri Motel. This motel is also on University Avenue.

1696
04:18:45.860 --> 04:18:59.699

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Boardroom: And we previously were funding this with state, ERF funds. We also have a city match involved in those, and so, we proposed to use in fiscal year 27, we are responsible for half a year of funding.

1697
04:18:59.900 --> 04:19:10.670
Boardroom: For the lease, we're proposing to use Measure U1 resources in fiscal year 27, and then continuing to use general fund resources in fiscal year 28 for that motel program.

1698
04:19:10.970 --> 04:19:19.409
Boardroom: And there's a small amount of money as well for flexible funds to assist people with various needs to keep them housed, rental assistance, utility payments, etc.

1699
04:19:19.750 --> 04:19:26.209
Boardroom: So that outlines the totality of Measure U1 as proposed for fiscal year 27 and 28.

1700
04:19:28.150 --> 04:19:33.560
Boardroom: Now, I want to go through a number of different slides to talk a bit about the budget balancing plan.

1701
04:19:33.780 --> 04:19:43.189
Boardroom: So, this budget balancing plan was, presented to our workforce on April 15th. Our city manager led an all-employee webinar.

1702
04:19:43.530 --> 04:19:49.759
Boardroom: We also then, presented this to the Budget and Finance Policy Committee on April 16th.

1703
04:19:50.010 --> 04:19:56.699
Boardroom: And I'm not going to go through the totality of that presentation, but I do want to talk about some of the impacts

1704
04:19:56.880 --> 04:20:01.849
Boardroom: About… amongst the various departments, that are in front of you this evening.

1705
04:20:01.950 --> 04:20:04.930
Boardroom: So first, I want to talk about the police department.

1706
04:20:05.240 --> 04:20:15.860

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Boardroom: And I think as everyone here knows, the police department is a personnel-driven organization that not only works to proactively address public safety, but they also respond to calls for service.

1707
04:20:16.100 --> 04:20:23.710
Boardroom: And over the past 5 years, the police department has been very busy. They've responded to nearly 62,000 calls for service.

1708
04:20:24.450 --> 04:20:30.939
Boardroom: And as you all know, when a call to 911 comes in, we have an obligation to respond.

1709
04:20:31.540 --> 04:20:46.780
Boardroom: The proposed 10% reduction in the police department requires significant personnel reductions that materially reduces public safety service levels and compromises the department's specialized units to respond effectively to community needs.

1710
04:20:46.990 --> 04:20:49.820
Boardroom: This is because calls for service will continue.

1711
04:20:50.530 --> 04:21:01.359
Boardroom: For the Communications Center, the proposed budget reductions will threaten the Department's ability to timely answer 911 calls and reliably dispatch police and fire resources.

1712
04:21:02.220 --> 04:21:07.990
Boardroom: Patrol is a department's core function and must be preserved to maintain emergency response.

1713
04:21:08.540 --> 04:21:11.849
Boardroom: The proposed reductions of 25 sworn personnel.

1714
04:21:12.050 --> 04:21:15.540
Boardroom: 23 police officers and 2 police sergeants.

1715
04:21:15.780 --> 04:21:31.470
Boardroom: would require consolidation or elimination of specialty units, including the Traffic and Motors Division, the Community Services Bureau, the bicycle Team, and significant portions of the Detectives Bureau, all of this in order to backfill the Patrol Division.

1716
04:21:32.320 --> 04:21:44.179

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Boardroom: However, as part of the proposed budget balancing plan, we have allocated one-time resources, to bridge the gap until the outcome of the sales and use tax measure becomes more clear.

1717
04:21:44.290 --> 04:21:54.629
Boardroom: Those one-time resources will be used to help maintain 15 police officers, so a net reduction of 10, as well as 6 of the 13 dispatchers.

1718
04:22:01.180 --> 04:22:04.110
Boardroom: Now I want to talk a little bit about the fire department.

1719
04:22:05.350 --> 04:22:12.360
Boardroom: So over the past 20 years, Berkeley has experienced significant growth, and is taller, denser, and more urban.

1720
04:22:12.480 --> 04:22:17.279
Boardroom: Which brings greater emergency response demands and a more complex operating environment.

1721
04:22:17.830 --> 04:22:28.610
Boardroom: At the same time, the fire department's call volume has increased 36% to over 17,500 calls for service in 2025.

1722
04:22:29.270 --> 04:22:37.509
Boardroom: The proposed cuts will leave the department less prepared to meet the urban fire, rescue, EMS, and wildfire risks that continue to grow.

1723
04:22:38.330 --> 04:22:43.240
Boardroom: The Fire Department's 12% budget reduction proposal is very impactful.

1724
04:22:44.060 --> 04:22:52.519
Boardroom: Of all the proposed reductions, the one I want to talk about first is the proposed closure of Fire Station 4 that impacts a total of 9 positions.

1725
04:22:52.840 --> 04:22:55.300
Boardroom: Fire Station 4 is very busy.

1726
04:22:55.640 --> 04:23:00.069

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Boardroom: The staff report that we published for the budget balancing plan

1727
04:23:00.170 --> 04:23:03.740
Boardroom: indicates that Engine 4 responded to 28 fires.

1728
04:23:04.050 --> 04:23:09.300
Boardroom: 966 emergency medical incidents, including 17 cardiac arrests.

1729
04:23:09.520 --> 04:23:12.860
Boardroom: And numerous other emergencies in 2025.

1730
04:23:13.430 --> 04:23:31.650
Boardroom: Closing this station will certainly degrade response times and first alarm effectiveness in its service area and adjacent districts. And that is why, as part of the budget balancing plan and the proposed budget, we are also proposing to use one-time money in fiscal year 2027 to keep Fire Station open.

1731
04:23:31.910 --> 04:23:38.439
Boardroom: to preserve all of those 9 positions until we can understand better the outcome of the sales and use tax in November.

1732
04:23:39.740 --> 04:23:49.340
Boardroom: In addition to the closure of Fire Station 4, the Department's budget reduction plan decreases the Department's ability to support development reviews for construction projects and special events.

1733
04:23:49.740 --> 04:23:52.969
Boardroom: It ends the department's street trauma prevention work.

1734
04:23:53.370 --> 04:23:59.559
Boardroom: Limit the department's ability to monitor and apply for grants, and diminishes EMS oversight.

1735
04:24:00.260 --> 04:24:09.179
Boardroom: Finally, through cost shifting, the department will significantly reduce its employee health and wellness programming and education, which is troublesome.

1736
04:24:09.810 --> 04:24:21.830

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Boardroom: Since the pandemic, employee injury leave related to workers' compensation for physical and mental injury has remained about 6,000 hours higher than pre-pandemic levels.

1737
04:24:22.360 --> 04:24:29.039
Boardroom: Certainly, while the department will work to reassign much of this work, there's obviously no way that it can absorb all of it.

1738
04:24:34.130 --> 04:24:36.799
Boardroom: Health, Housing, and Community Services Department.

1739
04:24:36.960 --> 04:24:48.419
Boardroom: So the Health Housing, and Community Services Department budget reduction plan is inclusive of not just the general fund, but results from the loss of funding and special funds managed by the department, including mental health.

1740
04:24:48.570 --> 04:24:51.540
Boardroom: Public health, aging, and housing.

1741
04:24:51.940 --> 04:24:57.260
Boardroom: As a result, in totality, the department is eliminating 45 positions.

1742
04:24:57.760 --> 04:25:04.329
Boardroom: The department's budget reduction plan proposals results in the transfer of our vector control program to Alameda County.

1743
04:25:04.660 --> 04:25:07.629
Boardroom: Eliminates our mobile crisis response team.

1744
04:25:08.280 --> 04:25:25.340
Boardroom: Eliminates the heart-to-heart Health Community Education and Promotion Program, as well as diminished emergency preparedness capacity that will result in the department not having the capacity to coordinate comprehensive citywide emergency readiness and response initiatives.

1745
04:25:26.180 --> 04:25:39.860
Boardroom: While the department worked hard to leverage other funding sources to preserve programs for people experiencing homelessness, as I described before, and I won't get back into them, the department did have to propose some difficult cuts in our work to address homelessness.

1746

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04:25:41.970 --> 04:25:46.430
Boardroom: I also want to comment on the significant reductions proposed for the Mental Health Division.

1747
04:25:46.760 --> 04:25:50.580
Boardroom: For this division, there are 32 proposed position reductions.

1748
04:25:51.060 --> 04:26:02.439
Boardroom: These reductions represent a right-sizing of the division that has been in the works for some time due to the fact that anticipated revenues never materialized, and the loss of revenue due to state law.

1749
04:26:03.030 --> 04:26:21.569
Boardroom: As a result of this right-sizing and changes in the funding landscape, the Mental Health Division will continue to provide specific intensive services and focus on navigating residents toward county-level alternatives to ensure that residents have a clear pathway to all other mandated psychiatric and emergency services.

1750
04:26:22.140 --> 04:26:31.319
Boardroom: Finally, due to state and federal funding cuts, there are a number of different programs outlined in the staff report associated with the budget balancing plan.

1751
04:26:31.520 --> 04:26:37.909
Boardroom: That attribute program reductions that reduce health, nutrition, equity, and mental health services.

1752
04:26:46.020 --> 04:27:02.540
Boardroom: For the Parks, Recreation, and Waterfront Department, in addition to having to reduce expenditures in the General Fund, the department had to address marina fund deficits and expiring T1 funding that reduced capacity in recreation, maintenance, and capital project delivery.

1753
04:27:03.160 --> 04:27:14.450
Boardroom: Within the general fund, in addition to some cost shifting, the department is proposing to reduce after-school programs, camps, as well as operating hours for community centers and pools.

1754
04:27:14.910 --> 04:27:25.300
Boardroom: These reductions to youth recreation and adult programs are proposed to be maintained by using one-time resources with future year funding assigned to the sales and use tax.

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1755
04:27:26.240 --> 04:27:40.650
Boardroom: For the Marina Fund, which has been operating in a deficit for many years, the department is proposing staffing and reduction in non-personnel expenditures that will reduce capacity to oversee marina operations, leases, and secure grants.

1756
04:27:41.470 --> 04:27:52.589
Boardroom: Finally, because of all the funding generated by T1 has been allocated, the department has had to recommend staffing reductions that reduce capacity to deliver capital projects.

1757
04:27:59.320 --> 04:28:10.130
Boardroom: Not only did the Public Works Department have to address the general fund deficit, but their budget balancing plan proposals address challenges that are being experienced in other funds, such as the Building Maintenance Fund.

1758
04:28:10.440 --> 04:28:15.010
Boardroom: off-street, non-street parking funds, and the Capital Improvement Program Fund.

1759
04:28:15.550 --> 04:28:20.390
Boardroom: In total, the department is proposing a 5% reduction in its workforce.

1760
04:28:20.490 --> 04:28:30.059
Boardroom: And the department will prioritize their work to focus on essential public life safety systems, legal compliance, and preventing catastrophic infrastructure failure.

1761
04:28:30.840 --> 04:28:40.210
Boardroom: So what the department will continue to emphasize includes emergency response to storms, downed trees in the right-of-way, and immediate hazard mitigation.

1762
04:28:40.570 --> 04:28:43.340
Boardroom: Regulatory and environmental compliance.

1763
04:28:43.610 --> 04:28:54.329
Boardroom: Critical life safety infrastructure that includes items such as maintenance of traffic signals at high-volume intersections, and structural integrity of public buildings with high occupancy.

1764

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04:28:55.020 --> 04:29:03.769
Boardroom: And essential sanitation such as core, trash collection, and basic maintenance of public health facilities to prevent and address disease vectors.

1765
04:29:04.200 --> 04:29:07.920
Boardroom: Delays are anticipated in repairs and facility work.

1766
04:29:08.200 --> 04:29:15.759
Boardroom: Non-emergency community concerns received through 311, such as standard pothole repair, graffiti abatement.

1767
04:29:15.960 --> 04:29:20.260
Boardroom: Litter and illegal dumping, and reduced support for special events.

1768
04:29:20.890 --> 04:29:35.769
Boardroom: In addition to the service level impacts described, the department is proposing a reduction in security services for the corporation yard, and project deferrals that ultimately increase long-term maintenance issues and revenue risks and defer capital projects.

1769
04:29:40.950 --> 04:29:47.920
Boardroom: So now I'm gonna touch on a variety of other departments, and there's more than I'll describe that is actually on this slide.

1770
04:29:48.700 --> 04:29:55.009
Boardroom: So for the City Clerk's Office, there's proposed elimination of resources for overtime and temporary staffing.

1771
04:29:55.230 --> 04:29:58.149
Boardroom: There will be delay plan software upgrades.

1772
04:29:58.440 --> 04:30:03.250
Boardroom: There will be reduced captioning costs by relying on Zoom functionality.

1773
04:30:03.420 --> 04:30:10.750
Boardroom: And we're proposing to reallocate about 75% of our rental costs for this boardroom to other special funding streams.

1774
04:30:11.640 --> 04:30:19.580

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Boardroom: For the City Manager's Office, the proposed plan represents expenditure reductions of about 13%, with 9 positions that are impacted.

1775
04:30:20.220 --> 04:30:27.619
Boardroom: However, over the past 2 budget cycles, there are 13 positions impacted, representing 20% of the department's total staffing.

1776
04:30:28.600 --> 04:30:31.909
Boardroom: In terms of service impacts, I would like to highlight the following.

1777
04:30:32.600 --> 04:30:38.579
Boardroom: Between this fiscal year and last fiscal year, all of the staff in the Office of DEI will be eliminated.

1778
04:30:38.900 --> 04:30:48.490
Boardroom: We will do our best in the City Manager's office to pick up some of the priority projects, but the portfolio of work will be vastly less than what was envisioned when the office was established.

1779
04:30:48.600 --> 04:30:53.199
Boardroom: And the level of community engagement that was anticipated will not occur.

1780
04:30:54.140 --> 04:31:04.769
Boardroom: In economic development, there will be reduced support for small businesses, loan fund management, business improvement district and commission support, as well as marketing activities.

1781
04:31:05.320 --> 04:31:15.859
Boardroom: Within civic Arts, there will be a reduction in operational capacity, grant opportunities, and staff work will be prioritized to focus on the backlog of public arts projects.

1782
04:31:16.700 --> 04:31:28.670
Boardroom: For our communications division, with the loss of both communications specialists, there will be delays in response times, and work will need to shift to departments to develop communications and respond to the media.

1783
04:31:29.160 --> 04:31:34.309
Boardroom: Also, our ability to respond to crisis and emergency incidents will be impacted.

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1784
04:31:34.950 --> 04:31:40.289
Boardroom: In addition, there will be increased administrative workload that will be spread throughout the department.

1785
04:31:40.710 --> 04:31:48.779
Boardroom: And as I mentioned, there are proposed reductions to our work with DBA and the Homeless Outreach Coordinator, and a reduction in animal services contracts.

1786
04:31:50.650 --> 04:31:57.970
Boardroom: Within the finance department, there are four positions, all of which are vacant, that are proposed, that are part of the budget balancing plan.

1787
04:31:58.350 --> 04:32:01.809
Boardroom: Eliminating these positions will have the following impacts.

1788
04:32:01.910 --> 04:32:06.659
Boardroom: Diminished capacity for system modernization and technology system upgrades.

1789
04:32:06.920 --> 04:32:16.850
Boardroom: Loss of the only broad-scope analyst, which will limit the ability to perform internal analysis. Revenue monitoring and providing vital backup coverage.

1790
04:32:17.080 --> 04:32:24.969
Boardroom: And there will be reduced staffing for business tax audits and collections, reducing revenue generation for the general fund, and Zero Waste Fund.

1791
04:32:25.620 --> 04:32:32.479
Boardroom: In addition, there's a proposal to reduce training by 25%, which we think will be manageable with online offerings.

1792
04:32:33.960 --> 04:32:45.490
Boardroom: For our Human Resources Department, as a result of the positions that are part of the Budget Balancing Plan, the department's focus will shift from proactive and strategic efforts to a compliance-driven baseline model.

1793
04:32:46.090 --> 04:32:51.600

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Boardroom: Portions of multiple human resource employee roles will be shifted to the Workers' Compensation fund.

1794
04:32:52.140 --> 04:32:56.819
Boardroom: And their responsibilities will limit broader human resource services for the organization.

1795
04:32:57.400 --> 04:33:04.599
Boardroom: As a result, there will be slower response times associated with ergonomic assessments, site visits, and compliance support.

1796
04:33:05.240 --> 04:33:23.190
Boardroom: And in addition to the personnel impacts, there are a number of non-personnel reductions proposed, including the elimination of some consulting work, software, and modeling tools that will increase manual work and require that some work is redistributed amongst existing staff.

1797
04:33:24.279 --> 04:33:40.349
Boardroom: In our information technology department, with the reductions proposed, there will be diminished capacity for system support and modernization, project management, infrastructure improvements, 311 customer service, and slower response times to employee concerns.

1798
04:33:41.300 --> 04:33:55.420
Boardroom: Projects that will be deferred or delayed include modernizing the city's phone system, developing an integrated accounts receivable and general billing platform, and certain AI tools that could streamline city processes and improve service delivery.

1799
04:33:56.410 --> 04:34:07.589
Boardroom: Within our planning department, there's a reallocation of eligible staff costs to the Permit Service Center Fund and other funds, reducing general fund spending with no immediate service changes.

1800
04:34:07.880 --> 04:34:16.089
Boardroom: There are also adjustments to internal service charges to a properly align with workload that will also generate additional general fund savings.

1801
04:34:18.900 --> 04:34:35.770
Boardroom: onto the charter offices. So, we received proposals from the charter offices, and you can see, what they are here, and we provided you with all the background from the charter offices that we received. I do want to note, we did receive a proposal from the city attorney's office.

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1802
04:34:35.980 --> 04:34:47.029
Boardroom: Late last week, with personnel and non-personnel savings of about $250,000. There's a non-personal savings of $52,456.

1803
04:34:47.180 --> 04:34:53.969
Boardroom: And then one, position, a paralegal position that is currently filled that generates about $201,000 in savings.

1804
04:34:54.250 --> 04:35:07.159
Boardroom: The impact of these, proposals have not been built into this budget balancing plan and this budget, because they came in just last week, but we certainly will work with our city manager and city council to integrate them as we move forward.

1805
04:35:10.130 --> 04:35:22.859
Boardroom: And I'll turn it back over to Maricar to talk about workforce impacts. Thank you. So, all of those, things that David talked about leads to this very slide, workforce impacts.

1806
04:35:23.169 --> 04:35:27.429
Boardroom: The City of Berkeley has a very personnel-driven budget.

1807
04:35:27.640 --> 04:35:35.839
Boardroom: And this really limited our balancing options. And this was probably the most difficult part of the budget balancing exercise.

1808
04:35:36.320 --> 04:35:42.320
Boardroom: About 70% of the general fund baseline budget, is for personnel.

1809
04:35:42.750 --> 04:35:48.360
Boardroom: So, this really limited our ability to close our deficit through non-personnel cuts alone.

1810
04:35:48.880 --> 04:35:52.360
Boardroom: And other funding sources face similar constraints.

1811
04:35:53.220 --> 04:36:00.730
Boardroom: During the budget balancing phase, departments really prioritized eliminating vacant positions.

1812
04:36:01.070 --> 04:36:05.489

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Boardroom: And looking at other appropriate funding sources to reallocate positions.

1813
04:36:05.610 --> 04:36:07.169
Boardroom: Whenever possible.

1814
04:36:07.330 --> 04:36:17.059
Boardroom: And they only identified filled positions as a last resort, with focus on preserving core services and to support long-term fiscal health.

1815
04:36:18.240 --> 04:36:30.820
Boardroom: The budget balancing plan, which, David spoke about, includes 183 FTEs. However, this proposed budget includes 150 FTE reduction.

1816
04:36:31.110 --> 04:36:36.969
Boardroom: 45 of that, is vacant from the prior fiscal year 26, budget balancing.

1817
04:36:37.320 --> 04:36:38.310
Boardroom: Measure.

1818
04:36:38.750 --> 04:36:42.950
Boardroom: And 85 vacant plus 20 filled in this biennium.

1819
04:36:43.320 --> 04:36:50.250
Boardroom: The remaining 33 FGEs, from the 183 total are preserved.

1820
04:36:50.720 --> 04:37:07.860
Boardroom: And what we mean by that is that 15 of those 33 FTEs are vacant, and 18 are filled. And they are preserved by using the one-time resources that I spoke about in prior slides, ensuring that these positions are funded in fiscal year 2027.

1821
04:37:08.130 --> 04:37:12.039
Boardroom: And we're allocating this cost to the sales and use tax.

1822
04:37:12.250 --> 04:37:16.539
Boardroom: For fiscal year 2028, the revenue is included in the projection.

1823
04:37:16.830 --> 04:37:26.320

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Boardroom: But however, if the measure does not pass in November, additional reduction will be required in the mid-annual budget update to balance.

1824
04:37:30.700 --> 04:37:49.790
Boardroom: The next three slides really just gives you a more detailed look at the cumulative reduction in force, and this is broken down by position. So this includes 183 positions that I spoke about earlier, and this is cumulative with fiscal year 26 and 27 and 28.

1825
04:37:51.830 --> 04:37:57.120
Boardroom: This, is actually also included in the financial summaries that was…

1826
04:37:57.300 --> 04:38:01.259
Boardroom: Part of this, item for tonight.

1827
04:38:06.279 --> 04:38:24.870
Boardroom: Mayor, did you want to pause here for questions? Yeah, so because this presentation is so long, I wanted to pause during certain parts of it to allow us to ask some questions, so we're not just asking 100 questions each at the end of the night. So, do you have, does anyone have questions? I'm going to start with Councilmember Taplin.

1828
04:38:24.919 --> 04:38:30.310
Boardroom: Yes, thank you very much. I have 4 questions for budget, fire, PD, and PRW.

1829
04:38:30.430 --> 04:38:45.979
Boardroom: So FY28 assumes a passage of the sales tax. Do we have any draft projections of what things will look like if it doesn't? It's okay if we don't have those, but I just want to know if we do. Projections of what? If the sales tax doesn't pass, do we have any, like, draft numbers of what…

1830
04:38:47.150 --> 04:38:50.959
Boardroom: What deeper cuts you might have to make? Do we have any kind of scenarios that we…

1831
04:38:51.140 --> 04:39:09.319
Boardroom: 9.4, 9.6. So we are currently allocating in fiscal year 27 $9.4 million of programs and services between police, fire, parks, recreation, and waterfront. That goes up to about $9.6 million for fiscal year 2028. So if the sales tax measure does not pass.

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1832
04:39:09.410 --> 04:39:28.750
Boardroom: assuming all else remains unchanged, we would have $9.6 million of proposed budget reductions to address in fiscal year 28. Thank you. For PD, Chief Lewis, I'm wondering if you can describe some of the work that the special units do, and how CSB interacts with the community?

1833
04:39:34.550 --> 04:39:41.849
Boardroom: And you said Public Works as well, so… Prw. Oh, PRW, sorry. Yeah, of course. So maybe if you want to start heading up this way.

1834
04:39:41.850 --> 04:40:05.910
Boardroom: So, as you know, our patrol personnel do the immediate response to calls for service. All those other units that we mentioned, the Bike Force, the Community Services Bureau, the Detective Division, they're the ones that do the follow-on investigation or relieve the immediate tension, that the patrol officers would face if they had to handle those calls for service. It allows us to, engage with the business districts, the community, and ensure we have,

1835
04:40:05.930 --> 04:40:17.090
Boardroom: proper follow-up of investigations. Thank you. For Fire Chiefs Craig, can you talk about, the street trauma prevention program and the neighborhood utility of the CERT trainings?

1836
04:40:17.580 --> 04:40:34.629
Boardroom: Sorry, what was the second part of the question? Second part was the neighborhood utility of the CERT trainings. Yeah. So, Street Trauma Prevention Program, I think everybody's somewhat familiar with. It's a novel program, started here, I think it's the first in the nation, where we're trying to integrate the fire department into the Division Zero.

1837
04:40:34.890 --> 04:40:51.869
Boardroom: Process for the city, and look at how we can achieve what are two righteous goals, both reducing street trauma and death, and also maintaining or improving response time, so we don't see an increase in injury and morbidity from, on the emergency response side.

1838
04:40:52.910 --> 04:41:04.520
Boardroom: Let's see, CERT. So, this is a long-standing community education program that helps prepare individuals and drive neighborhood preparedness for all types of disasters.

1839
04:41:04.870 --> 04:41:18.749

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Boardroom: Essentially operating under the idea that people are going to be on their own for 72 to 96 hours following a major disaster, so there should be a personal preparedness plan, and neighbors should come together to prepare, for that period of time.

1840
04:41:19.410 --> 04:41:24.000
Boardroom: Thank you for, Director Farris. Can you give us a sense of the number of

1841
04:41:24.240 --> 04:41:31.960
Boardroom: community center and pool hours that would be reduced. And how many families might be impacted by camp and after-school reductions?

1842
04:41:32.480 --> 04:41:33.660
Boardroom: I think,

1843
04:41:34.710 --> 04:41:44.249
Boardroom: We had, you know, it depends on how you divide it up, but we had planned on… one scenario means that we would close the pool on weekends.

1844
04:41:44.470 --> 04:41:49.460
Boardroom: reducing after-school spots by, I think it was 35 or 45.

1845
04:41:49.580 --> 04:42:00.460
Boardroom: And reducing a variety of, summer, you know, kind of low-income, camp spots, and a variety of other programmatic changes.

1846
04:42:01.160 --> 04:42:04.570
Boardroom: Thank you all very much.

1847
04:42:04.930 --> 04:42:05.689
Boardroom: Number 10.

1848
04:42:06.960 --> 04:42:09.589
Boardroom: Thank you. Moving on to Councilmember Bacabee.

1849
04:42:09.970 --> 04:42:21.980
Boardroom: Thanks, Madam Mayor, and thanks to everyone for being here. Just to be really clear about the next fiscal year budget, so, Station 4 and the 9 fire department personnel

1850

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04:42:22.000 --> 04:42:32.899
Boardroom: and the 15 police officers and 6 dispatchers that had been considered to have been reduced in the initial balancing plan, those are… those are retained. I just want to be…

1851
04:42:32.900 --> 04:42:51.750
Boardroom: crystal clear about that in the process, so folks know. That's correct, along with 3 positions in the Parks, Recreation, and Waterfront Department that will continue to maintain pool hours, community centers, etc. So we know what's at stake, and we know this is an option that's been considered, but for the next fiscal year, those are all retained. Okay.

1852
04:42:51.930 --> 04:43:04.219
Boardroom: One kind of global question, maybe this is for the city manager, you know, what we're seeing is certainly not unique to Berkeley. We're seeing a lot of local jurisdictions, we're seeing the county, we're seeing the city of San Francisco.

1853
04:43:04.220 --> 04:43:20.900
Boardroom: that are struggling with these really big structural deficits. Is there anything, you know, are there any other trends or things that are going on that we can look at there that apply, and how does that affect how we balance our budget here? I mean, how much… basically, it's how much of this is local to Berkeley, and how much are other effects that we're trying to deal with?

1854
04:43:21.210 --> 04:43:37.150
Boardroom: Well, as you point out, rightly, this is a phenomenon that we're seeing in a lot of other jurisdictions, as you said, ranging from San Francisco to Oakland to Alameda County to Hayward, San Leandro. It's, we're seeing it happen all over, and

1855
04:43:37.250 --> 04:43:45.750
Boardroom: you know, there's different reasons for the deficits in different places. I think as the staff described.

1856
04:43:45.950 --> 04:43:48.810
Boardroom: Here today, part of it on our side is.

1857
04:43:49.290 --> 04:44:05.910
Boardroom: expenditures going up higher than revenues, driven by a lot of different forces, whether that's inflation related to whatever's going on, COVID-related, or in this case, we're anticipating more, you know, Iran war and oil price-related increases, and so…

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1858
04:44:06.120 --> 04:44:08.429
Boardroom: There are a lot of different reasons, but it's,

1859
04:44:08.590 --> 04:44:15.300
Boardroom: We're seeing similar deficits all over the Bay Area. And in the private sector, too.

1860
04:44:15.800 --> 04:44:33.839
Boardroom: On the homeless services side, it feels like one of the big elephants in the room when it comes to the budget is just what, if anything, is happening with Measure W from the county, and when we can expect funds, or do we have any visibility? I just, I find it incredibly difficult to budget when we don't really

1861
04:44:33.890 --> 04:44:43.489
Boardroom: know what's happening there. Could you speak a little to that? I can, but not with a lot of comfort, unfortunately. We also don't have a lot of insight into when the county's gonna release various

1862
04:44:43.630 --> 04:45:03.429
Boardroom: tranches and types of Measure W resources. You all have done a… collectively, as a council, a good job advocating to the county for Berkeley's needs. We also, on the staff side, talk to staff in the county a lot, and so we do have good and open lines of communication, and I think partly they're just still figuring it out on the county side also.

1863
04:45:03.430 --> 04:45:08.399
Boardroom: Would we expect that when the funds come, that they are supplementary?

1864
04:45:08.460 --> 04:45:18.609
Boardroom: Or could some of that actually replace city spending? I'm just… did that free up city spending, or how would… how are we thinking about that? Well, it's a good question, and we have…

1865
04:45:18.780 --> 04:45:31.540
Boardroom: really tried to make the case to the county on both of those sides of that equation. One, you heard today that… and you know that we have this fiscal cliff issue with the motels, and that has been something that we have really highlighted with the county to say.

1866
04:45:31.610 --> 04:45:48.179
Boardroom: You know, we respect and appreciate that we want to do more and create more programs and housing opportunities, but at the same time,

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we need to be thoughtful and cognizant of not adding to the problem by letting programs that we already have established and know work

1867
04:45:48.290 --> 04:46:05.570
Boardroom: cease to exist. And so, we've made that case quite clearly to them. You all have helped make that case also, so they're very aware of it, and I'm hopeful that they'll take that into account when they start figuring out how exactly they're gonna put forward their Measure W funds. Great. Two more things, and then I'll be done.

1868
04:46:05.730 --> 04:46:19.029
Boardroom: on the fire side with Chief Sprague, some of the feedback we've gotten, certainly from residents, in addition to, obviously, opposing the closing of the fire station, which I, which I share, I couldn't, I could not vote for a budget that closed Station 4.

1869
04:46:19.090 --> 04:46:21.369
Boardroom: But folks are asking about.

1870
04:46:21.370 --> 04:46:41.190
Boardroom: you know, we passed Measure GG in 2008, we passed Measure FF in 2020, but the fire department is also significantly supported by the General Fund. And just help us, kind of, again, understand the source of the funding and why we can't just rely on FF and GG to fund, kind of, the overall fire department efforts, and why general fund is an important part of that.

1871
04:46:41.610 --> 04:46:47.590
Boardroom: So, the fire department, I think fairly uniquely, is, 30% funded by special funds.

1872
04:46:47.790 --> 04:46:56.720
Boardroom: So, our general fund budget has now, about 90% of it is… pays for sworn staff operating out of firehouses.

1873
04:46:57.020 --> 04:47:13.959
Boardroom: Whereas most of the administrative functions have, been shifted to these special funds over the years, primarily because they've either stopped and then been restarted when these special funds were passed by the voters, or services were expanded by the voters that are paid for exclusively by these special funds.

1874
04:47:14.430 --> 04:47:19.189
Boardroom: So, when we're talking about a general fund deficit and reduction in the general fund.

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1875
04:47:19.400 --> 04:47:24.510
Boardroom: There's not a lot of positions that are… Possible to cut.

1876
04:47:24.980 --> 04:47:36.090
Boardroom: That don't directly impact service delivery. Does that answer your question? Yeah, it's like, so 30% of your budget is from the special funds, but 70% is still from the general fund? Correct. So that's part of what's happening is…

1877
04:47:36.610 --> 04:47:45.039
Boardroom: the majority of your funding still comes from the general fund. It does, but because all those administrative services have been pushed to special funds, 90% of that

1878
04:47:45.440 --> 04:48:02.140
Boardroom: general fund allocation is paying for people that are in the firehouses delivering service. Got it. Okay. Last, last one. A PRW question, it's actually a PRW to fire connected question, and we've talked about this before. I noticed one small bullet point in the PRW, slide was.

1879
04:48:02.140 --> 04:48:06.819
Boardroom: reduction in spending on fire fuel work. Obviously, that's important to D6.

1880
04:48:06.820 --> 04:48:14.300
Boardroom: Can you talk about that? How sizable is that, and is that something we could figure out a way to at least restore some, of?

1881
04:48:15.710 --> 04:48:19.400
Boardroom: The reduction, typically, in the last…

1882
04:48:19.570 --> 04:48:28.899
Boardroom: Couple budget cycles, we've gotten $450,000 to do vegetation management and tree removal in the right-of-way in the hills.

1883
04:48:29.160 --> 04:48:35.349
Boardroom: And, This year, we…

1884
04:48:35.530 --> 04:48:39.449
Boardroom: With the cut will probably eliminate all the tree removal.

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1885
04:48:39.760 --> 04:48:53.710
Boardroom: Our… my city arborist feels comfortable that we have done a lot of good work over the last 8 to 10 years in the right-of-way. I think that money started coming in in 2016, and that, we're in pretty good shape there.

1886
04:48:53.930 --> 04:48:59.830
Boardroom: And so the remaining… I think the… we're proposing not to cut the $223,000 will…

1887
04:48:59.950 --> 04:49:08.309
Boardroom: go into vegetation removal in the hills. Okay. And that might look different in fiscal 28 than 27? It would be the same.

1888
04:49:08.640 --> 04:49:11.739
Boardroom: Maintained 27 and 28. Yeah. Okay. Alright, thank you.

1889
04:49:13.970 --> 04:49:16.899
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Councilmember O'Keefe.

1890
04:49:18.030 --> 04:49:19.220
Boardroom: Thank you.

1891
04:49:22.120 --> 04:49:34.149
Boardroom: I think this question's for the WDC City Manager, or maybe Chief Sprague. I was wondering if you could speak a little more about how the decision was made to target, Station 4 for potential closure?

1892
04:49:35.120 --> 04:49:35.980
Boardroom: Yeah.

1893
04:49:36.740 --> 04:49:42.340
Boardroom: there's no good firehouse to close. Each firehouse has, a huge impact.

1894
04:49:42.600 --> 04:50:00.049
Boardroom: The way we landed on Station 4 was it's the second to… second slowest station. Station 7 on Shasta is the slowest station, but it's so isolated. One, if we close that station, response times would be so much longer, and also, I can only cover it from one

1895
04:50:00.580 --> 04:50:09.849

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Boardroom: From one side, from the west, from Station 4. Whereas station 4 is the second slowest station, I can cover it from 3 sides, 7 can come down the hill.

1896
04:50:10.030 --> 04:50:28.080
Boardroom: Station 2 can come from downtown, and Station 6 can come from the west. So, if there was a station to close, you want to close a lower volume station, because all those calls don't go away, they have to be redistributed to other companies, and then you look at how can I fill that hole, fill the gap that's left.

1897
04:50:29.070 --> 04:50:35.260
Boardroom: Do you have, have you done an analysis, or do you have an estimate on how long, how much longer it would take, the average response?

1898
04:50:36.060 --> 04:50:49.359
Boardroom: We're working on it. Unfortunately, we don't have that type of technology, like, at our fingertips. Yeah, I wasn't sure if that was mathematically modelable. I was wondering if, any alternatives,

1899
04:50:51.130 --> 04:50:59.670
Boardroom: Like, did you consider perhaps trying to save the same amount of money by distributing the staff reductions in a different way, like,

1900
04:51:00.120 --> 04:51:17.759
Boardroom: like a… more like a brownout model, or like, you know, reductions sort of across the board, rather than closing a station. Yeah, I mean, closing a fire station to us is kind of the nuclear option. We looked at every other scenario. Brownouts, keep in mind that's savings via overtime.

1901
04:51:17.790 --> 04:51:23.890
Boardroom: So you're not saving full staff costs there, you're only saving the difference between what it costs

1902
04:51:24.130 --> 04:51:29.810
Boardroom: Per person to staff full-time, and what it costs to backfill that vacancy with overtime.

1903
04:51:30.010 --> 04:51:33.120
Boardroom: So it's a much lower, savings.

1904
04:51:33.300 --> 04:51:40.949

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Boardroom: And, in order to reach the $3.5 million target, we'd have to close upwards of 2 fire stations a day.

1905
04:51:41.060 --> 04:51:43.950
Boardroom: with the brown app model, which just isn't feasible.

1906
04:51:44.620 --> 04:51:45.450
Boardroom: Okay.

1907
04:51:45.670 --> 04:51:49.490
Boardroom: Second to last question.

1908
04:51:51.030 --> 04:51:58.040
Boardroom: Do you… how many residents in the high-fire zone are currently served by Station 4?

1909
04:51:58.180 --> 04:52:01.140
Boardroom: set. I mean, I don't need an exact number, but do you have a sense?

1910
04:52:01.480 --> 04:52:05.579
Boardroom: I can get it, I'm not sure. Okay. Some, some. Many?

1911
04:52:05.750 --> 04:52:11.379
Boardroom: Yeah, I wouldn't want to venture to guess, but thousands, for sure. Okay.

1912
04:52:11.990 --> 04:52:29.949
Boardroom: Okay, thank you for those answers. Yeah, this is very concerning, and I didn't know you shared the concern, but it's just good to, for the public and for us to get an understanding of how this decision was made, so thank you. I just would like to clarify, also for the record, this is more of a procedural question.

1913
04:52:30.390 --> 04:52:38.350
Boardroom: you know, obviously we're not gonna vote on this budget tonight. We're not… we're far away from that, but,

1914
04:52:38.760 --> 04:52:42.080
Boardroom: Let's say this was the proposal that we voted on.

1915
04:52:44.880 --> 04:53:02.310

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Boardroom: It would, you know, the idea of closing the station is a projected outcome for the next fiscal year. So, is it true to say that if we did pass this proposal or something like it, that we would have another chance to vote on actually closing the station?

1916
04:53:02.500 --> 04:53:10.979
Boardroom: the following year. Like, we… it comes back. If you could help us understand that process, I'm not sure. Yeah, I can start it, yes. So…

1917
04:53:11.560 --> 04:53:24.709
Boardroom: The short answer is that our hope is that the sales and use tax in November passes, and we don't have to have that conversation. That's… that's the plan. If that fails and we're back here having that conversation, we would immediately start

1918
04:53:25.050 --> 04:53:39.750
Boardroom: planning on, well, what would that look like? And so then we would be having another series of, budget and finance committee meetings where we're talking about that, budget hearings here, preparing for what's the fiscal year 28 budget look like, and we'd have to decide that, obviously, between

1919
04:53:39.940 --> 04:53:41.930
Boardroom: November and June.

1920
04:53:42.150 --> 04:53:53.449
Boardroom: And the council would get another chance to weigh in on that? Correct. Okay, thank you, yeah, because I think, like, I think Councilmember Blackaby said, I'm not comfortable voting on a budget that would actually, close the fire station, but…

1921
04:53:53.450 --> 04:54:12.110
Boardroom: I understand this is sort of… this is a projection, sort of a loose plan for next year, and we'll… hopefully won't have to figure that out. But that's… that's helpful to have that clarified procedurally. Thank you so much. And just to reinforce the City Manager's point, and the point Marikar made about our budget projections, the fiscal year 28 revenues assume the sales and use tax measure passes.

1922
04:54:12.110 --> 04:54:13.640
Boardroom: Of course, yes, thank you.

1923
04:54:14.870 --> 04:54:18.420
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Vice Mayor Trey Gob.

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1924
04:54:18.720 --> 04:54:32.909
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor. I have 5 questions. Some of these, I've asked before in committee, but I thought it would be valuable for the public's benefit to ask them here. Others are new.

1925
04:54:32.980 --> 04:54:44.640
Boardroom: 3 of them are related to HHCS, specifically mental health and behavioral health, so I don't know if,

1926
04:54:45.000 --> 04:54:54.380
Boardroom: who the appropriate, person would be who is available to answer these, but I will just step through these.

1927
04:54:55.520 --> 04:55:05.480
Boardroom: I wanted to, ask about the impacts of, moving…

1928
04:55:05.930 --> 04:55:11.599
Boardroom: Certain, funding for, like, mental health and public health.

1929
04:55:11.910 --> 04:55:18.509
Boardroom: To the county, Specifically,

1930
04:55:22.970 --> 04:55:29.159
Boardroom: I just need the percentage, generally, what percentage of the funding streams,

1931
04:55:29.450 --> 04:55:44.689
Boardroom: come from the general fund versus those that are pass-throughs through the county or other revenue sources. I am certainly not advocating,

1932
04:55:45.080 --> 04:55:50.649
Boardroom: closing any department, just… just to be clear, so that… but…

1933
04:55:51.140 --> 04:55:58.069
Boardroom: since we have received some questions, what… or I have received questions from constituents,

1934
04:55:58.380 --> 04:56:12.449
Boardroom: if we were to move all of our public health functions to the county, would that even be possible, and would it save any money? Could you, speak to that?

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1935
04:56:12.780 --> 04:56:19.560
Boardroom: The first part of your question, are you asking specifically what percentage,

1936
04:56:20.080 --> 04:56:26.640
Boardroom: general fund supports public health and mental health. I believe our fiscal manager is also online.

1937
04:56:26.940 --> 04:56:28.220
Boardroom: And song.

1938
04:56:29.560 --> 04:56:37.269
Ann Song: I… I'm online, and I'm… working on those calculations right now, and I can try to provide them.

1939
04:56:37.650 --> 04:56:39.730
Ann Song: Sometime during this meeting.

1940
04:56:41.000 --> 04:56:44.090
Boardroom: I can say at a high level, Councilmember, that

1941
04:56:44.230 --> 04:56:51.879
Boardroom: part of your question was, what would the process be? It would be a complicated process where we'd have to get authority from the state and authority from

1942
04:56:52.110 --> 04:57:01.280
Boardroom: work out an agreement with the county. As you're alluding to, there is general fund subsidy in public health, mental health, and environmental health, and so…

1943
04:57:01.390 --> 04:57:09.589
Boardroom: You know, one of the questions that would be asked of all of us is, okay, if we were to transition the public health division to the county.

1944
04:57:10.920 --> 04:57:12.339
Boardroom: What part of that

1945
04:57:12.970 --> 04:57:21.159

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Boardroom: what part of that city subsidy would go along with it, if any? And we would just have to be clear-eyed that if the answer was.

1946
04:57:21.230 --> 04:57:35.749
Boardroom: none, then we'd be understanding, here's what we're not funding anymore. And so, the budget and finance manager can speak a little bit to that later on in the meeting about how much that is, and if you want, we could come back with more detail about specifically what programs we're talking about.

1947
04:57:36.670 --> 04:57:45.940
Boardroom: Yeah, thank you for, my understanding based on past conversations, is any… any savings would be…

1948
04:57:46.420 --> 04:57:49.190
Boardroom: Somewhat minuscule as a…

1949
04:57:49.520 --> 04:58:00.479
Boardroom: proportion of the overall budget to fund, mental and behavioral health, but I just wanted to confirm that. Okay, my next question is,

1950
04:58:00.950 --> 04:58:13.959
Boardroom: around the… operational impact of, discontinuing mobile crisis and, the county picking up that function.

1951
04:58:14.020 --> 04:58:26.790
Boardroom: if I am, walking in the district, as I do every day, and I see a mentor health call and… or a mentor health, situation,

1952
04:58:27.570 --> 04:58:44.250
Boardroom: do I have options available to me around calls for service or, other than, PD, or do I call, 911 or the non-emergency line, depending on what the issue is?

1953
04:58:48.330 --> 04:58:54.839
Boardroom: So, yeah, mobile crisis services would go to the county, and…

1954
04:58:55.240 --> 04:58:59.859
Boardroom: My understanding is that the county would be your option there.

1955
04:59:01.760 --> 04:59:09.690

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Boardroom: and… This is a… probably a longer conversation, not to… but,

1956
04:59:10.010 --> 04:59:23.050
Boardroom: around how would the public be informed what number to call if they want a call to go to the county. Okay. Moving on,

1957
04:59:23.580 --> 04:59:34.850
Boardroom: I wanted to ask what direct or indirect impacts to behavioral and mental health services, there might be,

1958
04:59:35.040 --> 04:59:39.490
Boardroom: as a result of the governor's May revise.

1959
04:59:41.270 --> 04:59:44.410
Boardroom: And specifically, are there…

1960
04:59:45.120 --> 04:59:51.740
Boardroom: aspect, I know it just came out, so, really this is a question of how,

1961
04:59:52.330 --> 04:59:55.120
Boardroom: To the extent you've had a chance to look

1962
04:59:55.220 --> 05:00:01.540
Boardroom: Does it impact any of the projections, positively or negatively?

1963
05:00:03.130 --> 05:00:13.350
Boardroom: Yeah, the May revised budget just came out, so we haven't, taken that into account, and, it's not finalized. So…

1964
05:00:13.600 --> 05:00:16.950
Boardroom: Especially as it pertains to behavioral health monies.

1965
05:00:18.640 --> 05:00:19.640
Boardroom: Thank you.

1966
05:00:19.920 --> 05:00:32.849
Boardroom: This is, my penultimate question, can you speak broadly? This might be for…

1967

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05:00:32.970 --> 05:00:45.960
Boardroom: David, When it comes to revenue-generating positions that may be at risk of being,

1968
05:00:46.980 --> 05:00:58.390
Boardroom: cut, how, are projections being made in terms of, the…

1969
05:00:58.950 --> 05:01:12.520
Boardroom: Opportunity… the potential opportunity costs of then not be… having staff available to apply for certain grants, or to realize additional, revenue-generating opportunities.

1970
05:01:13.270 --> 05:01:25.589
Boardroom: I mean, I'll start off with, you know, in developing the budget balancing plan and looking at our revenue projections, we did not anticipate any impact to our revenue projections from the budget balancing plan.

1971
05:01:25.590 --> 05:01:33.889
Boardroom: However, you know, there is reduced staffing, that is proposed in the budget balancing plan that will impact our ability to go after grants.

1972
05:01:34.000 --> 05:01:46.259
Boardroom: We're trying to preserve some resources to maintain our flexibility to do so, but it won't be as broad as it is today. You know, in terms of other revenue opportunities, as we mentioned, there are two…

1973
05:01:46.270 --> 05:01:57.050
Boardroom: Positions in the finance department. They're vacant today, they've been vacant for some time. But if they were filled, they certainly could enhance our ability, to generate revenue as well.

1974
05:01:57.160 --> 05:02:00.530
Boardroom: So those are some of the things that we, were looking at.

1975
05:02:01.840 --> 05:02:07.889
Boardroom: Thank you. My last question is around,

1976
05:02:08.360 --> 05:02:16.379
Boardroom: you know, later on this agenda, we will be voting on potential, fee increases, you're gonna have some of my time.

1977

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05:02:16.990 --> 05:02:23.859
Boardroom: Okay, thank you. Can you just confirm that,

1978
05:02:23.960 --> 05:02:33.209
Boardroom: The current budget, assumptions does not factor in, those fee increases.

1979
05:02:33.280 --> 05:02:46.489
Boardroom: And what… if… if that is the case, what may be the impact directly or indirectly on the budget projections, if we…

1980
05:02:46.620 --> 05:02:52.430
Boardroom: Do not, approve the… Recommended fee increases tonight.

1981
05:02:54.740 --> 05:03:01.390
Boardroom: So, the fiscal 2027 fees that we'll be discussing later are not included in our proposed budget.

1982
05:03:03.090 --> 05:03:13.149
Boardroom: And therefore, if they do pass, and we start receiving revenue, we will then have a better idea, and that will be implemented in the 2028 mid-annual budget update.

1983
05:03:14.310 --> 05:03:16.110
Boardroom: Thank you, those for all my questions.

1984
05:03:17.310 --> 05:03:31.009
Boardroom: Thank you. Excuse me, we have a few… a couple council members left. I want to remind folks we're only a third of the way done with this presentation, so if you could keep your comments brief, we will… we will keep getting back to it. Alright, Councilmember Bartlett.

1985
05:03:31.240 --> 05:03:39.839
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor, and, thank you for this, very, very sobering and, of course, very alarming, budget.

1986
05:03:40.200 --> 05:03:45.340
Boardroom: I have a question about the… Mr. Sprague, are you here still? Yeah.

1987
05:03:45.620 --> 05:03:52.890
Boardroom: This is regarding the, the fire station closure, right?

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1988
05:03:53.370 --> 05:03:58.939
Boardroom: So, how does the budget string work? Because I'm thinking about…

1989
05:03:59.130 --> 05:04:06.920
Boardroom: the measure FFs of the world, and the things that we've worked hard to provide what felt like direct funding to BFD.

1990
05:04:07.060 --> 05:04:08.670
Boardroom: What's the interplay there?

1991
05:04:09.330 --> 05:04:16.580
Boardroom: to this budget reduction process? Yeah. So, the budget reduction exercise was… there's a general fund deficit, so cut…

1992
05:04:16.790 --> 05:04:19.450
Boardroom: 10 or 12.5% from the general fund.

1993
05:04:19.990 --> 05:04:22.529
Boardroom: We looked at, you know, the…

1994
05:04:22.770 --> 05:04:34.230
Boardroom: there is some cost shifting that we did do to UC funds, Measure GG and Measure FF, but we were very careful to stay within the confines of, how those measures were written.

1995
05:04:34.660 --> 05:04:39.590
Boardroom: Alternatively, we could have legally gone in and taken the full, you know.

1996
05:04:39.710 --> 05:04:50.890
Boardroom: $6 million out of those measures, but then, our feeling was we were kind of, going back on the promises that we made to the voters when they passed those measures for expanded services.

1997
05:04:52.190 --> 05:04:55.349
Boardroom: If we were to use those funds and supplant,

1998
05:04:55.970 --> 05:04:58.060
Boardroom: General fund dollars, if that makes sense.

1999

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05:04:58.650 --> 05:05:04.260
Boardroom: Okay, I think so. I think that made sense, actually. I'll have to watch it later and…

2000
05:05:04.770 --> 05:05:11.799
Boardroom: Break it down again. Yeah, very, very, very, very disturbing.

2001
05:05:12.040 --> 05:05:14.459
Boardroom: Is the HHCS person here online?

2002
05:05:15.470 --> 05:05:19.869
Boardroom: Yes, I'm… Oh, yeah, yeah, yeah. Excellent, hey, so,

2003
05:05:20.310 --> 05:05:26.519
Boardroom: Regarding the… sort of the significant cuts to your department, I'm wondering…

2004
05:05:26.900 --> 05:05:38.739
Boardroom: If any of those cuts are restored via the proposed bond measures and tax, sales tax measure that we are contemplating, putting before voters.

2005
05:05:41.340 --> 05:05:45.450
Boardroom: I don't believe… Any of our… we'll defer to you on that.

2006
05:05:45.840 --> 05:06:02.930
Boardroom: I guess, Mr. White, would you know that? Can you repeat the question, please? It's, regarding the HHCS officers who are, who are, who are, who are cutting to the plan. Does the, does the sales tax and the bond measure, restore any of those, or any of the services, performed therein?

2007
05:06:02.970 --> 05:06:07.199
Boardroom: No, the sales and use tax measure only supports,

2008
05:06:07.610 --> 05:06:18.859
Boardroom: within the police department, the officers and dispatchers, fire station 4, and then 3 positions in Parks, Recreation, and Waterfront, to preserve community, programs.

2009
05:06:19.100 --> 05:06:19.840
Boardroom: Okay.

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2010
05:06:20.500 --> 05:06:24.689
Boardroom: And, and I think that's all for now. Thank you.

2011
05:06:25.530 --> 05:06:29.569
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Oh, was there another…

2012
05:06:29.880 --> 05:06:33.030
Boardroom: Councilmember, did you… No? Okay. Thanks.

2013
05:06:33.700 --> 05:06:39.750
Boardroom: Okay, I want to get back to the presentation, and I also am wondering if the tally's done so that we can…

2014
05:06:40.260 --> 05:06:47.410
Boardroom: finish that off so folks can leave. The tally is done, we just need to… they just need to get over here and confirm it.

2015
05:06:47.570 --> 05:06:51.369
Boardroom: Yeah, they have to, you know.

2016
05:06:51.620 --> 05:07:11.419
Boardroom: put it all together. Do the certification form and everything, and they'll bring it over here for me to sign. We also need to open the other public hearings before 10 p.m. Yeah. Okay, so what I want to do is I'm gonna say first, I'm going to open all of the public hearings for the remaining items. That is item 20… do you need me to read them all, or can I just…

2017
05:07:12.200 --> 05:07:37.120
Boardroom: 22, the animal care services fee schedule. 23, the Neighborhood Services Code and Fourth and Fee Schedule. 24, changes to the environmental health fee schedule. 25, fees, health, housing, and community services facility rental fees. 26, changes to selected recreational facilities and program fees. 27, changes to the planning and development fee schedule. 28, repeal and reenact Berkeley Municipal Code Chapter 14.4.

2018
05:07:37.120 --> 05:07:49.239
Boardroom: 52 to adjust the Go Berkeley Parking Management Program, change parking permit fees, establish a new schedule for parking violations, fines, and late payment penalties, and rescind resolution number 71…

2019

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05:07:49.240 --> 05:07:51.890
Boardroom: Comma 627-NS.

2020
05:07:52.380 --> 05:08:02.770
Boardroom: and 29, zero waste plan checks and compliance inspections fees. Those are now all opened, so, before 10 o'clock. So, and then…

2021
05:08:03.690 --> 05:08:11.189
Boardroom: I think we still haven't gotten that, so what I'm gonna do is gonna go back to the presentation, and hopefully finish another third. Go ahead.

2022
05:08:17.110 --> 05:08:21.620
Boardroom: So this next section is focusing on the general fund.

2023
05:08:22.400 --> 05:08:33.290
Boardroom: We wanted to show you the trajectory of the general fund from the baseline development all the way to what we're proposing right now as the proposed budget.

2024
05:08:33.380 --> 05:08:47.479
Boardroom: So, for 2027, the baseline, the revenue projection was $297.2 million. Personnel expenditure at the time was $225.5 million. Non-personnel came in at $105 million.

2025
05:08:47.950 --> 05:08:56.650
Boardroom: A total expenditure of $329.5 million, so we were looking at a deficit of $32.3 million.

2026
05:08:57.930 --> 05:08:59.889
Boardroom: Do we need to stop? They're here.

2027
05:09:01.590 --> 05:09:07.679
Boardroom: The fiscal year 20… Oh wait, yeah, go back, thank you. One more.

2028
05:09:08.110 --> 05:09:09.710
Boardroom: Oh, no, okay, that's fine.

2029
05:09:10.650 --> 05:09:26.229
Boardroom: And with the fiscal year 2027 proposed, what we are presenting to you today, tonight, is a revenue of $314.9 million, and a total expenditure of $313.9 million.

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2030
05:09:26.260 --> 05:09:31.849
Boardroom: We're actually, have a surplus of $981,000.

2031
05:09:33.110 --> 05:09:50.719
Boardroom: And the proposed surplus is subject to change, obviously, as the budget is refined. The current estimate reflects a combination of the revised revenue projection from February 2026, a routine budget cleanup that occurs working with departments.

2032
05:09:50.790 --> 05:10:00.610
Boardroom: We added a one-time general fund resources to the revenue, as well as an increase in indirect cost charges and implementing the budget balancing items.

2033
05:10:03.140 --> 05:10:20.800
Boardroom: This slide, talks about the same thing, but for fiscal year 2027, the baseline revenue at the time was $302.3 million. The total expenditure came in at $335.6 million, and we were looking at a deficit of $33.2 million.

2034
05:10:21.160 --> 05:10:32.570
Boardroom: After the revised revenue, the budget balancing, and, typical budget process cleanup, the proposed includes a revenue of $320.3 million.

2035
05:10:32.750 --> 05:10:40.369
Boardroom: Total expenditure at $319.6 million, with a surplus of almost $700,000.

2036
05:10:43.380 --> 05:10:55.170
Boardroom: So this slide talks about what changed from 27 and 28 baseline versus 2027 and 2028 proposed, and it breaks it down a little bit more than the prior slides.

2037
05:10:55.440 --> 05:10:57.429
Boardroom: And what this really talks about

2038
05:10:57.520 --> 05:11:16.590
Boardroom: is this is all personnel, and it goes… tells you the decreases from those major cost drivers under the personnel category, so health and retiree, other, pension, salaries, workers' compensation, and overtime. And it really just highlights that the bulk of our reduction

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2039
05:11:16.690 --> 05:11:19.259
Boardroom: Came from our personnel costs.

2040
05:11:29.320 --> 05:11:32.610
Boardroom: Catch up. General fund revenue by category.

2041
05:11:35.560 --> 05:11:40.230
Boardroom: So, this is a breakdown of the revenues that we receive.

2042
05:11:40.400 --> 05:11:45.760
Boardroom: We receive… we have a lot of revenue sources from the general fund, so we categorize some of them.

2043
05:11:46.020 --> 05:11:54.140
Boardroom: But the takeaway from this is that our number one revenue source that goes into the general fund is

2044
05:11:54.440 --> 05:11:58.640
Boardroom: Property-related taxes, which comes in at about 45%.

2045
05:11:59.170 --> 05:12:05.949
Boardroom: And the other, revenue are coming from business license tax, sales tax.

2046
05:12:06.200 --> 05:12:17.520
Boardroom: Utility users tax, vehicle in lieu, and interest income, which totals another, 31%. Those are our top revenue generating.

2047
05:12:17.800 --> 05:12:22.110
Boardroom: Which is why I spent a little bit of time earlier talking about the state.

2048
05:12:22.370 --> 05:12:26.229
Boardroom: a measure that might be on the ballot this November.

2049
05:12:34.870 --> 05:12:40.230
Boardroom: This slide shows a breakdown of our expenditure by department.

2050
05:12:42.440 --> 05:12:49.619
Boardroom: So, the city, the city clerk's budget, shows,

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2051
05:12:49.880 --> 05:12:56.129
Boardroom: a million dollars more than what was in the budget balancing plan. That's because

2052
05:12:56.480 --> 05:13:05.519
Boardroom: We kept that $1 million to preserve it for the known increases in our property and liability insurance.

2053
05:13:06.110 --> 05:13:12.430
Boardroom: The city manager budget decreased more than what was in the budget balancing plan.

2054
05:13:12.660 --> 05:13:17.279
Boardroom: Because we are moving the whole budget for the animal services.

2055
05:13:18.320 --> 05:13:21.790
Boardroom: to its own fund, Fund 115 Animal Shelter Fund.

2056
05:13:22.300 --> 05:13:30.630
Boardroom: And the non-departmental increased Because we are transferring out money from the General Fund to Fund 115.

2057
05:13:30.840 --> 05:13:39.289
Boardroom: And also, just a slight note that the library, does not get any… typically does not get any general fund allocation.

2058
05:13:39.420 --> 05:13:44.609
Boardroom: And the Rent Board, gets an annual fixed amount of $370,000.

2059
05:13:59.330 --> 05:14:00.119
Boardroom: Thank you.

2060
05:14:00.960 --> 05:14:03.630
Boardroom: The proposed general fund expenditure by department

2061
05:14:03.960 --> 05:14:06.430
Boardroom: And this really just breaks down…

2062
05:14:06.790 --> 05:14:13.380

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Boardroom: Our biggest cost driver for the general fund, and it's no surprise that it's… Public Safety.

2063
05:14:14.120 --> 05:14:17.930
Boardroom: than HHCS. There's also general government.

2064
05:14:18.130 --> 05:14:31.780
Boardroom: which is administrative, our legal department, so that's city manager, mayor council, HR, IT, City Audit, all the charter offices, finance.

2065
05:14:32.750 --> 05:14:40.399
Boardroom: And non-departmental is also a big cost driver, and that typically is, transfer outs.

2066
05:14:40.570 --> 05:14:43.440
Boardroom: From the general fund to other funds.

2067
05:14:43.640 --> 05:14:51.529
Boardroom: One of the examples of that is, the $13 million or so that we transfer annually from… to the CIP fund.

2068
05:14:52.010 --> 05:14:58.490
Boardroom: For, $4.9 million of annual baseline and the $8 million plus CPI.

2069
05:14:58.840 --> 05:15:01.200
Boardroom: for the PCI improvement.

2070
05:15:13.030 --> 05:15:23.680
Boardroom: This is just another look of the proposed, general fund by expenditure, but it's broken down by category. So I wanted to point out, that…

2071
05:15:24.030 --> 05:15:26.860
Boardroom: The biggest driver, again, is salaries.

2072
05:15:29.480 --> 05:15:35.560
Boardroom: Can you guys hear me? It's salaries. And the next point is, I wanted to point out that

2073
05:15:37.060 --> 05:15:41.940

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Boardroom: The capital outlay is significantly smaller than prior years.

2074
05:15:42.430 --> 05:15:50.110
Boardroom: And that's because this budget cycle, we did not have any one-time allocation to…

2075
05:15:50.160 --> 05:16:05.700
Boardroom: capital projects that stems from the general fund. Some of you who's been here before are familiar with the term Tier 1, where we would have general fund, funding available, and we would allocate those to one-time

2076
05:16:06.090 --> 05:16:11.970
Boardroom: programs or projects. This time around, we did not have that opportunity in this proposed budget.

2077
05:16:19.880 --> 05:16:24.540
Boardroom: Thanks, this is another one of our, like, little pauses. Does anyone have any questions?

2078
05:16:24.840 --> 05:16:29.970
Boardroom: Yep, go ahead. Oh, sorry, I think, yep, Councilmember Taplin.

2079
05:16:30.100 --> 05:16:40.160
Boardroom: Okay, Councilmember Lenopara. Thank you, I just have a quick question about the vacancy tax, and if that's in the other tax section. I just didn't see it on the list.

2080
05:16:41.340 --> 05:16:44.119
Boardroom: Yes, it's in the, other taxes.

2081
05:16:44.300 --> 05:16:51.950
Boardroom: And did the vacancy tax underperform or overperform this year? Like, where is it on the…

2082
05:16:52.080 --> 05:17:05.250
Boardroom: Our finance director can speak more specifically. I understand for this fiscal year, we had, I think, $2 million budgeted, and right now we've collected about $400,000, was the last time I checked. I haven't seen the most recent

2083
05:17:05.450 --> 05:17:10.880

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Boardroom: monthly numbers. If Director Oyakame has anything updated, he can certainly share that.

2084
05:17:10.880 --> 05:17:17.700
Henry Oyekanmi: We have about half a million… we've received about half a million dollars. It's underperforming.

2085
05:17:18.150 --> 05:17:27.199
Boardroom: Is that because, property owners aren't paying it, that have vacant units, or because there are less vacant units than previous?

2086
05:17:27.810 --> 05:17:45.630
Henry Oyekanmi: Combination of both. This is the first time we're building it, and we… we are partnering with the rain board. The rain board sends us the two departments that are working on it. The Rain Board sends us who to bill, and we bill them, and so we've been having, issues with

2087
05:17:45.700 --> 05:17:58.830
Henry Oyekanmi: maybe the building itself and the collection piece. But this is the first time we're doing it, and so we are in the middle of looking at one of the reasons why are we not building enough, or if the assumptions we had

2088
05:17:58.860 --> 05:18:09.520
Henry Oyekanmi: was… was… was wrong, whether the information we had about how… how… or whether the… the rental people are actually doing their renting, we're not having enough

2089
05:18:09.590 --> 05:18:16.719
Henry Oyekanmi: Vacancy as we thought they would have, but we're looking at it to review why it's not performing as we proposed.

2090
05:18:18.000 --> 05:18:18.729
Boardroom: Thank you.

2091
05:18:20.230 --> 05:18:26.130
Boardroom: Thank you. Councilmember Taplin? Thank you, and for my edification, can you clarify

2092
05:18:26.440 --> 05:18:31.060
Boardroom: How slash why there would be a surplus if we have a structural deficit?

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2093
05:18:32.000 --> 05:18:37.649
Boardroom: Clarify what again? How there would be a surplus if we have a deficit? Yeah. Do you want me to answer that?

2094
05:18:38.480 --> 05:18:55.730
Boardroom: So, we started off with a general fund deficit. However, after we did the budget balancing measure, plus the application of the one-time use of the $12.045 billion one-time revenue, and the changes in indirect cost charges, among other things.

2095
05:18:55.730 --> 05:19:00.049
Boardroom: We ended up with, a very small amount of,

2096
05:19:00.770 --> 05:19:19.570
Boardroom: of, no longer a deficit, but a surplus. Thank you. Had we considered using that to replenish some of the one-time borrowing that we did, or so-called one-time borrowing that we've previously done from, let's say, the pension trust, or the workers' comp fund?

2097
05:19:21.170 --> 05:19:26.639
Boardroom: No. No, we didn't, Councilmember. We, as, as… Budgetum energy pie, I said.

2098
05:19:27.470 --> 05:19:38.809
Boardroom: concerned about some, expenses coming in higher than we thought. For example, the insurance came in, I don't know, quite a lot higher than budgeted, and we think there's gonna be some other ones behind that one.

2099
05:19:38.810 --> 05:19:48.680
Boardroom: Right, so we want that for… to account for volatility. Exactly. Yes, to address some of those issues, the challenges and unknowns, that we talked about earlier.

2100
05:19:48.920 --> 05:19:49.960
Boardroom: Thank you very much.

2101
05:19:50.260 --> 05:19:52.230
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember Blackaby.

2102
05:19:52.870 --> 05:19:59.099
Boardroom: Two questions. First, around the sales tax. So, our fiscal 28…

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2103
05:19:59.590 --> 05:20:04.710
Boardroom: proposed revenue. That assumes a full year of the sales tax, is that right?

2104
05:20:04.790 --> 05:20:22.249
Boardroom: Correct. Okay. So without the sales tax, and we, again, we think that's around $8 or $9 million, I think that's… 9.64. Okay. So, just looking at fiscal 27 versus 28 revenue, without the sales tax, our fiscal 28 revenue would actually be $311.

2105
05:20:22.570 --> 05:20:32.749
Boardroom: In fiscal 27 revenues 314. So, without the sales tax, we're actually projecting a reduction in revenue year over year. Do we know, kind of, what's driving that? Is that a Henry question?

2106
05:20:33.390 --> 05:20:34.659
Boardroom: If Henry's there.

2107
05:20:35.390 --> 05:20:44.369
Boardroom: I'm just curious, year over year, what's happening to cause us to project a reduction in revenue, if there's any one or two particular things?

2108
05:20:44.720 --> 05:20:47.649
Henry Oyekanmi: we… we're in oper… we're…

2109
05:20:48.040 --> 05:21:06.419
Henry Oyekanmi: all the projections that we have for the next 5 years, there's just a marginal rate of revenues, like, about 2.33%, where there's no reduction in revenues from the next 5 years that we have. The just marginal rate of return is what we have. So, for 27…

2110
05:21:06.710 --> 05:21:08.630
Henry Oyekanmi: I think we're projecting…

2111
05:21:08.820 --> 05:21:27.639
Henry Oyekanmi: We changed that, and then it's, like, 310 for 28, or 311, and then it's 318 for 29, and it's 325 for 2030. So, all our 5-year projections, like, about 2% to 3% increase in revenues.

2112
05:21:27.640 --> 05:21:46.719
Boardroom: Okay, I was just observing on that slide between fiscal 27 and fiscal 28, if you subtract out the sales tax in fiscal 28, it looks like…

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anyway, just take a look at that. That's a really good observation, and yes, because in 2027, we incorporated in the revenue the, one-time

2113
05:21:46.800 --> 05:21:53.110
Boardroom: The $12.05 million for the one-time use. Correct. And that's not included in 2028.

2114
05:21:53.110 --> 05:21:54.119
Henry Oyekanmi: Indeed, yes.

2115
05:21:54.120 --> 05:22:10.060
Boardroom: Last thing, non-personal expenditures, so even after, again, we've gone through this exercise, we're trying to reduce where we can, baseline to proposed in both 27 and 28, like, non-personal expenditures or forecasts increase, is that where we're seeing the things like increased insurance and some of these, like.

2116
05:22:10.430 --> 05:22:24.180
Boardroom: you know, everything else is coming down, you know, personnel expenditures are down 7%, total expenditures are down 4.7%, but non-personnel expenditures are up a million dollars, even after this sort of budget balancing exercise. Just curious, again, what's driving

2117
05:22:24.440 --> 05:22:26.799
Boardroom: You know, what's driving that, if we know?

2118
05:22:27.600 --> 05:22:39.630
Boardroom: Our non-departmental, because we… we did, move some… we increased our general fund non-departmental, again, to offset some of the, animal services.

2119
05:22:39.770 --> 05:22:44.640
Boardroom: Move. We also, increased our non-departmental to,

2120
05:22:45.350 --> 05:22:59.650
Boardroom: predict some UAL costs due to… because UAL cost is a fixed cost, no matter how many staffing… how many FTEs we have. So we did a very, you know, rough estimate of how much we would still need to pay.

2121
05:22:59.780 --> 05:23:16.999
Boardroom: Even if we, we lose, FTEs, and there's, other various, various things that we added. It did sound, and there's this unexpected insurance… I know there's other things that we're seeing. Yes, in 2027

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and 28, even though we, in the baseline, we, we treated it up, what we have

2122
05:23:17.010 --> 05:23:32.730
Boardroom: budgeted in the past for insurance, then U.S. estimate we received is still about half a million dollars, more than the increase that we have already implemented in our 2027 budget. And this is for things like seismic fire, you know, just… Correct. Okay, thank you.

2123
05:23:33.520 --> 05:23:50.500
Boardroom: Thank you so much. I'm sorry, I have… in my rush to continue us on, I didn't get to ask two questions for both Chiefs. One of the question is, maybe Chief or David, can you clarify which of the specialty units will shrink and which ones will end?

2124
05:23:50.810 --> 05:23:53.239
Boardroom: I just wasn't clear on that slide.

2125
05:23:57.230 --> 05:24:10.829
Boardroom: Yeah, so, most of our units are already working at reduced staffing, just from attrition we've had over the years. We would get to the place where we'd have to make the assessment about whether we just continue to shrink them and try to keep them all open, but…

2126
05:24:10.830 --> 05:24:17.760
Boardroom: relatively ineffectual, or close one together. We haven't got to the point where we've really laid out what that exact decision-making would be.

2127
05:24:18.350 --> 05:24:37.190
Boardroom: Thank you, I appreciate that. And then for Chief Spray, can you just speak to… just follow up on what Councilmember Taplan was asking about, the street trauma prevention position? Like, how has that been working? Is there currently anyone in that seat? Can you just talk a little bit about that, please? Sure. Yeah, it's a filled position. Rania's here.

2128
05:24:37.360 --> 05:24:43.950
Boardroom: In the audience, and, it is… it's an exciting program.

2129
05:24:44.060 --> 05:24:50.189
Boardroom: because it's new, because this is an issue across the country where fire departments and Vision Zero

2130

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05:24:50.700 --> 05:24:56.590
Boardroom: Employees in public works and advocates in the community are kind of coming into conflict often.

2131
05:24:56.870 --> 05:25:01.270
Boardroom: When everybody's focused on saving lives,

2132
05:25:01.500 --> 05:25:11.789
Boardroom: But it's a difficult situation, so we're trying to create a program that can de-conflict that, bring people together that find themselves at odds in this situation.

2133
05:25:11.950 --> 05:25:18.889
Boardroom: And the work that's coming out of, STP and that Rania's doing is novel.

2134
05:25:19.200 --> 05:25:20.920
Boardroom: from everything…

2135
05:25:22.030 --> 05:25:31.030
Boardroom: I'll put it this way. Until Rania came, I was the only one that had time to think about this stuff in our department. So there's just nobody to do this work.

2136
05:25:31.210 --> 05:25:36.269
Boardroom: So, she's helping move things forward that are as simple as adopting

2137
05:25:36.800 --> 05:25:42.889
Boardroom: A modified speed hump that allows us to pass, that many other jurisdictions already have in place.

2138
05:25:43.190 --> 05:25:47.680
Boardroom: To as complex as, having numerous groups of.

2139
05:25:47.920 --> 05:25:55.380
Boardroom: Cal students work on a variety of different projects around technology, community perception.

2140
05:25:55.550 --> 05:26:00.629
Boardroom: So, all kinds of interesting work is really starting to flow out of that program right now.

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2141
05:26:01.100 --> 05:26:06.349
Boardroom: And unfortunately, all that would stop, because there's… it would go back to just me being able to…

2142
05:26:06.610 --> 05:26:08.160
Boardroom: focus on it when I have time.

2143
05:26:09.300 --> 05:26:12.820
Boardroom: Did that answer your question? Yeah, thank you, I appreciate that, that's helpful.

2144
05:26:12.990 --> 05:26:16.400
Boardroom: Okay, and… in…

2145
05:26:16.640 --> 05:26:28.259
Boardroom: the theme of making this an even more confusing meeting. We are gonna pause this really quickly so that we can take care of this item that we had not finished earlier. Now that we have gotten the tabulation,

2146
05:26:28.970 --> 05:26:42.709
Boardroom: of the votes, and… was the… City Clerk, were you able to prepare and sign the certification? Yes, so, City received 175 ballots.

2147
05:26:42.800 --> 05:27:00.569
Boardroom: The staff, reviewed and tabulated those ballots, 170 of which were valid. They are weighted by the, proportional financial obligation of the affected property, how much of the assessment that they'll pay.

2148
05:27:00.570 --> 05:27:18.740
Boardroom: And, the weighted tabulation of the ballots is, yes, 81.53% and no, 18.47%. So the, the bid can be, renewed.

2149
05:27:19.610 --> 05:27:30.169
Boardroom: So there's the two actions on item 20, there's the resolution, reestablishing, the downtown…

2150
05:27:30.340 --> 05:27:45.479
Boardroom: Downtown bid for a 10-year period, and then the second resolution authorizing City Manager to execute the contract with the DBA, for the 10-year period as well. With the staff recommendations.

2151
05:27:45.970 --> 05:27:56.439

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Boardroom: Thank you. Did you have another comment, Councilmember, or was that it? That's it. Okay, is there a second? A second from Councilmember Kesarwani. Did you… were you gonna say something, Councilmember Barnes?

2152
05:27:58.340 --> 05:28:03.170
Boardroom: Alright, very good. Can we please take, take the role on this?

2153
05:28:03.420 --> 05:28:10.900
Boardroom: Okay, to approve the recommendations to reestablish the downtown Berkeley Property-Based Business Improvement District.

2154
05:28:11.030 --> 05:28:17.599
Boardroom: Councilmember Keserwani? Yes. Taplin? Aye. Bartlett? Yes. Dragum? Aye.

2155
05:28:17.710 --> 05:28:20.570
Boardroom: O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby? Yes.

2156
05:28:20.570 --> 05:28:39.599
Boardroom: Unapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mayor Ishii? Yes. Okay, motion carries. Okay, thank you all so much. Now you can leave. Alright, so… thanks, everyone. Alright, back to the budget. Sorry, everyone, I know this is very confusing. Alright, let's finish off the last…

2157
05:28:39.610 --> 05:28:45.070
Boardroom: third of this, unless you have another question right now, or you… Yeah, a quick question. Yeah, okay.

2158
05:28:57.840 --> 05:29:15.290
Boardroom: And this is something that's been on my mind for a while, trying to just kind of quantitatively think about the assessment of, you know, position cuts, right, position eliminations, et cetera, versus

2159
05:29:15.650 --> 05:29:23.570
Boardroom: The… the cost… I guess the medical kind of wear and tear on the body from overtime.

2160
05:29:23.820 --> 05:29:30.600
Boardroom: Or early retirement, or burnout. I'm trying to just… have you thought about that? Are there people that think about those numbers?

2161
05:29:33.030 --> 05:29:56.499

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Boardroom: Well, it's an interesting point, because it's the same thing we discussed. If we cut our staffing levels to a minimum, just to fill minimum staffing, then any absence requires overtime to fill it. That's what we're experiencing in our communications center right now. And we do see, a lot more end-of-career workers' comp-related injuries or stress-related injuries as a result of it.

2162
05:29:56.500 --> 05:30:15.480
Boardroom: what we experience is some degradation in the quality of service we can provide, you know, by the officers, because they're tired. The communication center's tired, the officers are tired. So, absolutely, that's a real factor that we look at when we look at how we address the budget deficit, with the money we have to save, which is in personnel.

2163
05:30:15.920 --> 05:30:24.629
Boardroom: Is there some sort of… Berkeley-inspired smart ratio of, sort of, overtime balance with

2164
05:30:25.500 --> 05:30:35.909
Boardroom: You know, not adequate staffing, but some sort of marginal, balance between available staff and amount of overtime that functions

2165
05:30:36.100 --> 05:30:37.379
Boardroom: Kind of will.

2166
05:30:37.930 --> 05:30:56.599
Boardroom: Well, we know a couple things to be true. One is that, even at a set staffing level, you have 10-15% that are gone for injury, vacation, training time off, and whatever. So that's one, allowance you have to consider. The other thing that we know is that, the…

2167
05:30:58.390 --> 05:31:10.870
Boardroom: the balance of… the cost for an FTE and the salary savings you might experience by not hiring, which then is… has to be, filled by a position doing a minimum staffing for overtime.

2168
05:31:10.870 --> 05:31:18.480
Boardroom: creates an automatic deficit, a structural deficit in the way that our system works. We know a couple other things, too, which is that,

2169
05:31:18.480 --> 05:31:32.249
Boardroom: We have been able to work within our budget. So our patrol, division, which is the largest, financial driver of our overtime, that's our biggest division, the division that has the minimum staffing, they are able to work year over year pretty close to at their budget.

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2170
05:31:32.250 --> 05:31:50.699
Boardroom: So we know that there's just a certain cost of business of unexpected calls, needs for training, wellness, needs for the officers that cause you to have some amount of overtime, the unpredictability of it. In other situations, like our communications center, we are over 300% over our budget.

2171
05:31:50.700 --> 05:32:09.240
Boardroom: Because of how decimated we are in staffing in that unit, and those things are harder to absorb. And so, as you're looking at how you can, like I said, look at salary savings to cover, or reduce your minimum staffing, or the way you staff a unit, when you know you have a bare minimum that is required to do the work.

2172
05:32:09.240 --> 05:32:19.730
Boardroom: If you, if you get too close to that margin, then you force overtime, which has a negative health effect, negative service effect, and also, raises up your over, your overall cost.

2173
05:32:20.070 --> 05:32:27.749
Boardroom: Is that a similar sort of, understanding around, the dispatch, the dispatch personnel?

2174
05:32:28.620 --> 05:32:44.939
Boardroom: Because, you know, they're stretched as well. Do they do overtime, or how does that work? Yeah, we have a significant amount of overtime that's mandated for our communications center. They have been understaffed for a very long time, working under very hard conditions. That is…

2175
05:32:44.940 --> 05:32:50.889
Boardroom: Like I said, they're 300% over their normal budget because of how narrow that margin is.

2176
05:32:53.990 --> 05:32:57.999
Boardroom: Thank you. Alright, let's finish off this last chunk, please.

2177
05:33:03.350 --> 05:33:10.859
Boardroom: So this next section is talking about all funds, so not just general fund, but it does include, our general fund.

2178
05:33:12.830 --> 05:33:15.500
Boardroom: It's broken down by categories.

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2179
05:33:16.020 --> 05:33:25.739
Boardroom: So, capital project funds is at, $34 million for 2027. For 2028 is at $34.3.

2180
05:33:25.880 --> 05:33:29.919
Boardroom: Debt service is at $7.5 million for both.

2181
05:33:30.220 --> 05:33:35.080
Boardroom: Enterprise Funds, which is one of our biggest, funding sources for the city.

2182
05:33:35.100 --> 05:33:46.950
Boardroom: comes in at $137.2 million, for 2027, and $140 for 2028. And general funds is $327.7 in 27.

2183
05:33:46.960 --> 05:34:04.169
Boardroom: And 333.2 at 2020… in 2028. I want to pause here to explain for those of you who can recall that the general fund revenue, we mentioned earlier, it was, like, $314 in 2027 and $320 in 2028.

2184
05:34:04.170 --> 05:34:16.399
Boardroom: This general fund, all funds, includes the whole general fund family, and so that includes funds anywhere from Measure U1, as well as our payroll deduction trust. So the whole general fund

2185
05:34:16.420 --> 05:34:20.370
Boardroom: Family is included in here. That's why there's a discrepancy in the number.

2186
05:34:21.270 --> 05:34:35.509
Boardroom: The grant funds is at $42.5 for 2027, and $42 for 2028. Our ISF, or internal service funds, is at $51.7 million in 2027, and $51.7 in 2028.

2187
05:34:36.000 --> 05:34:54.910
Boardroom: Other funds at 15.4 and, in both in 27 and 28. And special funds, is at $155.8 in 2027, and 148 in 2028, totaling $772 million, in 2027.

2188
05:34:55.040 --> 05:34:58.139
Boardroom: And $773 million in 2028.

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2189
05:35:07.480 --> 05:35:13.289
Boardroom: This is just the same information, but broken down just to see the bulk of

2190
05:35:13.430 --> 05:35:18.749
Boardroom: are all fund sources. The number one source is coming from the general fund.

2191
05:35:19.350 --> 05:35:21.329
Boardroom: And at 42%.

2192
05:35:21.490 --> 05:35:25.260
Boardroom: And coming in next is our special funds at 20%.

2193
05:35:25.710 --> 05:35:36.060
Boardroom: enterprise funds at 18%. So those 3 funding sources alone combine 80% of all of our funding sources for the City of Berkeley.

2194
05:35:40.450 --> 05:35:47.670
Boardroom: We're now moving on to the expenditure side of all funds, and this is broken down by department?

2195
05:35:48.700 --> 05:36:07.499
Boardroom: So, for… this is a little bit different. I just wanted to show how vast, the services we provide and our funding sources, instead of just focusing on the general fund. So in general fund, the number one, expense source was public safety, in terms of department, but now it's flipped a little bit.

2196
05:36:07.690 --> 05:36:13.149
Boardroom: Public Works is 26%, HHCS is at 18%,

2197
05:36:13.500 --> 05:36:17.769
Boardroom: Police is at 12%, non-departmental is at 11%.

2198
05:36:18.020 --> 05:36:24.379
Boardroom: and general government at 10%, fire at 8%, and PRW at 6%.

2199
05:36:32.970 --> 05:36:37.880
Boardroom: This slide shows the difference between baseline and proposed.

2200

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05:36:38.620 --> 05:36:43.510
Boardroom: So, for 27 baseline, it was $832.2 million.

2201
05:36:43.810 --> 05:37:00.510
Boardroom: And the base… and the proposed year is $905.2 million, so that's a huge increase of about $73 million. For fiscal year 2028, the baseline, all funds, was at $848.1 million.

2202
05:37:00.680 --> 05:37:13.330
Boardroom: And in the proposed budget, it is $865.3. So that's a difference of $17.2 million. So I just want to address the, examples of the increases in the non-personnel.

2203
05:37:13.700 --> 05:37:22.970
Boardroom: So, we open up the budget to the departments after developing the baseline, because they know their funds that they manage best.

2204
05:37:24.260 --> 05:37:27.380
Boardroom: There's Measure O, it's $27 million.

2205
05:37:28.310 --> 05:37:31.319
Boardroom: There's also capital programs.

2206
05:37:31.550 --> 05:37:34.210
Boardroom: That have been… Budgeted.

2207
05:37:34.360 --> 05:37:51.820
Boardroom: That's why there's a huge increase in non-personnel. For example, Measure FF streets is a good example. There's a $29 million addition from baseline to proposed. Another one is for… another $14.5 million just in overall capital projects.

2208
05:37:52.740 --> 05:37:55.850
Boardroom: Some of the decreases come from…

2209
05:37:56.190 --> 05:38:11.690
Boardroom: Fiscal year 227-28, the CIP fund is about $2 million decrease. We talked about their stressed fund, so Public Works did a really good job cost-shifting that, Fund 501 personnel cost to other appropriate funding sources.

2210
05:38:20.830 --> 05:38:22.049
Boardroom: Do we need to pause?

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2211
05:38:22.470 --> 05:38:23.660
Boardroom: We're not gonna pause.

2212
05:38:24.730 --> 05:38:35.389
Boardroom: So this is, the next section is about staffing. We kind of touched on this, during the first part of this presentation, but this breaks it down more into, detail.

2213
05:38:35.830 --> 05:38:37.670
Boardroom: Of what we are looking at.

2214
05:38:42.410 --> 05:38:49.990
Boardroom: So the full-time equivalent total is 1,604, or 1,605 FTEs.

2215
05:38:50.480 --> 05:38:55.580
Boardroom: The largest departments are Public Works, Police, HHCS, and Fire.

2216
05:38:56.300 --> 05:39:01.979
Boardroom: The general fund, supports, 663 FTEs, or 41%.

2217
05:39:02.220 --> 05:39:07.520
Boardroom: And all of the other funds support 941 FTEs, totaling 59%.

2218
05:39:08.860 --> 05:39:14.709
Boardroom: This total of 1,605, almost, includes the library and the red board.

2219
05:39:14.940 --> 05:39:27.039
Boardroom: Excluding these two, and we only talk about charter offices and city manager managed departments, the total goes down to about 1,445 FTEs.

2220
05:39:35.720 --> 05:39:40.519
Boardroom: This next slide shows historical, not just the proposed.

2221
05:39:43.790 --> 05:39:46.519
Boardroom: And as you can see, we had…

2222
05:39:48.700 --> 05:39:55.590

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Boardroom: 1,504 FTEs in 2024, and in 2027-28,

2223
05:39:55.840 --> 05:40:00.500
Boardroom: We, with the proposed budget, we have $1,604.

2224
05:40:01.360 --> 05:40:07.019
Boardroom: I want to point out that the highest increase in our FTE came between

2225
05:40:07.410 --> 05:40:20.380
Boardroom: from 2022 to 2023, where our workforce increased by 8.7%, or 127, or 128 FTEs.

2226
05:40:21.470 --> 05:40:27.780
Boardroom: The 2027 and 2028 proposed staffing level decreased by 9.3%,

2227
05:40:28.410 --> 05:40:33.939
Boardroom: or 164.3 FTEs compared to 2026.

2228
05:40:35.560 --> 05:40:40.160
Boardroom: This proposed budget, as mentioned earlier, reflects a reduction

2229
05:40:40.300 --> 05:40:43.599
Boardroom: of 150 FTEs from the Budget Balancing Plan.

2230
05:40:44.670 --> 05:40:49.479
Boardroom: And the 33 FTEs, from the 183 total that we mentioned.

2231
05:40:49.580 --> 05:40:52.140
Boardroom: It's preserved, for the meantime.

2232
05:40:57.510 --> 05:41:09.209
Boardroom: So that concludes our presentation. So we're gonna talk about next steps and discussion. So before we go into discussion, we just wanted to briefly talk about timeline and expectations.

2233
05:41:10.880 --> 05:41:17.299
Boardroom: So we're here today to talk about… we presented the… proposed budget.

2234

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05:41:18.110 --> 05:41:30.750
Boardroom: On May 28th, we are going back to Budget and Finance Policy Committee to talk about, the CIP, the 5-year CIP, and also the Mayor's budget recommendations.

2235
05:41:31.580 --> 05:41:39.169
Boardroom: on June 9th, We are going back to the full council to present the 5-year CIP.

2236
05:41:39.480 --> 05:41:54.389
Boardroom: June 16th is a potential discontinued discussion in front of all of you, regarding both the biannual budget and the 5-year CIP, because by that time, you would have all, seen and heard we would have presented them.

2237
05:41:54.570 --> 05:42:01.629
Boardroom: And then hopefully June 23rd, we are going to adopt the, 27-28 biannual budget.

2238
05:42:01.940 --> 05:42:15.210
Boardroom: and the 5-year CIP. And just looking ahead, July 1st, the fiscal year 2027 begins, and the budget balancing plan that's adopted, whatever form that is, will take into effect.

2239
05:42:15.530 --> 05:42:21.479
Boardroom: And July 2nd, employees being impacted, by the adopted budget receives notices.

2240
05:42:28.640 --> 05:42:38.930
Boardroom: So we're now ready for discussion of the proposed budget. Thank you. Thank you. I think we actually have questions first. So are there any other questions for this last section of the budget?

2241
05:42:40.050 --> 05:42:42.960
Boardroom: I will start with Council… Vice Mayor Trey Gup.

2242
05:42:44.470 --> 05:42:54.879
Boardroom: Thank you, this is just a request, on slight… 36… no, I'm sorry, on…

2243
05:42:55.590 --> 05:43:05.310
Boardroom: Whichever… I guess slide 34, when you talked about the discrepancy between the general fund and the general fund plus

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2244
05:43:05.450 --> 05:43:08.819
Boardroom: Family of other funds.

2245
05:43:09.210 --> 05:43:20.789
Boardroom: I, if it might be possible to share a breakdown of all of those funds, I would be interested in seeing a tabulation of that.

2246
05:43:20.990 --> 05:43:27.040
Boardroom: It might have been in the budget book, and if so, I apologize, I didn't see it there.

2247
05:43:27.420 --> 05:43:36.349
Boardroom: Also, on slide 37, The, accounting of how…

2248
05:43:36.870 --> 05:43:45.130
Boardroom: Non-personnel, expenditures increased from the baseline to proposed,

2249
05:43:46.020 --> 05:43:53.230
Boardroom: I would benefit from seeing a graphical representation of the cost shifting to get there. Thank you.

2250
05:44:05.960 --> 05:44:14.830
Boardroom: Sorry. We'll get it. Okay, thank you. Yeah, for sure. I wasn't sure if you wanted to address that. Alright, and, was there another question?

2251
05:44:15.420 --> 05:44:17.590
Boardroom: Okay, anyone else? Questions? No.

2252
05:44:18.180 --> 05:44:22.340
Boardroom: Okay.

2253
05:44:23.080 --> 05:44:28.159
Boardroom: Alright, we will go on to our public comment on this item.

2254
05:44:29.980 --> 05:44:33.389
Boardroom: If you have public comment on…

2255
05:44:34.020 --> 05:44:42.099

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Boardroom: Item number 21, which is the proposed FY2027, FY2028 biennial budget, and proposed biennial budget public hearing number 1.

2256
05:44:42.360 --> 05:44:43.750
Boardroom: Please come on up.

2257
05:44:52.680 --> 05:44:55.699
Boardroom: Yeah. I think I have a couple of minutes over here.

2258
05:44:56.550 --> 05:45:06.929
Boardroom: Okay. 1, 2… Is there a third minute, please? There's one online. There's one online. The last name is Nijkovsky.

2259
05:45:07.500 --> 05:45:11.170
Boardroom: Okay… Theodore? Theodore?

2260
05:45:15.080 --> 05:45:17.949
Boardroom: Theodore, are you okay with giving your minute?

2261
05:45:20.480 --> 05:45:36.090
Boardroom: I'm gonna assume yes. Go ahead. Okay. Good evening, Honorable Mayor and members of the City Council. For those of you who don't know me, my name is Justin Pitcher, and I'm a Recreation Program Supervisor in the Parks, Recreation, and Waterfront Department, here to speak tonight in my capacity as President of Public Employees Union Local 1, AFSCME.

2262
05:45:36.570 --> 05:45:42.310
Boardroom: Before Unite is the first reading of the budget. It has been a long ride to get here, but at the same time, our work has just begun.

2263
05:45:42.930 --> 05:45:47.470
Boardroom: My representational unit stands to lose 20 positions, 5 of which are currently filled.

2264
05:45:48.160 --> 05:45:51.450
Boardroom: Proposed cuts include one in engineering, two in mental health.

2265
05:45:51.650 --> 05:45:55.289
Boardroom: One in the waterfront, and one in the fire department, subject to bumping.

2266

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05:45:56.160 --> 05:45:59.180
Boardroom: Many of our team are here in solidarity tonight.

2267
05:45:59.450 --> 05:46:09.290
Boardroom: Earlier tonight, you heard from one of our members, Abby, from the Rent Board, who stands to lose her position through the bumping process, having received an impact notice just weeks after joining the city team.

2268
05:46:10.140 --> 05:46:23.290
Boardroom: I want to reiterate that the City decided to fill this position, and Abby brought her family to Berkeley, giving up stable employment to serve our amazing community with an implied insurance that the city intended to fill the position it advertised for the long haul.

2269
05:46:24.050 --> 05:46:31.369
Boardroom: Also in the audience tonight is Rania, who serves as the program manager and only staff member to the pilot project for the Street Trauma Prevention Team.

2270
05:46:31.970 --> 05:46:33.179
Boardroom: Through her work.

2271
05:46:33.300 --> 05:46:44.970
Boardroom: We are on the cutting edge of making a difference across Berkeley. Her program will cease to exist with the elimination of her position, as Chief Sprague has indicated that he has no other staffing to shift the program to.

2272
05:46:45.700 --> 05:46:54.050
Boardroom: The City's in the current process of applying for a grant that would fund this program over the next 4 years, starting in July of 20… calendar 2027.

2273
05:46:54.700 --> 05:46:57.740
Boardroom: Eliminating this program now is very short-sighted.

2274
05:46:58.330 --> 05:47:03.280
Boardroom: These are but two stories of public service that will be lost in the budget elimination process.

2275
05:47:04.160 --> 05:47:08.389
Boardroom: All budget reductions have an immediate impact on the services we provide across the city.

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2276
05:47:08.910 --> 05:47:12.840
Boardroom: As you can imagine, this is a trying time to be a member of the City of Berkeley team.

2277
05:47:13.190 --> 05:47:22.419
Boardroom: Tensions are high, uncertainty is next level, and expressed feelings make some days at the office unbearable for those of us that continue to give our all to fulfill the duties.

2278
05:47:23.360 --> 05:47:25.090
Boardroom: Of our assignments, and more.

2279
05:47:26.240 --> 05:47:31.600
Boardroom: We're an amazing group of dedicated individuals who serve our constituents day in and day out around the clock.

2280
05:47:32.790 --> 05:47:47.089
Boardroom: As we progress over the next 6 weeks, and we work hand-in-hand with the Council to ultimately adopt a budget in time for the June 30th deadline, we ask that the Council, act with care for all of us, especially those who provide the services that are on the table for elimination.

2281
05:47:47.590 --> 05:47:53.660
Boardroom: Through the Budget and Finance Committee process, the unions continue to uphold its commitment to being a partner in balancing the budget.

2282
05:47:54.040 --> 05:48:06.750
Boardroom: Furthermore, we are grateful for the partnership forged by the esteemed City Manager through his union leadership budget meetings, and are looking forward to continuing that partnership with each of you. Keep an eye out in your email for our meeting requests.

2283
05:48:07.530 --> 05:48:15.880
Boardroom: While each of us is a civil servant, we are also members of society, members of families, and upstanding citizens who stand to lose a lot through these reductions.

2284
05:48:16.480 --> 05:48:19.740
Boardroom: Tonight, the Council celebrated the work that many of our members provide.

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2285
05:48:19.870 --> 05:48:26.299
Boardroom: We are the managers and supervisors that make public works happen. We are the engineers that built Willard Clubhouse.

2286
05:48:26.400 --> 05:48:32.480
Boardroom: We are the analysts and admin and fiscal services managers that have made the hard recommendations to make these cuts.

2287
05:48:32.660 --> 05:48:34.789
Boardroom: That are impacting city services.

2288
05:48:36.140 --> 05:48:40.739
Boardroom: We all are the boots on the ground that engage with our community every single day.

2289
05:48:41.220 --> 05:48:44.030
Boardroom: In closing, I urge the City Council

2290
05:48:44.660 --> 05:48:49.940
Boardroom: To look at each of your employees as real people and not a statistic on a budget spreadsheet.

2291
05:48:50.460 --> 05:48:54.209
Boardroom: Think of our families and those we support in each hard decision ahead.

2292
05:48:54.670 --> 05:48:58.759
Boardroom: Plan to work within our means, and work today to protect services tomorrow.

2293
05:48:58.910 --> 05:49:08.790
Boardroom: We can't change the past, but we can prepare for a more stable Berkeley tomorrow on be… and on behalf of the hardworking members of Public Employees Union, Local One ASCME, I thank you for your time.

2294
05:49:08.950 --> 05:49:11.340
Boardroom: Thank you.

2295
05:49:20.340 --> 05:49:27.919
Boardroom: Good evening, I'm Leah Summon-Weisberg. I live in District 2. I serve on the Housing Advisory Commission.

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2296
05:49:27.920 --> 05:49:41.770
Boardroom: I'm here tonight because, there are several projects in District 2 that are ready for, funding from the small sites. We don't have enough money for any of those sites, and so we have housing that is being put at risk.

2297
05:49:41.770 --> 05:49:55.190
Boardroom: Last year, last time we did the budget, you know, when you look at the coverage, we talked a lot about small sites. We didn't have… the money was not placed in that, and now we've not been able to have fun projects.

2298
05:49:55.190 --> 05:50:19.200
Boardroom: I think… I know you're balancing a lot of different things, but I think just to echo the situation that the county is placing us in, and that they… they are not ensuring that we can fund programs that we know work, and we're gonna lose them. The same thing is happening with small sites. It's a program that really, really works, but you have to actually fund it. Please, please protect, what we have, and if possible, add so we actually have enough for the projects.

2299
05:50:19.200 --> 05:50:20.050
Boardroom: Thank you.

2300
05:50:21.180 --> 05:50:22.299
Boardroom: Thank you.

2301
05:50:26.360 --> 05:50:29.240
Boardroom: Thank you. I have one volunteer to cede her time to me.

2302
05:50:29.750 --> 05:50:38.289
Boardroom: Thank you. Thanks. I'm Rebecca Webb, and I am the chapter president of the clerical chapter, and I'm here representing both the maintenance and clerical chapters today.

2303
05:50:38.400 --> 05:50:42.210
Boardroom: Can you talk into the mic? Sorry. Sure. You can hold it up, yeah, there you go.

2304
05:50:43.070 --> 05:50:53.120
Boardroom: When we first received the, the proposed budget in March, we breathed a sigh of relief because we saw that none of our

2305

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05:50:53.300 --> 05:51:09.179
Boardroom: people were going to be out the door. As you, recently heard, that's not true for all of the units. But that sigh of relief was kind of short-lived when we looked at the list and saw that what we were losing is 50, 5-0 positions in our unit alone.

2306
05:51:09.280 --> 05:51:22.510
Boardroom: That's about 10% of our workforce. And that represents your laborers, your landscape gardeners, your 911 dispatchers, your 311 customer service, one of my personal favorites, your payroll clerks.

2307
05:51:22.510 --> 05:51:30.040
Boardroom: your, all… a whole slew of boots-on-the-ground employees. And,

2308
05:51:31.840 --> 05:51:41.029
Boardroom: And that's just a hard pill to swallow, that we're going to be losing those positions, because that, we know, means that that work now lands on the people who are still here.

2309
05:51:41.190 --> 05:51:48.609
Boardroom: And we did hear our city manager tell us in an all-staff meeting that it is understood that you cannot do more with less.

2310
05:51:48.930 --> 05:51:52.210
Boardroom: But that is… that's easier said than done.

2311
05:51:52.350 --> 05:52:00.299
Boardroom: Because we are the ones who are seeing people face-to-face, and the community expects just as much out of us today as they did yesterday, the day before, and tomorrow.

2312
05:52:00.810 --> 05:52:12.339
Boardroom: We're not gonna get any less 911 calls, we're not gonna get any less 311 calls, we're not gonna get any less potholes, or any less blades of grass that need to be cut. All of this work needs to be done.

2313
05:52:12.560 --> 05:52:28.169
Boardroom: And it will be on the backs of people. As you saw, the majority of where we have to cut is in the budget. One of the things that I really want to touch on that is important for you to make sense of is that this really does the buck stops here.

2314
05:52:28.190 --> 05:52:36.499

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Boardroom: We are all stewards. Everyone who collects a paycheck, is there someone who will cede a minute to me? Thank you, a minute over here. Thank you so much.

2315
05:52:37.680 --> 05:52:43.029
Boardroom: Everyone who receives a paycheck in the City of Berkeley, thank you, payroll clerks, is

2316
05:52:43.240 --> 05:52:52.380
Boardroom: is stewards of our resources and our assets. But really, the buck stops with you all on where those resources are led.

2317
05:52:52.540 --> 05:52:55.439
Boardroom: I oftentimes will see items on the agenda.

2318
05:52:55.750 --> 05:53:07.500
Boardroom: That, to your point, a million hair, a million there, there's a half a million here, where is that going? And sometimes I see, in the rationale, not much more than, because we need it.

2319
05:53:08.110 --> 05:53:09.040
Boardroom: Really?

2320
05:53:09.880 --> 05:53:16.799
Boardroom: If I had said that to my mom in the 10th grade when I wanted to go to Great America, can you give me 50 bucks? Why? Because I need it.

2321
05:53:17.290 --> 05:53:19.380
Boardroom: That wouldn't have flown very far.

2322
05:53:20.590 --> 05:53:22.299
Boardroom: That's a… that's a…

2323
05:53:23.450 --> 05:53:33.950
Boardroom: You really, please, pay attention to what is before you, and what you're spending on, because that is your decision whether you approve or don't approve.

2324
05:53:34.100 --> 05:53:39.679
Boardroom: of the actions that are brought before you. Thank you so much. Thank you.

2325

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05:53:47.530 --> 05:53:55.680
Boardroom: Good evening, Council. My name is Christina Oatfield. I serve on the Planning Commission, although I'm just here speaking on behalf of myself.

2326
05:53:55.750 --> 05:54:10.580
Boardroom: Tonight, wow, listening to the staff presentations and prior speakers, I'm, appreciating how challenging the budget situation is, and how the city is between a rock and a hard place, but

2327
05:54:10.580 --> 05:54:22.880
Boardroom: I am here to ask that the Council try to come up with, a restoration of at least some of the funds that were previously cut from the Small Sites program to fund,

2328
05:54:22.880 --> 05:54:38.739
Boardroom: basically anti-displacement strategies for vulnerable residents. I work with affordable housing organizations in various jurisdictions around the state, and I've seen over and over again how local government dollars can be used to leverage

2329
05:54:38.740 --> 05:54:50.340
Boardroom: other fundings to, acquire and rehabilitate, properties with vulnerable tenants, so I hope we can continue to invest in that strategy. Thank you. Thank you.

2330
05:54:53.180 --> 05:54:54.710
Boardroom: You're gonna have an extra minute?

2331
05:54:58.810 --> 05:55:07.130
Boardroom: Councilmembers, I'm no expert on the budget, but I can say this, it's really jarring to hear that there's not going to be a warming center.

2332
05:55:07.990 --> 05:55:12.340
Boardroom: That just… it's just not what they would just… they were just… how much does it cost to pick up the bodies?

2333
05:55:13.060 --> 05:55:14.760
Boardroom: Cause that's what you're talking about.

2334
05:55:16.020 --> 05:55:26.210
Boardroom: It's a total abdication, and I have to say that it really chaffs to see $3 million allocated for the Dwight and Telegraph.

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2335
05:55:26.580 --> 05:55:39.130
Boardroom: How can you possibly spend $3 million on that triangle, and yet nothing, not a dollar, to people when it's freezing cold, when they're wet, when they're hypothermic, when they're dying in the street?

2336
05:55:39.540 --> 05:55:48.519
Boardroom: And I don't understand, because I heard the chief say that there's a staffing crisis, I've heard you guys worrying about money and so forth.

2337
05:55:48.800 --> 05:55:59.900
Boardroom: by eliminating all non-police responses… I'm sorry, all… by eliminating… we have no non-police response.

2338
05:56:00.400 --> 05:56:03.089
Boardroom: To calls for service that don't require

2339
05:56:03.230 --> 05:56:08.690
Boardroom: Police. You've got the Community Services Bureau, they're responding to non-criminal calls.

2340
05:56:08.980 --> 05:56:21.969
Boardroom: We did this through the reimagining process. We said that what you have in your budget, it says that the only response to mental health emergencies and wellness checks will be police.

2341
05:56:22.160 --> 05:56:25.810
Boardroom: That's the absolute most expensive alternative you could choose.

2342
05:56:26.610 --> 05:56:30.970
Boardroom: That is the… that's just… A total waste of money.

2343
05:56:31.340 --> 05:56:38.399
Boardroom: You could have actual people, actually trained, who actually are trained in this field to respond.

2344
05:56:38.640 --> 05:56:43.279
Boardroom: With care! And, and, and with, you know, thrift.

2345
05:56:43.890 --> 05:56:51.190

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Boardroom: So I, you know, please justify some of your choices, because it's making no sense to those of us who…

2346
05:56:51.520 --> 05:56:55.049
Boardroom: Live in this town and palace people in need every day.

2347
05:56:55.230 --> 05:56:56.480
Boardroom: What are you doing?

2348
05:56:57.210 --> 05:56:58.239
Boardroom: Thank you.

2349
05:56:59.680 --> 05:57:00.780
Boardroom: Thank you.

2350
05:57:05.650 --> 05:57:25.059
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor and Council. My name is Matt Gustafson. I'm a resident of District 2, and I work with the Bay Area Community Land Trust. I'm here to advocate for the small sites program to be adequately funded in the FY27-28 budget. Berkeley's naturally affordable so-called housing stock is rapidly shrinking, according to the California Housing Partnership, since 2020.

2351
05:57:25.060 --> 05:57:30.860
Boardroom: Berkeley's lost around 1,000 homes affordable to low-income households in this town.

2352
05:57:31.110 --> 05:57:32.030
Boardroom: A thousand.

2353
05:57:32.290 --> 05:57:42.740
Boardroom: Berkeley's Small Sites Program was built to preserve these homes and to transform them, not just to preserve them as affordable, but to transform them into community-controlled social housing, really. And it's… the program is working.

2354
05:57:43.130 --> 05:57:49.589
Boardroom: We're grateful that the Council's funded this important program in the past, and I just want to say that the allocation that's currently

2355
05:57:49.600 --> 05:57:56.120

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Boardroom: coming from Housing Trust Fund this year, it's just not really enough. The program is built for projects of 5 to 25 units right now.

2356
05:57:56.120 --> 05:58:09.629
Boardroom: It could support maybe a 5-7 unit project at most. There's residents of a 23-unit property in District 2. Some of them were here earlier tonight and they had to go home, but there's not enough money to purchase that property right now, so… Thank you. Please fund small sites. Thank you. Thanks, Matt.

2357
05:58:15.190 --> 05:58:16.100
Boardroom: Hello.

2358
05:58:16.800 --> 05:58:20.470
Boardroom: Good evening. My neighbor, Lisa, is ceding her time to me.

2359
05:58:21.100 --> 05:58:39.629
Boardroom: Good evening, Council and Mayor. My name is Angela, and I'm here to ask the Council to fund small sites, a critical program to preserve and create natural… naturally occurring affordable housing. I'm part-time staff with City of Berkeley Recreation at the Adventure Playground. I've loved working there for the last year.

2360
05:58:39.670 --> 05:58:51.449
Boardroom: I'm also a resident in District 2 at Addison Court Housing Cooperative, which is just 2 blocks across the street. A limited equity housing co-op that the city helped grant an initial loan 30 years ago.

2361
05:58:51.790 --> 05:59:09.469
Boardroom: We house income tiers from 50 to 80% AMI, and diverse ages from 1 to 83 years old. And some of our elders have moved out, allowing for a new generation to come in, like me. We maintain affordability through collective decision-making, real-life mutual aid and care for our neighbors through life changes.

2362
05:59:09.470 --> 05:59:20.609
Boardroom: Resident labor to maintain our 100-year-old garden apartments, which are really cute. Thank you to Lisa, standing over there, who is our longest-term resident and one of the founders when the previous landlord needed to sell.

2363
05:59:20.780 --> 05:59:31.670
Boardroom: She had her 80th birthday party around the block at BK Studio, and is a big reason our buildings are still beautiful and sustainably

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maintained as a maintenance gardener by trade and former gardener teacher in town.

2364
05:59:32.560 --> 05:59:38.250
Boardroom: We also maintain affordability due to our 99-year ground lease with the Northern California Land Trust.

2365
05:59:38.790 --> 05:59:41.220
Boardroom: Recently, I've joined the staff with Matt.

2366
05:59:41.360 --> 05:59:56.339
Boardroom: At the Bay Area Community Land Trust, and the skills I've gained in living in cooperative living here and in Illinois, there's hundreds of projects around the country, maintaining affordable housing and caring for our neighbors and for the communities we truly live in, and we can invest in it because

2367
05:59:56.660 --> 06:00:01.609
Boardroom: We have permanence, and… Love our neighbors and the people we live with.

2368
06:00:02.780 --> 06:00:09.830
Boardroom: And now I can support other low-income tenants in Berkeley to buy their property and learn how to collectively manage it, and stay in place.

2369
06:00:10.200 --> 06:00:20.579
Boardroom: Please appropriately fund and support the small sites program before long-time community members and naturally occurring affordable housing becomes displaced. Thank you.

2370
06:00:29.220 --> 06:00:33.040
Boardroom: I always have to lower the microphone here.

2371
06:00:33.300 --> 06:00:37.920
Boardroom: I'm sorry? Oh, okay, yes. Two minutes.

2372
06:00:38.570 --> 06:00:53.739
Boardroom: Thank you very much. My name is Michelle Tuetti. I know a lot of you in some way or another. I am one of the organizers for the Firewise groups, as well as HelpBuckley.org. I am not here to advocate for

2373

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06:00:53.840 --> 06:00:57.599
Boardroom: Specific programs, but to talk maybe more about process.

2374
06:00:57.660 --> 06:01:10.629
Boardroom: My corporate career was in more than 30 years in startups. In startups, we typically have a runway of approximately 2 years, sometimes less, sometimes more. We constantly have to make

2375
06:01:10.640 --> 06:01:25.100
Boardroom: Priority decisions that involve people and involve money, and when we hear the employees and the union reps and everybody discuss the consequences of these decisions, it's always very difficult.

2376
06:01:27.210 --> 06:01:41.490
Boardroom: What we do, however, is we use a very different budget management system in those organizations that's priority-based. It's called priority-based budgeting. And that's the only way that we're able to actually manage

2377
06:01:41.490 --> 06:01:54.370
Boardroom: the constant changes that we have to effect to be able to reorient companies that have a very short runway ahead of them. Now, in 2013, the auditor of the City of Berkeley

2378
06:01:54.370 --> 06:02:05.499
Boardroom: commissioned a study by the Gelman School of Public Policy that recommended the use of a hybrid version of priority-based budgeting for the City of Berkeley

2379
06:02:05.500 --> 06:02:14.950
Boardroom: When you look at what it would enable, it would make a very significant difference. You have time to adopt a system such as this one over the next couple of years, because

2380
06:02:14.950 --> 06:02:34.440
Boardroom: the decisions you're making today, over the next couple of months, are going to have to carry through. But by using priority-based budgeting, you can actually use strategy to be able to make changes to allocations, rather than looking at a 10-12% cut across the budget. Thank you very much.

2381
06:02:35.470 --> 06:02:36.530
Boardroom: Thank you.

2382

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06:02:38.950 --> 06:02:48.420
Boardroom: Carol Morasovic, Chair of the Homeless Services Panel of Experts, speaking to our unanimous recommendations. First, I want to state that

2383
06:02:48.420 --> 06:03:10.739
Boardroom: there will be additional revenue that will be coming in in late 2027 when City Measure W kicks in, and if we can get past these hurdles. We vigorously, oppose, ending, terminating the emergency shelter. Staff's position is that there is no location.

2384
06:03:10.740 --> 06:03:16.619
Boardroom: However, the city manager has produced a list of locations to you of city

2385
06:03:16.850 --> 06:03:29.600
Boardroom: owned properties that can be used for a shelter. And as far as the monies, contracts can be renegotiated for the leases, at the various,

2386
06:03:30.870 --> 06:03:50.299
Boardroom: motels that are going on, and we have calculated a 10% reduction would result in $370,000 to the 358, I have changed more minutes. I have one from Ron Torres. Okay, one from Kelly, and one from… Oh, two more minutes. Oh, Kelly Hammergren.

2387
06:03:50.300 --> 06:03:56.030
Boardroom: Thank you. We recommended, fund… continuing to fund the DBA social workers.

2388
06:03:56.030 --> 06:04:13.420
Boardroom: It's less than a half. It's $40,000. You see unhoused people lined up all over downtown without outreach. We would like to see this to continue to be funded, and… but we want more, vigorous, coordination with the city.

2389
06:04:13.470 --> 06:04:22.330
Boardroom: and better case management. We do believe that, the Community Services Bureau has performed an important function.

2390
06:04:22.330 --> 06:04:46.870
Boardroom: Because they… they actually respond a lot to the public, and it puts a human face on policing, and they hear complaints about the homeless, and mitigate those concerns, and otherwise, they're just gonna go bombard the city manager with more complaints. Also, BFD, the, mobile

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crisis team was already operating on a skeleton crew. This investigation by the Federal Department of Justice

2391
06:04:47.030 --> 06:04:54.749
Boardroom: And the federal litigation is extremely important. It holds the county responsible. We need to hold their feet to the fire.

2392
06:04:54.750 --> 06:05:08.750
Boardroom: on these services. This investigation, which included persons from Berkeley in mental health crisis, showed that they were… people were being disproportionately, particularly black males, sent to Santa Rita Jail

2393
06:05:08.750 --> 06:05:33.150
Boardroom: and John George, and this requires community-based services, and we need to be very aggressive to make sure that Berkeley gets the services that is required under this… under this settlement agreement. We concurred with, with the pathways, reduction, and we asked that the city spend a little more money on consultants going back to the mobile crisis.

2394
06:05:33.220 --> 06:05:48.369
Boardroom: Again, this involves community-based services, which is mobile crisis, crisis residential, and, and peer respites, and we need to make sure that we get our fair share at the county's dime. Thank you.

2395
06:05:49.530 --> 06:05:50.729
Boardroom: Thanks, Carol.

2396
06:05:51.320 --> 06:06:03.409
Boardroom: Let's move online to public comment on item number 21, which is the proposed FY2027 and FY2028 biennial budget, and proposed biennial budget public hearing number 1.

2397
06:06:03.780 --> 06:06:08.250
Boardroom: Okay, first speaker is Ben… Nash.

2398
06:06:10.970 --> 06:06:22.020
Ben Nash: Yes, good evening. My name is Ben Nash, I represent District 3 on the Parks, Recreation, and Waterfront Commission. I'd like to present some highlights from the Commission's first annual State of the Parks Report, which we hope you'll read in full.

2399
06:06:22.330 --> 06:06:38.960

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Ben Nash: First, we strongly encourage the Council not to cut the Parks Department budget. Further reductions will worsen existing inequities and strain already limited facilities and programs. We recognize the City's difficult fiscal situation, which is why the Commission recommends several long-term strategies, most importantly, a parks impact fee.

2400
06:06:39.130 --> 06:06:48.370
Ben Nash: Berkeley is expected to add thousands of new residents in the coming years, yet we already fall below state park plan standards and are considered critically underserved under state law.

2401
06:06:48.390 --> 06:07:02.010
Ben Nash: Without new investment, population growth will place even greater pressure on our parks facilities. A well-designed parks impact fee is fundamentally pro-housing. It would ensure that new development contributes to the infrastructure needed to support a dense, livable city.

2402
06:07:02.050 --> 06:07:06.800
Ben Nash: These fees do not burden existing taxpayers and can include exemptions for affordable housing.

2403
06:07:06.980 --> 06:07:16.269
Ben Nash: We encourage the Council to fund a nexus study for future parks impact fee, which would not commit the Council to adopting the fee, but would provide the information necessary to seriously evaluate this important.

2404
06:07:16.270 --> 06:07:23.289
Boardroom: Ben, thank you for your comment. You're out of time. I appreciate your comment. Next is Andy Katz.

2405
06:07:27.320 --> 06:07:47.540
Andy Katz: Good evening, Andy Katz, Chair of the Community Health Commission, speaking on behalf of our unanimous recommendations. We recognize the difficult fiscal constraints. We ask for three things. First, retain the Heart to Heart program with at least one FTE, or require a real transition plan to a community-based organization before any position is cut.

2406
06:07:47.880 --> 06:07:59.929
Andy Katz: Heart to Heart is not duplicated by FQHCs. It is the community bridge that connects Black, Latino, low-income, and uninsured residents in South and West Berkeley to care they would otherwise never access.

2407

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06:07:59.930 --> 06:08:08.590
Andy Katz: The Health Status Report documents a 10-year life expectancy gap between Flatland and Hills neighborhoods, driven largely by cardiovascular disease.

2408
06:08:08.590 --> 06:08:10.610
Andy Katz: This program is how we close it.

2409
06:08:10.610 --> 06:08:15.960
Andy Katz: But eliminating the program could disrupt the experience learned in continuity with community partners.

2410
06:08:15.960 --> 06:08:30.849
Andy Katz: Second, retain at least one FTE for public health emergency preparedness. And third, we express deep concern about the unhoused population and all who are served by behavioral health programs. These cuts fall hardest on residents with nowhere else to turn. Thank you.

2411
06:08:32.920 --> 06:08:38.070
Boardroom: Next is… John Kaner?

2412
06:08:39.780 --> 06:08:48.919
John Caner: Hi, John Kainer, Downtown Berkeley Association. As I spoke at the Budget Committee, the homeless outreach, position

2413
06:08:48.990 --> 06:09:04.940
John Caner: specialist position, that has been co-funded by the city, started off as a 50-50 match, and over the last, 4 or 5 years, we now contribute $50,000, and the city $40,000. It's not clear at all that we can afford to continue that.

2414
06:09:04.950 --> 06:09:21.719
John Caner: going forward, and I know there's a lot of pressure, but this money is levered with the Downtown Berkeley Association, and as Carol said, this position is really important for the downtown. So, thank you for your consideration. Bye.

2415
06:09:21.940 --> 06:09:22.990
Boardroom: Thanks, John.

2416
06:09:25.250 --> 06:09:28.390
Boardroom: Next is Tom Parrish.

2417

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06:09:32.230 --> 06:09:50.479
Tom Parrish (he/him): Hi, I'm Tom Parrish, I'm a resident of District 6 and an arts leader in Berkeley. I'm calling in to advocate for maintaining funding for the Civic Arts Grant Program. Cutting civic Arts funding is a bad fiscal decision and could cause the city to lose more revenue than the amount of expense savings.

2418
06:09:50.490 --> 06:10:08.449
Tom Parrish (he/him): According to the Berkeley Creative Economy Economic Impact Analysis from December 2025 by CBL Economics, civic arts funding has a high return on investment. Every dollar of civic arts funding catalyzed $197 in total economic impact across the city.

2419
06:10:08.510 --> 06:10:24.489
Tom Parrish (he/him): the creative economy as a generator of property tax, sales tax, transient occupancy tax, and other forms of revenue. And in 2024, Berkeley's creative economy helped generate $10.7 million in tax revenue, representing 3.9% of the city's tax base.

2420
06:10:24.570 --> 06:10:32.549
Tom Parrish (he/him): Maintaining or growing funding for the creative economy is critical for both the recovery of this sector and the fiscal growth of the City of Berkeley. Thank you.

2421
06:10:33.490 --> 06:10:34.580
Boardroom: Thanks, Tom.

2422
06:10:34.730 --> 06:10:36.399
Boardroom: Okay, that's… that's all.

2423
06:10:37.580 --> 06:10:54.649
Boardroom: Okay, thank you very much. We are going to go to comments from my Council colleagues, starting with Councilmember Taplin. Thank you very much, and thank you to, everyone who spoke. I especially want to thank our labor partners and our city workers, and I want to thank the budget team and…

2424
06:10:54.800 --> 06:11:00.190
Boardroom: City Admin and the Budget and Finance Committee. Madam Mayor, I think…

2425
06:11:00.200 --> 06:11:15.879
Boardroom: I don't know if it was at the last council meeting or our budget and finance, but you did ask us to come prepared to share our budget priorities, is that correct? I did, yes. Okay, thank you. Thanks

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for remembering. Of course, of course. I write down everything you say, just kidding.

2426
06:11:16.110 --> 06:11:26.359
Boardroom: I, I didn't want to preface, what I'm gonna say by sharing. I think, you know, we all remember a time when the city

2427
06:11:26.630 --> 06:11:37.910
Boardroom: Could do all kinds of amazing things, and that was because we have amazing organizations, and community partners, and staff, and leaders, and we were able to, like, you know, subsidize parking

2428
06:11:37.910 --> 06:11:55.160
Boardroom: at the marina, subsidize the kite festival, subsidize events, pick up people's fees, make generous contributions to people doing really great work in the community. And I think we did that because we believed in the work they were all doing, we wanted to make people happy, we wanted to invest and hold

2429
06:11:55.260 --> 06:11:59.340
Boardroom: Our public spaces in a way that could really flourish and

2430
06:11:59.600 --> 06:12:04.529
Boardroom: resonate and embody our values, and I think we did that

2431
06:12:05.020 --> 06:12:09.130
Boardroom: As long as we could, in a way that perhaps

2432
06:12:09.430 --> 06:12:15.170
Boardroom: We are now being confronted with a need to reevaluate how to not just…

2433
06:12:15.370 --> 06:12:23.340
Boardroom: keep what we have, but get back to a place where we can do more. And that is going to be very difficult, but I do think that…

2434
06:12:24.030 --> 06:12:28.130
Boardroom: We are all committed and dedicated…

2435
06:12:28.700 --> 06:12:35.779
Boardroom: To do that, if we can keep, you know, focus, and… And persevere through these tough.

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2436
06:12:36.540 --> 06:12:39.390
Boardroom: seas that we find ourselves on.

2437
06:12:41.150 --> 06:12:44.699
Boardroom: To answer the priorities question, I have…

2438
06:12:44.770 --> 06:13:01.619
Boardroom: I'll just go through these. First and foremost, and to the extent possible, my priority is further minimizing, or even if at all possibly preventing, reductions to the city workforce and disruptions of core city-provided services and critical city-run programs.

2439
06:13:04.120 --> 06:13:05.110
Boardroom: Bun.

2440
06:13:05.500 --> 06:13:13.529
Boardroom: the Capital Improvement Program, The Marina Fund, Waterfront projects, and parks and Recreation programs.

2441
06:13:14.460 --> 06:13:15.270
Boardroom: Sorry?

2442
06:13:15.560 --> 06:13:17.789
Boardroom: Slowly. Slowly, sorry.

2443
06:13:18.180 --> 06:13:33.029
Boardroom: Capital crew program, the Marina Fund, and waterfront projects, and Parks and Recreation programs, keeping Station 4 open, sustaining the street trial and prevention program, and CERT trainings, and retention of the fire crew positions created by the SAFER grant.

2444
06:13:33.310 --> 06:13:42.330
Boardroom: and the maintenance of the Community Services Bureau operations and special units like the Bike Force, the Flex Teams, and community safety partnership programs like Live Free.

2445
06:13:45.580 --> 06:13:56.929
Boardroom: And that's… that's my list, and I have some more time left, and I think that, you know, I do want to call out what the person said about priority-based budgeting,

2446
06:13:57.350 --> 06:14:04.389

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Boardroom: I… that resonates with me. I think it's easier said than done. There are 9 of us, there are 8 districts, we have a very…

2447
06:14:05.020 --> 06:14:09.240
Boardroom: We have a very large, dedicated, involved community that has

2448
06:14:09.790 --> 06:14:14.909
Boardroom: A vast array of economic needs, and we have a lot of disparities.

2449
06:14:16.250 --> 06:14:26.040
Boardroom: But I think that… We have to… Keep the balance of Subsidy and investment with…

2450
06:14:28.560 --> 06:14:32.610
Boardroom: Fiscal viability, because we can't fund programs that we

2451
06:14:32.810 --> 06:14:37.510
Boardroom: Don't have workforce or revenue to sustain.

2452
06:14:37.930 --> 06:14:40.790
Boardroom: So… moving forward.

2453
06:14:41.510 --> 06:14:58.920
Boardroom: I want to offer my commitment to my colleagues and our city admin and everyone to getting us out of this mess, and, you know, I'm proud of myself for not blaming everyone who came before us, but we're here now, and I…

2454
06:14:59.660 --> 06:15:06.470
Boardroom: I am cautiously optimistic that we will find ourselves in a place where we can not just…

2455
06:15:06.770 --> 06:15:10.669
Boardroom: keep what we have, but give even more than we have before. Thank you.

2456
06:15:12.080 --> 06:15:14.639
Boardroom: Thank you. Councilmember Bartlett?

2457
06:15:15.680 --> 06:15:19.830
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor. And, just to quickly,

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2458
06:15:19.940 --> 06:15:29.669
Boardroom: note my priorities here for you. And there's sort of a… sort of… it's more thematic. There's a couple of specifics, but essentially, you know, we recognize we're going into…

2459
06:15:29.830 --> 06:15:44.390
Boardroom: a turbulent time. This is… there's really no way around this. We have to go through it. You know, the… the pension fund… the pension funding formulas and the healthcare costs, the president just took out a trillion dollars out of healthcare.

2460
06:15:44.410 --> 06:15:50.079
Boardroom: In this country. You know, so… what we see is gonna get a lot worse. And so…

2461
06:15:50.140 --> 06:15:55.360
Boardroom: My priorities are, the catch-all is to defend the week.

2462
06:15:56.200 --> 06:15:58.570
Boardroom: So, that takes care of seniors.

2463
06:15:58.710 --> 06:16:07.200
Boardroom: Small sites, mental health departments, outreach people, a warming center, I can't believe it's not in there, I can't believe I missed that one, a warming center.

2464
06:16:07.760 --> 06:16:14.060
Boardroom: Okay, so good. And, police and fire, obviously, and so that, that's sort of catch-all.

2465
06:16:14.180 --> 06:16:20.800
Boardroom: Just making sure our quality of life does not degenerate, so we have to step over people starving in the streets in front of us.

2466
06:16:23.800 --> 06:16:29.219
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember. Vice Mayor Trey Gob… oh, sorry, I'm sorry, that was wrong. Councilmember Humbert.

2467
06:16:30.610 --> 06:16:31.949
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor.

2468

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06:16:32.660 --> 06:16:39.050
Boardroom: I want to thank the city manager, the Deputy City Manager.

2469
06:16:39.160 --> 06:16:46.350
Boardroom: And their staff, but I also want to thank staff in the finance department, especially Budget Manager DePaya.

2470
06:16:46.880 --> 06:16:53.970
Boardroom: And I also want to thank everyone who spoke here tonight. Very moving.

2471
06:16:54.090 --> 06:17:11.619
Boardroom: statements, particularly by our city employees, I found them very moving. We have a difficult budget situation, to put it mildly, to deal with this year. It's something that has been decades in the making, unfortunately.

2472
06:17:11.800 --> 06:17:14.950
Boardroom: Between the… but between the economy.

2473
06:17:15.300 --> 06:17:26.219
Boardroom: federal, state, and state pullbacks, which, as Councilmember Bartlett said, are just gonna get worse, at least on the federal level, and one-time fixes that have run out.

2474
06:17:26.430 --> 06:17:44.660
Boardroom: We're having to look at some devastating cuts. Tonight, my personal goal has been mainly to listen and hear everyone's concerns and suggestions, and carry these forward with me as we consider what adjustments we may want to make to the budget proposed by staff.

2475
06:17:45.020 --> 06:17:51.089
Boardroom: In terms of my personal priorities, I would say…

2476
06:17:51.280 --> 06:17:58.939
Boardroom: public safety and fire. I would say preserving as many, jobs as possible.

2477
06:17:59.340 --> 06:18:06.630
Boardroom: And particularly, retaining positions

2478
06:18:06.790 --> 06:18:24.489

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Boardroom: for the proposed one position to be cut in OED, because I think long-term, OED is going to help us grow our tax base. They've been doing it, a heroic jobs, so I want to put in a pitch for OED. I want to make sure that we still have adequate neighborhood services.

2479
06:18:24.520 --> 06:18:30.950
Boardroom: And given what's happening, just globally, we need to focus on

2480
06:18:31.000 --> 06:18:46.809
Boardroom: Cybersecurity, frankly, I think we need to make sure… to really bear down on that in… in our budget. But that's all I have, really, at the moment, so thank you, everybody, who spoke here tonight. Thank you so much, Councilmember. Vice Mayor Treyko.

2481
06:18:48.640 --> 06:19:00.299
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor. I… I want to echo, what has already been said, by my colleagues.

2482
06:19:00.960 --> 06:19:14.440
Boardroom: I want to thank, the city manager and his team for… Working with us, to propose…

2483
06:19:15.050 --> 06:19:16.270
Boardroom: a budget.

2484
06:19:16.490 --> 06:19:17.310
Boardroom: Debt.

2485
06:19:17.860 --> 06:19:21.080
Boardroom: reflects these times.

2486
06:19:22.300 --> 06:19:27.240
Boardroom: This is, in a way.

2487
06:19:28.950 --> 06:19:31.669
Boardroom: This is a budget that meets

2488
06:19:31.890 --> 06:19:34.439
Boardroom: The moment that we are in.

2489
06:19:34.910 --> 06:19:39.920
Boardroom: That does not make it… at all easy.

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2490
06:19:40.570 --> 06:19:51.160
Boardroom: And… we… Can no longer afford to… Continue.

2491
06:19:51.340 --> 06:20:05.470
Boardroom: to, the status quo, because doing so would just, continue to,

2492
06:20:07.340 --> 06:20:17.620
Boardroom: backdate the pain and make the shared pain, even harder in the future. That said,

2493
06:20:18.560 --> 06:20:21.109
Boardroom: There's an enormous amount of,

2494
06:20:21.840 --> 06:20:25.199
Boardroom: Shared sacrifice that has already been made.

2495
06:20:25.320 --> 06:20:34.650
Boardroom: And… when I, you know, this is,

2496
06:20:34.880 --> 06:20:43.980
Boardroom: The budget, is a reflection of our values. It is one of the most consequential, votes that…

2497
06:20:44.190 --> 06:20:55.600
Boardroom: we will take on the Council. I know that, whatever this budget looks like, in the next month.

2498
06:20:56.050 --> 06:21:08.089
Boardroom: this will, by far, be the most challenging vote that, I hope to ever have to take in, on… in my council career.

2499
06:21:09.300 --> 06:21:13.330
Boardroom: No one wants or wishes to serve.

2500
06:21:13.900 --> 06:21:19.710
Boardroom: To try to prioritize which programs to cut, that is…

2501
06:21:20.010 --> 06:21:30.520
Boardroom: quite inimical to the reasons that we all ran and, serve. However,

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2502
06:21:31.470 --> 06:21:38.799
Boardroom: Due to a variety of reasons, we must exercise,

2503
06:21:39.950 --> 06:21:53.809
Boardroom: a kind of, priority-based budgeting, and so I… I do appreciate, the mayor asking us to come up, with priorities. Broadly, I…

2504
06:21:54.170 --> 06:21:59.420
Boardroom: I will, name mine, I will say, and I…

2505
06:22:00.290 --> 06:22:16.239
Boardroom: This was ingrained in me, on day one of my first job, and I mentioned this, I think, on the first day that I took office. The people are our greatest resource.

2506
06:22:16.700 --> 06:22:25.160
Boardroom: anything we can do to protect the jobs of as many people as we can, because,

2507
06:22:25.460 --> 06:22:28.320
Boardroom: Thank you for sharing,

2508
06:22:28.430 --> 06:22:39.829
Boardroom: who is behind, these 311 and 911 calls that I, too, have had to make as I walk around the district.

2509
06:22:41.070 --> 06:22:52.839
Boardroom: Within that, and this is, again, not to the exclusion or minimization of many other worthy, and worthwhile, programs.

2510
06:22:53.000 --> 06:22:55.749
Boardroom: But these are my three,

2511
06:22:57.250 --> 06:23:00.670
Boardroom: go to the mapped priorities,

2512
06:23:01.020 --> 06:23:10.479
Boardroom: Oh, and I will move to extend time… Second. To… What time is it? 2.

2513

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06:23:10.580 --> 06:23:16.320
Boardroom: By… 11… 11.30.40, 11.30. Yeah.

2514
06:23:20.470 --> 06:23:35.219
Boardroom: Is there any opposition to… I guess my only point is, do we have a bunch of stuff still to do? Are we gonna do all those? No, we are not. No, we're gonna try to get through as many as we can. I also, you know, I don't want to get into it too much, but I will just… I do want to say that…

2515
06:23:35.220 --> 06:23:48.299
Boardroom: I really don't want us going super late on these items, because I just feel like we're not in the right space to make good decisions, and so I think it's better if we end by 11.30, so that's my push for the 1130.

2516
06:23:49.540 --> 06:23:55.890
Boardroom: Okay, is there any opposition to approving an extension till 11.30?

2517
06:23:57.460 --> 06:24:08.270
Boardroom: No opposition? Alright, we will move to 11.30. Thank you very much. Councilmember, you have 41 seconds. Go ahead, your priorities, please. Alright, priorities,

2518
06:24:08.890 --> 06:24:32.279
Boardroom: Trying to, retain, the filled 1FTE position within the Economic Development Department for the reasons my colleague, Councilmember Humbert, already said. These are vital to the downtown and all commercial districts in its revenue generating. Trying to find a way to,

2519
06:24:32.660 --> 06:24:52.439
Boardroom: you know, finding, the 40K match to the DBA, and then the street trauma prevention, program would be my, my third, within the top three, priorities. Thank you. Thank you. Okay, moving on to Councilmember O'Keefe.

2520
06:24:56.080 --> 06:25:15.710
Boardroom: I want to start by thanking, City Manager, Deputy City Manager, the budget team, all of the department heads who, came and spoke, and also who, worked hard to come up with… I know each department came up with its own proposals for cuts, and I know that was very painful and hard work, so I just want to thank everybody.

2521

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06:25:15.940 --> 06:25:20.389
Boardroom: Everybody who is part of this fun process.

2522
06:25:22.290 --> 06:25:41.540
Boardroom: I really want to acknowledge that many of our city employees will be losing their jobs, and that is a deeply painful reality, especially given inflation, and the, job market right now, and the rising cost of living. And I just really want it. I know we've all… we're all naming that, and I'm going to name that too, because it's really important, and just…

2523
06:25:42.150 --> 06:25:45.229
Boardroom: Give some space for that reality.

2524
06:25:47.480 --> 06:25:58.919
Boardroom: Unfortunately, it's our responsibility to make decisions that preserve the long-time financial stability of this city. It's a really heavy and profound responsibility that I know we all feel.

2525
06:26:02.940 --> 06:26:04.830
Boardroom: I do want to say,

2526
06:26:05.170 --> 06:26:07.420
Boardroom: as a District 5 council member.

2527
06:26:07.680 --> 06:26:24.219
Boardroom: And also, from a perspective of citywide prepared… emergency preparedness, I have really, really profound concerns about the prospect of closing Fire Station 4 if the tax measure does not pass. And I want to emphasize that is a hypothetical closing, but it is something that's being discussed.

2528
06:26:24.790 --> 06:26:30.520
Boardroom: The Berkeley Hills… Of which I represent part of.

2529
06:26:31.050 --> 06:26:38.110
Boardroom: Faces unique wildfire risks, constrained evacuation routes, steep terrain, narrow streets,

2530
06:26:38.280 --> 06:26:44.109
Boardroom: And we can all remember, and I know Chief Sprague included, the lessons from the 1991 firestorm.

2531

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06:26:45.190 --> 06:26:48.830
Boardroom: In the area around Station 4, which I happen to represent.

2532
06:26:49.010 --> 06:27:00.280
Boardroom: is… has one of the oldest populations in the entire country. And so this is, these are people who are more prone to emergent health problems, and also more vulnerable in the event of a wildfire.

2533
06:27:00.840 --> 06:27:05.030
Boardroom: So, you know, this isn't really a matter of life and death.

2534
06:27:07.040 --> 06:27:10.050
Boardroom: So, as we move forward, my only…

2535
06:27:10.230 --> 06:27:18.809
Boardroom: My main priority is, just to remain focused on protecting all of the services that are most fundamental to public safety.

2536
06:27:18.960 --> 06:27:22.130
Boardroom: Most specifically, preserving

2537
06:27:22.610 --> 06:27:40.489
Boardroom: the fire and other public safety positions. I would add the street trauma position, that seems… that's… I would prioritize that. And beyond that, I just… I want to make sure we get a permanently balanced budget so we can move forward with protecting the long-term stability and resilience of our city.

2538
06:27:42.150 --> 06:27:51.329
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember. Moving on to Councilmember Blackaby. Thanks, Madam Mayor. I'll try and be, quick. I just want to associate myself with the comments on my colleagues.

2539
06:27:51.330 --> 06:28:08.589
Boardroom: with our appreciation for all the staff work that's gone into this, from the city manager on down. I'll just say, Marikara, I don't know how you keep all the facts and figures in your head. It's amazing. Your eyes look like they're glazing over, but we appreciate everything you've done, and Dave as well, for just, walking us through this, through

2540
06:28:08.590 --> 06:28:11.300
Boardroom: Countless budget meetings, as well as tonight, so thank you.

2541

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06:28:11.320 --> 06:28:20.279
Boardroom: I'll say, look, I mean, everything is important. We all, we value so much the work that our city staff does.

2542
06:28:20.470 --> 06:28:32.679
Boardroom: I also know that, you know, when I was elected, I think I was elected with the knowledge that our most important priority is keeping people safe. People want to live in Berkeley, and they want to be in a place where they feel safe. That is still kind of my…

2543
06:28:32.910 --> 06:28:48.569
Boardroom: North Star, public safety is still, for me, the number one priority. As I mentioned before, I mean, there's just no way I could vote for a budget that closed Station 4, as… along with Councilmember O'Keefe, you know, the responsibility representing the Berkeley Hills.

2544
06:28:48.670 --> 06:29:05.720
Boardroom: Station 4 is important to that, Station 7 is so important to that, given the wildfire safety that we face. So, I appreciate the fact that we're not, being faced with that now. I know that's still hanging out as a future prospect, but I appreciate that that's off the table, for the next fiscal year at a minimum, and hopefully for good.

2545
06:29:05.720 --> 06:29:15.119
Boardroom: I also appreciate the fact that we're able to retain the 15 police members and 6 dispatchers, that were initially considered, for reduction.

2546
06:29:15.120 --> 06:29:16.970
Boardroom: I'd also ask

2547
06:29:16.970 --> 06:29:37.009
Boardroom: for the, you know, potential of maintaining some of the CERT funding and some of the fuel reduction funding that we talked about before. This all, to me, goes in that public safety bucket, and to me, that's preeminent. That's just the basic expectation of a citizen in this city, is that they pay taxes and they should be safe in their city. Like, that just… I think that goes without saying.

2548
06:29:37.010 --> 06:29:46.759
Boardroom: Second, I think, is just the expectation that we have an infrastructure that works. You know, you count on the sewers, the storm drains, you count on the streets and the sidewalks, and…

2549
06:29:46.760 --> 06:29:58.860

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Boardroom: We've got a big backlog and a lot of work to do on the street and sidewalk side, so we can't lose sight of that over the coming year. We've got to make a huge amount of progress there. I know there's not much, again, that we're proposing.

2550
06:29:58.860 --> 06:30:09.799
Boardroom: reduction in that area, which is good, but again, just in terms of priorities, it's safety and infrastructure, to me, are the basics that people just expect of their municipal government, so we need to deliver on that.

2551
06:30:09.900 --> 06:30:29.800
Boardroom: Going forward, and this has less to do with this budget and more about years in the future, you know, we've talked, and I continue to harp on, in my questions tonight around revenue, around business stimulation, and I agree with, with, my colleagues, the OED function, the mighty team that does so much work.

2552
06:30:29.800 --> 06:30:44.650
Boardroom: You know, we've got to do a better job of keeping the innovation economy going. All the companies that are starting on the campus at UC Berkeley, making sure they have a place here in Berkeley, that's gonna be critical to the future of our city, is being a place where those people want to

2553
06:30:44.650 --> 06:30:56.630
Boardroom: Create jobs, hire people, bring people to live here, bring people to work here. Supporting our retail small business in commercial corridors. We know that there have been folks that have been challenged in those areas.

2554
06:30:58.220 --> 06:31:06.780
Boardroom: Just the business climate and being a hospitable place where people want to do work, and people want to live, do those jobs.

2555
06:31:06.780 --> 06:31:23.840
Boardroom: That's so critical to the future of our tax base. I'd also say unsticking some of the stalled housing projects is part and parcel of that. Again, none of these are going to affect this year's budget, but they start to make things a little bit easier as we go, if we can work on those priorities.

2556
06:31:23.970 --> 06:31:35.069
Boardroom: The other thing I'll say, on the, staff side, and I appreciate and have been moved by the stories and the… because you're right, these are not just numbers, these are people behind the numbers.

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2557
06:31:35.220 --> 06:31:41.399
Boardroom: And, we will miss folks who, who we lose.

2558
06:31:41.540 --> 06:31:58.999
Boardroom: And we will expect a lot from the people who stay. And, it's not fair to expect more from the same. But it also, though, to me, is a function where technology also becomes important. We have to… how do we provide our employees with the tools that will make them more productive?

2559
06:31:59.050 --> 06:32:21.989
Boardroom: We'll help them get more done in the same amount of time. We'll help, maybe receive some of those service requests that come from residents at all hours of the night, but just how can technology, again, be a force multiplier for the people that are continuing to work here and provide excellent service? Not customer service, to Cecilia's point, but service to residents that they expect.

2560
06:32:21.990 --> 06:32:31.580
Boardroom: So those are things that I'm thinking about, and I appreciate, again, the effort that's gotten us here, and look forward to helping to move this across the finish line in as expeditious and…

2561
06:32:31.580 --> 06:32:34.190
Boardroom: effective a way as we can. Thank you.

2562
06:32:34.420 --> 06:32:37.190
Boardroom: Thank you very much, Councilmember. Councilmember Kesarwani.

2563
06:32:37.360 --> 06:32:52.289
Boardroom: Thank you very much, Madam Mayor. Thank you, Mr. White and Ms. Dupaiah, for your, lengthy and detailed presentation. And, thank you to my colleagues for your comments. Thank you to the members of the public who gave, public comment on their priorities.

2564
06:32:52.510 --> 06:33:08.129
Boardroom: You know, I think it's already been said that this has been, a very difficult budget process, and will continue to be. And, I, you know, I do want to say that I'm really proud that we are looking at a combination of strategies

2565
06:33:08.280 --> 06:33:14.360
Boardroom: In a way that I think, and I hope will continue to align with our values.

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2566
06:33:14.450 --> 06:33:22.639
Boardroom: you know, I asked us to do the community survey on the sales tax, because I knew that the level of reduction

2567
06:33:22.640 --> 06:33:40.050
Boardroom: And what it would feel like in our community to cut $30 million from our budget, would not be acceptable. You know, it's not acceptable to me to cut that deeply. And I want the community to recognize that is why we have polled

2568
06:33:40.250 --> 06:33:51.539
Boardroom: for this sales tax, to raise, you know, an approximately $9.4 million to save, if I have the numbers correct, 33 positions, some of which are filled.

2569
06:33:51.540 --> 06:34:05.380
Boardroom: And those are public safety positions. That's the staffing for Fire Station 4 that we're hearing a lot of concern about. That's the staffing for programs that serve low-income and vulnerable populations.

2570
06:34:05.430 --> 06:34:14.649
Boardroom: And so, to me, that is making sure that what we are doing here aligns with our values, to take care of those populations, to make sure that

2571
06:34:14.760 --> 06:34:20.760
Boardroom: The response time when people call 911, and they need you know.

2572
06:34:21.160 --> 06:34:27.259
Boardroom: the types of services, that we send out from Fire Station 4, that that can be available

2573
06:34:27.710 --> 06:34:42.030
Boardroom: And you… you know, I want to focus on the budget, but we have a number of items here tonight that will also raise fee levels to be in line with costs, something that we have not been doing regularly. We need to continue to do that, and so I'm pleased to see that those are before us.

2574
06:34:42.340 --> 06:34:59.659
Boardroom: And of course, in addition to raising revenues, we have this difficult decision, you know, $9.4 million still leaves a substantial gap

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that we have to find a way to close, and so that is where I know you have proposed

2575
06:34:59.950 --> 06:35:12.049
Boardroom: eliminating a lot of vacant positions. I wanted to ask Mr. White, I don't know if you have the answer right now, are there vacant positions that have not been proposed for elimination?

2576
06:35:12.230 --> 06:35:17.570
Boardroom: Okay, so I want to look at that the next time we come to budget and finance, if you can have that.

2577
06:35:17.800 --> 06:35:25.520
Boardroom: available, because the reason why I want to know what those positions are is because, you know, we have folks here tonight

2578
06:35:25.690 --> 06:35:29.310
Boardroom: We have folks who are worried about getting laid off.

2579
06:35:29.560 --> 06:35:41.510
Boardroom: you know, 20 filled positions that are proposed for elimination, so I want to make sure that that's the right call. I don't want to do that if we can find vacant positions

2580
06:35:42.020 --> 06:35:43.729
Boardroom: And save those folks.

2581
06:35:43.910 --> 06:35:58.400
Boardroom: Because, you know, this is, you know, one city, one team, and, so that's my commitment, that we have to look at that. And… and I, you know, I think there's sort of this other category that we haven't talked a lot about.

2582
06:35:58.680 --> 06:36:01.790
Boardroom: Which is, you know, what can we do smarter?

2583
06:36:02.080 --> 06:36:12.250
Boardroom: I had mentioned at the last Budget and Finance Committee that I was at that I want to hear how we are monitoring our contracts.

2584
06:36:12.480 --> 06:36:27.929
Boardroom: you know, we haven't heard in this budget process which contracts are underperforming that we should not continue. And so I think

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we need to be thinking about that. You know, I also have a council item that's going to be heard at Budget and Finance.

2585
06:36:28.070 --> 06:36:33.400
Boardroom: To require competitive procurement across all city departments.

2586
06:36:33.470 --> 06:36:49.939
Boardroom: to ensure that we are getting the best value for all goods and services, including professional services, which our city auditor said we have not been doing. You know, we need to… we need to do all of these things so that we are being as cost-effective as we can.

2587
06:36:49.940 --> 06:36:55.530
Boardroom: And, you know, I know a lot of effort has been put in, but I think there's more we can be doing around

2588
06:36:55.530 --> 06:36:58.840
Boardroom: the contracts, and so,

2589
06:36:59.010 --> 06:37:13.719
Boardroom: So I want to have those conversations, and in terms of priority, you know, I would agree on preserving the filled position in the Office of Economic Development. This is the Community Development Project Coordinator, and

2590
06:37:14.160 --> 06:37:23.220
Boardroom: But you know, when we say that, we'd like to find, you know, like to be able to save things. You have to cut something else. You have to find the funds to do that.

2591
06:37:23.430 --> 06:37:36.959
Boardroom: So… so, you know, respectfully to the folks asking for more funding for small sites, you know, it's my understanding, and I think it is yours as well, that we have put out a request for proposal for $2.5 million for small sites.

2592
06:37:38.670 --> 06:37:44.800
Boardroom: And I'm really grateful that I reduced the allocation for small sites in the last budget.

2593
06:37:45.170 --> 06:37:59.570
Boardroom: Because I understand that we have had structural deficits for years, and we have to make hard choices. We can't always do the full

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amount that everybody is asking for all the time. Sometimes being a leader means knowing when to say no.

2594
06:38:01.970 --> 06:38:19.420
Boardroom: So, I'm really grateful we've had this hearing. I think we do, you know, really want to emphasize we need to look at the vacant positions that are still in the budget, and know what those classifications are, and what the fully loaded costs are.

2595
06:38:19.840 --> 06:38:26.559
Boardroom: And if I can get the org charts of where they are in each department.

2596
06:38:27.910 --> 06:38:29.929
Boardroom: That will also be helpful.

2597
06:38:31.580 --> 06:38:34.909
Boardroom: Okay, thank you very much. Thank you, Councilmember Lunapara.

2598
06:38:36.470 --> 06:38:44.549
Boardroom: Thank you, I first want to express my deep appreciation for the immense amount of time and energy

2599
06:38:45.090 --> 06:38:54.369
Boardroom: An exhaustive effort that our city manager, deputy city manager, budget team, and department heads have poured into developing this budget proposal.

2600
06:38:54.610 --> 06:39:02.569
Boardroom: Facing a decades-long structural deficit is incredibly daunting, and I want to thank you for addressing it with transparency and such deep care.

2601
06:39:03.540 --> 06:39:15.869
Boardroom: I also really want to thank the city workers who have stayed with us late into the night. It takes incredible dedication to speak here after a long workday to advocate so fiercely for your departments, your colleagues, and the services that our community relies on.

2602
06:39:15.960 --> 06:39:28.159
Boardroom: Your presence tonight matters, and your work does not go unrecognized or unappreciated. We know that you make the city what it is, and we know that these numbers represent real lives, real families, and the people who work alongside… we work alongside every day.

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2603
06:39:29.110 --> 06:39:43.920
Boardroom: As we move through this budget cycle, I am deeply committed to working alongside my colleagues and staff to ensure that we find a fiscally responsible path forward that protects the integrity of our workforce and minimizes the impact of the people who make the city run.

2604
06:39:44.870 --> 06:39:53.850
Boardroom: So in terms of my priorities, I want… I think it's important that as we're… as we are laying out the things that we want to…

2605
06:39:53.980 --> 06:40:04.250
Boardroom: save from this budget, that we are also proposing things that we are willing to reduce or eliminate, because that's the reality of how we're dealing with this budget right now. So…

2606
06:40:04.620 --> 06:40:08.210
Boardroom: In terms of the, the priorities that I,

2607
06:40:08.260 --> 06:40:16.220
Boardroom: for me, I want to make sure, first, that we are minimizing the impact to our workforce and minimizing layoffs. I think that's the most important piece of this.

2608
06:40:16.250 --> 06:40:34.889
Boardroom: I also think that we… I feel strongly that we should maintain our non-police responses, to homelessness, mental health, and addiction crises. I support retaining the street trauma prevention program, maintaining small sites funding, and…

2609
06:40:35.190 --> 06:40:39.309
Boardroom: Making sure we have a long-term financial solvency plan.

2610
06:40:39.950 --> 06:40:45.050
Boardroom: And in terms of some things that I think that we should… Look at reducing

2611
06:40:45.260 --> 06:40:54.179
Boardroom: I think we should look at reducing or eliminating council policy committees, consolidating more commissions, and reducing council non-personnel budgets.

2612
06:40:54.380 --> 06:41:05.899

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Boardroom: I think we also really need to figure out how to structurally reduce police overtime, which consistently goes over its allocated budget. We need to figure out how to address that in a structural way.

2613
06:41:06.630 --> 06:41:11.010
Boardroom: Thank you, and thank you to everyone who has put so much work into this.

2614
06:41:14.280 --> 06:41:26.349
Boardroom: Thank you. Thank you so much to my Council colleagues for your comments, and also for giving us your priorities. That's very helpful as I think about what my budget will look like.

2615
06:41:26.470 --> 06:41:30.809
Boardroom: I really want to thank, of course,

2616
06:41:31.040 --> 06:41:43.590
Boardroom: all of the city staff who've been working on this, from the department heads to, of course, Mari Kaur and your team, to David White, to our city manager. I… I just…

2617
06:41:44.560 --> 06:42:04.469
Boardroom: I like to start… I want to start by talking about just people and the impacts on people. We have had people come already to Council and share their stories and, tell us about the impact that these cuts are gonna have on their lives. And I'm somebody who does this work because I care a lot about people.

2618
06:42:04.470 --> 06:42:11.719
Boardroom: And so, I just want you all to know that that is something that is, is really kind of the focus of.

2619
06:42:12.120 --> 06:42:15.570
Boardroom: Of the work that we're doing right now, and thinking about

2620
06:42:15.660 --> 06:42:40.650
Boardroom: you know, the budget that we're going to propose from my office, and I really want to thank the city manager for, I feel, having a very people-first approach in this, in trying to be as communicative as possible, really considering everything that's going into it. I really do want the public to understand that it's having an immense impact, on him, and that he's losing sleep over it. These are not easy decisions for any of us.

2621

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06:42:40.650 --> 06:42:57.320
Boardroom: believe me when I say that we are all, you know, suffering, and we really do feel for folks as we're talking about these positions. We're aware that these are individuals that we're talking about, not just the positions that are filled that are getting cut, but also

2622
06:42:57.480 --> 06:43:17.070
Boardroom: in thinking about the impacts on people when we cut positions that aren't filled. So I do want to thank you all so much to everyone who's come and shared their stories, and shared the impact that these cuts will have on them, and their lives, and their families. I really do appreciate you being here and sharing, and to everyone who's also written in to us as well.

2623
06:43:17.570 --> 06:43:20.870
Boardroom: You know.

2624
06:43:21.110 --> 06:43:39.820
Boardroom: this is not something that any of us want to do. Certainly, in my first term as mayor, to make these kinds of cuts, it's really challenging. And, I also know that there are some things that we need to be doing that we have very little option of what else to do at this point.

2625
06:43:40.000 --> 06:43:54.780
Boardroom: We really can't afford to depend anymore on these one-time measures to balance the budget, and we have to phase these one-time measures out. And that's really what the plan is for this, is to address the underlying structural deficit, to make changes,

2626
06:43:54.780 --> 06:44:01.960
Boardroom: you know, that are really tough, but hopefully will create the ability for us to have a sustainable budget moving forward. I think that's

2627
06:44:01.960 --> 06:44:16.650
Boardroom: really key, because if we fund things a little bit here and there, we throw in money for a position for one year, that's not sustainable. That means that the next time around, we're gonna have to cut someone else somewhere else again. And that also isn't fair, so we really do need to consider that.

2628
06:44:16.930 --> 06:44:23.370
Boardroom: I also really appreciate the charter offices for responding to my request to reduce their budgets.

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2629
06:44:23.370 --> 06:44:48.359
Boardroom: On the City Council, we all cut our budgets by 12.5%. That's our average across the councils, and, I really do want to thank my colleagues for making those, those, those decisions. And thank you, of course, also to our city attorney's Office, our, Director of Police Accountability, and also our city auditor. They also made cuts to their budgets as well.

2630
06:44:48.360 --> 06:44:52.620
Boardroom: Well… And,

2631
06:44:52.780 --> 06:45:09.549
Boardroom: you know, we really… we heard today, you know, how we got here and situation, and one thing I did just want to mention as well is the impacts that have really been felt for generations by Prop 13, which has really taken a lot of funding from local government.

2632
06:45:09.560 --> 06:45:26.179
Boardroom: and made us rely on special funds, which really, honestly, I think are not the best way to be filling our budgets. I am really hopeful that we will have state change on this matter so that we can have more funding, come into local jurisdictions. And then…

2633
06:45:26.480 --> 06:45:45.479
Boardroom: there are some specific things I want to mention that I think are really important. If anyone's had a conversation with me about my priorities as mayor, you will have heard me say a million times, my priorities are housing and homelessness, public safety, and infrastructure, and these are really things that, I'm looking at

2634
06:45:45.580 --> 06:45:51.319
Boardroom: when I'm thinking about this budget, and of course, accountability and transparency are really key to me.

2635
06:45:51.320 --> 06:46:15.059
Boardroom: I want to make some comments about homelessness in particular. So, just so folks know, the inclement weather shelter is still going to be open. That's not recommended to be cut. I think that there was some confusion about that versus the winter shelter. And in terms of the winter shelter, it's true that there was an alternative housing, item that was brought forward by Councilmember O'Keefe and a number of us.

2636
06:46:15.300 --> 06:46:31.699
Boardroom: And, we are still working on that issue. So, when we think about the winter shelter being closed, our hope is that we have this

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alternative shelter, open, so that it's not just winter time where it's open, that there's actually space for folks to.

2637
06:46:31.790 --> 06:46:42.449
Boardroom: I'm running this meeting, so I'm gonna go over my time. So, that we… that we will continue to do that work and apply for Measure W funds on the county level.

2638
06:46:42.540 --> 06:46:51.069
Boardroom: And then around mental health, something I just wanted to mention is that

2639
06:46:51.160 --> 06:47:10.779
Boardroom: the CAT team, which is the county's crisis response team, that they are losing funding on a state level, and so that is something that I will be advocating, against, so against cuts to that, because that is where we have… we're relying on the county to cover mental health.

2640
06:47:10.810 --> 06:47:23.720
Boardroom: And also advocating for that to be a non-police response, because we also know about the success of a non-police response. And then around the revenues piece, I think that's something that

2641
06:47:23.720 --> 06:47:48.069
Boardroom: the city staff didn't get to talk about enough is also how much work they're doing around revenues. I know we're focused really on cuts, because that's really where we're feeling the pain, but I also want the public to understand that the city manager's office and all the different offices are also looking for other sources of revenue. So that's grant funding, that's looking, of course, at fee increases, we are looking at a sales tax and also an infrastructure bond.

2642
06:47:48.370 --> 06:48:07.259
Boardroom: And, you know, I'm also really… I've also spoken to the city attorney's office about recouping more money, with litigation, or writing, letters, to folks, legal letters, to bring in more funding for money that's owed to the city, because there's actually a lot of money, millions of dollars, that's owed to the city that hasn't been brought in.

2643
06:48:07.260 --> 06:48:18.799
Boardroom: And I've also been working very closely in my office, and many of the other offices as well, to encourage tourism, to bring in people into our city, because this is a source of funding that doesn't require us

2644

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06:48:18.800 --> 06:48:37.939
Boardroom: to tax people more, and, it doesn't require us, it really just allows us to bring in more funding from outside of the city. And so we've been doing a lot more work around tourism, so I want to thank the Office of Economic Development for being a really important partner in that work, and, also the different business districts, Chamber of Commerce, Visit Berkeley.

2645
06:48:38.150 --> 06:49:03.119
Boardroom: In the event that the sales tax doesn't move forward or pass, although I've already said earlier in the evening that I will be working personally very hard on both taxes together, and want to encourage my Council colleagues to reach out if you have questions about that. But I… if the sales tax doesn't move forward, I've also asked staff to cost out mandatory time off and, and, I think the word is very

2646
06:49:03.120 --> 06:49:04.110
Boardroom: time off.

2647
06:49:04.110 --> 06:49:11.940
Boardroom: As well, options, including non-sworn officers, not including, sorry, not including sworn officers in fire and police.

2648
06:49:12.070 --> 06:49:27.300
Boardroom: And my understanding is that if we do an MTO, it'll garner approximately $7.6 million, which doesn't completely cover that… that money from the sales tax. And I understand also that this is a meet and confer issue with our labor partners.

2649
06:49:27.300 --> 06:49:42.950
Boardroom: But this could be something that's worth exploring, so I do want to just throw that out there, because I know we're concerned about losing positions, so this could potentially be something that would help prevent us from losing positions. So, I want to throw that out there. And then, as was mentioned by some other folks.

2650
06:49:42.950 --> 06:49:59.790
Boardroom: One thing that I am particularly interested in is, saving this Office of Economic Development position, as we've mentioned. Bringing in more funds into the city is really important to us, and so if there are positions that can assist with that, we really want to make sure we maintain those positions.

2651
06:50:00.000 --> 06:50:01.390
Boardroom: So…

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2652
06:50:01.660 --> 06:50:15.560
Boardroom: You know, as was mentioned, I will bring, another budget in, I'm working with my current Brown Act Circle, but I've also heard everyone's priorities as well, so we will work to, to try and

2653
06:50:15.800 --> 06:50:26.700
Boardroom: Bring those priorities in as much as possible, and of course, understanding, as was commented on earlier, that when we make, when we bring something back, that means we have to cut somewhere else.

2654
06:50:26.730 --> 06:50:41.030
Boardroom: So these… this really is about trade-offs, and those are really challenging. And, you have my word that I will do my absolute best to make sure that we are continuing to have this process that's transparent and accountable.

2655
06:50:41.030 --> 06:50:46.849
Boardroom: And that is respectful of the people that not only work for the city, but also live here, so…

2656
06:50:47.320 --> 06:50:53.899
Boardroom: Thank you all very much. It is 11.20, we have 10 minutes, and…

2657
06:50:54.480 --> 06:51:01.079
Boardroom: I think that there's a request to try to go to 11.45 to try to finish a few more of these.

2658
06:51:01.800 --> 06:51:06.620
Boardroom: Move to extend to 1145.

2659
06:51:08.490 --> 06:51:10.810
Boardroom: Quick… Oh, boy.

2660
06:51:11.280 --> 06:51:12.360
Boardroom: Second.

2661
06:51:12.740 --> 06:51:18.980
Boardroom: There's a second. I'm gonna ask you to take the roll on this one. A second from Councilmember Kassarwani.

2662
06:51:19.230 --> 06:51:25.469

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Boardroom: Okay, to extend to 1145… Councilmember Kisnerwani? Yes. Taplin?

2663
06:51:25.620 --> 06:51:26.730
Boardroom: No.

2664
06:51:27.060 --> 06:51:30.360
Boardroom: Bartlett? Yes. Trega? Aye.

2665
06:51:30.580 --> 06:51:31.820
Boardroom: O'Keefe.

2666
06:51:31.930 --> 06:51:32.920
Boardroom: Sure.

2667
06:51:33.300 --> 06:51:35.680
Boardroom: Blackaby? Yes.

2668
06:51:35.810 --> 06:51:37.360
Boardroom: Lunapara? Yes.

2669
06:51:37.940 --> 06:51:39.470
Boardroom: Humbert? Yeah.

2670
06:51:40.080 --> 06:51:57.680
Boardroom: Mayor Ishii? Yes, but only because Paul asked me. Okay. Me too. Motion carries. Sorry. I know. I'm sorry. Okay, alright, so, I know we have an order, we're gonna go as quickly as possible.

2671
06:51:57.870 --> 06:52:04.509
Boardroom: There are… the position, sorry, the… we've already opened the,

2672
06:52:05.730 --> 06:52:08.770
Boardroom: We've already opened all of them, but I just realized we also need to close.

2673
06:52:09.050 --> 06:52:13.949
Boardroom: the previous… item. Is there a motion? Motion close? Yeah. Second.

2674
06:52:14.400 --> 06:52:17.770

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Boardroom: Is there any opposition to closing the public hearing on the budget item?

2675
06:52:18.610 --> 06:52:27.520
Boardroom: Okay, the public hearing is closed. Alright, so we're gonna try to go 22, 23, 25, 26, 27, those are the ones that don't have, presentations.

2676
06:52:27.650 --> 06:52:30.960
Boardroom: And then, go from there. So…

2677
06:52:31.220 --> 06:52:38.689
Boardroom: We're going to… we've already opened the public hearing, but we're gonna start with item number 22. There's no presentation on that, but are there any questions?

2678
06:52:39.690 --> 06:52:40.380
Boardroom: Oh.

2679
06:52:40.410 --> 06:52:58.530
Boardroom: Questions? Yes? I just have one comment before you start. Thank you, Madam Mayor. Thank you for… thank you all. Really appreciate you extending this meeting until 1145, so that we can get through at least the ones with no presentations for the staff that have been sitting here all night. That's much appreciated. So for this item, one quick note is that we do have a fee in here.

2680
06:52:58.530 --> 06:53:00.430
Boardroom: for,

2681
06:53:00.830 --> 06:53:09.590
Boardroom: for the senior-owned licenses for altered animals, which means animals that have been spayed or neutered. And it turns out that we,

2682
06:53:10.030 --> 06:53:21.250
Boardroom: We don't have to actually charge that fee per our Berkeley Municipal Code, so I want to strike that fee out for the 3 years we have it in there for senior altered animal permits.

2683
06:53:23.480 --> 06:53:26.950
Boardroom: Okay, thank you very much. Any other questions?

2684
06:53:27.270 --> 06:53:32.229

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Boardroom: Is there public comment on this item? Item number 22, Animal Care Services Fee Schedule?

2685
06:53:34.370 --> 06:53:43.439
Boardroom: Is there… oh, this person online, are you making comment for item number 22, animal care services fee schedule?

2686
06:53:46.160 --> 06:53:47.360
Boardroom: We'll try them.

2687
06:53:47.630 --> 06:53:54.489
Boardroom: This caller ending in 211, this is for public comment only on the animal care services fee schedule.

2688
06:53:55.860 --> 06:54:02.089
1510****211: I want to wait until to make public comment and non-agenda items. I will, I will mute myself.

2689
06:54:02.430 --> 06:54:05.060
Boardroom: So we're gonna wait for that. Thank you.

2690
06:54:05.230 --> 06:54:23.409
Boardroom: Okay, is there any… are there any comments on this item? Oh, Councilmember Blackaby. One quick question, just, for, for staff. I know that, the total budget is about $2.5 million, and we're generating about $300,000 in revenue. Is there anything else we can do to close the gap? I mean, raising these fees is what we're doing. Is there any way that, I mean.

2691
06:54:23.460 --> 06:54:25.509
Boardroom: Is it appropriate to think about this ever?

2692
06:54:25.720 --> 06:54:29.629
Boardroom: Revenues covering costs, or is this always going to be running a deficit out of this fund?

2693
06:54:30.540 --> 06:54:35.830
Boardroom: I think it's unlikely that we're going to be able to fully recover our costs with fees.

2694
06:54:38.250 --> 06:54:53.820
Boardroom: Okay, Council… or Vice Mayor Trey Gobb. I move the staff recommendation as amended by Paul. Second. I need to close the public

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hearing. Oh. And I also move to close the public hearing. And I'll second that motion. Is there any opposition to closing the public hearing?

2695
06:54:54.770 --> 06:54:57.030
Boardroom: Alright, the public hearing is closed.

2696
06:54:57.220 --> 06:55:04.420
Boardroom: And you want to make a motion to move the recommendation? Yes. Second again.

2697
06:55:04.700 --> 06:55:11.759
Boardroom: Is there any opposition to approving the Animal Care Services Fee Schedule item as recommended by the City Manager?

2698
06:55:13.190 --> 06:55:19.219
Boardroom: Nope. Alright. We will pass that then, by unanimous consent. Thank you very much.

2699
06:55:19.360 --> 06:55:26.060
Boardroom: We are moving on to item 23, which is the Neighborhood Services Code Enforcement Fee Schedule. Are there any questions about this?

2700
06:55:29.280 --> 06:55:33.770
Boardroom: Okay, is there any public comment on item number 23?

2701
06:55:34.120 --> 06:55:36.889
Boardroom: Neighborhood Services Code Enforcement Fee Schedule.

2702
06:55:38.130 --> 06:55:43.569
Boardroom: No comments online, no raised hands. Okay, very good. I move to close the public hearing. Second.

2703
06:55:44.010 --> 06:55:46.299
Boardroom: Is there any opposition to closing the public hearing?

2704
06:55:47.250 --> 06:55:50.499
Boardroom: Public hearing is closed. I move the item. Second.

2705
06:55:51.190 --> 06:55:57.480
Boardroom: Okay, is there any… is there any opposition to approving the recommendation from item 23?

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2706
06:55:58.510 --> 06:56:12.209
Boardroom: All right, we will pass that as well. Thank you very much. Thank you very much, Peter. All right, moving on to item 25, which is the fees, health, housing, and community services facility rental fees.

2707
06:56:13.200 --> 06:56:15.649
Boardroom: Are there any questions?

2708
06:56:17.960 --> 06:56:21.830
Boardroom: Nope. Is there any public comment on this item?

2709
06:56:22.480 --> 06:56:39.669
Boardroom: Carol, are you moving up here for public comment? No. Okay. Any public comment online for fees, health, housing, community services, facility rental fees? No hands raised, no. All right, very good. I move to close the public hearing. Okay. Is there a second? Second. Is there any opposition to closing the public hearing?

2710
06:56:40.230 --> 06:56:44.200
Boardroom: Public hearing is closed. I move that staff recommendations have it. Second.

2711
06:56:44.420 --> 06:56:48.059
Boardroom: Is there any opposition to approving the staff recommendation?

2712
06:56:49.550 --> 06:57:00.540
Boardroom: All right, staff recommendation is approved. Thank you very much, Tonya. Moving on to item number 26, changes to selective recreation facilities and program fees.

2713
06:57:01.640 --> 06:57:04.400
Boardroom: Is there… are there any questions for this item?

2714
06:57:06.410 --> 06:57:17.639
Boardroom: Okay, is there any public comment on this item? This is item number 26, those changes to selected recreation facilities and program fees. Please raise your hand if you have any questions, comments.

2715
06:57:20.940 --> 06:57:24.369
Boardroom: Seeing none, I will see if there's a motion to close the public hearing.

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2716
06:57:24.540 --> 06:57:30.469
Boardroom: Oh, wait, John Kaner raised his hand. Okay, apologies. John Kaner.

2717
06:57:31.920 --> 06:57:34.690
John Caner: Yeah, what happened to item 24?

2718
06:57:35.870 --> 06:57:43.339
Boardroom: We skipped that item, we're not on that item right now, because that one involves a presentation, so we will likely not have time this evening.

2719
06:57:43.340 --> 06:57:44.730
John Caner: Okay, thank you.

2720
06:57:47.480 --> 06:57:51.840
Boardroom: Alright, is there a motion to close the public hearing? I have to close the public hearing.

2721
06:57:52.400 --> 06:57:53.959
Boardroom: Is there a second? Second.

2722
06:57:54.060 --> 06:57:57.359
Boardroom: Is there any opposition to closing the public hearing?

2723
06:57:57.930 --> 06:58:13.200
Boardroom: All right, we have closed the public hearing for item number 25. I move the staff recommendation. Second. Whatever. Staff recommendation? Okay. And there's a second from Councilmember Humbert. Is there any opposition to approving the staff recommendation?

2724
06:58:14.240 --> 06:58:17.890
Boardroom: 26. Sorry, thank you. 26.

2725
06:58:18.460 --> 06:58:23.660
Boardroom: All right. We have approved the staff recommendation for item number 26.

2726
06:58:24.140 --> 06:58:31.470
Boardroom: Moving on to, thank you very much, item number 27, changes to the planning and development fee schedule.

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2727
06:58:33.200 --> 06:58:34.550
Boardroom: Hi, folks!

2728
06:58:34.870 --> 06:58:36.620
Boardroom: Are there any questions?

2729
06:58:38.610 --> 06:58:44.930
Boardroom: Okay, question from Councilmember Casserwani. Yes, Director Klein, I just wanted to make sure I'm understanding correctly, so is…

2730
06:58:45.080 --> 06:58:49.909
Boardroom: We are increasing fees for appeals, correct?

2731
06:58:50.880 --> 06:59:05.329
Boardroom: I'm here with Jim Bondi, Associate Management Analyst. I'll let Jim field this. Okay. Only for building official appeals, which, until about a year ago, none of us could ever remember having received, and then we've gotten about 3 of them in the last 18 months.

2732
06:59:05.360 --> 06:59:17.510
Boardroom: And we created a fee last year, and it's not sufficient, so we're articulating it better, but the rate is not increasing. Land use appeals are not being increased. Okay, how much are the land use appeal amounts?

2733
06:59:19.120 --> 06:59:33.709
Boardroom: I think they're in here. So, there's a number of different appeals. So, an appeal of a ZAB decision by anyone other than the applicant is $3,000. That was increased last May.

2734
06:59:33.720 --> 06:59:46.429
Boardroom: And an appeal, I think it was doubled, I believe, last May, from $1,500 to $3,000. Okay, okay, I saw those fee amounts, so they have already been increased to reflect cost.

2735
06:59:46.900 --> 06:59:56.249
Boardroom: I would say we're not quite at cost recovery there. We considered proposing an increase again this year, but felt like…

2736
06:59:56.450 --> 07:00:05.049
Boardroom: increases in consecutive years. We just… we weren't ready to propose an increase, but it's something that we're gonna look at for next year. Okay, alright.

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2737
07:00:05.160 --> 07:00:06.130
Boardroom: Thank you.

2738
07:00:06.610 --> 07:00:09.900
Boardroom: Any other questions? Oh, Council Vice Mayor Treykov?

2739
07:00:10.150 --> 07:00:24.950
Boardroom: Yeah, thank you. Just wanted to confirm, under PV or, battery storage install, sorry, are there any proposals to change that, or does that stay static?

2740
07:00:25.520 --> 07:00:38.270
Boardroom: It's static, and in fact, we, because a few of the other percentage fees might impact those, we have built in a, language into the resolution which will keep those within the state-mandated caps.

2741
07:00:38.270 --> 07:00:45.859
Boardroom: Even if the percentages would otherwise have put them over those caps. Great. That's the answer I was hoping to hear, so thank you for confirming.

2742
07:00:46.270 --> 07:00:56.779
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Any other questions? Are there any comments on this item? We are on item number 27, which is changing to the planning and development fee schedule.

2743
07:00:57.320 --> 07:00:58.590
Boardroom: Anybody online?

2744
07:00:58.970 --> 07:01:06.569
Boardroom: No hands raised on that. Okay, is there a motion to close the public hearing? Motion to close the public hearing. Second. Second. Is there any opposition to closing the public hearing?

2745
07:01:07.220 --> 07:01:12.079
Boardroom: Alright, we have closed the public hearing for item number 27. I'll move the item. Second.

2746
07:01:12.300 --> 07:01:14.919
Boardroom: Is there any opposition to moving the recommendation?

2747

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07:01:16.410 --> 07:01:20.310
Boardroom: Okay, recommendation has been approved, thank you very much.

2748
07:01:20.600 --> 07:01:23.840
Boardroom: Alright, that was actually our final one.

2749
07:01:23.980 --> 07:01:28.170
Boardroom: for the evening.

2750
07:01:28.170 --> 07:01:45.849
Boardroom: So, that… by the way, that left 24, 28, and 29 that we will not be able to finish for this evening. Since we've already opened the public hearing, what is the protocol? So we can continue, the public hearing on 24, 28, and 29 to the June 9th.

2751
07:01:45.940 --> 07:01:46.880
Boardroom: Meeting?

2752
07:01:47.240 --> 07:01:54.189
Boardroom: Or another date, if… Yes, I think that makes sense, given our conversations about the upcoming meetings.

2753
07:01:54.950 --> 07:01:57.720
Boardroom: All right. Is there a motion? Is there a motion?

2754
07:01:58.660 --> 07:02:04.080
Boardroom: Okay, is there any opposition to the motion?

2755
07:02:04.630 --> 07:02:07.529
Boardroom: Which is to continue these items, this is the June 9th meeting.

2756
07:02:07.960 --> 07:02:10.140
Boardroom: All right, motion is approved.

2757
07:02:10.410 --> 07:02:13.929
Boardroom: Alright, we have moved those items.

2758
07:02:14.270 --> 07:02:15.670
Boardroom: to the…

2759

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07:02:15.840 --> 07:02:34.800
Boardroom: June 9th meeting. Is there any public comment for items not listed on the agenda? Yes, Carol? Yes, physical disabilities and homeless services programs. I speak as Carol Morasovic, Chair of the Homeless Services Panel of Experts. So when we were at Pathways, Astair, doing a site visit.

2760
07:02:34.800 --> 07:02:41.019
Boardroom: I asked, as I had other programs, how would you accommodate persons who are blind slash

2761
07:02:41.020 --> 07:02:47.370
Boardroom: Visually impaired, deaf slash hearing impaired, and we, we were told

2762
07:02:48.180 --> 07:03:03.200
Boardroom: Maybe they don't belong here. Maybe they need to find another place. And this is especially… particularly concerning, because the city has just spent all this money, hundreds of thousands of dollars, making

2763
07:03:03.350 --> 07:03:25.930
Boardroom: This Pathway Stair Accessible. Another question that I asked every provider was, what would you cut if you had to cut 5%, 10%? And they said in Pathway Stairs, flex funds and a service coordinator, which is contrasted… I, I really… Kellen, will you give me a minute?

2764
07:03:25.930 --> 07:03:34.070
Boardroom: Please? Someone? Okay, okay, come on. Okay, let me conclude this. So this is particularly…

2765
07:03:34.070 --> 07:03:37.210
Boardroom: Contrast this with the other

2766
07:03:37.470 --> 07:03:47.560
Boardroom: programs that we visited that actually approached me afterwards, asking for accommodations, and and also.

2767
07:03:47.570 --> 07:04:06.870
Boardroom: The complaint from other providers at the motel conversions we visited, providers inside Housing Door today, was they were concerned that they didn't have enough availability of flex funds. And so this is something that's really important for the clients, but that's the response that we received at STARE.

2768

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07:04:06.900 --> 07:04:07.790
Boardroom: Thank you.

2769
07:04:08.300 --> 07:04:11.319
Boardroom: Thanks, Carol. Any other public comment online?

2770
07:04:11.990 --> 07:04:13.650
Boardroom: Non-agenda items?

2771
07:04:13.790 --> 07:04:19.409
Boardroom: Yes, caller with a phone number ending in 211.

2772
07:04:22.570 --> 07:04:30.170
1510****211: Okay, this is a totally different topic. I'm really concerned about that, the…

2773
07:04:30.410 --> 07:04:40.679
1510****211: hantavirus in the Midwest, the Southern is now it is in the Strip, and it's coming to the United States. Also, Apollo and Africa. These are very dangerous.

2774
07:04:41.030 --> 07:04:45.490
1510****211: Covid-19 is a little baby compared to these giant colors.

2775
07:04:45.760 --> 07:04:50.870
1510****211: So we have to be very careful, we have to research. As far as the business community.

2776
07:04:51.080 --> 07:04:59.860
1510****211: All of the shutdown places in Berkeley should be open, should be staffed, should have businesses. The City of Berkeley created Emeryville by being anti-business.

2777
07:05:00.090 --> 07:05:13.810
1510****211: Here's that policy. Mayor Ishii, you're a great woman, we need your help. Let us fill all of these empty places with good, thriving business that can bring tax money to the city, and good service and sales to

2778
07:05:13.890 --> 07:05:20.150
1510****211: residents of Berkeley and the whole Bay Area. We did over $200 million of business over the last 53 years.

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2779
07:05:20.510 --> 07:05:24.880
1510****211: Let us make example of Eid to everybody else. Thank you.

2780
07:05:24.880 --> 07:05:25.570
TELEPHONE_USER: Good night.

2781
07:05:25.570 --> 07:05:29.719
Boardroom: Have a good night. One more, we have, Chris Devere Kohler.

2782
07:05:32.640 --> 07:05:37.949
Christoverre Kohler: Hello, all. I just wanted to add to, Ms. Marausevich's remarks that,

2783
07:05:38.550 --> 07:05:56.240
Christoverre Kohler: I happen to have completed the HUD training in auditing recipients and subrecipients of federal funding, and it's quite detailed. I know that our commission goes and does site visits, but nowhere near the same kind of audit. And I'm wondering if the city has any function

2784
07:05:56.450 --> 07:05:59.770
Christoverre Kohler: That kind to audit their efficacy.

2785
07:06:02.320 --> 07:06:03.220
Christoverre Kohler: Thank you.

2786
07:06:04.140 --> 07:06:05.130
Boardroom: Thank you!

2787
07:06:05.300 --> 07:06:08.919
Boardroom: Any other public comment for non-agenda?

2788
07:06:09.650 --> 07:06:20.299
Boardroom: No, no more. Okay. Thank you very much. Is there a motion to adjourn? Second. All right, any opposition to adjournment? We are adjourned. Thank you all so much.

2789
07:06:21.550 --> 07:06:24.399
Boardroom: Anyway, good property, good property.

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